The Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa

Pūrṇapramukhāvadānaśataka · Toh 343 · Derge Kangyur
གང་པ་ལོ་སགོས་པའི་རྟོགས་པ་བརྗོད་པ་བརྒྱ་པ།

The Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, known in Sanskrit as the Avadānaśataka and in Tibetan as Gang po la sogs pa'i rtogs pa brjod pa brgya pa, is a great collection of one hundred avadānas, or stories of noble deeds, illustrating how actions bear fruit across lifetimes. Grouped in decades, each introduced by a short summary verse, its tales tell of brahmins, merchants, kings, gods, and spirits who, through acts of faith, generosity, and devotion toward the Buddha and his community, come to receive predictions of future awakening, to attain arhatship, or to reap the results of their past deeds, while the Buddha reveals the karmic histories behind their fortunes. The collection closes with accounts of the Buddha's passing and of King Aśoka, a century later, learning from the elder Upagupta the deeds that shaped a remarkable monk's life. It is Toh 343 in the Kangyur, belonging to the General Sūtra section, and was translated into Tibetan by the Indian preceptor Jinamitra together with the Tibetan editor-translator Devacandra.

In the language of India: Pūrṇapramukha Avadānaśatika. In the language of Tibet: The Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa. The first section.

Homage to the Omniscient One.

The summary:

The good Pūrṇa and Yaśomatī,
The lazy one and the caravan leaders,
Great Candra and Padma,
Pañcāla and the incense,
And the king, named at the end:
This is the summary of the chapter.

In a certain region there lived a brahmin called Pūrṇa. At that time the Blessed Buddha was honored, esteemed, revered and worshipped by kings, great ministers, wealthy men, the people of the royal court, guild leaders, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. The Blessed Buddha, worshipped and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, was endowed with great merit and received robes, food, bedding, seats, medicines for the sick and other

requisites. The Buddha had newly appeared, and the time had come to drink the essence of the scriptures. He taught perfectly to all, from the gods down to human beings. Together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, he was staying at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove, at the Kalandaka feeding ground.

Not long after the Blessed One had become a perfectly and completely awakened buddha, the world was filled with his fame. Now, in the region called Dakṣiṇāgiri, there lived a great and eminent brahmin called Pūrṇa. He was rich, with much wealth and great means, with extensive and vast possessions; he had wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa and rivaled the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He was also endowed with faith, virtuous and of good intention, dedicated to his own benefit and to the benefit of others, greatly compassionate and of great nobility, eager for the Dharma, keen to give away, delighting in generosity, rejoicing in giving abundantly, and dwelling in great liberality. For a time he held a sacrificial feast for all who had gone forth, and many thousands of non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) and others ate food there.

At the time when the Blessed One had tamed King Bimbisāra and his retinue, and through his taming many hundreds of thousands of living beings had been tamed, relatives of Pūrṇa came from Rājagṛha and spoke in praise of the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha in front of Pūrṇa. When the great and eminent brahmin Pūrṇa heard of the Blessed One's qualities, he was filled with great joy. Then he went up onto the roof of his house, sat facing in the direction of Rājagṛha, set both kneecaps on the ground, scattered flowers, offered incense and water, and made this request to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, please come to my sacrificial feast! Please look upon the enclosure of my sacrifice!"

Then, through the buddha power of the buddhas and the divine power of the gods, those flowers became a house of flowers above the Blessed One. The incense became like a canopy of cloud. The water became like a column of beryl.

Then the venerable Ānanda joined his palms and asked the Blessed One, "Venerable One, where has this invitation come from?"

The Blessed One declared: "Ānanda, in the region called Dakṣiṇāgiri there lives a great and eminent brahmin called Pūrṇa, and we must go there. Monks, get ready!"

Then the Blessed One, attended by a thousand monks, set out wandering through the region of Dakṣiṇāgiri. When he had come to a place near the

enclosure of the great and eminent brahmin Pūrṇa's sacrifice, he reflected, "I shall bring the brahmin Pūrṇa to faith by a miraculous display of magical power." Then the Blessed One made those thousand monks invisible, and, all alone, carrying his alms bowl and water pot in his hand, went to a place near Pūrṇa.

Then the great and eminent brahmin Pūrṇa saw the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty minor marks, adorned with a halo of light a fathom wide, possessed of a light surpassing a thousand suns, like a moving mountain of jewels, excellent in every way. On seeing him, he went very quickly up to the Blessed One and said to him: "Welcome, Blessed One! Blessed One, please be seated. For my benefit, will you consent to partake of food?"

The Blessed One declared, "If you are giving it away completely, give it into this alms bowl."

Then the great and eminent brahmin Pūrṇa, attended by five hundred brahmin youths, began to fill the Blessed One's alms bowl with various kinds of food: cakes, cooked dishes, soft foods, foods to be licked, foods to be sucked, and so on. And the Blessed One transferred that food from his own alms bowl into the alms bowls of the thousand monks. When the Blessed One knew that the alms bowls of the thousand monks were full, at that moment he showed his own alms bowl to be full. Then he made the thousand monks appear, seated in the shape of a crescent moon, with their alms bowls full. And the gods abiding in the sky also proclaimed aloud, "The alms bowls of the Blessed One and of the thousand monks have been filled!"

Then, through that display of miracles, the great and eminent brahmin Pūrṇa was delighted. Joyful, pleased, overjoyed, rejoicing, delighted and happy in mind, he fell at the feet of the Blessed One like a tree cut off at the root, bowed down, and made this aspiration: "By this root of virtue, by this arousing of the mind, and by this complete giving away of what is to be given, in this world that is blind, without a guide and wholly without a leader, may I become a buddha who ferries across the beings who have not crossed, frees those who are not freed, gives relief to those who have not found relief, and brings to complete nirvāṇa those who have not attained complete nirvāṇa."

Then the Blessed One, knowing how the great and eminent brahmin Pūrṇa's causes followed one upon another and how his actions followed one upon another, smiled. Now it is the nature of things that whenever the blessed

buddhas smile, rays of light, blue, yellow, red and white, come forth from their mouths at that time. Some go downward and some go upward.

Those that go downward go to the hells: Saṃjīva, Kālasūtra, Saṃghāta, Raurava, Mahāraurava, Tapana, Pratāpana and Avīci; and the Blistering hell, the hell of Bursting Blisters, the hell of Chattering Teeth, the hell of Crying "Alas!", the hell of Crying "Achoo!", the hell Split like a Blue Lotus, the hell Split like a Lotus, and the hell Split like a Great Lotus. Into those that are hot hells they descend as coolness; into those that are cold hells they descend as warmth. Then the particular torments of those beings are soothed. Then they think, "Oh! Have we died and passed from here, or have we been born somewhere else?" Then, in order to arouse faith in them, the Blessed One sends forth an emanation, and when they see the emanation they think, "Oh! We have not died and passed from here, nor have we been born somewhere else. Rather, it is through the power of this being, never seen before, who has appeared, that our particular torments have been soothed." Then their minds become joyful toward the emanation, and the karma that was to be experienced in hell is exhausted, and they take rebirth among gods and humans, wherever they may become fit vessels for the truths.

Those that go upward go to the gods of the Four Great Kings, the Thirty-Three, the Yāma gods, the Tuṣita gods, the Nirmāṇarati gods, the Paranirmitavaśavartin gods, the Brahmakāyika gods, the Brahmapurohita gods, the Mahābrahmā gods, the gods of Limited Light, Immeasurable Light and Clear Light, the gods of Limited Virtue, Immeasurable Virtue and Expansive Virtue, the Cloudless gods, the Merit-Born gods, the gods of Great Fruit, the gods Not Greater, the gods Without Torment, the gods of Fine Appearance, the gods of Perfect Vision, and as far as the gods of Akaniṣṭha, and there they proclaim the sound of impermanence, suffering, emptiness and selflessness. They also recite two verses:

"Undertake renunciation!
Apply yourselves to the Buddha's teaching!
As an elephant crushes a house of reeds,
Crush the army of the Lord of Death!

Whoever, in this very Dharma and Vinaya,
Conducts himself with heedfulness
Will completely abandon the cycle of birth
And bring suffering to an end."

So they recite. Then those rays of light circle the great trichiliocosm, the world-system of a thousand million worlds, and follow along behind the Blessed One himself. If the Blessed One wishes to explain past deeds, they vanish into the Blessed One's back. If he wishes to explain future deeds, they vanish into his front. If he wishes to foretell a birth in hell, they vanish into the soles of his feet. If he wishes to foretell a birth as an animal, they vanish into his heels. If he wishes to foretell a birth as a hungry ghost, they vanish into his big toes. If he wishes to foretell a birth as a human, they vanish into his two knees. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a wheel-turning king of force, they vanish into the palm of his left hand. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a wheel-turning king, they vanish into the palm of his right hand. If he wishes to foretell a birth as a god, they vanish into his navel. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a śrāvaka, they vanish into his mouth. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a pratyekabuddha, they vanish into the space between his eyebrows. If he wishes to foretell unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, they vanish into the crown protuberance on his head.

Then those rays of light circled the Blessed One three times and vanished into the crown protuberance on the Blessed One's head. Then the venerable Ānanda joined his palms and said to the Blessed One:

"Variegated, interwoven with a thousand hues,
Many rays have come forth from the doorway of your mouth.
They have lit up every direction,
Just as the rising sun does."

And again he spoke in verse:

"The buddhas, free of agitation, who have abandoned pride and displeasure,
Who have become the supreme cause for beings,
The victors who have conquered the foe, do not without cause or condition
Show a smile the color of lotus root and conch.

Steadfast One, since with your own understanding you know the time has come,
O Lord of Victors among śramaṇas, for the listeners who are in doubt,
With the supreme, steadfast and excellent words of the bull among sages,
Please dispel the doubts that have arisen.

The protectors, the perfect buddhas, steadfast as the ocean and the king of mountains,
Do not show a smile without reason.

The reason for which the heroes show a smile,
A great many people long to hear from you."

The Blessed One declared: "Ānanda, so it is; it is just so. Ānanda, the tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas, do not smile without cause and without condition. Ānanda, did you see this great and eminent brahmin pay me such honor?"

"Venerable One, I saw it."

"Ānanda, by this root of virtue, this arousing of the mind, and this complete giving away of what is to be given, this great and eminent brahmin will fully accomplish the awakening that is to be fully accomplished over three incalculable eons. He will perfect the six perfections, wholly suffused with great compassion, and will become a perfectly and completely awakened buddha called the good Pūrṇa, endowed with the ten powers, the four fearlessnesses, the three unmixed applications of mindfulness, and great compassion, and he will appear in the world. His gift is this one, through which his mind became joyful toward me."

At the time when the Blessed One foretold the great and eminent brahmin Pūrṇa's unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, Pūrṇa fed the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas for three months in the enclosure of his sacrifice, and beyond that he also generated roots of virtue of many different kinds.

"Monks, therefore you should train in this way: 'We shall honor the Teacher. We shall esteem him. We shall revere him. We shall worship him. Having honored, esteemed, revered and worshipped the Teacher, we shall live in dependence on him.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and highly praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Yaśomatī.

The Blessed Buddha was honored, esteemed, revered and worshipped by kings, great ministers, wealthy men, the people of the royal court, guild leaders, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. The Blessed Buddha, worshipped and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, was endowed with great merit and received robes, food, bedding, seats, medicines for the sick and

other requisites. Together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, he was staying at Vaiśālī, in the Kūṭāgāra Hall on the bank of the Markaṭa Pond.

Then, in the morning, the Blessed One put on his lower robe and his Dharma robe, took up his alms bowl, and, attended by the assembly of monks and with the Saṅgha of monks going before him, went into Vaiśālī for alms. Having gone on his alms round through Vaiśālī in due order, he went to the house of General Siṃha, and when he arrived he sat down on the seat that had been prepared.

Now General Siṃha had a daughter-in-law called Yaśomatī, who was beautiful, good to look upon and lovely. When she saw the Blessed One, blazing with the major and minor marks of every kind, she was filled with great joy. She asked her father-in-law, "Is there perhaps some means by which I too might come to possess such qualities?"

Then General Siṃha thought, "Ah, this girl is inclined toward what is vast. If she meets with the right condition, she will make an aspiration for unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening." Knowing this, he said, "Girl, if you take up the cause correctly and keep to it, you too will become just like the Blessed One." Then, to increase Yaśomatī's faith, General Siṃha gave her much money, gold and many jewels.

Then Yaśomatī invited the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas to her house for the midday meal on the following day, and the Blessed One consented, in order to benefit her. Then the girl Yaśomatī had flowers made of gold, silver and jewels, and she gathered much incense, many garlands of flowers and many ointments. Having also laid out food of a hundred flavors, she sent a messenger to the Blessed One to announce the meal: "Venerable One, the time for the midday meal has come and the food is ready. Now, if the Blessed One sees that the time has come, please come."

Then the Blessed One, attended by the assembly of monks and with the Saṅgha of monks going before him, went to the house of General Siṃha, and when he arrived he sat down on the seat prepared in the midst of the Saṅgha of monks. Then the girl Yaśomatī, seeing that the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha was comfortably seated, satisfied them with her own hands with food of a hundred flavors, and scattered flowers over the Blessed One. Then, through the buddha power of the buddhas and the divine power of the gods, those flowers became, above the Blessed One, a house of jewels and a pavilion with jewel banners, such as not even a smith or a smith's apprentice,

however well trained, could make.

Then, when the girl Yaśomatī saw that utterly wondrous miracle, which brings gods and humans to faith, she fell at the feet of the Blessed One with her whole body, like a tree cut off at the root, bowed down, and made this aspiration: "By this root of virtue, by this arousing of the mind, and by this complete giving away of what is to be given, in this world that is blind, without a guide and wholly without a leader, may I become a buddha who ferries across the beings who have not crossed, frees those who are not freed, gives relief to those who have not found relief, and brings to complete nirvāṇa those who have not attained complete nirvāṇa."

Then the Blessed One, knowing how the girl Yaśomatī's causes followed one upon another and how her actions followed one upon another, smiled. Now it is the nature of things that whenever the blessed buddhas smile, rays of light, blue, yellow, red and white, come forth from their mouths at that time. Some go downward and some go upward.

Those that go downward go to the hells Saṃjīva, Kālasūtra, Saṃghāta, Raurava, Mahāraurava, Tapana, Pratāpana, Avīci, Arbuda, Nirarbuda, Aṭaṭa, Huhuva, Hahava, Utpala, Padma and Mahāpadma. Into those that are hot hells they descend having become cool, and into those that are cold hells they descend having become warm. In this way the various torments of those beings are soothed. Then those beings think, "Oh! Have we died and passed away from here, or have we been born somewhere else?" Then, in order to inspire faith in them, the Blessed One sends forth an emanation, and when they see the emanation they think, "Oh! We have neither died and passed away from here nor been born somewhere else. Rather, it is through the power of this being, never seen before, that our various torments have been soothed." Then, their minds rejoicing in the emanation, the karma that was to be experienced in the hells is exhausted, and they take rebirth among gods and humans, where they will become fit vessels for the truths.

Those that go upward go to the gods of the Four Great Kings, the Thirty-Three, the Yāma gods, the Tuṣita gods, the Nirmāṇarati gods, the Paranirmitavaśavartin gods, the Brahmakāyika gods, the Brahmapurohita gods, the Mahābrahmā gods, the Parīttābha gods, the Apramāṇābha gods, the Ābhāsvara gods, the Parīttaśubha gods, the Apramāṇaśubha gods, the Śubhakṛtsna gods, the Anabhraka gods, the Puṇyaprasava gods, the Bṛhatphala gods, the Abṛha gods, the Atapa gods, the Sudṛśa gods, the

Sudarśana gods, and as far as the gods of Akaniṣṭha, and they proclaim the sounds of impermanence, suffering, emptiness and selflessness. They also recite two verses:

Set out upon renunciation!
Apply yourselves to the Buddha's teaching!
As an elephant crushes a hut of reeds,
Crush the army of the Lord of Death!

Whoever in this very Dharma and Vinaya
Conducts himself with heedfulness
Will utterly abandon the cycle of births
And bring suffering to an end.

So they recite. Then those rays of light, having circled the great trichiliocosm, return and follow after the Blessed One himself. If the Blessed One wishes to explain past deeds, they vanish into the Blessed One's back. If he wishes to foretell future deeds, they vanish into his front. If he wishes to foretell rebirth in the hells, they vanish into the soles of his feet. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as an animal, they vanish into his heels. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a hungry ghost, they vanish into his big toes. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a human, they vanish into his two knees. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a king who turns the wheel by force, they vanish into the palm of his left hand. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a wheel-turning king (cakravartin), they vanish into the palm of his right hand. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a god, they vanish into his navel. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a śrāvaka, they vanish into his mouth. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a pratyekabuddha, they vanish into the space between his eyebrows. If he wishes to foretell unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, they vanish into the crown protuberance on his head.

Then those rays of light circled the Blessed One three times and vanished into the crown protuberance on the Blessed One's head. Then the venerable Ānanda joined his palms and said to the Blessed One:

Variegated, interspersed with a thousand hues,
Many rays have issued from the door of your mouth;
They have made all the directions shine
Just as the rising sun does.

And again he addressed him in verse:

Free of agitation, rid of pride and dejection,
The buddhas, who have become the supreme cause for beings,
The victors who have conquered the foe, do not, without cause or condition,
Show a smile the color of lotus root and conch.

Steadfast one, since by your own understanding you know the time has come,
O lord of ascetics, for the listeners who are in doubt,
Bull among sages, with your supreme, firm
And excellent words, please dispel the doubts that have arisen.

The protectors, the perfect buddhas, steadfast as the ocean and the king of mountains,
Do not show a smile without reason.
That for whose sake, O hero, you show a smile,
The great multitude longs to hear from you.

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, so it is. So it is. Ānanda, the tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas, do not smile without cause and without condition. Ānanda, did you see this girl Yaśomatī pay me such honor?"

"Reverend One, I saw it."

"Ānanda, through this root of virtue, this generation of the mind of awakening, and this complete giving away of things to be given, Yaśomatī will accomplish the awakening that is to be accomplished over three incalculable eons. Having perfected the six perfections, permeated by great compassion, she will become a perfectly and completely awakened buddha named Ratnavat, endowed with the ten powers, the four fearlessnesses, the three unmixed applications of mindfulness, and great compassion, and will appear in the world. Her gift is this: that her mind rejoiced in me."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the monks were delighted and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Lazy One.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace retinue, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras and great mahoragas. Worshiped and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras and great mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and

medicines and requisites for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time there lived in Śrāvastī a merchant who was rich, of great wealth and great means, with vast and extensive possessions, possessed of the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He took a wife from a family of equal standing, and he played, made love and enjoyed himself with her. Yet though he played, made love and enjoyed himself, he had neither son nor daughter. Resting his cheek on his hand, he sat brooding, thinking, "Although my house is endowed with much wealth, I have neither son nor daughter. Since I have no son, after I pass away everything I own will fall to the king."

Then ascetics, brahmins, soothsayers, friends, relatives and other kinsfolk urged him, "Pray to the gods!" There is a saying in the world that sons and daughters are born because of prayer, but that is not so. If sons and daughters were born because of prayer, then each person would have a thousand sons, like a wheel-turning king. In fact, sons and daughters are born from the coming together of three conditions. What are the three? The father and mother come together aroused by desire; the mother is in her season and fertile; and a gandharva is present. Sons and daughters are born from the coming together of these three conditions. Nevertheless, prompted by the ascetics, brahmins, soothsayers, friends, relatives and kinsfolk, he, being without a son and wanting a son, prayed to Śiva, Varuṇa, Kubera, Śakra (Indra), Brahmā and others, and to other particular gods as well: that is, he prayed to the gods of parks, the gods of forests, the gods of crossroads, the gods of three-way junctions, the gods who receive offerings, and the gods who are born together with one, who share one's nature, and who constantly follow one. And while he was devoting himself to prayer, a certain being died and passed away from a certain class of beings and entered his wife's womb.

Some women of wise nature have five special qualities. What are the five? They know when a man is passionate and when he is not passionate; they know the right time and know their fertile period; they know when they have conceived and know from whom they have conceived; and they know whether it is a boy or a girl: if it is a boy, it rests on the right side of the womb; if it is a girl, it rests on the left side of the womb.

Then she, overjoyed, told her husband, "My lord, I have conceived a child. Since it rests on the right side of my womb, it is certain to be a boy. Please rejoice!" He too was overjoyed, and lifting the upper part of his body and stretching out his right hand, he uttered these joyful words: "I shall see the face of the son I have long wished for! May my son be well formed, and not ill formed! May he do my tasks! May he support us in return for having been supported! May he enjoy his inheritance! May my lineage long endure! And after we have passed away and died, may he give gifts and make merit on our behalf, whether much or little, and dedicate the offering, saying, 'Wherever these two have been born and gone, may this go to them!'"

Knowing that she had conceived, he placed her at ease in the upper part of the mansion so as to care for the child. In the cold season she had things for the cold, and in the hot season things for the heat. She ate the foods prescribed by the physician, foods not too bitter, not too sour, not too salty, not too sweet, not too pungent, and not too astringent: foods free of bitterness, sourness, saltiness, sweetness, pungency and astringency. Her body adorned with necklaces and garlands, like a daughter of the gods roaming in the Nandana Grove, she moved from couch to couch and from seat to seat and did not come down to the ground below, and he saw to it that she heard no unpleasant sound whatsoever.

When eight or nine months had passed, she gave birth, and bore a boy who was handsome, good to look upon and beautiful. When he was born, everyone in the household rejoiced. They held a birth feast for his birth, and then they named him, asking, "What name shall we give this boy?" The relatives said, "Since at his birth everyone in the household rejoiced, let this boy be named Delighter." And so he was named Delighter.

Then the boy Delighter was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry him in their laps, two nurses to suckle him, two nurses to wash away dirt, and two nurses to play with him. The eight nurses raised and nourished him with milk, curd, butter, ghee, the cream of butter, and every other fine provision, so that he grew up quickly, like a lotus in a lake.

Then, when he had grown and was five or six years old, he became a lazy one, exceedingly lazy, not wanting even to rise from his bed and seat. Being sharp and clear-minded, he studied the treatises while remaining at home.

Then the merchant thought, "After I propitiated the gods, a son was born to me, as rarely as once in a hundred times, and yet he has become a lazy one,

exceedingly lazy, who does not even rise from his bed and seat. Though his body is normal, he just sits there like a cripple. What use is a son like this?"

Now the merchant was devoted to Pūraṇa. He invited the six non-Buddhist (tīrthika) teachers to his house, thinking, "If the boy sees them, perhaps he will be inspired to follow them and will at least get up from his bed." But when the lazy boy saw those teachers, he did not even look at them, let alone rise, speak respectfully, or offer them a seat. When the merchant saw this state of affairs he was even more deeply distressed, and resting his cheek on his hand, he sat brooding.

Now for the buddhas, the blessed ones, there is nothing that they do not know, do not see, do not realize or do not understand. The buddhas, the blessed ones, are endowed with great compassion, engaged in benefiting the world, the sole protectors, the sole heroes without equal, who never speak with a double tongue, who abide in calm abiding and insight, who illuminate the three knowledges, who are well trained in the three trainings, skilled in the three bases of discipline, who have crossed the four floods, the soles of whose feet, the four bases of miraculous power, stand most firm, who have long practiced the four means of attraction, who are fearless with the four fearlessnesses, who roar the great, true lion's roar of the bull, who have entirely abandoned the five factors, who have wholly transcended the five destinies, who are endowed with the six factors, who have perfected the six perfections, who dwell in the six constant abidings, who are rich in the flowers of the seven limbs of awakening, who teach the eightfold path, who are skilled in the nine successive meditative absorptions, who possess the strength of the ten powers, whose fame pervades the ten directions, and who are far more exalted even than the lord of the thousandfold world. By the nature of things, three times by day and three times by night, they look upon the world with the eye of a buddha, and the vision of their wisdom engages, thinking: "Who is declining? Who is prospering? Who is in want? Who has fallen into danger? Who is afflicted? Who is in want, in danger and afflicted? Who is inclined toward the lower realms? Who is sliding toward the lower realms? Who has fallen into the lower realms? Whom shall I lift out of the lower realms and establish in the higher realms, in liberation and in the fruit? Whom shall I pull out by the hand from sinking in the mire of sensual desire? Whom, lacking the seven noble riches, shall I make master of the sovereignty of the seven noble riches? In whom, where the roots of virtue have not been produced, shall I produce them? In whom, where the roots of virtue have already been

produced, shall I bring them to maturity? Whom, already matured, shall I liberate?"

Here it is said:

The ocean, the abode of sea monsters,
May perhaps let its tide pass by its time;
But for the children who are to be trained,
The Buddha never lets the time pass by.

Then the Blessed One saw: "If the lazy boy sees me, he will begin to exert diligence, and his mind will be turned toward unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening." Then, in order to cut through the arrogance and pride of the tīrthikas and to produce roots of virtue in the boy, the Blessed One sent forth golden rays of light surpassing the light of a thousand suns, and they illuminated that whole house. He also sent forth rays of loving-kindness, cultivated over a thousand eons, and as soon as they touched the boy's body it was filled with ease. He thought, "By whose power has my body been filled with ease?" and he looked all around.

Then the Blessed One, attended by the assembly of monks, entered that house, and the lazy boy saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessed of light surpassing a thousand suns, like a moving mountain of jewels, wholly excellent. Seeing him, he was overjoyed, and at once he got up by himself, arranged a seat for the Blessed One, and said, "Come, Blessed One! Welcome, Blessed One! Blessed One, please be seated on the seat that has been arranged." When his parents and the household saw this eager respect, never seen before, they were utterly amazed.

Then the lazy boy, with eyes bright with joy, bowed at the feet of the Blessed One and sat before him to hear the Dharma. The Blessed One spoke to him in many ways about the faults of laziness and the benefits of exerting diligence, and he also gave him a sandalwood staff and said, "Boy, strike this staff!" When he struck the staff, a sweet sound was heard, and he also saw various treasures of jewels. Then he thought, "Ah! Exerting diligence has such great advantages. I must certainly exert diligence again and again." He had it proclaimed in Śrāvastī with the sound of a bell, announcing that he himself would act as caravan leader, and he crossed the great ocean six times. Having accomplished the purpose of his voyages, he gathered great jewels, and he

invited the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas to a meal in his house and made an aspiration for unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

Then the Blessed One, knowing how the lazy boy's causes followed one upon another and how his actions followed one upon another, smiled. Now it is the nature of things that whenever the buddhas, the blessed ones, smile, rays of light, blue, yellow, red and white, come forth at that time from the door of their mouths. Some go downward and some go upward.

Those that go downward go to the hells Saṃjīva, Kālasūtra, Saṃghāta, Raurava, Mahāraurava, Tapana, Pratāpana, Avīci, Arbuda, Nirarbuda, Aṭaṭa, Huhuva, Hahava, Utpala, Padma and Mahāpadma. Into those that are hot hells they descend having become cool, and into those that are cold hells they descend having become warm. In this way the various torments of those beings are soothed. Then those beings think, "Oh! Have we died and passed away from here, or have we been born somewhere else?" Then, in order to inspire faith in them, the Blessed One sends forth an emanation, and when they see the emanation they think, "Oh! We have neither died and passed away from here nor been born somewhere else. Rather, it is through the power of this being, never seen before, that our various torments have been soothed." Then, their minds rejoicing in that emanation, the karma that was to be experienced in the hells is exhausted, and they take rebirth among gods and humans, where they will become fit vessels for the truths.

Those that go upward go to the gods of the Four Great Kings, the Thirty-Three, the Yāma gods, the Tuṣita gods, the Nirmāṇarati gods, the Paranirmitavaśavartin gods, the Brahmakāyika gods, the Brahmapurohita gods, the Mahābrahmā gods, the Parīttābha gods, the Apramāṇābha gods, the Ābhāsvara gods, the Parīttaśubha gods, the Apramāṇaśubha gods, the Śubhakṛtsna gods, the Anabhraka gods, the Puṇyaprasava gods, the Bṛhatphala gods, the Abṛha gods, the Atapa gods, the Sudṛśa gods, the Sudarśana gods, and as far as the gods of Akaniṣṭha, and they proclaim the sounds of impermanence, suffering, emptiness and selflessness. They also recite two verses:

Set out upon renunciation!
Apply yourselves to the Buddha's teaching!
As an elephant crushes a hut of reeds,
Crush the army of the Lord of Death!

Whoever in this very Dharma and Vinaya
Conducts himself with heedfulness
Will utterly abandon the cycle of births
And bring suffering to an end.

So they recite. Then those rays of light, having circled the great trichiliocosm, return and follow after the Blessed One himself. If the Blessed One wishes to explain past deeds, they vanish into the Blessed One's back. If he wishes to foretell future deeds, they vanish into his front. If he wishes to foretell rebirth in the hells, they vanish into the soles of his feet. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as an animal, they vanish into his heels. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a hungry ghost, they vanish into his big toes. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a human, they vanish into his two knees. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a king who turns the wheel by force, they vanish into the palm of his left hand. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a wheel-turning king, they vanish into the palm of his right hand. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a god, they vanish into his navel. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a śrāvaka, they vanish into his mouth. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a pratyekabuddha, they vanish into the tuft of hair between his eyebrows. If he wishes to foretell unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, they vanish into the crown protuberance on his head.

Then those rays of light circled the Blessed One three times and vanished into the crown protuberance on the Blessed One's head. Then the venerable Ānanda joined his palms and said to the Blessed One:

Variegated, interspersed with a thousand hues,
Many rays have issued from the door of your mouth;
They have made all the directions shine
Just as the rising sun does.

And again he addressed him in verse:

Free of agitation, rid of pride and dejection,
The buddhas, who have become the supreme cause for beings,
The victors who have conquered the foe, do not, without cause or condition,
Show a smile the color of lotus root and conch.

Steadfast one, since by your own understanding you know the time has come,
O lord of ascetics, for the listeners who are in doubt,
Bull among sages, with your supreme, firm
And excellent words, please dispel the doubts that have arisen.

The protectors, the perfect buddhas, steadfast as the ocean and the king of mountains,
Do not show a smile without reason.
That for whose sake, O hero, you show a smile,
The great multitude longs to hear from you.

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, so it is. So it is. Ānanda, the tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas, do not smile without cause and without condition. Ānanda, did you see this lazy boy pay me such honor?"

"Reverend One, I saw it."

"Ānanda, through this root of virtue, this generation of the mind of awakening, and this complete giving away of things to be given, this lazy boy will accomplish the awakening that is to be accomplished over three incalculable eons. Having perfected the six perfections, permeated by great compassion, he will become a perfectly and completely awakened buddha named Fully Endowed with Strength, Diligence and Prowess, possessed of the ten powers, the four fearlessnesses, the three unmixed applications of mindfulness, and great compassion, and will appear in the world. His gift is this: that he rejoiced in me."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the monks were delighted and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, Second Section.

The Caravan Leader.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace retinue, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras and great mahoragas. Worshiped and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras and great mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, in the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time in Śrāvastī there was a great caravan leader whose ship capsized on the great ocean, and he came back. Two and three times he prayed to all the gods, but whenever he set out on the great ocean, his ship still capsized

and he came back. Then great dejection arose in him, and he thought, "By what means can I gather wealth? What means is there?" Then he thought further, "This Buddha, the Blessed One, is far more exalted than all the gods. He is engaged in benefiting himself and benefiting others; he is compassionate, magnanimous, devoted to the Dharma, and kind to living beings. Now, relying on him, I shall set out again on the great ocean, and when I have successfully accomplished the purpose of my voyage and come back, I shall make offerings to him with half my wealth."

Having resolved in this way, he set out once more on the great ocean, and by the Buddha's power he reached the island of jewels. He gathered great jewels and returned to his home safely and without mishap. When he had rested and unpacked his containers, he saw the many kinds of jewels, and great attachment arose in him. He began to think, "How could I give half of jewels such as these to the ascetic Gautama? Instead, I shall sell them to my wife for a quarter of a coin, and I shall certainly offer incense to the Blessed One."

With the quarter coin he bought aloeswood incense and went to the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta. Then, very much ashamed, he stayed by the doorway and burned the aloeswood. Then the Blessed One performed a miracle such that the incense he had burned rose up into the sky above, pervaded all of Śrāvastī, and remained there like the crest of a great cloud. When the caravan leader saw that most marvelous wonder, which inspires faith in gods and humans, great joy arose in him. Restraining his own mind, he said, "It is not for me to cheat the Blessed One of the jewels."

Then the caravan leader invited the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas to a meal in his house. He satisfied them with fine food and then strewed great jewels over them. Then, through the buddha power of the buddhas and the divine power of the gods, those jewels rose into the sky above the Blessed One's head and turned into a jeweled house and a jeweled pavilion with jeweled banners, such as even a well-trained smith or smith's apprentice could not make. When the caravan leader saw that wonder, intense joy arose in him, and falling like a tree cut at the root, he bowed at the feet of the Blessed One and made this aspiration: "Through this root of virtue, this generation of the mind of awakening, and this complete giving away of things to be given, in a world that is blind, without a guide and wholly without a leader, may I become a buddha who ferries across the beings who have not crossed, frees those who are not freed, gives relief to those who have not found relief, and brings to complete nirvāṇa those who have not attained

complete nirvāṇa."

Then the Blessed One, knowing how the caravan leader's causes followed one upon another and how his actions followed one upon another, smiled. Now it is the nature of things that whenever the buddhas, the blessed ones, smile, rays of light, blue, yellow, red and white, come forth at that time from the door of their mouths. Some go downward and some go upward.

Those that go downward go to the hells Saṃjīva, Kālasūtra, Saṃghāta, Raurava, Mahāraurava, Tapana, Pratāpana, Avīci, Arbuda, Nirarbuda, Aṭaṭa, Huhuva, Hahava, Utpala, Padma and Mahāpadma. Into those that are hot hells they descend having become cool, and into those that are cold hells they descend having become warm. In this way the various torments of those beings are soothed. Then those beings think, "Oh! Have we died and passed away from here, or have we been born somewhere else?" Then, in order to inspire faith in them, the Blessed One sends forth an emanation, and when they see the emanation they think, "Oh! We have neither died and passed away from here nor been born somewhere else. Rather, it is through the power of this being, never seen before, that our various torments have been soothed." Then, their minds rejoicing in the emanation, the karma that was to be experienced in the hells is exhausted, and they take rebirth among gods and humans, where they will become fit vessels for the truths.

Those that go upward go among the gods: the gods of the Four Great Kings, the Thirty-Three, the Yāma gods, the Tuṣita gods, the Nirmāṇarati gods, the Paranirmitavaśavartin gods, the Brahmakāyika gods, the Brahmapurohita gods, the Mahābrahmā gods, the Parīttābha gods, the Apramāṇābha gods, the Ābhāsvara gods, the Parīttaśubha gods, the Apramāṇaśubha gods, the Śubhakṛtsna gods, the Anabhraka gods, the Puṇyaprasava gods, the Bṛhatphala gods, the Abṛha gods, the Atapa gods, the Sudṛśa gods, the Sudarśana gods, and so on up to the gods of Akaniṣṭha. There they proclaim the sounds of impermanence, suffering, emptiness, and selflessness, and they also utter two verses:

Set about renunciation!
Apply yourselves to the Buddha's teaching!
Like an elephant crushing a house of reeds,
Crush the army of the Lord of Death!

Whoever, in this very Dharma and discipline,
Conducts himself with heedfulness

Will completely abandon the cycle of births
And bring suffering to an end.

So they proclaim. Then, having encircled the great trichiliocosm, the world system of a billion worlds, those rays follow back after the Blessed One himself. If the Blessed One wishes to explain past karma, they disappear into the Blessed One's back. If he wishes to explain future karma, they disappear into his front. If he wishes to foretell rebirth in the hells, they disappear into the soles of his feet. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as an animal, they disappear into his heels. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a hungry ghost, they disappear into his big toes. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a human being, they disappear into his two knees. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a king who is a cakravartin by force, they disappear into the palm of his left hand. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a cakravartin king, they disappear into the palm of his right hand. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a god, they disappear into his navel. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a śrāvaka, they disappear into his mouth. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a pratyekabuddha, they disappear into the curl of hair between his eyebrows. If he wishes to foretell unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, they disappear into the crown protuberance on his head.

Then those rays circled the Blessed One three times and disappeared into the crown protuberance on the Blessed One's head. Then the venerable Ānanda joined his palms and addressed the Blessed One:

A many-colored cluster, interwoven with a thousand hues,
Has come forth from between your lips,
And by it all directions everywhere have been illumined,
Just as they are by the rising sun.

And again he addressed him in verse:

Buddhas, free of agitation, rid of dejection and pride,
Who have become the supreme cause for beings,
Victors who have conquered the foe, do not without cause or condition
Display a smile white as a lotus root or a conch.

Steadfast one, since you know by your own understanding that the time has come,
For the listeners, O Śramaṇa, Lord of Victors, who are in doubt,
O bull among sages, with your steadfast, supreme,

And excellent speech, please dispel the doubts that have arisen.

The protectors, the perfect buddhas, steadfast as the ocean and the king of mountains,
Do not display a smile for no reason.
The purpose for which the hero displays a smile,
That is what the great multitude of people wish to hear from you.

The Blessed One declared, "So it is, Ānanda, so it is. Ānanda, tathāgatas, arhats, perfect and complete buddhas do not smile without cause or condition. Ānanda, did you see this caravan leader pay me such honor?"

"Venerable One, I saw it."

"Ānanda, through this root of virtue, this generation of the resolve, and this giving away of a gift, this caravan leader will fully accomplish the awakening that is to be accomplished through three incalculable eons. Having brought to completion the six perfections, permeated by great compassion, he will become a perfect and complete buddha called Gandhottama, endowed with the ten powers, the four fearlessnesses, the three unmixed applications of mindfulness, and great compassion, and he will appear in the world. His gift is this: that his mind delighted in me."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Candra. The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed, and worshipped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, townspeople, guild masters, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas. Worshipped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas, renowned, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, alms food, bedding, seats, remedies for the sick, and medicines, the Buddha, the Blessed One, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas in Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

Now in Śrāvastī there lived a weaver called Candra, who was poor, utterly poor. However much work he did, he earned no more than that day's food, and he could not set aside even a little. Then he thought, "I came here from the other world without having made merit, and here too I do no virtue. So I may well have to go from here to the other world without having made merit, without having done virtue, and without having made a protector and refuge

against fear and terror. It would be good if I made an offering to the Blessed One with a few things."

Then he wove cloth for another householder, took from it some strips of fringe, and went out into the street. In the morning the Blessed One put on his lower garment and his Dharma robe, took up his alms bowl, and went into Śrāvastī for alms. Then the weaver saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two major marks and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, like a moving mountain of jewels, beautiful in every way. And having seen him, his mind took delight in the Blessed One.

In order to benefit him, the Blessed One for his part showed his own Dharma robe as torn. Then the weaver offered those strips of fringe to the Blessed One, and at once the Blessed One showed the Dharma robe as mended. Then, filled with great joy, he bowed at the Blessed One's feet and made this aspiration:

The gift is small, but the field is vast.
Since you, Great Powerful One, have accepted it,
By this, which has become a great gift,
May I become a buddha of vast renown.

Though this gift is small,
My mind is vast and immeasurable;
Accepted by the Victor, supreme among humans and gods,
Even a small gift becomes a great fruit.

The Blessed One declared:

In the future you, peaceful and of great power,
Of vast renown, worshipped by humans and gods,
Self-arisen, a benefactor of the world, endowed with compassion,
Will become a Victor called Supreme Fringe.

Then the Blessed One, knowing the succession of causes, one after another, and the succession of deeds, one after another, of the weaver Candra, smiled. It is the nature of things that when buddhas, the blessed ones, smile, blue, yellow, red, and white rays come forth from their mouths. Some go downward and some go upward.

Those that go downward go to the hells Saṃjīva, Kālasūtra, Saṃghāta, Raurava, Mahāraurava, Tapana, Pratāpana, Avīci, Arbuda, Nirarbuda, Aṭaṭa,

Huhuva, Hahava, Utpala, Padma, and Mahāpadma. Into the hot hells they descend as coolness, and into the cold hells they descend as warmth. Thereby the various torments of those beings are soothed. Then they think, "Oh! Have we died and passed away from here, or have we been born somewhere else?" Then, in order to inspire faith in them, the Blessed One sends forth an emanation, and when they see the emanation they think, "Oh! We have neither died and passed away from here nor been born somewhere else. Rather, it is through the power of this being, never seen before, that our various torments have been soothed." Then, their minds rejoicing in the emanation, the karma that was to be experienced in the hells is exhausted, and they take rebirth among gods and humans, where they will become fit vessels for the truths.

Those that go upward go among the gods: the gods of the Four Great Kings, the Thirty-Three, the Yāma gods, the Tuṣita gods, the Nirmāṇarati gods, the Paranirmitavaśavartin gods, the Brahmakāyika gods, the Brahmapurohita gods, the Mahābrahmā gods, the Parīttābha gods, the Apramāṇābha gods, the Ābhāsvara gods, the Parīttaśubha gods, the Apramāṇaśubha gods, the Śubhakṛtsna gods, the Anabhraka gods, the Puṇyaprasava gods, the Bṛhatphala gods, the Abṛha gods, the Atapa gods, the Sudṛśa gods, the Sudarśana gods, and so on up to the gods of Akaniṣṭha. There they proclaim the sounds of impermanence, suffering, emptiness, and selflessness, and they also utter two verses:

Set about renunciation!
Apply yourselves to the Buddha's teaching!
Like an elephant crushing a house of reeds,
Crush the army of the Lord of Death!

Whoever, in this very Dharma and discipline,
Conducts himself with heedfulness
Will completely abandon the cycle of births
And bring suffering to an end.

So they proclaim. Then, having encircled the great trichiliocosm, the world system of a billion worlds, those rays follow back after the Blessed One himself. If the Blessed One wishes to explain past karma, they disappear into the Blessed One's back. If he wishes to explain future karma, they disappear into his front. If he wishes to foretell rebirth in the hells, they disappear into the soles of his feet. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as an animal, they

disappear into his heels. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a hungry ghost, they disappear into his big toes. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a human being, they disappear into his two knees. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a king who is a cakravartin by force, they disappear into the palm of his left hand. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a cakravartin king, they disappear into the palm of his right hand. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a god, they disappear into his navel. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a śrāvaka, they disappear into his mouth. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a pratyekabuddha, they disappear into the curl of hair between his eyebrows. If he wishes to foretell unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, they disappear into the crown protuberance on his head.

Then those rays circled the Blessed One three times and disappeared into the crown protuberance on the Blessed One's head.

Then the venerable Ānanda joined his palms and addressed the Blessed One:

A many-colored cluster, interwoven with a thousand hues,
Has come forth from between your lips,
And by it all directions everywhere have been illumined,
Just as they are by the rising sun.

And again he addressed him in verse:

Buddhas, free of agitation, rid of dejection and pride,
Who have become the supreme cause for beings,
Victors who have conquered the foe, do not without cause or condition
Display a smile white as a lotus root or a conch.

Steadfast one, since you know by your own understanding that the time has come,
For the listeners, O Śramaṇa, Lord of Victors, who are in doubt,
O bull among sages, with your steadfast, supreme,
And excellent speech, please dispel the doubts that have arisen.

The protectors, the perfect buddhas, steadfast as the ocean and the king of mountains,
Do not display a smile for no reason.
The purpose for which the hero displays a smile,
That is what the great multitude of people wish to hear from you.

The Blessed One declared, "So it is, Ānanda, so it is. Ānanda, tathāgatas, arhats, perfect and complete buddhas do not smile without cause or condition.

Ānanda, did you see this weaver Candra pay me such honor?"

"Venerable One, I saw it."

"Ānanda, through this root of virtue, this generation of the resolve, and this giving away of a gift, the weaver Candra will fully accomplish the awakening that is to be accomplished through three incalculable eons. Having brought to completion the six perfections, permeated by great compassion, he will become a perfect and complete buddha called Supreme Fringe, endowed with the ten powers, the four fearlessnesses, the three unmixed applications of mindfulness, and great compassion, and he will appear in the world. His gift is this: that his mind delighted in me."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Great. The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed, and worshipped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, townspeople, guild masters, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas. Worshipped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas, renowned, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, alms food, bedding, seats, remedies for the sick, and medicines, the Buddha, the Blessed One, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas in Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time there lived in Śrāvastī the son of a guild master, called Great. He was one in whom outbursts of anger were very strong, and he made offerings to the six teachers, Pūraṇa and the rest. Later he was struck by a severe illness, and, having no physician, no medicine, and no one to nurse him, he came close to death. He thought, "Now who else is there, other than the Buddha, to be a refuge for me in my suffering or to grant me the life I hold dear?" Having thought this, he prayed to the Blessed One.

Now, there is nothing that buddhas, the blessed ones, do not know, do not see, do not realize, or do not comprehend. The buddhas, the blessed ones, are endowed with great compassion, engaged in benefiting the world, possessed of a single guardianship, solely heroic, without peer, never speaking in two ways, abiding in calm abiding and insight. They illuminate the three knowledges, are well trained in the three trainings, and are skilled in the three bases of discipline. They have crossed the four floods; the soles of their feet, the four bases of miraculous power, are firmly planted; they have long been accustomed to the four means of attraction; they are fearless with the four

fearlessnesses; they roar the great, true lion's roar of the bull. They have entirely abandoned the five factors and have passed completely beyond the five destinies. They are endowed with the six factors, have perfected the six perfections, and abide in the six constant abidings. They are rich with the flowers of the seven limbs of awakening, teach the eightfold path, are skilled in the nine successive meditative attainments, and possess the strength of the ten powers. Their renown pervades the ten directions, and they are far superior even to those who hold sway over a thousand. By the nature of things, three times by day and three times by night, they look upon the world with the eye of a buddha, and the vision of their wisdom arises, thinking: "Who is declining? Who is prospering? Who is in want? Who is in danger? Who is afflicted? Who is in want, in danger, and afflicted? Who is inclined toward the lower realms? Who is sliding toward the lower realms? Who has fallen into the lower realms? Whom shall I draw out of the lower realms and establish in the higher realms, in liberation, and in the fruit? Whom, sunk in the mire of desire, shall I pull out by the hand? Whom, lacking the seven noble riches, shall I bring to mastery over the wealth of the seven noble riches? In whom shall I generate roots of virtue not yet generated? In whom shall I ripen roots of virtue already generated? Whom, already ripened, shall I liberate?"

Here it is said:

The ocean, the abode of sea monsters,
May perhaps let the time of its tide pass by,
But for the children to be trained,
The Buddha never lets the time pass by.

Then the Blessed One, seeing the condition of the guild master's son Great, sent forth golden rays surpassing the light of a thousand suns, and they illuminated that entire house. He also sent forth rays of loving-kindness, cultivated thoroughly for a thousand eons, and as soon as they touched his body he was deeply refreshed. Then the Blessed One went to his door, and the doorkeeper announced to him, "The Blessed One is standing at the door."

Then the guild master's son Great was overjoyed, and, his breathless distress giving way to relief, he said, "Welcome, Blessed One! Please, Blessed One, come inside. I long to see the Blessed One's face." Then the Blessed One went inside and sat on the seat that had been prepared. Once seated, the Blessed One said to Great, "Great, what ails you?"

Great replied, "I suffer from an affliction of the body and an affliction of the mind."

Then, with a mind of loving-kindness toward all sentient beings, the Blessed One gave him instruction, declaring, "This is the antidote to the suffering of your mind." Then he formed a worldly intention, thinking, "Oh, it would be good if Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, were to bring the śirika herb from Mount Gandhamādana." The moment the Blessed One formed this intention, Śakra, lord of the gods, took the śirika herb from Mount Gandhamādana and offered it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One took it in his own hand and gave it to Great, declaring, "This will soothe the suffering and fever of your body."

Then he attained the bliss of complete pliancy of body and mind, and his mind delighted in the Blessed One. His mind delighted, he informed King Prasenajit, served a meal to the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, offered a robe worth a hundred thousand, and also made offerings with every kind of flower, incense, and garland. Then, having steadied his mind, he made this aspiration: "By this root of virtue, this generation of the resolve, and this giving away of a gift, just as the Blessed One, the unsurpassed king of physicians, has healed me, so may I too, at a future time when the world is blind, without a guide and without a leader, become a buddha who ferries across beings who have not crossed, liberates those not liberated, brings relief to those without relief, and leads to complete nirvāṇa those who have not attained complete nirvāṇa."

Then the Blessed One, knowing the succession of causes, one after another, and the succession of deeds, one after another, of Great, smiled. It is the nature of things that when buddhas, the blessed ones, smile, blue, yellow, red, and white rays come forth from their mouths. Some go downward and some go upward.

Those that go downward go to the hells Saṃjīva, Kālasūtra, Saṃghāta, Raurava, Mahāraurava, Tapana, Pratāpana, Avīci, Arbuda, Nirarbuda, Aṭaṭa, Huhuva, Hahava, Utpala, Padma, and Mahāpadma. Into the hot hells they descend as coolness, and into the cold hells they descend as warmth. Thereby the various torments of those beings are soothed. Then they think, "Oh! Have we died and passed away from here, or have we been born somewhere else?" Then, in order to inspire faith in them, the Blessed One sends forth an emanation, and when they see the emanation they think, "Oh! We have neither died and passed away from here nor been born somewhere else.

Rather, it is through the power of this being, never seen before, that our various torments have been soothed." Then, their minds rejoicing in the emanation, the karma that was to be experienced in the hells is exhausted, and they take rebirth among gods and humans, where they will become fit vessels for the truths.

Those that go upward go among the gods: the gods of the Four Great Kings, the Thirty-Three, the Yāma gods, the Tuṣita gods, the Nirmāṇarati gods, the Paranirmitavaśavartin gods, the Brahmakāyika gods, the Brahmapurohita gods, the Mahābrahmā gods, the Parīttābha gods, the Apramāṇābha gods, the Ābhāsvara gods, the Parīttaśubha gods, the Apramāṇaśubha gods, the Śubhakṛtsna gods, the Anabhraka gods, the Puṇyaprasava gods, the Bṛhatphala gods, the Abṛha gods, the Atapa gods, the Sudṛśa gods, the Sudarśana gods, and so on up to the gods of Akaniṣṭha. There they proclaim the sounds of impermanence, suffering, emptiness, and selflessness, and they also utter two verses:

Set about renunciation!
Apply yourselves to the Buddha's teaching!
Like an elephant crushing a house of reeds,
Crush the army of the Lord of Death!

Whoever, in this very Dharma and discipline,
Conducts himself with heedfulness
Will completely abandon the cycle of births
And bring suffering to an end.

So they proclaim. Then, having encircled the great trichiliocosm, the world system of a billion worlds, those rays follow back after the Blessed One himself. If the Blessed One wishes to explain past karma, they disappear into the Blessed One's back. If he wishes to explain future karma, they disappear into his front. If he wishes to foretell rebirth in the hells, they disappear into the soles of his feet. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as an animal, they disappear into his heels. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a hungry ghost, they disappear into his big toes. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a human being, they disappear into his two knees. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a king who is a cakravartin by force, they disappear into the palm of his left hand. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a cakravartin king, they disappear into the palm of his right hand. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a god, they disappear into his navel. If he wishes to foretell the

awakening of a śrāvaka, they disappear into his mouth. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a pratyekabuddha, they disappear into the curl of hair between his eyebrows. If he wishes to foretell unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, they disappear into the crown protuberance on his head.

Then those rays circled the Blessed One three times and disappeared into the crown protuberance on the Blessed One's head. Then the venerable Ānanda joined his palms and addressed the Blessed One:

A many-colored cluster, interwoven with a thousand hues,
Has come forth from between your lips,
And by it all directions everywhere have been illumined,
Just as they are by the rising sun.

And again he addressed him in verse:

Buddhas, free of agitation, rid of dejection and pride,
Who have become the supreme cause for beings,
Victors who have conquered the foe, do not without cause or condition
Display a smile white as a lotus root or a conch.

Steadfast one, since you know by your own understanding that the time has come,
For the listeners, O Śramaṇa, Lord of Victors, who are in doubt,
O bull among sages, with your steadfast, supreme,
And excellent speech, please dispel the doubts that have arisen.

The protectors, the perfect buddhas, steadfast as the ocean and the king of mountains,
Do not display a smile for no reason.
The purpose for which the hero displays a smile,
That is what the great multitude of people wish to hear from you.

The Blessed One declared, "So it is, Ānanda, so it is. Ānanda, tathāgatas, arhats, perfect and complete buddhas do not smile without cause or condition. Ānanda, did you see this guild master's son Great pay me such honor?"

"Venerable One, I saw it."

"Ānanda, through this root of virtue, this generation of the resolve, and this giving away of a gift, the guild master's son Great will fully accomplish the awakening that is to be accomplished through three incalculable eons. Having brought to completion the six perfections, permeated by great compassion, he will become a perfect and complete buddha called Śākyamuni, endowed with

the ten powers, the four fearlessnesses, the three unmixed applications of mindfulness, and great compassion, and he will appear in the world. His gift is this: that his mind delighted in me."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Padma. The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed, and worshipped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, townspeople, guild masters, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas. Worshipped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas, renowned, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, alms food, bedding, seats, remedies for the sick, and medicines, the Buddha, the Blessed One, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas in Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

Before the Blessed One had appeared in the world, King Prasenajit used to honor other gods three times a day with flowers, incense, perfumes, garlands, and ointments. When the Blessed One had appeared in the world and had tamed King Prasenajit by means of the examples in the Daharasūtra, the king found faith in the teaching of the Blessed One. From then on, filled with joy and gladness, he went to the Blessed One three times a day and made offerings with lamps, incense, flowers, perfumes, garlands, and ointments.

Then, at one point, a gardener picked a freshly bloomed lotus flower and was taking it into Śrāvastī to King Prasenajit, when a lay follower of the non-Buddhist sects saw him and asked, "Hey, you there, is that lotus for sale?"

"It is for sale," he replied.

As that man wanted to buy it, the householder Anāthapiṇḍada arrived on the scene and raised the price to double, and the two bid against each other until it had risen to a hundred thousand. Then the gardener thought, "This householder Anāthapiṇḍada is not a frivolous man; he is a steady person, so there must be some purpose in this." Doubt arose in him, and he asked the man who favored the non-Buddhists, "For whose sake are you bidding like this?"

He said, "I am bidding for the sake of the blessed Nārāyaṇa."

Anāthapiṇḍada said, "I am bidding for the sake of the Blessed One, the Buddha."

The gardener asked, "Who is this one called the Buddha?" Then Anāthapiṇḍada described to him at length the qualities of the Buddha. Then the gardener said to Anāthapiṇḍada, "Householder, I myself will make an offering to that Blessed One."

Then the householder Anāthapiṇḍada took the gardener with him and went to where the Blessed One was. There the gardener saw the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, like a moving mountain of jewels, beautiful in every way. As soon as he saw him, the gardener tossed the lotus to the Blessed One, and as soon as he tossed it, the lotus became the size of a cartwheel and remained above the Blessed One.

Then, when the gardener saw that miracle, he fell at the feet of the Blessed One like a tree cut off at the root. Joining his palms, he made his mind steadfast and made this aspiration: "By this root of virtue, this generation of the mind, and this giving away of what is to be given, may I, in a world that is blind, without a guide and without a leader, become a buddha who ferries across those beings who have not crossed, frees those who are not free, gives relief to those who have found no relief, and brings to complete nirvāṇa those who have not attained complete nirvāṇa."

Then the Blessed One, knowing the gardener's succession of causes, one after another, and his succession of actions, one after another, smiled. It is the nature of things that whenever buddhas, blessed ones, smile, rays of light, blue, yellow, red and white, come forth from their mouths. Some go downward, and some go upward.

Those that go downward go to the hells Saṃjīva, Kālasūtra, Saṃghāta, Raurava, Mahāraurava, Tapana, Pratāpana, Avīci, Arbuda, Nirarbuda, Aṭaṭa, Huhuva, Hahava, Utpala, Padma and Mahāpadma. Into all the hot hells they descend having become cool, and into all the cold hells they descend having become warm. As a result, the various torments of those beings are relieved. Then they think, "Oh! Have we died and passed on from here, or have we been born somewhere else?" Then, in order to inspire faith in them, the Blessed One sends forth an emanation. Seeing the emanation, they think, "Oh! We have not died and passed on from here, nor have we been born somewhere else. Rather, it is through the power of this being, never seen before, that our various torments have been relieved." Then, their minds delighted in the

emanation, the karma that would have made them experience the hells is exhausted, and they take rebirth among gods and humans, where they will become fit vessels for the truths.

Those that go upward go to the gods of the Four Great Kings, the Thirty-Three, the Yāma gods, the Tuṣita gods, the Nirmāṇarati gods, the Paranirmitavaśavartin gods, the Brahmakāyika gods, the Brahmapurohita gods, the Mahābrahmā gods, the Parīttābha gods, the Apramāṇābha gods, the Ābhāsvara gods, the Parīttaśubha gods, the Apramāṇaśubha gods, the Śubhakṛtsna gods, the Anabhraka gods, the Puṇyaprasava gods, the Bṛhatphala gods, the Abṛha gods, the Atapa gods, the Sudṛśa gods, the Sudarśana gods, and as far as the gods of Akaniṣṭha, and proclaim the sounds of impermanence, suffering, emptiness and selflessness. They also recite two verses:

"Undertake renunciation!
Apply yourselves to the Buddha's teaching!
As an elephant crushes a house of reeds,
Crush the army of the Lord of Death!

Whoever, in this very Dharma and discipline,
Lives with heedfulness
Will abandon the cycle of birth
And bring suffering to an end."

So they recite. Then those rays of light circle the great trichiliocosm, the world system of a thousand million worlds, and follow right behind the Blessed One. If the Blessed One wishes to foretell past actions, they vanish into his back. If he wishes to foretell future actions, they vanish into his front. If he wishes to foretell rebirth in the hells, they vanish into the soles of his feet. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as an animal, they vanish into his heels. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a hungry ghost, they vanish into his big toes. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a human, they vanish into his two knees. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a balacakravartin king, a wheel-turning king by force, they vanish into the palm of his left hand. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a wheel-turning king, they vanish into the palm of his right hand. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a god, they vanish into his navel. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a śrāvaka, they vanish into his mouth. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a pratyekabuddha, they vanish into the curl of hair between his eyebrows. If he wishes to foretell unsurpassed, perfect and

complete awakening, they vanish into the crown protuberance on his head.

Then those rays of light circled the Blessed One three times and vanished into the crown protuberance on the Blessed One's head. Then the venerable Ānanda joined his palms and said to the Blessed One:

"Many-hued, interlaced with a thousand colors,
Many rays have come forth from the door of your mouth.
They have lit up all the directions
Just as the rising sun does."

And again he said in verse:

"Buddhas, free of agitation, rid of pride and dejection,
Have become the supreme cause for beings.
Victors, conquerors of the foe, do not without cause and condition
Display a smile white as lotus root or conch.

Steadfast one, since by your own wisdom you know the time has come,
Lord of Victors among ascetics, for the listeners who long to know,
Bull among sages, with your excellent, steadfast and virtuous words,
Please dispel the doubt that has arisen.

Not without reason do the protectors, the perfect buddhas,
Steadfast like the ocean and the king of mountains, display a smile.
The great multitude of people longs to hear from you
That for whose sake, O hero, you displayed your smile."

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, so it is. So it is. Ānanda, tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas do not smile without cause or condition.

"Ānanda, do you see the honor this gardener has paid me?"

"I see it, venerable one."

"Ānanda, by this root of virtue, this generation of the mind, and this giving away of what is to be given, this gardener will fully accomplish the awakening that is to be accomplished over three incalculable eons. Having brought to completion the six perfections, imbued with great compassion, he will become a perfectly complete buddha called Padmottara, endowed with the ten powers, the four fearlessnesses, the three unmixed applications of mindfulness, and great compassion, and he will appear in the world. His gift is this: that his mind delighted in me."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Pañcāla.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, people of the court, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras and mahoragas. Worshiped and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and provisions for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time the king of Northern Pañcāla fell into discord with the king of Southern Pañcāla. Then King Prasenajit of Kosala went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, King Prasenajit of Kosala said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, you are the unsurpassed king of the Dharma, the protector of beings in distress, who reconciles those who bear enmity toward one another. This king of Northern Pañcāla is in discord with the king of Southern Pañcāla, and the two of them are bringing many people to ruin against each other. Out of your loving kindness, may the Blessed One please pacify the enmity that has long existed between the two of them."

The Blessed One consented to King Prasenajit of Kosala by remaining silent. Then King Prasenajit of Kosala, understanding that the Blessed One had consented by remaining silent, bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet, rose from his seat and departed.

Then, early in the morning of the following day, the Blessed One put on his lower robe and Dharma robe, took up his alms bowl, and set out wandering toward the towns of the Kāśis in the direction of Vārāṇasī. Wandering by stages, he reached Vārāṇasī, and in Vārāṇasī he stayed at Ṛṣivadana, in the Deer Park.

Then, after a while, those two learned that the Blessed One had come to their country. Then, through the Blessed One's miraculous power, a fourfold army was emanated, and the king of Northern Pañcāla, terrified and afraid, mounted a chariot and went into the presence of the Blessed One. The Blessed One taught him a Dharma that would bring an end to enmity. Having heard that Dharma, he went forth in the presence of the Blessed One, and by striving,

effort and exertion he abandoned all afflictions and realized arhatship.

The king of Southern Pañcāla, for his part, invited the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas for three months, served them food with a hundred flavors, and also offered robes worth a hundred thousand. Then he made this aspiration: "By this root of virtue, this generation of the mind, and this giving away of what is to be given, may I, in a world that is blind, without a guide and without a leader, become a buddha who ferries across those beings who have not crossed, frees those who are not free, gives relief to those who have found no relief, and brings to complete nirvāṇa those who have not attained complete nirvāṇa."

Then the Blessed One, knowing the succession of causes, one after another, and the succession of actions, one after another, of that king of Southern Pañcāla, smiled. It is the nature of things that whenever buddhas, blessed ones, smile, rays of light, blue, yellow, red and white, come forth from their mouths. Some go downward, and some go upward.

Those that go downward go to the hells Saṃjīva, Kālasūtra, Saṃghāta, Raurava, Mahāraurava, Tapana, Pratāpana, Avīci, Arbuda, Nirarbuda, Aṭaṭa, Huhuva, Hahava, Utpala, Padma and Mahāpadma. Into the hot hells they descend having become cool, and into the cold hells they descend having become warm. As a result, the various torments of those beings are relieved. Then they think, "Oh! Have we died and passed on from here, or have we been born somewhere else?" Then, in order to inspire faith in them, the Blessed One sends forth an emanation. Seeing that emanation, they think, "Oh! We have not died and passed on from here, nor have we been born somewhere else. Rather, it is through the power of this being, never seen before, that our various torments have been relieved." Then, their minds delighted in the emanation, the karma that would have made them experience the hells is exhausted, and they take rebirth among gods and humans, where they will become fit vessels for the truths.

Those that go upward go to the gods of the Four Great Kings, the Thirty-Three, the Yāma gods, the Tuṣita gods, the Nirmāṇarati gods, the Paranirmitavaśavartin gods, the Brahmakāyika gods, the Brahmapurohita gods, the Mahābrahmā gods, the Parīttābha gods, the Apramāṇābha gods, the Ābhāsvara gods, the Parīttaśubha gods, the Apramāṇaśubha gods, the Śubhakṛtsna gods, the Anabhraka gods, the Puṇyaprasava gods, the Bṛhatphala gods, the Abṛha gods, the Atapa gods, the Sudṛśa gods, the

Sudarśana gods, and as far as the gods of Akaniṣṭha, and proclaim the sounds of impermanence, suffering, emptiness and selflessness. They also recite two verses:

"Undertake renunciation!
Apply yourselves to the Buddha's teaching!
As an elephant crushes a house of reeds,
Crush the army of the Lord of Death!

Whoever, in this very Dharma and discipline,
Lives with heedfulness
Will abandon the cycle of birth
And bring suffering to an end."

So they recite. Then those rays of light circle the great trichiliocosm, the world system of a thousand million worlds, and follow right behind the Blessed One. If the Blessed One wishes to foretell past actions, they vanish into his back. If he wishes to foretell future actions, they vanish into his front. If he wishes to foretell rebirth in the hells, they vanish into the soles of his feet. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as an animal, they vanish into his heels. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a hungry ghost, they vanish into his big toes. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a human, they vanish into his two knees. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a balacakravartin king, a wheel-turning king by force, they vanish into the palm of his left hand. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a wheel-turning king, they vanish into the palm of his right hand. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a god, they vanish into his navel. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a śrāvaka, they vanish into his mouth. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a pratyekabuddha, they vanish into the curl of hair between his eyebrows. If he wishes to foretell unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, they vanish into the crown protuberance on his head.

Then those rays of light circled the Blessed One three times and vanished into the crown protuberance on the Blessed One's head. Then the venerable Ānanda joined his palms and said to the Blessed One:

"Many-hued, interlaced with a thousand colors,
Many rays have come forth from the door of your mouth.
They have lit up all the directions
Just as the rising sun does."

And again he said in verse:

"Buddhas, free of agitation, rid of pride and dejection,
Have become the supreme cause for beings.
Victors, conquerors of the foe, do not without cause and condition
Display a smile white as lotus root or conch.

Steadfast one, since by your own wisdom you know the time has come,
Lord of Victors among ascetics, for the listeners who long to know,
Bull among sages, with your excellent, steadfast and virtuous words,
Please dispel the doubt that has arisen.

Not without reason do the protectors, the perfect buddhas,
Steadfast like the ocean and the king of mountains, display a smile.
The great multitude of people longs to hear from you
That for whose sake, O hero, you displayed your smile."

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, so it is. So it is. Ānanda, tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas do not smile without cause or condition. Ānanda, do you see the honor this king of Pañcāla has paid me?"

"I see it, venerable one."

"Ānanda, by this root of virtue, this generation of the mind, and this giving away of what is to be given, this king of Pañcāla will fully accomplish the awakening that is to be accomplished over three incalculable eons. Having brought to completion the six perfections, imbued with great compassion, he will become a perfectly complete buddha called Gandhottama, endowed with the ten powers, the four fearlessnesses, the three unmixed applications of mindfulness, and great compassion, and he will appear in the world. His gift is this: that his mind delighted in me."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

From The Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, the third section.

The story called Incense.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, people of the court, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras and mahoragas. Worshiped and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and provisions for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta

Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time, in Śrāvastī, two merchants fell into discord with each other. Of the two, one had faith in Pūraṇa, and the other had faith in the Buddha, the Blessed One. The two of them then settled on a debate with each other. Pūraṇa's lay follower said, "Pūraṇa is far more distinguished than the Buddha."

The Buddha's lay follower said, "The Blessed One, the perfectly complete Buddha, is far more distinguished."

Then the two of them laid down a wager in which all their possessions were staked. After a while, King Prasenajit heard of it and ordered his ministers, "Put those two to the test." Then those ministers had the bell rung throughout the land, proclaiming, "Seven days from now, the two lay followers, the Buddha's and the non-Buddhist's (tīrthika's), will be put to the test. Whoever wishes to see something marvelous, come!"

When seven days had passed, in a spacious place where many hundreds of thousands of people had gathered, with many hundreds of thousands of gods gathered in the sky, a maṇḍala was made with cow dung, and incense, flowers and garlands of every kind were gathered there. First of all, the non-Buddhist lay follower made an invocation of truth: "By the truth and the words of truth that the six teachers, Pūraṇa and the rest, are supreme, by that truth and those words of truth, may these flowers, this incense and this water go to them!"

The moment he said this, the flowers fell to the ground, the fire died out, and the water sank into the ground, was used up and dried away completely. Then that great crowd of people raised an uproar and laughter and shouted loudly. When the non-Buddhist lay follower saw this, he sat without a word. Dejected, his shoulders slumped, his eyes cast down, his confidence gone, his mind withdrawn into itself, he sat brooding with his cheek resting on his hand.

Then the disciple of the Blessed One, overjoyed, his eyes bright and shining with delight, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, set his right knee on the ground, and made an invocation of truth: "By the truth and the words of truth that the Blessed One is supreme among all beings, by that truth and those words of truth, may these flowers, this incense and this water go to the Blessed One!"

The moment he said this, the flowers rose into the sky like a line of geese and went off facing toward the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta. The incense became like a

canopy of cloud, and the water became like a pillar of beryl. Then that great crowd of people, seeing that miracle, raised an uproar and laughter, shouted loudly, and went along following behind them. Then the flowers remained above the Blessed One, and the incense and the water remained before him.

Then that great crowd of people, delighted, bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet and sat before him in order to hear the Dharma, and the Blessed One taught them this sūtra:

"Brahmins and householders, these three are declared supreme. What are the three? The Buddha is declared supreme, the Dharma is declared supreme, and the Saṅgha is declared supreme.

"What is the declaration that the Buddha is supreme? Brahmins and householders, whatever beings there may be, whether footless, two-footed, four-footed or many-footed, whether having form or formless, whether having perception, without perception, or neither with perception nor without perception, among them the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha is taught to be supreme. Whoever delights in the Buddha delights in the supreme, and it should be known that for those who delight in the supreme, the ripening too will be solely the highest among those who become gods among the gods, or among those who become humans among humans. Brahmins and householders, this is called the declaration that the Buddha is supreme.

"What is the declaration that the Dharma is supreme? Whatever dharmas there may be, whether conditioned or unconditioned, among them the Dharma of freedom from desire is taught to be supreme. Whoever delights in the Dharma delights in the supreme, and it should be known that for those who delight in the supreme, the ripening too will be solely the highest among those who become gods among the gods, or among those who become humans among humans. Brahmins and householders, this is called the declaration that the Dharma is supreme.

"What is the declaration that the Saṅgha is supreme? Whatever gatherings, groups, multitudes or assemblies there may be, among them the Saṅgha of the Tathāgata's śrāvakas is taught to be known as supreme. Whoever delights in the Saṅgha delights in the supreme, and it should be known that for those who delight in the supreme, the ripening too will be solely the highest among those who become gods among the gods, or among those who become humans among humans. Brahmins and householders, this is called the

declaration that the Saṅgha is supreme."

When this discourse on the Dharma had been taught, some of those brahmins and householders gained faith in the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha. Some took refuge and took up the bases of training. Some went forth and, understanding that this five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra is moving and unstable, and having determined that all kinds of formations are by nature subject to decay, falling, scattering and destruction, abandoned all afflictions and realized arhatship.

The non-Buddhist lay follower, too, gained faith in the Blessed One. Then, falling at his feet like a tree cut off at the root, he made this aspiration: "By this root of virtue, this generation of the mind, and this giving away of what is to be given, may I, in a world that is blind, without a guide and without a leader, become a buddha who ferries across those beings who have not crossed, frees those who are not free, gives relief to those who have found no relief, and brings to complete nirvāṇa those who have not attained complete nirvāṇa."

Then the Blessed One, knowing the succession of causes, one after another, and the succession of actions, one after another, of that non-Buddhist lay follower, smiled.

It is the nature of things that whenever buddhas, blessed ones, smile, rays of light, blue, yellow, red and white, come forth from their mouths. Some go downward, and some go upward.

Those that go downward go to the hells Saṃjīva, Kālasūtra, Saṃghāta, Raurava, Mahāraurava, Tapana, Pratāpana, Avīci, Arbuda, Nirarbuda, Aṭaṭa, Huhuva, Hahava, Utpala, Padma and Mahāpadma. Into the hot hells they descend having become cool, and into the cold hells they descend having become warm. As a result, the various torments of those beings are relieved. Then they think, "Oh! Have we died and passed on from here, or have we been born somewhere else?" Then, in order to inspire faith in them, the Blessed One sends forth an emanation. Seeing the emanation, they think, "Oh! We have not died and passed on from here, nor have we been born somewhere else. Rather, it is through the power of this being, never seen before, that our various torments have been relieved." Then, their minds filled with faith in the emanation, the karma that would have made them experience the hells is exhausted, and they take rebirth among gods and humans, where they will become fit vessels for the truths.

Those that go upward go to the gods of the Four Great Kings, the Thirty-Three, the Yāma gods, the Tuṣita gods, the Nirmāṇarati gods, the Paranirmitavaśavartin gods, the Brahmakāyika gods, the Brahmapurohita gods, the Mahābrahmā gods, the Parīttābha gods, the Apramāṇābha gods, the Ābhāsvara gods, the Parīttaśubha gods, the Apramāṇaśubha gods, the Śubhakṛtsna gods, the Anabhraka gods, the Puṇyaprasava gods, the Bṛhatphala gods, the Abṛha gods, the Atapa gods, the Sudṛśa gods, the Sudarśana gods, and as far as the gods of Akaniṣṭha, and proclaim the sounds of impermanence, suffering, emptiness and selflessness. They also recite two verses:

"Undertake renunciation!
Apply yourselves to the Buddha's teaching!
As an elephant crushes a house of reeds,
Crush the army of the Lord of Death!

Whoever, in this very Dharma and discipline,
Lives with heedfulness
Will abandon the cycle of birth
And bring suffering to an end."

So they recite. Then those rays of light circle the great trichiliocosm, the world system of a thousand million worlds, and follow right behind the Blessed One. If the Blessed One wishes to foretell past actions, they vanish into his back. If he wishes to foretell future actions, they vanish into his front. If he wishes to foretell rebirth in the hells, they vanish into the soles of his feet. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as an animal, they vanish into his heels. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a hungry ghost, they vanish into his big toes. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a human, they vanish into his two knees. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a balacakravartin king, a wheel-turning king by force, they vanish into the palm of his left hand. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a wheel-turning king, they vanish into the palm of his right hand. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a god, they vanish into his navel. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a śrāvaka, they vanish into his mouth. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a pratyekabuddha, they vanish into the curl of hair between his eyebrows. If he wishes to foretell unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, they vanish into the crown protuberance on his head.

Then those rays of light circled the Blessed One three times and vanished into the crown protuberance on the Blessed One's head. Then the venerable

Ānanda joined his palms and said to the Blessed One:

"Many-hued, interlaced with a thousand colors,
Many rays have come forth from the door of your mouth.
They have lit up all the directions
Just as the rising sun does."

And again he said in verse:

"Buddhas, free of agitation, rid of pride and dejection,
Have become the supreme cause for beings.
Victors, conquerors of the foe, do not without cause and condition
Display a smile white as lotus root or conch.

Steadfast one, since by your own wisdom you know the time has come,
Lord of Victors among ascetics, for the listeners who long to know,
Bull among sages, with your excellent, steadfast and virtuous words,
Please dispel the doubt that has arisen.

Not without reason do the protectors, the perfect buddhas,
Steadfast like the ocean and the king of mountains, display a smile.
The great multitude of people longs to hear from you
That for whose sake, O hero, you displayed your smile."

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, so it is. So it is. Ānanda, tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas do not smile without cause or condition. Ānanda, do you see the honor this non-Buddhist lay follower has paid me?"

"I see it, venerable one."

"Ānanda, by this root of virtue, this generation of the mind, and this giving away of what is to be given, this non-Buddhist lay follower will fully accomplish the awakening that is to be accomplished over three incalculable eons. Having brought to completion the six perfections, imbued with great compassion, he will become a perfectly complete buddha called Acala, endowed with the ten powers, the four fearlessnesses, the three unmixed applications of mindfulness, and great compassion, and he will appear in the world. His gift is this: that his mind delighted in me."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks were delighted and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Now, the one called "The King." The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed, and worshipped by kings, by great ministers, by the

wealthy, by the townsfolk, by merchants, by caravan leaders, by gods, by nāgas, by yakṣas, by asuras, by garuḍas, by kiṃnaras, and by great mahoragas. The Buddha, the Blessed One, worshipped and acknowledged by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and great mahoragas, endowed with great merit, receiving robes, food, bedding, seats, medicine for the sick, and medical supplies, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time King Prasenajit of Kosala and King Ajātaśatru fell into hostility with each other. King Ajātaśatru then equipped his fourfold army, the elephant corps, the cavalry, the chariot corps, and the infantry, and led it out to do battle with King Prasenajit of Kosala. King Prasenajit of Kosala heard: "King Ajātaśatru has equipped his fourfold army, the elephant corps, the cavalry, the chariot corps, and the infantry, and has led it out to do battle with me." Having heard this, he too equipped his fourfold army, the elephant corps, the cavalry, the chariot corps, and the infantry, and led it out to do battle with King Ajātaśatru.

Then King Ajātaśatru captured the whole of King Prasenajit of Kosala's elephant corps, cavalry, chariot corps, and infantry. King Prasenajit of Kosala, defeated, terrified, and routed, utterly defeated and turning his back in flight, went off to Śrāvastī with a single chariot. Three times this same thing happened. Then King Prasenajit of Kosala went into the chamber of sorrow and sat with his cheek propped on his hand, brooding.

Now in Śrāvastī there lived a merchant who was rich, of great wealth and great means, whose holdings were broad and vast, who possessed wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, wealth that rivaled the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He heard how King Prasenajit of Kosala, defeated, terrified, and routed, utterly defeated and turning his back in flight, had gone off to Śrāvastī with a single chariot. Having heard this, he went to where King Prasenajit of Kosala was. On arriving, he hailed King Prasenajit, saying, "Victory to you! May you live long!" and then said, "Your Majesty, why are you so downcast? Your Majesty, I wish to offer Your Majesty as much gold as it will take for Your Majesty to be glad and content once more."

He then heaped up for him a great heap of gold and presented it, a heap so great that a person sitting on one side could not see a person standing on the other, nor could a person standing see one who was sitting.

Then King Prasenajit of Kosala sent spies out all through his own country, saying, "Listen to what people are saying." Once, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, two old men were talking with each other. They said, "There is a battle stratagem called the Lotus Filament. In it, the men who are cowardly are sent out first, as the fodder of battle. Those who are middling are placed in the middle. The men who are supremely brave are placed at the rear."

They reported this to the king. King Prasenajit of Kosala, having heard it, equipped his fourfold army accordingly and led it out to do battle with King Ajātaśatru. Then King Prasenajit of Kosala captured the whole elephant corps of King Ajātaśatru, son of Vaidehī. He captured his cavalry, his chariot corps, and his infantry as well. King Ajātaśatru, son of Vaidehī, in turn defeated, terrified, and routed, utterly defeated and turning his back, was taken alive. Prasenajit put him in a single chariot and went to where the Blessed One was. On arriving, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, King Prasenajit of Kosala said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable One, for a long time this King Ajātaśatru has borne enmity toward me though I am no rival of his, and has acted as an enemy though I am no foe of his. Yet because he is the son of my friend, I do not wish to kill him; I wish to let him go."

The Blessed One said, "Great king, let him go," and then on that occasion spoke these verses:

"When one is victorious, enmities are many;
When one is defeated, one dwells in suffering.
But when victory and defeat are both abandoned,
One is fully at peace and dwells in happiness."

Then King Prasenajit of Kosala thought, "That I have regained my kingdom is owing to the kindness of this merchant. I shall give him the chance of whatever reward he wishes." So King Prasenajit of Kosala offered the merchant whatever reward he wished, and the merchant replied, "I ask for a reward that I would enjoy: grant me the kingship for seven days, to do with as I please."

Then King Prasenajit of Kosala had it proclaimed by bell throughout all his country: "My kingdom has been given to the merchant for seven days." In due course the merchant invited the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha, together with King Prasenajit and his retinue, to the midday meal for seven days.

He also sent messengers to all the multitudes of people living in the lands of the Kāśis and of Kosala, saying, "For seven days, free of taxes and levies, live as you please, contented, and enjoy yourselves in happiness. Come here too, and go for refuge to the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha. Seek out my feast as well, and attend upon the Tathāgata." Then for seven days he honored the Blessed One and the Saṅgha of śrāvakas with great honors, and many hundreds of thousands of people were also brought to happiness.

When the seven days had passed, he bowed at the Blessed One's feet, made his mind resolute, and made this aspiration: "By this root of virtue, this generation of the mind, and this giving away of what is to be given, in a world that is blind, without a guide and without a leader, may I become a buddha who ferries across those beings who have not crossed over, frees those who are not freed, gives relief to those who have not found relief, and brings to complete nirvāṇa those who have not attained complete nirvāṇa."

Then the Blessed One, knowing the merchant's chain of causes, one after another, and his chain of actions, one after another, smiled. It is the nature of things that whenever the buddhas, the blessed ones, smile, rays of light, blue, yellow, red, and white, issue from their mouths. Some go downward and some go upward.

Those that go downward go to the hells Saṃjīva, Kālasūtra, Saṃghāta, Raurava, Mahāraurava, Tapana, Pratāpana, Avīci, Arbuda, Nirarbuda, Aṭaṭa, Huhuva, Hahava, Utpala, Padma, and Mahāpadma. Into those that are hot hells they descend having become cool, and into those that are cold hells they descend having become warm. In this way the various torments of those beings are allayed. Then those beings think, "Oh! Have we died and passed away from here, or have we been born somewhere else?" Then, in order to inspire faith in them, the Blessed One sends forth an emanation. When they see the emanation they think, "Oh! We have not died and passed away from here, nor have we been born somewhere else. Rather, it is through the power of this being, never seen before, that our various torments have been allayed." Then, their minds delighting in the emanation, the karma that was to be experienced in the hells is exhausted, and they take rebirth among gods and humans, wherever they will become fit vessels for the truths.

Those that go upward go to the gods of the Four Great Kings, the Thirty-Three, the Yāma gods, the Tuṣita gods, the Nirmāṇarati gods, the Paranirmitavaśavartin gods, the Brahmakāyika gods, the Brahmapurohita

gods, the Mahābrahmā gods, the Parīttābha gods, the Apramāṇābha gods, the Ābhāsvara gods, the Parīttaśubha gods, the Apramāṇaśubha gods, the Śubhakṛtsna gods, the Anabhraka gods, the Puṇyaprasava gods, the Bṛhatphala gods, the Abṛha gods, the Atapa gods, the Sudṛśa gods, the Sudarśana gods, and as far as the gods of Akaniṣṭha, and there they proclaim the sound of impermanence, suffering, emptiness, and selflessness. They also utter two verses:

"Set about renunciation;
Apply yourselves to the Buddha's teaching.
Like an elephant in a house of reeds,
Crush the army of the Lord of Death.

Whoever, in this very Dharma and Vinaya,
Conducts himself with heedfulness,
Will abandon the cycle of births
And bring suffering to an end."

So they proclaim. Then those rays of light, having circled the great trichiliocosm, return and follow behind the Blessed One himself. If the Blessed One wishes to explain past actions, they vanish into the Blessed One's back. If he wishes to explain future actions, they vanish into his front. If he wishes to foretell rebirth in the hells, they vanish into the soles of his feet. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as an animal, they vanish into his heels. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a hungry ghost, they vanish into his big toes. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a human, they vanish into his two knees. If he wishes to foretell that someone will be a wheel-turning king ruling by force, they vanish into the palm of his left hand. If he wishes to foretell that someone will be a wheel-turning king, they vanish into the palm of his right hand. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a god, they vanish into his navel. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a śrāvaka, they vanish into his mouth. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a pratyekabuddha, they vanish into the tuft of hair between his eyebrows. If he wishes to foretell unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, they vanish into the crown protuberance on his head.

Then those rays of light circled the Blessed One three times and vanished into the crown protuberance on the Blessed One's head.

Then the venerable Ānanda joined his palms and said to the Blessed One:

"Many rays, of every kind, interspersed with a thousand hues,
Have come forth from the door of your mouth,

And they have lit up all the directions,
Just as the rising sun does."

And again he spoke in verse:

"The buddhas, free of agitation, rid of pride and of displeasure,
Who have become the supreme cause for beings,
The Victors, the conquerors of foes, do not without cause and condition
Display a smile the color of lotus fibers and of conch.

Steadfast one, since by your own understanding you know the time has come,
O lord of ascetics, for the listeners who are in doubt,
O bull among sages, with your supreme and steady speech,
Excellent one, please dispel the doubt that has arisen.

The protectors, the perfect buddhas, steady as the ocean and the king of mountains,
Do not display a smile without a reason.
The reason for which you, O hero, display this smile,
That the great multitude wishes to hear from you."

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, so it is. It is just so. Ānanda, the tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly complete buddhas, do not smile without cause and without condition. Ānanda, do you see the honor this merchant has shown the Tathāgata together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, and how he has established a great multitude of people in virtue?"

"I see it, venerable one."

"Ānanda, by this root of virtue, this generation of the mind, and this giving away of what is to be given, this merchant will fully accomplish the awakening that is to be accomplished over three incalculable eons. Having brought to completion the six perfections, imbued with great compassion, he will become a perfectly complete buddha called Abhayada, endowed with the ten powers, the four fearlessnesses, the three unmixed applications of mindfulness, and great compassion, and he will appear in the world. His gift is this: that his mind delighted in me."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks were delighted and praised what the Blessed One had said.

From the Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, the first summary verse is complete.

The summary:
The Ferrymen, the Pillar, the Bath,
The Epidemic, the Miracle,
The Five-Year Festival, Praise, the Boon-Giver,
The Kāśi Cloth, and Divine Food.

Now, the one called "The Ferrymen." The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed, and worshipped by kings, by great ministers, by the wealthy, by the townsfolk, by merchants, by caravan leaders, by gods, by nāgas, by yakṣas, by asuras, by garuḍas, by kiṃnaras, and by great mahoragas. The Buddha, the Blessed One, worshipped and acknowledged by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and great mahoragas, endowed with great merit, receiving robes, food, bedding, seats, medicine for the sick, and medical supplies, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas near Śrāvastī, at the ferrymen's village at the landing on the river Ajiravatī.

Then those ferrymen went to where the Blessed One was. On arriving, they bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. When they were seated to one side, the Blessed One instructed those ferrymen with a talk on the Dharma, led them to take it up, inspired them, and gladdened them. Having instructed them, led them to take it up, inspired them, and gladdened them with talk on the Dharma in many ways, he remained silent.

Then those ferrymen rose from their seats, draped their upper robes over one shoulder, set their right knees on the ground, bowed with palms joined toward the Blessed One, and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, would you, together with the Saṅgha of monks, consent to take the midday meal with us tomorrow there on the bank of the river Ajiravatī? We would also like to ferry you across by the boat bridge." The Blessed One consented to the ferrymen by remaining silent.

Then those ferrymen cleared the bank of the river Ajiravatī of stones, gravel, and potsherds. They raised victory banners and flags, scattered flowers of many kinds, burned incense in censers, set out fine food, and prepared a great many flowers. They also adorned the top of the boat bridge with pavilions of flowers. Then they sent a messenger to announce the midday meal to the Blessed One: "Venerable one, it is time for the midday meal, and the food is ready. Please, Blessed One, consider that the time has now come, and come."

Then the Blessed One, attended by the assembly of monks and with the Saṅgha of monks going before him, went to the ferrymen's village. On arriving, he sat down on the seat prepared in the midst of the Saṅgha of monks. Then, seeing that the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha was comfortably seated, the ferrymen with their own hands served them pure and excellent foods, hard and soft, satisfying them and giving them all they wished. Having with their own hands satisfied them with pure and excellent foods, hard and soft, of many kinds, and having given them all they wished, they saw that the Blessed One had finished his meal, set aside his alms bowl, and washed his hands. Then they took low seats and sat before the Blessed One in order to listen to the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, understanding the dispositions, the latent tendencies, the temperaments, and the natures of those ferrymen, taught them the Dharma in such a way that they would realize the four noble truths. Having heard it, many of the ferrymen attained the fruit of stream entry. Some attained the fruit of once-returning. Some attained the fruit of non-returning. Some abandoned all afflictions and realized arhatship. Some generated the mind set on the awakening of a śrāvaka. Some generated the mind set on the awakening of a pratyekabuddha.

Some generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. And the whole assembly was established in devotion to the Buddha, inclination toward the Dharma, and attraction to the Saṅgha.

Then those ferrymen, with great honor, ferried the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of monks across by the boat bridge. The monks, too, were glad at heart on seeing this veneration of the Buddha, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, "Where did the Blessed One create these roots of virtue?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, in other, former lives the Tathāgata himself performed and accumulated actions whose requisites had been gathered and whose conditions had matured, actions that have now come upon him like a flood and that must inevitably bear fruit. That is why this veneration has been offered to the Tathāgata. Monks, do you wish to hear about it?"

"Blessed One, we wish to hear."

"Monks, long ago, in times past, there appeared in the world a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, a sugata, a knower of the world, a guide who tames persons, unsurpassed, a teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one called Bhagīratha.

Attended by sixty-two thousand arhats, he was traveling through the countryside and came to the bank of the Ganges. At that time a caravan leader, together with a retinue of many hundreds, was ferrying travelers across the river Ganges. In that region there was also great danger from robbers.

"Then the caravan leader saw the perfectly complete buddha Bhagīratha, attended by sixty-two thousand arhats. Seeing him, he was glad at heart, and glad at heart he said to the Blessed One, 'I wish to ferry the Blessed One across first of all.' The perfectly complete buddha Bhagīratha consented to the caravan leader by remaining silent. Then that caravan leader, with great magnificence, ferried the perfectly complete buddha Bhagīratha, attended by sixty-two thousand arhats, across by the boat bridge, satisfied them with fine food as well, and made an aspiration for unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who was the caravan leader at that time, on that occasion, was I. Through the ripening of that action, in which I ferried across by the boat bridge the perfectly complete buddha Bhagīratha, attended by sixty-two thousand arhats, satisfied them with fine food, and made an aspiration, I experienced great and boundless happiness in saṃsāra, and now too, when I have fully awakened into unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, such veneration has been offered to me. Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall honor the Teacher. We shall revere him. We shall esteem him. We shall worship him. Having honored, revered, esteemed, and worshipped the Teacher, we shall live in reliance on him.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks were delighted and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Now, the one called "The Pillar." The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed, and worshipped by kings, by great ministers, by the wealthy, by the townsfolk, by merchants, by caravan leaders, by gods, by nāgas, by yakṣas, by asuras, by garuḍas, by kiṃnaras, and by great mahoragas. The Buddha, the Blessed One, worshipped and acknowledged by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and great mahoragas, endowed with great merit, receiving robes, food, bedding, seats, medicine for the sick, and medical supplies, was traveling with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas through the Kuru country and came to the city of the Kurus. The multitudes of

Kuru people there were to be tamed by the Buddha; they were of broad mind, and every one of them delighted in giving.

Then the Blessed One thought, "I shall summon Śakra, lord of the gods, surrounded by his retinue of gods, for on seeing him the virtue of these people will increase." Then the Blessed One brought forth a worldly thought: "Oh, how good it would be if Śakra, lord of the gods, attended by the hosts of gods, were to come bringing pillars of gośīrṣa sandalwood!" The very moment he brought forth that thought, Śakra, lord of the gods, attended by the hosts of gods, together with Viśvakarman and the Four Great Kings, and attended by many gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, and kumbhāṇḍas, arrived, bringing pillars of gośīrṣa sandalwood. Crying "Ha ha!", making a clamor of laughter and raising a great shout, they built a fine palace of gośīrṣa sandalwood for the Blessed One.

Then in that palace Śakra, lord of the gods, honored, revered, esteemed, and worshipped the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas with divine food, divine bedding and seats, divine perfumes, and garlands of flowers. When the multitudes of Kuru people saw that divine splendor, they were filled with the greatest wonder and thought, "Since the gods together with their lord worship the Blessed One in this way, surely he is supreme in the world!" With their minds drawn to him, they went to the Blessed One, bowed at the Blessed One's feet, and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the multitudes of Kuru people felt great delight in that palace.

Then the Blessed One made the palace vanish and taught them the Dharma, bound up with impermanence, in such a way that they would realize the four noble truths. Having heard it, some of the Kuru people attained the fruit of stream entry. Some attained the fruit of once-returning. Some attained the fruit of non-returning. Some abandoned all afflictions and realized arhatship. Some generated the mind set on the awakening of a śrāvaka. Some generated the mind set on the awakening of a pratyekabuddha. Some generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. And the whole assembly was established in devotion to the Buddha, inclination toward the Dharma, and attraction to the Saṅgha.

The monks, too, were glad at heart on seeing this veneration of the Buddha, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, "Where did the Blessed One create these roots of virtue?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, in other, former lives the Tathāgata himself performed and accumulated actions whose requisites had been gathered and whose conditions had matured, actions that have now come upon him like a flood and that must inevitably bear fruit. That is why this veneration has been offered to the Tathāgata. Monks, do you wish to hear about it?"

"Blessed One, we wish to hear."

"Monks, long ago, in times past, there appeared in the world a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, a sugata, a knower of the world, a guide who tames persons, unsurpassed, a teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one called Brahmā. The perfectly complete buddha Brahmā, attended by sixty-two thousand arhats, was traveling through the countryside and came to a certain royal city. The king, a head-anointed kṣatriya, heard: 'The perfectly complete buddha Brahmā, attended by sixty-two thousand arhats, traveling through the countryside, has come into my land.' Having heard this, he went with great royal splendor and great royal power to where the Blessed One, the perfectly complete buddha Brahmā, was. On arriving, he bowed his head at the feet of the perfectly complete buddha Brahmā and sat down to one side. When he was seated to one side, the Blessed One fully established the head-anointed kṣatriya king in the qualities that bring about the attainment of awakening.

"Then the king, delighted, rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, bowed with palms joined toward the Blessed One, and said this to the Blessed One: 'I wish to serve the Blessed One with robes, food, bedding, seats, medicine for the sick, and medical supplies. Would the Blessed One, together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, consent to stay here in this royal city for three months?' The perfectly complete buddha Brahmā consented to the king by remaining silent.

"Then the head-anointed kṣatriya king had a palace of gośīrṣa sandalwood built for the Blessed One. He adorned it with cloths and ornaments of many kinds, scattered flowers of many kinds, and perfumed it with incense burners. He offered it to the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, satisfied them with fine food for three months, presented them with fine robes of many kinds, and also made an aspiration for unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who was the head-anointed kṣatriya king at that time, on that occasion, was I. Through the

ripening of the action of offering such veneration to the perfectly complete buddha Brahmā, I experienced great and boundless happiness in saṃsāra, and now too, when I have fully awakened into unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, such veneration has been offered to me. Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall honor the Teacher. We shall revere him. We shall esteem him. We shall worship him. Having honored, revered, esteemed, and worshipped the Teacher, we shall live in reliance on him.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks were delighted and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, fascicle four.

Now, the one called "The Bath." The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed, and worshipped by kings, by great ministers, by the wealthy, by the townsfolk, by merchants, by caravan leaders, by gods, by nāgas, by yakṣas, by asuras, by garuḍas, by kiṃnaras, and by great mahoragas. The Buddha, the Blessed One, worshipped and acknowledged by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and great mahoragas, endowed with great merit, receiving robes, food, bedding, seats, medicine for the sick, and medical supplies, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time some five hundred merchants of Śrāvastī set out on a road through the wilderness. They lost their way and came into a sandy desert. Exhausted by the hardship of the road, their provisions used up, and scorched by the heat of the sun at midday, they writhed on the ground like fish thrown onto dry land, experiencing feelings that were fierce, unbearable, burning, and disagreeable. They prayed one by one to Śiva, to Varuṇa, to Kubera, to Śakra, and to some thousand other gods, yet none was able to save them from it.

Among them was a layman who was familiar with the teaching of the Buddha, and he said to the merchants, "Go for refuge to the Buddha!" Then all of them, with one voice, went for refuge.

Now, for the buddhas, the blessed ones, there is nothing whatever that they do not know, do not see, do not realize, or do not comprehend. The buddhas, the blessed ones, are endowed with great compassion and engaged in benefiting the world. They are the sole protectors, the sole heroes, without equal, who never speak with a double tongue. They abide in calm abiding and

insight, illuminate the three knowledges, are well trained in the three trainings, and are skilled in the three bases of discipline. They have crossed the four floods; the soles of their feet, the four bases of miraculous power, stand firm; and they have long been practiced in the four means of attracting disciples. Fearless through the four fearlessnesses, they roar the great, true lion's roar of the bull among men. They have thoroughly abandoned the five factors, have completely transcended the five destinies, and are endowed with the six qualities. They have perfected the six perfections and abide in the six constant abidings. They are rich with the flowers of the seven limbs of awakening, they teach the eightfold path, and they are skilled in the nine successive meditative absorptions. They possess the strength of the ten powers, their fame pervades the ten directions, and they are far more exalted even than the lord of the thousandfold world. By the nature of things, three times each day and three times each night, they survey the world with the eye of a buddha, and their gaze of wisdom goes forth with the thought: "Who is declining? Who is flourishing? Who is in want? Who has fallen into danger? Who is afflicted by harm? Who is in want, in danger, and afflicted by harm? Who is inclining toward the lower realms? Who is sliding toward the lower realms? Who has fallen into the lower realms? Whom shall I draw out of the lower realms and establish in the higher realms, in liberation, and in the fruits? Whom, sunk in the mire of desire, shall I pull out by the hand? Whom, lacking the seven noble riches, shall I make master of the sovereignty of the seven noble riches? In whom who has not generated roots of virtue shall I generate them? In whom who has already generated roots of virtue shall I bring them to full ripeness? Whom, already fully ripened, shall I bring to complete liberation?"

Here it is said:

The ocean, dwelling place of sea monsters,
May perhaps let the time of its tide go by,
But toward the children who are to be trained,
The Buddha never lets the time go by.

Then, at a certain moment, the Blessed One saw the many merchants who were in want and had fallen into danger. Then, in the time it takes to blink an eye, attended by the assembly of monks, he vanished from the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta and went to that place. The merchants saw the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of monks, and when they saw him they raised a great cry.

Then the Blessed One formed a worldly intention, thinking, "It would be good if Śakra, lord of the gods, were to send down a great rain and also send forth a cool breeze." The very moment the Blessed One formed this intention, Śakra sent down a great rain and also sent forth a cool breeze. Because of this the merchants were no longer thirsty, and their torment from the heat subsided as well. Then the merchants were refreshed, and the Blessed One also showed them the way, so that they reached Śrāvastī.

Then, when they had recovered from their weariness, they went before the Blessed One, and the Blessed One taught them the Dharma in such a way that they came to realize the Four Noble Truths. Having heard it, some attained the fruit of stream-entry, some attained the fruit of once-returning, and some attained the fruit of non-returning. Some abandoned all afflictions and directly realized arhatship. Some generated the mind set on the awakening of a śrāvaka, some generated the mind set on the awakening of a pratyekabuddha, and some generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. The whole assembly was established in inclining toward the Buddha, sloping toward the Dharma, and bending toward the Saṅgha.

Then doubts arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, the one who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, it is wonderful how the Blessed One rescued these merchants from the wilderness in this way, and how, the very moment he formed the intention, a great rain fell and a cool breeze arose."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, the Tathāgata himself, in other, former lives, performed and accumulated actions whose accumulations had matured and whose conditions had come together, which came on like a flood and were bound inevitably to arrive. Since I myself performed and accumulated those actions, who else would experience them? Monks, actions that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external element of earth, nor do they ripen in the elements of water, fire, or wind. Virtuous and non-virtuous actions that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

The actions of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When they have gathered and their time has come,
They ripen as their very fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, there appeared in the world a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfect and complete buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, a sugata, knower of the world, guide who tames persons, unsurpassed, teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one, called Candana. Then, as the perfect and complete buddha Candana was wandering through the country, he came to a certain royal capital. The king there, a kṣatriya anointed on the crown of his head, went to where the perfect and complete buddha Candana was. Having arrived, he bowed his head at the feet of the perfect and complete buddha Candana and sat down to one side. When the kṣatriya king anointed on the crown of his head was seated to one side, the Blessed One instructed him well in the teachings that lead to the attainment of awakening."

"Then the king, the kṣatriya anointed on the crown of his head, rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, set his right knee on the ground, bowed with palms joined toward the perfect and complete buddha Candana, and said this to the perfect and complete buddha Candana: 'Would the Blessed One, together with the Saṅgha of monks, consent to stay in this royal capital for three months?' Then the perfect and complete buddha Candana consented to the king by remaining silent.

"At that time a great drought occurred, and because of it the rivers and wells ran low, and the trees too were left without flowers or fruit. Then the king made a request to the perfect and complete buddha Candana: 'Blessed One, if you would allow a pool filled with scented water to be made within this city, I pray that the Blessed One, together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, bathe there. If the Blessed One bathes in this way, I hope that rain will fall from the sky in my land.' Then the Blessed One, the perfect and complete buddha Candana, consented to the king by remaining silent.

"Then the king, the kṣatriya anointed on the crown of his head, commanded his ministers, 'Prepare scented water and jeweled vases, and with them I shall bathe the Buddha, the Blessed One, together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas.' Then the king, together with his retinue of ministers, cleared the city of stones, gravel, and potsherds. Banners and flags were raised, all kinds of flowers were strewn, it was sprinkled with scented water, it was perfumed with all kinds of incense, and in the center a pool was made. Then the Blessed One, the perfect and complete buddha Candana, for the sake of benefiting beings, put on a bathing cloth and entered the pool. Then the king, together with his retinue of ministers, bathed the Blessed One, the perfect and complete buddha Candana, together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, with water infused with all

kinds of fragrances. The very moment the Blessed One, the perfect and complete buddha Candana, bathed, Śakra, lord of the gods, sent down a great rain of such a kind that all the crops flourished. On that account a great many people also gained faith in the Buddha, the Blessed One, and they built many stupas anointed with fragrances and consecrated them.

"All those there who went for refuge to the perfect and complete buddha Candana have passed into complete nirvāṇa; of them I alone remain. Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall honor the Teacher, revere him, esteem him, and make offerings to him. Having served, revered, esteemed, and made offerings to the Teacher, we shall live in reliance upon him.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Epidemic.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed, and offered to by kings, great ministers, wealthy men, the people of the royal capitals, guild masters, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines for the sick, was dwelling together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove at the Kalandaka Feeding Ground.

At that time a pestilence broke out among the many people of the Reed Grove country. A great many of the people there were stricken by the disease, and though they prayed one by one to Śiva, to Varuṇa, to Kubera, to Śakra, and to some thousand other gods, the epidemic did not abate. Then a layman who lived in the Reed Grove country said this to the brahmins and householders of the Reed Grove: "Come here! Go for refuge to the Buddha, and invite the Blessed One to come here; and also make this request: 'May the Blessed One please bring the epidemic to an end with little trouble.'" Then the brahmins and householders of the Reed Grove made a request to the Blessed One, saying, "Blessed One, please come here and free us from this want and misery."

Now, for the buddhas, the blessed ones, there is nothing whatever that they do not know, do not see, do not realize, or do not comprehend. The buddhas, the blessed ones, are endowed with great compassion and engaged in

benefiting the world. They are the sole protectors, the sole heroes, without equal, who never speak with a double tongue. They abide in calm abiding and insight, illuminate the three knowledges, are well trained in the three trainings, and are skilled in the three bases of discipline. They have crossed the four floods; the soles of their feet, the four bases of miraculous power, stand firm; and they have long been practiced in the four means of attracting disciples. Fearless through the four fearlessnesses, they roar the great, true lion's roar of the bull among men. They have thoroughly abandoned the five factors, have completely transcended the five destinies, and are endowed with the six qualities. They have perfected the six perfections and abide in the six constant abidings. They are rich with the flowers of the seven limbs of awakening, they teach the eightfold path, and they are skilled in the nine successive meditative absorptions. They possess the strength of the ten powers, their fame pervades the ten directions, and they are far more exalted even than the lord of the thousandfold world. By the nature of things, three times each day and three times each night, they survey the world with the eye of a buddha, and their gaze of wisdom goes forth with the thought: "Who is declining? Who is flourishing? Who is in want? Who has fallen into danger? Who is afflicted by harm? Who is in want, in danger, and afflicted by harm? Who is inclining toward the lower realms? Who is sliding toward the lower realms? Who has fallen into the lower realms? Whom shall I draw out of the lower realms and establish in the higher realms, in liberation, and in the fruits? Whom, sunk in the mire of desire, shall I pull out by the hand? Whom, lacking the seven noble riches, shall I make master of the sovereignty of the seven noble riches? In whom who has not generated roots of virtue shall I generate them? In whom who has already generated roots of virtue shall I bring them to full ripeness? Whom, already fully ripened, shall I bring to complete liberation?"

Here it is said:

The ocean, dwelling place of sea monsters,
May perhaps let the time of its tide go by,
But toward the children who are to be trained,
The Buddha never lets the time go by.

Then in the morning the Blessed One put on his lower robe and Dharma robe, took up his alms bowl, and, attended by the assembly of monks and with the Saṅgha of monks going before him, went to the Reed Grove. Then the Blessed One pervaded all the people of that town with loving-kindness, and because of

this the nonhuman beings departed and the epidemic subsided. Then those brahmins and householders, on seeing the Blessed One, were filled with great joy. Filled with joy, they offered the Blessed One and the Saṅgha of śrāvakas the opportunity to receive whatever they wished of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines for the sick.

Then the Blessed One taught them the Dharma in such a way that they came to realize the Four Noble Truths. Having heard it, many brahmins and householders attained the fruit of stream-entry, some attained the fruit of once-returning, and some attained the fruit of non-returning. Some went forth, abandoned all afflictions, and directly realized arhatship. Some generated the mind set on the awakening of a śrāvaka, some generated the mind set on the awakening of a pratyekabuddha, and some generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. All the people of that town were established in inclining toward the Buddha, sloping toward the Dharma, and bending toward the Saṅgha.

Then doubts arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, the one who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, it is wonderful how these beings, through the joy that arose in them toward the Blessed One, have been freed from their want."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, the Tathāgata himself, in other, former lives, performed and accumulated actions whose accumulations had matured and whose conditions had come together, which came on like a flood and were bound inevitably to arrive. Since I myself performed and accumulated those actions, who else would experience them? Monks, actions that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external element of earth, nor do they ripen in the elements of water, fire, or wind. Virtuous and non-virtuous actions that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

The actions of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When they have gathered and their time has come,
They ripen as their very fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, there appeared in the world a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfect and complete buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, a sugata, knower of the world, guide who tames persons, unsurpassed, teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one, called Candra. Then, as

the perfect and complete buddha Candra was wandering through the country, he came to a certain royal capital. The king there, a kṣatriya anointed on the crown of his head, heard, 'The perfect and complete buddha Candra has come to my land.' Having heard this, he went, with great royal splendor and great royal might, to where the perfect and complete buddha Candra was. Having arrived, he bowed his head at the feet of the perfect and complete buddha Candra and sat down to one side. When the kṣatriya king anointed on the crown of his head was seated to one side, the perfect and complete buddha Candra instructed him well in the teachings that lead to the attainment of awakening. Then the king, the kṣatriya anointed on the crown of his head, rejoicing, rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, set his right knee on the ground, bowed with palms joined toward the perfect and complete buddha Candra, and said this to the perfect and complete buddha Candra:

"'Since I wish to serve the Blessed One with robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines for the sick, would the Blessed One, together with the Saṅgha of monks, consent to stay here for three months?' Then the perfect and complete buddha Candra consented to the king by remaining silent.

"At that time a pestilence broke out among the many people in that royal city, and it caused great harm to a great many of them. Then, in order to bring the disease to an end, the king made a request to the perfect and complete buddha Candra: 'Blessed One, would you consent to provide a means by which this epidemic may be brought to an end?' Then the Blessed One, the perfect and complete buddha Candra, said to the king, 'Great king, go and fasten this patched Dharma robe of mine to the top of a banner, and with great honor have it carried around your land. Hold a great festival for it as well, and have all the multitude of people properly keep the recollection of the Buddha. By this you will come to well-being.' Then the king did everything exactly as he had been instructed, and by that cause and that condition the epidemic was completely ended. Then those multitudes of people rejoiced, and the king, the ministers, and the people of the royal capital went for refuge to the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who was the king at that time, on that occasion, was I. Through the ripening of the karma of having made great offerings to the perfect and complete buddha Candra, I experienced in saṃsāra the great happiness of attaining births among gods and humans, and now too I am endowed with the prosperity that has arisen

from that cause. Therefore, whatever I have thought of and whatever I have wished for has all been accomplished accordingly. Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall honor the Teacher, revere him, esteem him, and make offerings to him. Having honored, revered, esteemed, and made offerings to the Teacher, we shall live in reliance upon him.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Miracle.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed, and offered to by kings, great ministers, wealthy men, the people of the royal capitals, guild masters, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines for the sick, was dwelling together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove at the Kalandaka Feeding Ground.

At the time when, at Devadatta's instigation, King Ajātaśatru had killed his father, the righteous king who lived by the Dharma, and had himself assumed the kingship, those who were without faith became powerful, and those who had faith became weak. Then, at a certain time, an old minister who was without faith and hostile to the teaching of the Blessed One held a sacrificial offering for the brahmins. Many hundreds of thousands of brahmins assembled there, and among themselves they made a rule that no one should go to see the ascetic Gautama. Then the brahmins, having made this rule, gathered in harmony and, overjoyed, in the middle of the street, following the rite that comes from the Vedas, made supplication to Śakra, saying, "Come, O husband of the Boneless Lady! Come!"

Now, for the buddhas, the blessed ones, there is nothing whatever that they do not know, do not see, do not realize, or do not comprehend. The buddhas, the blessed ones, are endowed with great compassion and engaged in benefiting the world. They are the sole protectors, the sole heroes, without equal, who never speak with a double tongue. They abide in calm abiding and insight, illuminate the three knowledges, are well trained in the three trainings, and are skilled in the three bases of discipline. They have crossed the four floods; the soles of their feet, the four bases of miraculous power,

stand firm; and they have long been practiced in the four means of attracting disciples. Fearless through the four fearlessnesses, they roar the great, true lion's roar of the bull among men. They have thoroughly abandoned the five factors, have completely transcended the five destinies, and are endowed with the six qualities. They have perfected the six perfections and abide in the six constant abidings. They are rich with the flowers of the seven limbs of awakening, they teach the eightfold path, and they are skilled in the nine successive meditative absorptions. They possess the strength of the ten powers, their fame pervades the ten directions, and they are far more exalted even than the lord of the thousandfold world. By the nature of things, three times each day and three times each night, they survey the world with the eye of a buddha, and their gaze of wisdom goes forth with the thought: "Who is declining? Who is flourishing? Who is in want? Who has fallen into danger? Who is afflicted by harm? Who is in want, in danger, and afflicted by harm? Who is inclining toward the lower realms? Who is sliding toward the lower realms? Who has fallen into the lower realms? Whom shall I draw out of the lower realms and establish in the higher realms, in liberation, and in the fruits? Whom, sunk in the mire of desire, shall I pull out by the hand? Whom, lacking the seven noble riches, shall I make master of the sovereignty of the seven noble riches? In whom who has not generated roots of virtue shall I generate them? In whom who has already generated roots of virtue shall I bring them to full ripeness? Whom, already fully ripened, shall I bring to complete liberation?"

Here it is said:

The ocean, dwelling place of sea monsters,
May perhaps let the time of its tide go by,
But toward the children who are to be trained,
The Buddha never lets the time go by.

Then the Blessed One saw those brahmins: through having generated roots of virtue again and again in the past, they had become fit for liberation; they had found what was to be sought; they were facing inward toward nirvāṇa and facing away from saṃsāra. Seeing them, he thought, "Now, because they rely on unwholesome spiritual friends, they have become hostile to my teaching. I shall make an effort to train them."

Then the Blessed One emanated himself in the guise of Śakra, lit up the sacrificial assembly hall with divine light, and went there. Then those brahmins

were glad, delighted, overjoyed, and elated, joyful and happy in mind, and with one voice they said, "Come, Lord! Come! Welcome, Lord!" Then the Blessed One, remaining in the guise of Śakra, sat on the seat that had been prepared. Then throughout the city of Rājagṛha the report also spread, "Śakra, lord of the gods, has come to the sacrifice!" Hearing it, many hundreds of thousands of living beings gathered.

Then the Blessed One, knowing that the brahmins had come to have faith, made the guise of Śakra disappear, took on the guise of a buddha, and taught the Dharma in such a way that they came to realize the Four Noble Truths. Having heard it, sixty-two thousand brahmins destroyed with the vajra of wisdom the twenty lofty peaks of the mountain of the view of the perishable aggregates, and directly realized the fruit of stream-entry. Many hundreds of thousands of living beings also gained faith in the Blessed One.

Then doubts arose in those monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, the one who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, it is wonderful how these brahmins, having met the Blessed One in this way, came to see the truths, and how many hundreds of thousands of living beings attained great joy."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, the Tathāgata himself, in other, former lives, performed and accumulated actions whose accumulations had matured and whose conditions had come together, which came on like a flood and were bound inevitably to arrive. Since I performed and accumulated those actions, who else would experience them? Monks, actions that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external element of earth, nor do they ripen in the elements of water, fire, or wind. Virtuous and non-virtuous actions that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

The actions of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When they have gathered and their time has come,
They ripen as their very fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, there appeared in the world a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfect and complete buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, a sugata, knower of the world, guide who tames persons, unsurpassed, teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one, called Indradamana. As he was wandering through the country, he came to a certain royal capital, and

that royal capital had fallen under the sway of the tīrthikas. Then the king there, a kṣatriya anointed on the crown of his head, heard, 'The perfect and complete buddha Indradamana has come to my land.' Having heard this, he went, with great royal splendor and great royal might, to where the perfect and complete buddha Indradamana was. Having arrived, he bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, the perfect and complete buddha Indradamana, and sat down to one side. When the kṣatriya king anointed on the crown of his head was seated to one side, the perfect and complete buddha Indradamana instructed him in the teachings that lead to the attainment of awakening.

"Then the king, the kṣatriya anointed on the crown of his head, rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, set his right knee on the ground, bowed with palms joined toward the perfect and complete buddha Indradamana, and said this to the perfect and complete buddha Indradamana: 'Since I wish to serve the Blessed One with robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines for the sick, would the Blessed One, together with the Saṅgha of monks, consent to stay here for three months?'

"The Blessed One said, 'Great king, is there in your land any monastery suitable as a lodging for monks who arrive and depart?'

"The king replied, 'Blessed One, there is none at present, but may the Blessed One accept my invitation, and I ask that you permit me to build a monastery suitable as a lodging for monks who arrive and depart.'

"Then the king had a monastery built for the Tathāgata, with walls, a portico, windows, and doorways, adorned with latticework, crescent-moon ornaments, and railings, furnished with coverings, filled all around with pools, and surrounded by many trees bearing flowers and fruit. When it was built, he offered it to the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas.

"Then he asked the Blessed One to perform a great miracle. Since the king had asked, the Blessed One, the perfect and complete buddha Indradamana, displayed the great miracle of the play of a multitude of buddhas. As a result the king, the ministers, the townspeople, the country folk, and all the people of the royal capital rejoiced, and they came to cherish the protection of the teaching.

"Monks, what do you think? The one who was the king at that time, on that occasion, was I myself. Through the karmic maturation of that deed, the offering I made in that way to the perfect and complete buddha Indradamana, I experienced boundless happiness in saṃsāra, and now that I have become a

tathāgata, this teaching of mine has also become beautiful. Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall honor the Teacher. We shall revere him. We shall esteem him. We shall make offerings to him. Having honored the Teacher, revered him, esteemed him, and made offerings to him, we shall dwell in reliance on him.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks were delighted and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Five-Year Festival.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed, and worshipped by kings, great ministers, wealthy householders, courtiers, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas. Worshipped and acknowledged by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit and receiving robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and provisions for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove, at the Kalandaka Feeding Ground.

At that time the foolish Devadatta, though he had done the Blessed One's teaching a thousand harms, had not been able to stir even a single hair of the Blessed One's body. So he said to King Ajātaśatru, "Great king, issue a decree that no one from Rājagṛha is to go to the ascetic Gautama or give him food. If that is done, he will gain neither profit nor honor, and he will surely move away to another country." The king did just that.

Then the lay followers living there who had seen the truth wept, lamenting, "Alas! Though we have met with the appearance of a buddha, a blessed one, as rare as the udumbara flower, we are not even able to attend on him. The people of the city of Rājagṛha have become without a protector!" The monks heard those very words here and there, and the venerable Ānanda reported them to the Blessed One just as he had heard them.

The Blessed One declared, "Ānanda, in this the Tathāgata himself knows the right time, so do not be disheartened. Moreover, for as long as my teaching endures, the śrāvakas will never be without their requisites, so what need is there to speak of now?"

On that occasion Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, turned his knowing gaze to the world below, and he saw what had befallen the teaching of the Blessed One. The very moment he saw it, in order to stir the enthusiasm of patrons

and donors, to show truly the greatness of a buddha's appearance, to cut down the arrogance and pride of Ajātaśatru and Devadatta, and to show his own faith, he lit up the whole of Rājagṛha with a great light and called out in a loud voice, "From this day forward I shall serve the Blessed One and the Saṅgha of śrāvakas with divine robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and provisions for the sick!" Having said this, he went to where the Blessed One was. When he arrived, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side.

Seated to one side, Śakra, lord of the gods, said to the Blessed One, "For as long as I live, here in this very city of Rājagṛha, I wish to serve the Blessed One and the Saṅgha of śrāvakas with divine robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and provisions for the sick. May the Blessed One please grant me permission."

The Blessed One declared, "Kauśika, there are many in the world who desire merit. That you have brought your mind to faith in me in this way is enough."

Śakra said, "In that case, I wish to hold a Five-Year Festival for the Tathāgata for five years. May the Blessed One please grant me permission."

The Blessed One declared, "Kauśika, there are many in the world who desire merit. That you have brought your mind to faith in me in this way is enough."

Śakra said, "Then may the Blessed One please grant me permission for five years."

Then, in order to make manifest the power of his own merit, to benefit Śakra, lord of the gods, and so that in future times the festival of the fifth day would continue without interruption, the Blessed One consented by remaining silent.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, understanding that the Blessed One had consented by remaining silent, made the Bamboo Grove appear like the palace Vaijayanta, and he also made divine seats, divine pools, and divine food of ambrosia appear. Then the Blessed One sat down on the seat prepared for him.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, understanding that the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha was comfortably seated, together with an attendant retinue of many hundreds of thousands of gods, with his own hands satisfied them and served them whatever they wished. When he had satisfied them in many ways with his own hands and served them whatever they wished, and understood that the Blessed One had finished his meal, put away his bowl, and washed his

hands, he took a very low seat and sat before the Blessed One in order to listen to the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, with a talk on the Dharma, instructed Śakra, lord of the gods, together with his retinue, inspired them, fired them with enthusiasm, and delighted them.

King Ajātaśatru, who was on the upper terrace of his palace, also saw such offerings being made to the Blessed One in the Bamboo Grove. Having seen it, he was struck with remorse and gained great faith.

The courtiers living in Rājagṛha, moved by the force of the Dharma, also went before the king and said, "Alas, great king! Since even the gods, who live intoxicated and heedless, have left the realm of the gods to make offerings to the Blessed One, the courtiers living in Rājagṛha will be put to shame. It would be well if Your Majesty's decree were revoked."

Then King Ajātaśatru revoked the decree and had a bell rung through the royal city with the proclamation, "Honor the Blessed One as you please!" Then the courtiers living in Rājagṛha, together with their households, glad, pleased, delighted, rejoicing, and filled with joy and happiness, took flowers, incense, and garlands and went to see the Blessed One. Then gods and humans paid great honor to the Blessed One. On that basis the Blessed One taught gods and humans a Dharma such that they would realize the Four Noble Truths, and on hearing it many gods and humans came to see the truth.

Then the monks, having seen the offerings made to the Blessed One, were filled with doubt, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, the one who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, it is wondrous that such a festival has been held in the teaching of the Blessed One."

The Blessed One declared, "Monks, in other former lives the Tathāgata himself performed and accumulated deeds whose accumulations were complete and whose conditions had ripened, deeds that are bound to come forth like a flood and will inevitably arrive. Since I myself performed and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external element of earth, nor do they ripen in the element of water, the element of fire, or the element of wind. Rather, the virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When they are complete and their time has come,
They ripen as their fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in a time gone by, there appeared in the world a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfect and complete buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, a sugata, a knower of the world, the unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, a teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one called Jewel Mountain. As he traveled through the land, he came to a certain royal capital, and in that royal capital an epidemic broke out. Then, in order to quell the epidemic, the king invited the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas for the midday meal for three months. When the three months had passed, the epidemic subsided. Then the king and the townspeople, whose minds had become filled with faith, held a Five-Year Festival for the Tathāgata together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas."

Here it is said:

Ānanda, when I had become a king,
To Jewel Mountain of great light
I made my request, wishing for peace,
And held the Five-Year Festival.

"Monks, what do you think? The one who was the king at that time, on that occasion, was I myself. Through the karmic maturation of that deed, the Five-Year Festival I held for the perfect and complete buddha Jewel Mountain, I experienced great happiness in saṃsāra, and now that I have become a tathāgata, such honor has also been paid to me. Even after my parinirvāṇa, many hundreds of Five-Year Festivals will be held in my teaching. Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall honor the Teacher. We shall revere him. We shall esteem him. We shall make offerings to him. Having honored the Teacher, revered him, esteemed him, and made offerings to him, we shall dwell in reliance on him.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks were delighted and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa. Section five.

Praise.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed, and worshipped by kings, great ministers, wealthy householders, courtiers, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas. Worshipped and acknowledged by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit and receiving robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and provisions for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time about five hundred musicians, all members of a single troupe, were living in Śrāvastī. At that time a king of musicians called Supriya newly arrived, and his skill was such that he knew how to bring forth seven notes and twenty-one modulations from a single string. He had proclaimed six great cities to be no great places, and then he came to Śrāvastī. The musicians living in Śrāvastī reported this to the king. The king said, "I know the right time for this, so do not be disheartened."

Then Supriya, the king of musicians, thought, "It is said that King Prasenajit is highly skilled in music, so I shall compete with him." Then Supriya, the king of musicians, went to where Prasenajit, king of Kosala, was, and when he arrived, he said to Prasenajit, king of Kosala, "O king, I have heard that you are highly skilled in music. If it would not trouble you, I would like to put you to the test."

Then King Prasenajit, putting him off, said to him, "Good sir, I have a teacher, the unsurpassed king of musicians, who is staying in the Jeta Grove. Come, let us go there." Then Prasenajit, king of Kosala, attended by about five hundred musicians, went to the Jeta Grove with Supriya, the king of musicians, and many hundreds of thousands of people.

On that occasion, for the buddhas, the blessed ones, there is nothing that is not known, not seen, not understood, or not comprehended. The buddhas, the blessed ones, are endowed with great compassion, devoted to benefiting the world, possessed of a singular guardianship, singular heroes, without a second, never speaking in two ways, abiding in calm abiding and insight, illuminators of the three knowledges, well trained in the three trainings, skilled in the three bases of discipline, crossed over the four floods, with the soles of their feet firmly planted on the four bases of miraculous power, long familiar with the four means of attraction, fearless through the four fearlessnesses, proclaimers of the great true lion's roar of a supreme bull, rid of the five

factors, gone wholly beyond the five destinies, possessed of the six factors, perfect in the six perfections, abiding in the six constant abidings, rich in the flowers of the seven factors of awakening, teachers of the eightfold path, skilled in the nine successive absorptions, strong with the strength of the ten powers, adorned all about with renown in the ten directions, and far more exalted even than the lord of the thousandfold world. By their very nature, three times by day and three times by night, they survey the world with the eye of a buddha, and they turn their gaze of wisdom upon it, thinking, "Who is declining? Who is flourishing? Who is in want? Who is in danger? Who is afflicted? Who is in want, in danger, and afflicted? Who is inclined toward the lower realms? Who is sliding toward the lower realms? Who has fallen into the lower realms? Whom shall I draw out of the lower realms and set in the higher realms, in liberation, and in the fruits? Who is sunk in the mire of sensual desire, that I may pull him out by the hand? Who lacks the seven noble riches, that I may make him master of the sovereignty of the seven noble riches? In whom shall I produce the roots of virtue that have not yet been produced? In whom shall I ripen the roots of virtue that have already been produced? Whom, already ripened, shall I liberate?"

Here it is said:

The ocean, abode of sea monsters,
Might perhaps let the time of its tide go by,
But for the children he is to tame
The Buddha never lets the time go by.

Then, in order to benefit the people to be tamed, the Blessed One formed a worldly thought: "Oh, it would be good if Pañcaśikha, son of the gandharvas, surrounded by seven thousand gandharvas, were to come to me bringing a lute whose body is made of beryl." The very moment he formed that thought, Pañcaśikha, son of the gandharvas, surrounded by seven thousand gandharvas, came, made offerings to the Blessed One in the proper manner, and presented the Blessed One with a lute whose body was made of beryl.

Then Supriya, the king of musicians, took up his lute in the presence of the Blessed One and showed how seven notes and twenty-one modulations could be brought forth from even a single string. On hearing it, King Prasenajit and the many other people present were utterly amazed.

Then the Blessed One too strung the lute whose body was made of beryl, and he showed how many different kinds of notes and many kinds of modulations

could be brought forth from even a single string. And they resounded as emptiness and as selflessness. He showed that this body is like the lute, that the notes are like the sense faculties, and that the modulations are like the elements of mind.

On hearing this, Supriya, the king of musicians, gave rise to faith. He offered his lute to the Perfumed Chamber and went forth in the presence of the Blessed One. Through diligence, application, and effort, he understood that this very five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra is shifting and unstable, and he ascertained that all kinds of formations are by nature subject to decay, to falling, to scattering, and to destruction. Having abandoned all afflictions, he realized arhatship. Having become an arhat, free of desire for the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal, and his mind was like space and like the palm of the hand. He became cool like sandalwood paste. With knowledge he had broken the shell of the egg. He attained the knowledges, the superknowledges, and the analytical knowledges, and he turned his back on worldly gain, attachment, and honor. He became worthy of the worship, veneration, and respectful address of the gods, including Indra and Upendra.

Then the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas gained faith and set about protecting, guarding, and preserving the teaching of the Blessed One.

The five hundred musicians were also glad and happy, and they thought, "We carry on a lowly trade and make our living with difficulty. Why should we not ask the king and invite the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas to come to the city?" In time those musicians obtained permission and invited the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas to come to the city, and the Blessed One consented to those musicians by remaining silent.

Then those musicians, the king, the ministers, the courtiers, and the country folk joined together and cleared the whole city of Śrāvastī of stones, gravel, and potsherds. They sprinkled it with scented water, strewed it with various flowers, perfumed it with various incenses, and adorned it with canopies of flowers. The musicians, each bringing his own lute, paid homage with clay drums, flutes, round drums, and many special kinds of music. And with fine food they satisfied the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas. Then the Blessed One smiled.

Now it is the nature of things that whenever the buddhas, the blessed ones, smile, blue, yellow, red, and white rays of light come forth from their mouths. Some go downward and some go upward. Those that go downward reach the hells Saṃjīva, Kālasūtra, Saṃghāta, Raurava, Mahāraurava, Tapana, Pratāpana, Avīci, Arbuda, Nirarbuda, Aṭaṭa, Huhuva, Hahava, Utpala, Padma, and Mahāpadma. In the hot hells they descend as coolness, and in the cold hells they descend as warmth. As a result, the particular torments of those beings are soothed. Then those beings think, "Oh! Have we died and passed away from here, or have we been born somewhere else?" Then, in order to inspire faith in them, the Blessed One sends forth an emanation. When they see the emanation, they think, "Oh! We have not died and passed away from here, nor have we been born somewhere else. Rather, it is through the power of this being, never seen before, who has appeared, that our particular torments have been soothed." Then their minds delight in the emanation, the karma that was to be experienced in the hells is exhausted, and they take rebirth among gods and humans, wherever they will become fit vessels for the truths.

Those that go upward reach as far as the gods of the Four Great Kings, the Thirty-Three, the Yāma gods, the Tuṣita gods, the Nirmāṇarati gods, the Paranirmitavaśavartin gods, the Brahmakāyika gods, the Brahmapurohita gods, the Mahābrahmā gods, the Parīttābha gods, the Apramāṇābha gods, the Ābhāsvara gods, the Parīttaśubha gods, the Apramāṇaśubha gods, the Śubhakṛtsna gods, the Anabhraka gods, the Puṇyaprasava gods, the Bṛhatphala gods, the Abṛha gods, the Atapa gods, the Sudṛśa gods, the Sudarśana gods, and the gods of Akaniṣṭha, and there they proclaim the sounds of impermanence, suffering, emptiness, and selflessness. They also recite two verses:

Set about renunciation!
Apply yourselves to the Buddha's teaching!
As an elephant crushes a hut of reeds,
Crush the army of the Lord of Death!

Whoever, in this very Dharma and Vinaya,
Conducts himself with heedfulness
Will abandon the cycle of births
And bring suffering to an end.

Thus they recite.

Then those rays of light, having circled the great trichiliocosm, return to the Blessed One himself. If the Blessed One wishes to reveal a past deed, they vanish into the Blessed One's back. If he wishes to reveal a future deed, they vanish into his front. If he wishes to predict a rebirth in the hells, they vanish into the soles of his feet. If he wishes to predict a rebirth as an animal, they vanish into his heels. If he wishes to predict a rebirth as a preta, they vanish into his big toes. If he wishes to predict a rebirth as a human, they vanish into his two knees. If he wishes to predict that someone will become a king who turns the wheel by force, they vanish into the palm of his left hand. If he wishes to predict that someone will become a wheel-turning king, they vanish into the palm of his right hand. If he wishes to predict a rebirth as a god, they vanish into his navel. If he wishes to predict the awakening of a śrāvaka, they vanish into his mouth. If he wishes to predict the awakening of a pratyekabuddha, they vanish into the hair curl between his eyebrows. If he wishes to predict unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, they vanish into the crown protuberance on his head.

Then those rays of light circled the Blessed One three times and vanished into the hair curl between the Blessed One's eyebrows. Then the venerable Ānanda joined his palms and said to the Blessed One:

Many-hued, interwoven with a thousand colors,
A multitude came forth from the door of your mouth,
And it lit up all the directions
Just as the rising sun does.

And again he spoke in verse:

Free of agitation, rid of pride and of displeasure,
The buddhas, the supreme cause for beings,
The victors, conquerors of the foe, do not without cause or condition
Display a smile the color of lotus root and conch.

Steadfast One, since with your own mind you know the time has come,
Lord of victors, for the monks, your listeners, who are in doubt,
With the supreme, steady, and excellent words of the bull among sages,
Please dispel the doubt that has arisen.

The protectors, the perfect buddhas, steadfast as the ocean and the king of mountains,
Do not display a smile for no purpose.
The purpose for which you, O hero, display this smile,

The great multitude wishes to hear from you.

The Blessed One declared, "Ānanda, it is so. It is just so. Ānanda, the tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfect and complete buddhas, do not smile without cause and without condition. Ānanda, do you see the honor these musicians have paid me?"

"Venerable One, I see it."

"Ānanda, through this root of virtue, this generation of the mind, and this giving away of things to be given, these musicians will in due course achieve the awakening of a pratyekabuddha, and in a future time they will all become pratyekabuddhas called Sweet Voice. Compassionate toward the wretched and destitute, living in remote dwellings, they will become the sole worthy recipients of offerings for the world. Their gift of things to be given is this: that their minds took delight in me."

Then the monks were filled with doubt, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, the one who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, where did you perform the roots of virtue through which such power came about?"

The Blessed One declared, "Monks, in other former lives the Tathāgata himself performed and accumulated deeds whose accumulations were complete and whose conditions had ripened, deeds that are bound to come forth like a flood and will inevitably arrive. Since I myself performed and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external element of earth, nor do they ripen in the element of water, the element of fire, or the element of wind. Rather, the virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When they are complete and their time has come,
They ripen as their fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in a time gone by, there appeared in the world a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfect and complete buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, a sugata, a knower of the world, the unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, a teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one called Realizer. As he

traveled through the land, he came to a certain royal capital. There was a royal pleasure garden there, rich with excellent fruit in every season. The Blessed One went to that pleasure garden and, in order to benefit the king, settled at the foot of a tree. Then he sat down on the seat that had been spread out and entered the absorption of the fire element.

"Then that king, a consecrated kṣatriya, went to the pleasure garden with women sounding cymbals and music. As the king was strolling about the pleasure garden, he saw the Blessed One, the perfect and complete buddha Realizer, handsome and pleasing to behold, his senses at peace, his mind at peace, possessed of supreme discipline and tranquility of mind, blazing with splendor like a golden pillar. When he saw him, the king was delighted, and together with his retinue of queens he sounded cymbals of many kinds and requested the Blessed One to arise from that samādhi. He also served him fine food, and then he made an aspiration for unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.

"Monks, what do you think? The one who was the king at that time, on that occasion, was I myself. Because of the very offering I made to the perfect and complete buddha Realizer, the musicians have now paid me such homage. Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall honor the Teacher. We shall revere him. We shall esteem him. We shall make offerings to him. Having honored the Teacher, revered him, esteemed him, and made offerings to him, we shall dwell in reliance on him.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks were delighted and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Boon-Giver.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed, and worshipped by kings, great ministers, wealthy householders, courtiers, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas. Worshipped and acknowledged by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit and receiving robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and provisions for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

Now in Śrāvastī there was a man who lived in the stain of committing adultery with other men's wives. The king's men seized him and brought him before the

king, and the king handed him over to the executioners to be punished. Then the king's men, wearing blue garments, bearing weapons, and wearing garlands of karavīra flowers around their necks, proclaimed his crime aloud on the highways, the streets, the crossroads, and the junctions, and led him to the southern gate of the city.

At that time, there is nothing that the buddhas, the blessed ones, do not know, do not see, do not realize, or do not comprehend. The buddhas, the blessed ones, are endowed with great compassion. They are engaged in benefiting the world. They are possessed of a single protection, singular heroes, without equal, never speaking in two ways. They abide in calm abiding and insight. They illuminate the three knowledges. They have trained well in the three trainings. They are skilled in the three bases of discipline. They have crossed the four floods. The soles of their feet are firmly planted upon the four bases of miraculous power. For a long time they have made themselves familiar with the four means of attraction. Through the four fearlessnesses they are without fear. They roar the great and true lion's roar of the supreme bull. They have fully abandoned the five factors. They have entirely passed beyond the five destinies. They are endowed with the six qualities. They have perfected the six perfections. They abide in the six constant abidings. They are rich with the flowers of the seven limbs of awakening. They teach the eightfold path. They are skilled in the nine successive meditative attainments. They possess the power of the ten powers. Their renown pervades the ten directions. They are far more exalted even than the lord of the thousandfold world. As is their nature, three times by day and three times by night, they survey the world with the eye of a buddha, and the vision of their wisdom engages, thinking: "Who is declining? Who is flourishing? Who is in want? Who has fallen into danger? Who is beset with harm? Who is beset with want, danger, and harm? Who is inclined toward the lower realms? Who is sliding toward the lower realms? Who has fallen into the lower realms? Whom shall I draw out of the lower realms and establish in the higher realms, in liberation, and in the fruit? Whom shall I pull out by the hand from where he is sunk in the mire of desire? Whom, lacking the seven noble riches, shall I bring to mastery over the sovereignty of the seven noble riches? In whom shall I generate the roots of virtue not yet generated? In whom shall I bring to maturity the roots of virtue already generated? Whom, already matured, shall I liberate?"

Here it is said:

The ocean, the abode of sea monsters,
May let the time of its tide go by;
But for the children who are to be trained,
The Buddha never lets the time go by.

Then in the morning the Blessed One put on his lower robe and his Dharma robe, took up his alms bowl, and went into Śrāvastī for alms. Then that man saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and made beautiful by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, wholly excellent, like a moving mountain of jewels. Having seen him, he bowed at the Blessed One's feet and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, since I am worthy of the sublime gift, please grant me the life I hold so dear."

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda, "Ānanda, go and say this to King Prasenajit: 'Great king, give this man to me, and I shall have him go forth.'"

Then the venerable Ānanda, having heard what the Blessed One had said, went to where King Prasenajit of Kosala was. When he arrived, he gave King Prasenajit of Kosala the Blessed One's message in these words: "Great king, please permit this man to go forth under the Blessed One." King Prasenajit of Kosala, recognizing this as entirely fitting, gave his permission. The Blessed One had him go forth and gave him full ordination.

Through diligence, practice, and effort he came to understand that this very wheel of saṃsāra with its five spokes is moving and unstable. Having ascertained that all forms of conditioning factors are by nature subject to decay, to falling, to scattering, and to destruction, he abandoned all afflictions and directly realized arhatship. As an arhat, he became free of attachment to the three realms. Gold and a clod of earth were the same to him. His mind was like empty space and the palm of the hand. He became cool, like refined sandalwood. Through knowledge he had broken the shell of the egg. He attained the knowledges, the superknowledges, and the analytical knowledges. He turned his back on the gains of craving, on attachment, and on honors. He became one worthy of being worshiped, revered, and spoken to with respect by the gods together with Indra and Upendra.

Then doubts arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable, it is wondrous that everything is

accomplished by the Blessed One's mere intention."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, in other former lives the Tathāgata himself performed and accumulated those actions which, having gained their accumulations and possessing fulfilled conditions, arise like a flood and will come about without fail. Since I myself performed and accumulated these actions, who else would experience them? Monks, actions that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element, or the wind element. Virtuous and nonvirtuous actions that have been performed and accumulated ripen solely in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

The actions of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons;
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen into their very fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, there appeared in the world a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, a sugata, knower of the world, guide of beings to be tamed, unsurpassed, teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one, called Indradhvaja. As he was wandering through the countryside, he came to a certain royal capital. In that royal capital there lived, in the king's city, a brahmin who had mastered the Vedas and their ancillary sciences. Then the perfectly complete Buddha Indradhvaja, in the morning, put on his lower robe and his Dharma robe, took up his alms bowl, and went into that royal capital for alms.

Then that brahmin saw the perfectly complete Buddha Indradhvaja, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and made beautiful by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, wholly excellent, like a moving mountain of jewels. Having seen him, he fell like a tree cut down at the root, bowed at the Blessed One's feet, and said, "Blessed One, I am worthy of receiving the sublime. Sugata, since I am worthy of receiving the sublime, Blessed One, please be seated wherever you will."

Then, in order to benefit him, the Blessed One, the perfectly complete Buddha Indradhvaja, sat down there. When the perfectly complete Buddha Indradhvaja had sat down, the brahmin praised him with a hundred words. He also served him fine food, and then made an aspiration for unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening. On that basis faith arose in the king, the ministers, and

the people of the capital.

"Monks, what do you think? I myself was the one who at that time, on that occasion, was the brahmin. Because of the worship I offered to the perfectly complete Buddha Indradhvaja, I experienced boundless happiness in saṃsāra, and now too, whatever I think of and whatever I wish, all of it is accomplished. Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall show honor to the Teacher, hold him supreme, revere him, and worship him. Having shown honor to the Teacher, held him supreme, revered him, and worshiped him, we shall dwell relying on him.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Kāśi Cloth.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, held supreme, revered, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the capital, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped and renowned among the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, who received robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and supplies for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove at the Kalandaka Feeding Ground.

When King Bimbisāra, together with many hundreds of thousands of his followers, had come to see the truths, he invited the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas to the royal capital for the midday meal, in order to show his repayment of kindness for the benefit he had received, to establish the worship of the Buddha as a custom, to show the openness of his house, and to show how precious is the appearance of a buddha.

Then he commanded the people of the Magadhan capital, "When the Blessed One comes into the city, make offerings of flowers, garlands, incense, and ointments. Clear the whole city of Rājagṛha of stones, gravel, and potsherds. Strew it with all kinds of flowers and raise victory banners and pennants. Cover the whole road from the Bamboo Grove to Rājagṛha with cloth." The ministers carried all of this out.

Then King Bimbisāra with his own hand held a parasol of a hundred ribs over the Blessed One's head, and other people of the capital held parasols for the thousand monks.

Then the Blessed One, tamed and with a tamed retinue, peaceful and with a peaceful retinue, liberated and with a liberated retinue, consoled and with a consoled retinue, purified and with a purified retinue, an arhat and with a retinue of arhats, free of desire and with a retinue free of desire, beautiful and with a beautiful retinue, was like a bull surrounded by a herd of cattle, like an elephant surrounded by a herd of young elephants, like a lion surrounded by a pack of beasts of prey, like a king of geese surrounded by a flock of geese, like a garuḍa surrounded by a flock of birds, like a skilled physician surrounded by a crowd of patients, like a hero surrounded by a body of soldiers, like a guide surrounded by a band of travelers, like a caravan leader surrounded by a company of merchants, like a guild master surrounded by the people of the city, like a vassal king surrounded by his ministers, like a wheel-turning king surrounded by his thousand sons, like the moon surrounded by the hosts of stars, like the sun surrounded by its thousand rays, like Dhṛtarāṣṭra surrounded by the hosts of gandharvas, like Virūḍhaka surrounded by the hosts of kumbhāṇḍas, like Virūpākṣa surrounded by the hosts of nāgas, like Dhanada (Kubera) surrounded by the hosts of yakṣas, like Vemacitrin surrounded by the hosts of asuras, like Śakra (Indra) surrounded by the hosts of the gods of the Thirty-Three, and like Brahmā surrounded by the Brahmakāyika gods. Brimming and still like the ocean, like a cloud laden with rain, like a king of elephants free of rut, with his senses utterly serene, his deportment never faltering, adorned with the many unshared qualities of a buddha, the Blessed One entered that city.

When the Blessed One set his foot upon the threshold of the gate, this great earth shook in six ways, and when the Blessed One entered the city, such marvels as these occurred. Moreover, narrow gateways became wide, and low ones became high. The elephants trumpeted, the horses neighed, and the bulls bellowed.

All the various musical instruments kept in house after house sounded of their own accord. The blind came to see with their eyes. The deaf came to hear with their ears. The mute became able to speak. Those whose other faculties were impaired obtained complete faculties. Those drunk with liquor became sober. Those who had drunk poison became free of poison. Those who bore enmity toward one another attained minds of loving-kindness. Pregnant women gave birth with ease. Those in bonds were freed. Those without wealth found wealth. The gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas dwelling in the sky rained down a shower of divine flowers.

Then, with such splendor, the Blessed One went to the royal palace. King Bimbisāra himself, with his own hands, took up water scented with the finest sandalwood for cooling the feet at the outer gatehouse, and bathed the feet of the Blessed One and of the Saṅgha of monks. Then, seeing that the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha was comfortably seated, he served them food of a hundred flavors. When they had eaten, he also presented them with robes of Kāśi cloth. Because of this, the people of the Magadhan capital became filled with faith.

Then doubts arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable, where did the Blessed One create the roots of virtue by which the Blessed One and the Saṅgha of monks have received such worship?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, in other former lives the Tathāgata himself performed and accumulated those actions which, having gained their accumulations and possessing fulfilled conditions, arise like a flood and will come about without fail. Since I myself performed and accumulated these actions, who else would experience them? Monks, actions that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element, or the wind element. Virtuous and nonvirtuous actions that have been performed and accumulated ripen solely in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

The actions of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons;
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen into their very fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, there appeared in the world a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, a sugata, knower of the world, guide of beings to be tamed, unsurpassed, teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one, called Śaṅkara. As he was wandering through the countryside, he came to a certain royal capital. The king, a kṣatriya anointed on the crown of the head, heard that the perfectly complete Buddha Śaṅkara, wandering through the countryside, had come to that royal capital. Having heard this, he went, with great royal splendor and great royal might, to where the Blessed One, the perfectly complete Buddha Śaṅkara, was. When he arrived, he bowed his head at the feet of the perfectly complete Buddha Śaṅkara and sat down to one side.

When the king, the kṣatriya anointed on the crown of the head, had sat down to one side, the perfectly complete Buddha Śaṅkara caused him to take up properly the teachings that bring about the attainment of awakening. Then the king, overjoyed, invited the perfectly complete Buddha Śaṅkara to the royal palace and served him food of a hundred flavors. He also presented him with robes worth a hundred thousand. And he built a stūpa of his parinirvāṇa one yojana in circumference and one krośa in height.

"Monks, what do you think? I myself was the one who at that time, on that occasion, was the king. Because I made such offerings to the perfectly complete Buddha Śaṅkara, I experienced boundless happiness in saṃsāra, and through that very cause, now that I have become a tathāgata, King Bimbisāra too has made such offerings. Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall show honor to the Teacher, hold him supreme, revere him, and worship him. Having shown honor to the Teacher, held him supreme, revered him, and worshiped him, we shall dwell relying on him.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Divine Food.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, held supreme, revered, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the capital, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped and renowned among the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, who received robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and supplies for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove at the Kalandaka Feeding Ground.

There lived a guild master, rich, of great wealth and great means, with vast and extensive holdings, possessed of wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling Vaiśravaṇa in wealth, who was devoted to the tīrthikas. The venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana brought him to faith and introduced him to the teaching, and he became deeply devoted to the Blessed One. That householder was one inclined toward generosity on a vast scale, and he said to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, "I wish to make an offering to the Blessed One, so please be my helper." The venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana consented to the householder by remaining silent.

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana took that householder with him and went to where the Blessed One was. When they arrived, they bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. When they had sat down to one side, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable, this householder wishes to offer the midday meal to the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas. Out of kindness to him, may the Blessed One please consent."

Then the Blessed One consented to the householder by remaining silent. Then the householder, understanding that the Blessed One had consented by remaining silent, laid out food of a hundred flavors, flowers, incense, garlands, and ointments.

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana urged Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, saying, "Be this householder's helper." Then Śakra, lord of the gods, transformed the Bamboo Grove at the Kalandaka Feeding Ground into the likeness of the Nandana Grove. He also brought many thousands of elephants like Airāvaṇa and Supratiṣṭhita, and they held parasols of a hundred ribs over the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha. He also brought many thousands of goddesses, led by Gatherer of Bliss, and they fanned the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha with yak-tail whisks with jeweled handles. He also brought many thousands of gandharvas, led by Supriya, Pañcaśikha, and Tumburu, and they struck up all kinds of excellent music. He also prepared divine food of nectar.

Then the householder, having served the Blessed One with the requisites of gods and humans, bowed at the Blessed One's feet with his whole body and made this aspiration: "By this root of virtue, by this generation of the mind, and by this complete giving of a gift, in this blind world that has no guide and no leader at all, may I become a buddha who carries across those who have not crossed, frees those who are not free, consoles those who are not consoled, and brings to complete nirvāṇa those who have not attained complete nirvāṇa."

Then the Blessed One, knowing the succession of that householder's causes, one after another, and the succession of his actions, one after another, smiled. It is the nature of things that whenever the buddhas, the blessed ones, smile, blue, yellow, red, and white rays of light come forth from their mouths. Some go downward and some go upward.

Those that go downward go to the hells Saṃjīva, Kālasūtra, Saṃghāta, Raurava, Mahāraurava, Tapana, Pratāpana, Avīci, Arbuda, Nirarbuda, Aṭaṭa, Huhuva, Hahava, Utpala, Padma, and Mahāpadma. Into the hot hells they descend having become cool, and into the cold hells they descend having become warm. As a result, the particular torments of those beings are soothed. Then they think, "Oh, have we died and passed away from here, or have we been born somewhere else?" Then, in order to arouse their faith, the Blessed One sends forth an emanation. Seeing the emanation, they think, "Oh, we have neither died and passed away from here nor been born somewhere else. Rather, through the power of this being, never seen before, who has appeared to us, our particular torments have been soothed." Then, their minds rejoicing in the emanation, they exhaust the karma that was to be experienced in the hells, and they take rebirth among gods and humans, where they will become fit vessels for the truths.

Those that go upward go to the gods of the Four Great Kings, the Thirty-Three, the Yāma gods, the Tuṣita gods, the Nirmāṇarati gods, the Paranirmitavaśavartin gods, the Brahmakāyika gods, the Brahmapurohita gods, the Mahābrahmā gods, the Parīttābha gods, the Apramāṇābha gods, the Ābhāsvara gods, the Parīttaśubha gods, the Apramāṇaśubha gods, the Śubhakṛtsna gods, the Anabhraka gods, the Puṇyaprasava gods, the Bṛhatphala gods, the Abṛha gods, the Atapa gods, the Sudṛśa gods, the Sudarśana gods, and as far as the gods of Akaniṣṭha, and proclaim the sounds of impermanence, suffering, emptiness, and selflessness. They also recite two verses:

Set about renunciation;
Apply yourselves to the Buddha's teaching;
As an elephant crushes a house of reeds,
Destroy the army of the Lord of Death.

Whoever, in this very Dharma and Vinaya,
Conducts himself with heedfulness
Will abandon the cycle of birth
And make an end of suffering.

Thus they recite.

Then those rays of light, having circled the great trichiliocosm, return and follow after the Blessed One himself. If the Blessed One wishes to reveal past actions, they vanish into the Blessed One's back. If he wishes to reveal future

actions, they vanish into his front. If he wishes to predict rebirth in the hells, they vanish into the soles of his feet. If he wishes to predict rebirth as an animal, they vanish into his heels. If he wishes to predict rebirth as a preta, they vanish into his big toes. If he wishes to predict rebirth as a human, they vanish into his two knees. If he wishes to predict that someone will become a wheel-turning king of force, they vanish into the palm of his left hand. If he wishes to predict that someone will become a wheel-turning king, they vanish into the palm of his right hand. If he wishes to predict rebirth as a god, they vanish into his navel. If he wishes to predict the awakening of a śrāvaka, they vanish into his mouth.

If he wishes to predict the awakening of a pratyekabuddha, they vanish into the ūrṇā hair between his eyebrows. If he wishes to predict unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening, they vanish into the uṣṇīṣa on the crown of his head.

Then those rays of light circled the Blessed One three times and vanished into the uṣṇīṣa on the crown of the Blessed One's head. Then the venerable Ānanda joined his palms and asked the Blessed One:

Variegated, interlaced with a thousand hues,
Many rays have come forth from the door of your mouth;
They have lit up all the directions everywhere,
Just as the rising sun would do.

And again he asked in verse:

Free of agitation, having abandoned pride and displeasure,
The buddhas, who have become the supreme cause for beings,
The victors who have conquered their foes, do not, without cause or condition,
Display a smile the color of lotus root and conch.
Steadfast one, since with your own mind you know the time has come,
Lord of victors, for the śramaṇas who listen and are in doubt,
Bull among sages, with your steadfast and supreme speech
And with excellent words, please dispel the doubts that have arisen.
The protectors, the perfect buddhas, steadfast as the ocean and the king of mountains,
Do not display a smile without a reason;
The purpose for which the hero displays a smile,
That the great multitude longs to hear from you.

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, so it is. It is just so. Ānanda, the tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly complete buddhas, do not smile without cause and without condition. Ānanda, do you see the honor this householder has shown me?"

"Venerable, I see it."

"Ānanda, by this root of virtue, this generation of the mind, and this complete giving of a gift, this householder will fully accomplish the awakening that is to be fully accomplished over three incalculable eons. Having perfected the six perfections, wholly suffused with great compassion, he will become a perfectly complete buddha called Giver of Divine Food, endowed with the ten powers, the four fearlessnesses, the three unshared applications of mindfulness, and great compassion, and he will appear in the world. His gift is this one, through which his mind rejoiced in me."

On this occasion, King Bimbisāra of Magadha and his retinue heard this and were supremely amazed.

Then doubts arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Blessed One, see how this householder has worshiped the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas with the riches of gods and humans!"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, in other former lives the Tathāgata himself performed and accumulated those actions which, having gained their accumulations and possessing fulfilled conditions, arise like a flood and will come about without fail. Since I myself performed and accumulated these actions, who else would experience them? Monks, actions that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element, or the wind element. Virtuous and nonvirtuous actions that have been performed and accumulated ripen solely in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

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"Monks, long ago, in times past, there appeared in the world a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, a sugata, knower of the world, guide of beings to be tamed, unsurpassed,

teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one, called Pūrṇa. Then the perfectly complete Buddha Pūrṇa, wandering through the countryside, came to a certain royal capital. The king, a kṣatriya anointed on the crown of the head, heard that the perfectly complete Buddha Pūrṇa, wandering through the countryside, had come to that royal capital. Having heard this, he went, with great royal splendor and great royal might, to where the perfectly complete Buddha Pūrṇa was. When he arrived, he bowed his head at the feet of the perfectly complete Buddha Pūrṇa and sat down to one side. When the king, the kṣatriya anointed on the crown of the head, had sat down to one side, the perfectly complete Buddha Pūrṇa caused him to take up properly the teachings that bring about the attainment of awakening.

"Then the king, the kṣatriya anointed on the crown of the head, invited the perfectly complete Buddha Pūrṇa together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas to receive robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and supplies for the sick for three months. The perfectly complete Buddha Pūrṇa consented by remaining silent. Then the king, the kṣatriya anointed on the crown of the head, understanding that the perfectly complete Buddha Pūrṇa had consented by remaining silent, served him for three months with robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and supplies for the sick. He also had an image of the Blessed One made of precious substances and held a festival for the Buddha, at which many hundreds of thousands of living beings gained great faith; by that cause and that condition, they attained complete nirvāṇa.

"Monks, what do you think? I myself was the one who at that time, on that occasion, was the king. Because I made such offerings to the perfectly complete Buddha Pūrṇa, I experienced boundless happiness in saṃsāra, and through that very cause, now that I have become a tathāgata, the guild master and Śakra have made such offerings to me. Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall show honor to the Teacher, hold him supreme, revere him, and worship him. Having shown honor to the Teacher, held him supreme, revered him, and worshiped him, we shall dwell relying on him.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

From The Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, the second summary verse is complete.

The Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, the sixth section.

The summary:

Candana and Padma,
Likewise the Wheel, the Ten-Headed,
Soft Complexion and Cool Light,
The Boatman and Rising Fragrance,
And those called Vimala and Sweet Voice:
These are taught in this group.

The story called Candana.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, held supreme, revered, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, wealthy householders, the people of the palace retinue, guild masters, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped and recognized by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was wandering through the land of Magadha together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, and he arrived at the bank of the river Ganges.

At that time, not far from the bank of the river Ganges, there stood a stūpa that had fallen into ruin, worn away by wind and the heat of the sun. When the monks saw it, they asked the Blessed One, "Blessed One, whose stūpa is this?"

The Blessed One said, "There once was a pratyekabuddha called Candana. It is his."

The monks asked, "Blessed One, from where did the pratyekabuddha Candana come? From what was his name given?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, do you wish to hear where the pratyekabuddha Candana came from and from what his name was given?"

They replied, "Venerable One, we wish to hear it."

He said, "Then, monks, listen well and closely, and keep it in mind, and I shall explain.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, a king called Brahmadatta ruled in the city of Vārāṇasī. During his reign the land was prosperous, flourishing, peaceful, and blessed with good harvests, and full of many people and folk. Quarrels and fighting were stilled, and there was no unrest, no internal strife, no robbery and theft, no famine, and no disease. It was rich in sāli rice, sugarcane, cattle,

and buffaloes. That king, too, was righteous, a Dharma king endowed with the Dharma, and he ruled in accordance with the Dharma.

"He had no son, and wishing for a son, he prayed to Śiva, Varuṇa, Kubera, Śakra, Brahmā, and others, and to other particular gods as well, namely: he prayed also to the gods of parks, the gods of forests, the gods of crossroads where four roads meet, the gods of places where three roads meet, the gods who receive the torma offerings, and the gods who are born together with one, who share one's nature, and who constantly follow one about.

"There is indeed the saying in the world that sons and daughters are born because of prayer, but that is not so. If sons and daughters were born because of prayer, then each person would have a thousand sons, just like a universal monarch. Rather, sons and daughters are born from the coming together of three conditions. What are the three? The father and mother come together, aroused by desire; the mother is in season and fertile; and a gandharva has arrived. It is from the coming together of these three conditions that sons and daughters are born.

"While he remained intent on prayer, in a great pond in his pleasure garden there grew an exceedingly large lotus. Day by day it grew larger, yet it did not open. The keeper of the park reported this to the king, and the king commanded, 'Guard that lotus well!'

"Some time later, at sunrise, the lotus opened, and in the heart of the lotus sat a boy, handsome, pleasing to behold, and beautiful, of fine complexion, golden in color, with a head shaped like a parasol, long arms, a broad forehead, a high nose, a well-formed nose, and thick eyebrows. His body was well adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being and made beautiful by the eighty excellent minor marks. He was sitting with his legs crossed. From his mouth came the fragrance of a lotus, and from his body came the fragrance of sandalwood.

"The keeper of the park reported this as well to the king. Then the king, together with his ministers and queens, went to the pleasure garden. As soon as the boy saw him, he said to the king, 'Come here, father! I am the son of you who have no son.'

"The king was delighted, gladdened, and overjoyed, and said, 'Son, it is just as you say.' Then the king entered the pond, took the boy from the heart of the lotus, and placed him in his hands. Wherever the boy then set his foot, lotuses sprang up there. So they gave him the name Candana.

"When the boy Candana had gradually grown up, the people of the city said to the king, 'Your Majesty, if a festival takes place in this city of ours, it would be fitting to send the prince Candana. Then he will enjoy the festival together with us, and every place will be adorned with lotuses.'

"The king said, 'Let it be done so.'

"Then Candana, adorned with every ornament, accompanied by the sons of the ministers with their servants and retinue, and with the sounds of many kinds of music being played, went out from the royal palace in order to enjoy the city festival. As he went along, at every step lovely and captivating lotuses sprang up, but as soon as the rays of the sun struck them, they withered and dried up.

"Then he, a being who was pure, of virtuous intention, and who had generated roots of virtue toward buddhas in the past, saw this, and proper attention arose in him. He thought, 'Just as these lotuses are beautiful the moment they spring up, yet, scorched by the rays of the sun, wither and dry up, so too this body is just like them.'

"As he thought in this way, weighing it and examining it closely, the thirty-seven factors conducive to awakening became manifest to him, and right there, while still sitting amid the crowd of people, he directly realized the awakening of a pratyekabuddha.

"Then, after a while, the gods of the Pure Abodes offered him garments of colored cloth. He put them on, rose up into the sky, and performed miracles of many kinds. Seeing this, the king, together with his ministers and the people of the town, was filled with great joy, and they also generated roots of virtue of many kinds."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, that is where the pratyekabuddha Candana came from, and that too is how his name was given."

The monks asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, "Venerable One, what deeds did the pratyekabuddha Candana do and accumulate, such that his body was fragrant and his five faculties were keen?"

The Blessed One said, "He went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One Kāśyapa. There he offered a sprinkling of perfumed water to a stūpa containing that Buddha's hair and nail clippings, and he also hung flowers on it. And there he cultivated the path to the awakening of a pratyekabuddha.

"Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall show honor to the Teacher, hold him supreme, revere him, and worship him. Having shown honor to the Teacher, held him supreme, revered him, and worshiped him, we shall dwell relying on him.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Padma.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, held supreme, revered, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, wealthy householders, the people of the palace retinue, guild masters, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped and recognized by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time, following the custom of those who live in the Middle Country, the park keepers would gather lotuses and go into the streets to sell them.

Then, in the morning, the Blessed One put on his lower robe and his Dharma robe, took up his alms bowl, and went into Śrāvastī for alms.

A woman, too, was going along the street carrying a little boy on her hip. The boy saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being and made beautiful by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo of light a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, wholly excellent, like a mountain of jewels in motion. On seeing him, joy arose in the boy, and on a sudden impulse he stretched out his hand, took a lotus from a park keeper, and threw it onto the head of the Tathāgata.

Then that lotus grew to the size of a chariot wheel and stayed in the sky above him: when the Blessed One walked, it moved, and when he stood still, it stayed. Then the Blessed One emitted rays of light the color of rubies, and with them he illuminated the whole of Śrāvastī. Through this, the king, the ministers, and the people of the palace retinue were brought to faith.

Then the Blessed One smiled. Now it is the nature of things that whenever buddhas, blessed ones, smile, blue, yellow, red, and white rays of light come

forth from their mouths, and some go downward while some go upward.

Those that go downward reach the hells Saṃjīva, Kālasūtra, Saṃghāta, Raurava, Mahāraurava, Tapana, Pratāpana, Avīci, Arbuda, Nirarbuda, Aṭaṭa, Huhuva, Hahava, Utpala, Padma, and Mahāpadma. Into those that are hot hells they descend as coolness, and into those that are cold hells they descend as warmth. Thus the particular torments of those beings are soothed.

Then those beings think, "Oh! Have we passed away from here, or have we been born somewhere else?" Then, in order to inspire faith in them, the Blessed One sends forth an emanation. Seeing the emanation, they think, "Oh! We have not passed away from here, nor have we been born somewhere else. Rather, it is through the power of this being, never seen before, that our particular torments have been soothed." Then, their minds delighting in the emanation, they exhaust the karma that was to be experienced in hell, and they take rebirth among gods and humans, wherever they will become fit vessels for the truths.

Those that go upward reach as far as the gods of the Four Great Kings, the Thirty-Three, the Yāma gods, the Tuṣita gods, the Nirmāṇarati gods, the Paranirmitavaśavartin gods, the Brahmakāyika gods, the Brahmapurohita gods, the Mahābrahmā gods, the Parīttābha gods, the Apramāṇābha gods, the Ābhāsvara gods, the Parīttaśubha gods, the Apramāṇaśubha gods, the Śubhakṛtsna gods, the Anabhraka gods, the Puṇyaprasava gods, the Bṛhatphala gods, the Abṛha gods, the Atapa gods, the Sudṛśa gods, the Sudarśana gods, and the gods of Akaniṣṭha, and there they proclaim the sounds of impermanence, suffering, emptiness, and selflessness.

They also proclaim two verses:

"Set out, and go forth;
Apply yourselves to the Buddha's teaching;
As an elephant crushes a house of reeds,
Crush the army of the Lord of Death.

Whoever, in this very Dharma and Vinaya,
Conducts himself with heedfulness
Will abandon the cycle of births
And bring suffering to an end."

So they proclaim.

Then those rays of light, having circled the great trichiliocosm, follow along right behind the Blessed One. If the Blessed One wishes to explain a past deed, they disappear into the Blessed One's back. If he wishes to explain a future deed, they disappear into his front. If he wishes to foretell a rebirth in hell, they disappear into the soles of his feet. If he wishes to foretell a rebirth as an animal, they disappear into his heels. If he wishes to foretell a rebirth as a preta, they disappear into his big toes. If he wishes to foretell a rebirth as a human, they disappear into his two knees. If he wishes to foretell that one will become a universal monarch ruling by force, they disappear into the palm of his left hand. If he wishes to foretell that one will become a universal monarch, they disappear into the palm of his right hand. If he wishes to foretell a rebirth as a god, they disappear into his navel. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a śrāvaka, they disappear into his mouth. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a pratyekabuddha, they disappear into the tuft of hair between his eyebrows. If he wishes to foretell unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, they disappear into the crown protuberance on his head.

Then those rays of light circled the Blessed One three times and disappeared into the tuft of hair between the Blessed One's eyebrows.

Then the venerable Ānanda joined his palms and said to the Blessed One:

"Many rays, of every kind, interwoven with a thousand hues,
Have come forth from the door of your mouth;
They have lit up all directions everywhere,
Just as the rising sun would do."

And he spoke further in verse:

"Free of agitation, having abandoned pride and displeasure,
The buddhas, who have become the supreme cause for beings,
The victors who have conquered the foe, do not without cause or condition
Display a smile the color of lotus fiber and of conch.

Steadfast one, since by your own understanding you know the time has come,
For the śramaṇas, Lord of Victors, the listeners who are in doubt,
Bull among sages, with your supreme and steadfast words,
Excellent one, please dispel the doubts that have arisen.

The protectors, the perfect buddhas, steadfast like the ocean and the king of mountains,
Do not display a smile for nothing.

The reason, hero, for which you display this smile,
That is what the great crowd of people wishes to hear from you."

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, it is so. It is just so. Ānanda, the tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly complete buddhas, do not smile without cause and without condition. Ānanda, did you see this boy, filled with faith, throw a lotus onto the Tathāgata?"

"Venerable One, I saw it."

"Ānanda, through this root of virtue, through the resolve he has generated, and through this giving away of a gift, this boy will not fall into the lower realms for fifteen eons. Having experienced the happiness of gods and humans, he will become a pratyekabuddha called Padmottara. His gift is this one, through which his mind became joyful toward me.

"Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall show honor to the buddhas, the pratyekabuddhas, and the śrāvakas.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called the Wheel.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, held supreme, revered, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, wealthy householders, the people of the palace retinue, guild masters, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped and recognized by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove, at the Kalandaka Feeding Ground.

At that time a caravan leader from Rājagṛha had set out on the great ocean. His wife, in the prime of youth, longing for her husband and utterly disheartened, uttered laments, yet her husband did not come. So she bowed down to Nārāyaṇa and made a vow: "If my husband comes back quickly, I shall offer you a golden wheel."

Then her husband quickly returned from the great ocean and came back safely, without mishap. Then she had a golden wheel made, and, surrounded by a group of her maidservants, she set out for the temple carrying the wheel,

along with perfumes, incense, and flowers.

Now on that occasion, there is nothing that the buddhas, the blessed ones, do not know, do not see, do not realize, or do not comprehend. Yet the buddhas, the blessed ones, possessed of great compassion, engaged in benefiting the world, the sole guardians, the solely heroic, without equal, who do not speak in two ways, who dwell in calm abiding and insight, who illuminate the three knowledges, who are well trained in the three trainings, who are skilled in the three bases of discipline, who have crossed the four floods, the soles of whose feet, the four bases of miraculous power, stand firm, who have long been familiar with the four means of attraction, who are fearless through the four fearlessnesses, who roar the great and genuine lion's roar of the bull, who have entirely abandoned the five factors, who have wholly passed beyond the five destinies, who are endowed with the six factors, who have brought the six perfections to completion, who dwell in the six constant abidings, who are rich with the flowers of the seven limbs of awakening, who teach the eightfold path, who are skilled in the nine successive absorptions, who are powerful with the power of the ten strengths, whose fame spreads everywhere in the ten directions, and who are far more exalted even than the lord of the thousandfold world, by the nature of things look upon the world with the eye of a buddha three times each day and three times each night. Their wisdom and vision turn to it, thinking: "Who is declining? Who is flourishing? Who is in want? Who has fallen into danger? Who is afflicted with harm? Who is in want, in danger, and afflicted with harm? Who is inclined toward the lower realms? Who is sliding into the lower realms? Who has fallen into the lower realms? Whom shall I draw out of the lower realms and establish in the higher realms, in liberation, and in the fruits? Whom shall I take by the hand and pull out from sinking in the mire of desire? Whom, lacking the seven noble riches, shall I bring to command the sovereignty of the seven noble riches? In whom who has not generated roots of virtue shall I generate them? In whom who has already generated roots of virtue shall I bring them to full ripening? Whom, already fully ripened, shall I bring to liberation?"

On this it is said:

"The ocean, the abode of sea monsters,
May perhaps let its tide pass by its time;
But for the children who are to be trained,
The Buddha never lets the time pass by."

Then the Blessed One saw: "If that young woman sees me, she will generate roots of virtue for a pratyekabuddha's awakening."

Then, in the morning, the Blessed One put on his lower robe and his Dharma robe, took up his alms bowl, and, attended by the assembly of monks and preceded by the Saṅgha of monks, went into Rājagṛha for alms.

Then that young woman saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being and made beautiful by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo of light a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, wholly excellent, like a mountain of jewels in motion. The moment she saw him she was filled with joy, and she was about to throw the golden wheel to the Blessed One. Then her maidservant stopped her, saying, "This is not Nārāyaṇa!" Yet even as she was being stopped, her heart was drawn by intense faith, and she threw the golden wheel over the Buddha, the Blessed One. She also offered perfumes, incense, and flowers.

Then the Blessed One smiled. Now it is the nature of things that whenever buddhas, blessed ones, smile, blue, yellow, red, and white rays of light come forth from their mouths, and some go downward while some go upward.

Those that go downward reach the hells Saṃjīva, Kālasūtra, Saṃghāta, Raurava, Mahāraurava, Tapana, Pratāpana, Avīci, Arbuda, Nirarbuda, Aṭaṭa, Huhuva, Hahava, Utpala, Padma, and Mahāpadma. Into those that are hot hells they descend as coolness, and into those that are cold hells they descend as warmth. Then the particular torments of those beings are soothed.

Then those beings think, "Oh! Have we passed away from here, or have we been born somewhere else?" Then, in order to inspire faith in them, the Blessed One sends forth an emanation. Seeing the emanation, they think, "Oh! We have not passed away from here, nor have we been born somewhere else. Rather, it is through the power of this being, never seen before, that our particular torments have been soothed." Then, their minds delighting in the emanation, they exhaust the karma that was to be experienced in hell, and they take rebirth among gods and humans, wherever they will become fit vessels for the truths.

Those that go upward reach as far as the gods of the Four Great Kings, the Thirty-Three, the Yāma gods, the Tuṣita gods, the Nirmāṇarati gods, the Paranirmitavaśavartin gods, the Brahmakāyika gods, the Brahmapurohita gods, the Mahābrahmā gods, the Parīttābha gods, the Apramāṇābha gods, the

Ābhāsvara gods, the Parīttaśubha gods, the Apramāṇaśubha gods, the Śubhakṛtsna gods, the Anabhraka gods, the Puṇyaprasava gods, the Bṛhatphala gods, the Abṛha gods, the Atapa gods, the Sudṛśa gods, the Sudarśana gods, and the gods of Akaniṣṭha, and there they proclaim the sounds of impermanence, suffering, emptiness, and selflessness. They also proclaim two verses:

"Set out, and go forth;
Apply yourselves to the Buddha's teaching;
As an elephant crushes a house of reeds,
Crush the army of the Lord of Death.

Whoever, in this very Dharma and Vinaya,
Conducts himself with heedfulness
Will abandon the cycle of births
And bring suffering to an end."

So they proclaim.

Then those rays of light, having circled the great trichiliocosm, follow along right behind the Blessed One. If the Blessed One wishes to explain a past deed, they disappear into the Blessed One's back. If he wishes to explain a future deed, they disappear into his front.

If he wishes to foretell a rebirth in hell, they disappear into the soles of his feet. If he wishes to foretell a rebirth as an animal, they disappear into his heels. If he wishes to foretell a rebirth as a preta, they disappear into his big toes. If he wishes to foretell a rebirth as a human, they disappear into his two knees. If he wishes to foretell that one will become a universal monarch ruling by force, they disappear into the palm of his left hand. If he wishes to foretell that one will become a universal monarch, they disappear into the palm of his right hand. If he wishes to foretell a rebirth as a god, they disappear into his navel. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a śrāvaka, they disappear into his mouth. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a pratyekabuddha, they disappear into the tuft of hair between his eyebrows. If he wishes to foretell unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, they disappear into the crown protuberance on his head.

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"Many rays, of every kind, interwoven with a thousand hues,
Have come forth from the door of your mouth;
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Just as the rising sun would do."

And he spoke further in verse:

"Free of agitation, having abandoned pride and displeasure,
The buddhas, who have become the supreme cause for beings,
The victors who have conquered the foe, do not without cause or condition
Display a smile the color of lotus fiber and of conch.

Steadfast one, since by your own understanding you know the time has come,
For the monks, Lord of Victors, the listeners who are in doubt,
Bull among sages, with your supreme and steadfast words,
Excellent one, please dispel the doubts that have arisen.

The protectors, the perfect buddhas, steadfast like the ocean and the king of mountains,
Do not display a smile for nothing.
The reason, hero, for which you display this smile,
That is what the great crowd of people wishes to hear from you."

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, it is so. It is just so. Ānanda, the tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly complete buddhas, do not smile without cause and without condition. Ānanda, did you see this young woman throw a golden wheel over the Tathāgata?"

"Venerable One, I saw it."

"Ānanda, through this root of virtue, through the resolve she has generated, and through this giving away of a gift, this young woman will not fall into the lower realms for fifteen eons. Having experienced the happiness of gods and humans, she will become a pratyekabuddha called Cakrottara. Her gift is this one, through which her mind became joyful toward me.

"Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall show honor to the buddhas, the pratyekabuddhas, and the śrāvakas.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called the Ten-Headed.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, held supreme, revered, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, wealthy householders, the people of the palace retinue, guild masters, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped and recognized by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was wandering through the land of Magadha together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, and he arrived at the bank of the river Ganges.

Then the monks saw, from a long way off, an old stūpa worn away by wind and the heat of the sun. Having seen it, they asked the Blessed One, "Venerable One, whose stūpa is this?"

The Blessed One said, "It belongs to the pratyekabuddha the Ten-Headed."

The monks asked, "Blessed One, from where did the pratyekabuddha the Ten-Headed come? From what was his name given?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, do you wish to hear where the pratyekabuddha the Ten-Headed came from and from what his name was given?"

They replied, "Venerable One, we wish to hear it."

He said, "Then, monks, listen well and closely, and keep it in mind, and I shall explain.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, a king called Brahmadatta ruled in the city of Vārāṇasī. During his reign the land was prosperous, flourishing, peaceful, and blessed with good harvests, and full of many people and folk. Quarrels and fighting were stilled, and there was no unrest, no internal strife, no robbery and theft, no famine, and no disease. It was rich in sāli rice, sugarcane, cattle, and buffaloes. That king, too, was righteous, a Dharma king endowed with the Dharma, and he ruled in accordance with the Dharma.

"Then that king, having no son and wishing for a son, prayed to Śiva, Varuṇa, Kubera, Śakra, Brahmā, and others, and to other particular gods as well, namely: he prayed also to the gods of parks, the gods of forests, the gods of crossroads where four roads meet, the gods of places where three roads meet, the gods who receive the torma offerings, and the gods who are born together with one, who share one's nature, and who constantly follow one about.

"There is indeed the saying in the world that sons and daughters are born because of prayer, but that is not so. If sons and daughters were born because

of prayer, then each person would have a thousand sons, just like a universal monarch.

Rather, sons and daughters are born from the coming together of three conditions. What are the three? The father and mother, aroused by desire, come together; the mother is in season and has her menses; and a gandharva has arrived. From the coming together of these three conditions, sons and daughters are born.

He nevertheless kept devoting himself to prayer. Now in his park there was a great pond filled with utpala, padma, kumuda, and white lotuses, its banks made beautiful by geese, ducks, cranes, and many other kinds of birds. In it there unexpectedly grew a lotus of immeasurable size. Day by day it grew larger, yet its petals did not open. The keeper of the park reported this to the king, and the king ordered, "Guard that lotus well!"

Some time later, at sunrise, the lotus opened, and in its heart sat a boy, cross-legged: handsome, pleasing to behold, lovely, of fine complexion, golden in color, his head shaped like a parasol, with long arms, a broad forehead, a high nose, a well-formed nose, and thick eyebrows, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks. The keeper of the park reported this to the king as well.

When the king heard it, he went to the park together with his ministers and queens and saw the boy sitting so beautifully in the heart of the lotus. Seeing him, he was delighted, overjoyed, and thrilled; he rejoiced, and joy and happiness arose in him. He went into the pond, took up the boy, and with great honor carried him to his own palace. He told the matter to the ascetics, the brahmins, and the readers of signs, held a lavish birth celebration for three weeks, twenty-one days, and gave him the name the Ten-Headed.

Then the boy, the Ten-Headed, was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry him on their laps, two nurses to suckle him, two nurses to wash away his dirt, and two nurses to play with him. These eight nurses raised and nourished him with milk, curd, butter, ghee, cream of butter, and every other excellent provision, so that he grew quickly, like a lotus in a lake.

The boy was full of faith, of good and virtuous disposition, devoted to benefiting himself and benefiting others, greatly compassionate, magnanimous, a lover of the Dharma, and loving toward all creatures. While his father occupied the throne, the boy saw him performing deeds both blameworthy and blameless. Seeing this, the boy was displeased and said to

his father, "Father, please permit me to go forth into the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya."

His father gave him permission, and he shaved his hair and beard, put on dyed robes, and with true faith went forth from home into homelessness. Then, without having received instruction from anyone, he made manifest the thirty-seven factors conducive to awakening and actualized the awakening of a pratyekabuddha. Rising into the sky, he displayed various kinds of miracles to his father. His father then invited him to receive meals for three months. Then, wearied of having a body, he displayed various kinds of miracles and passed into nirvāṇa like a fire whose fuel is spent. This is his stupa."

Then the monks, feeling doubt, asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what deeds did the pratyekabuddha the Ten-Headed perform that he was not born from a mother's womb but was born from a lotus?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, the Ten-Headed himself, in other, earlier lives, performed and accumulated deeds which, once the accumulations were gathered and the conditions complete, come forth like a flood and will inevitably arrive. Since the Ten-Headed himself performed and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element, or the wind element. Virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen into their fruit.

Monks, long ago, in times past, ninety-one eons ago, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Vipaśyin, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one. The perfectly complete Buddha Vipaśyin was staying in dependence on the royal capital Bandhumatī.

Then one morning the perfectly complete Buddha Vipaśyin put on his lower robe and his Dharma robe, took up his alms bowl, and, attended by the assembly of monks and preceded by the Saṅgha of monks, went into the royal

capital Bandhumatī for alms. A certain caravan leader, carrying a lotus, had entered the street. He saw the perfectly complete Buddha Vipaśyin, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, altogether excellent, like a moving Jewel Mountain. As soon as he saw him, he threw the lotus over the Blessed One. As soon as he had thrown it, the lotus became as large as a chariot wheel above the Blessed One; when the Blessed One walked, it moved, and when he stopped, it stayed.

Then, after a while, the perfectly complete Buddha Vipaśyin prophesied that the caravan leader would attain the awakening of a pratyekabuddha. Delighted, overjoyed, and thrilled, the caravan leader went to his own home. At that moment his wife was giving birth and was crying out in distress. He asked a servant woman, "What is this?" and she told him just what was happening.

Then the caravan leader, dismayed, made this aspiration: "May I never, while in saṃsāra, be born in a mother's womb!"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who at that time, on that occasion, was the caravan leader is none other than the pratyekabuddha the Ten-Headed. Through that root of virtue, for ninety-one eons he was never born in a mother's womb, and in his final existence, too, he came to have such splendor. Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall show honor to buddhas, to pratyekabuddhas, and to śrāvakas.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Soft Complexion.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, wealthy men, members of the royal court, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time there lived in Śrāvastī a merchant who was rich, with much wealth and great means, with abundant riches and possessions, with many dependents, and with many friends, ministers, relatives, and elders. That householder was full of faith, virtuous and of good disposition, devoted to benefiting himself and benefiting others, greatly compassionate, magnanimous, and a lover of the Dharma.

Then he thought, "These riches are by nature like the moon reflected in water, like a mirage: impermanent, unstable, not lasting, untrustworthy, subject to change, and held in common with the five great harms. So I would do well to give the Buddha, the Blessed One, together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, a properly arranged bath and satisfy them with fine food."

He then invited the Blessed One, together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, to bathe and to take the midday meal. Then, in order to benefit him, the Blessed One, together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, attended by the assembly of monks and preceded by the Saṅgha of monks, went to the properly arranged bath. The merchant brought scented sesame oil, went into the bathhouse, and himself attended upon the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas.

Then, when the Blessed One and the Saṅgha of śrāvakas had finished bathing, the householder with his own hands satisfied the Blessed One, together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, with fine, pure food both hard and soft, serving them as much as they wished. Having with his own hands satisfied them with many kinds of fine, pure food both hard and soft, and having served them as much as they wished, he saw that the Blessed One had finished his meal, had put away his bowl, and had washed his hands. He then took a very low seat and sat before the Blessed One in order to hear the Dharma. The Blessed One instructed him with a talk on the Dharma, inspired him, roused his enthusiasm, and delighted him. Having instructed him with many kinds of talk on the Dharma, inspired him, roused his enthusiasm, and delighted him, he remained silent.

Then the merchant, having gained faith, fell like a tree cut at its root and bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, and he set his mind firmly on an aspiration.

Then the Blessed One smiled. It is the nature of things that whenever buddhas, blessed ones, smile, rays of blue, yellow, red, and white light come forth from their mouths. Some go downward and some go upward. Those that go downward go to the hells Saṃjīva, Kālasūtra, Saṃghāta, Raurava,

Mahāraurava, Tapana, Pratāpana, Avīci, Arbuda, Nirarbuda, Aṭaṭa, Huhuva, Hahava, Utpala, Padma, and Mahāpadma. In those that are hot hells they fall as coolness, and in those that are cold hells they fall as warmth. As a result, the particular torments of those beings are eased.

Then those beings think, "Oh! Have we died and passed on from here, or have we been born somewhere else?" Then, in order to arouse their faith, the Blessed One sends forth an emanation. Seeing the emanation, they think, "Oh! We have not died and passed on from here, nor have we been born somewhere else; rather, through the power of this being who has never appeared before, our particular torments have been eased." Then, their minds rejoicing in the emanation, they exhaust the karma that was to be experienced in the hells, and they take rebirth among gods and humans, where they become fit vessels for the truths.

Those that go upward go to the gods of the Four Great Kings, the Thirty-Three, the Yāma gods, the Tuṣita gods, the Nirmāṇarati gods, the Paranirmitavaśavartin gods, the Brahmakāyika gods, the Brahmapurohita gods, the Mahābrahmā gods, the Parīttābha gods, the Apramāṇābha gods, the Ābhāsvara gods, the Parīttaśubha gods, the Apramāṇaśubha gods, the Śubhakṛtsna gods, the Anabhraka gods, the Puṇyaprasava gods, the Bṛhatphala gods, the Abṛha gods, the Atapa gods, the Sudṛśa gods, the Sudarśana gods, and as far as the gods of Akaniṣṭha, and there they proclaim the sounds of impermanence, suffering, emptiness, and selflessness. They also recite two verses:

"Set out upon renunciation;
Apply yourselves to the Buddha's teaching.
As an elephant tramples a house of reeds,
Crush the army of the Lord of Death.

Whoever, in this Dharma and Vinaya,
Conducts himself with heedfulness
Will abandon the cycle of births
And bring suffering to an end."

So they recite. Then those rays of light, having circled the great trichiliocosm, the world system of a billion worlds, follow behind the Blessed One himself. If the Blessed One wishes to explain a past deed, they vanish into the Blessed One's back. If he wishes to explain a future deed, they vanish into his front. If he wishes to foretell a birth in the hells, they vanish into the soles of his feet. If

he wishes to foretell a birth as an animal, they vanish into his heels. If he wishes to foretell a birth as a preta, they vanish into his big toes. If he wishes to foretell a birth as a human, they vanish into his two knees. If he wishes to foretell a destiny as a balacakravartin, a wheel-turning king of force, they vanish into the palm of his left hand. If he wishes to foretell a destiny as a wheel-turning king, they vanish into the palm of his right hand. If he wishes to foretell a birth as a god, they vanish into his navel. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a śrāvaka, they vanish into his mouth. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a pratyekabuddha, they vanish into the tuft of hair between his eyebrows. If he wishes to foretell unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening, they vanish into the crown protuberance on his head.

Then those rays of light circled the Blessed One three times and vanished into the tuft of hair between the Blessed One's eyebrows. Then the venerable Ānanda, joining his palms and bowing, asked the Blessed One:

"Many-colored, interwoven with a thousand hues,
Many rays have come forth from the door of your mouth,
And they have illumined every direction
Just as the rising sun would do."

And again he said in verse:

"Buddhas free of agitation, who have abandoned pride and displeasure,
Who have become the supreme cause for beings,
Victors who have conquered their foes, do not without cause and condition
Display a smile the color of lotus root and conch.

Steadfast one, since by your own understanding you know the time has come,
Lord of victors among ascetics, for those listeners who are in doubt,
Bull among sages, with your supreme and steadfast words,
Your excellent words, please dispel the doubts that have arisen.

Protectors, perfectly complete buddhas, steadfast as the ocean and the king of mountains,
Do not display a smile without reason.
The reason for which you, hero, have displayed a smile,
That the great multitude longs to hear from you."

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, so it is; it is just so. Ānanda, the tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas do not smile without cause and without condition. Ānanda, did you see this merchant show me such honor?"

"Venerable One, I saw it."

"Ānanda, through this root of virtue, through this generation of the resolve, and through this relinquishing of a gift to be given, this merchant will become a pratyekabuddha called Soft Complexion. His gift to be given is this: that his mind rejoiced in me. Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall show honor to buddhas, to pratyekabuddhas, and to śrāvakas.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, the seventh section.

Cool Light.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, wealthy men, members of the royal court, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time there lived in Śrāvastī a householder who was rich, with much wealth and great means, with vast and extensive holdings, possessed of the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He was full of faith, virtuous and of good disposition, devoted to benefiting himself and benefiting others, greatly compassionate, magnanimous, a lover of the Dharma, and loving toward all creatures.

Then he thought, "These riches are by nature like the moon reflected in water, unsteady like an elephant's ear: impermanent, unstable, not lasting, untrustworthy, subject to change, and held in common with the five great harms. So I would do well to extract the essence from these essenceless riches."

When the hot season arrived, he invited the Blessed One, together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, to the midday meal. He cleared his house of stones, gravel, and potsherds, sprinkled it with sandalwood water, set out vessels of various fragrances, perfumed it with sweet-smelling incense, strewed it with various flowers, and laid out seats of flowers. Then, having prepared cool

drinks, pastries, and food, he sent a messenger to summon the Blessed One to the midday meal, saying, "Venerable One, the time for the midday meal has come and the food is ready. May the Blessed One, considering that the time has now come, please come."

Then in the morning the Blessed One put on his lower robe and his Dharma robe, took up his alms bowl, and, attended by the assembly of monks and preceded by the Saṅgha of monks, went to the house of that householder. Having arrived, he sat on the seat prepared in the midst of the Saṅgha of monks.

Then the householder, seeing that the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha was comfortably seated, with his own hands satisfied them with fine, pure food both hard and soft, serving them as much as they wished. Having with his own hands satisfied them with many kinds of fine, pure food both hard and soft, and having served them as much as they wished, he saw that the Blessed One had finished his meal, had put away his bowl, and had washed his hands. He then took a very low seat and sat before the Blessed One in order to hear the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One instructed the householder with a talk on the Dharma, inspired him, roused his enthusiasm, and delighted him. Having instructed him with many kinds of talk on the Dharma, inspired him, roused his enthusiasm, and delighted him, he remained silent. Then the householder, having gained faith, bowed at the feet of the Blessed One and set his mind firmly on an aspiration.

Then the Blessed One smiled. It is the nature of things that whenever buddhas, blessed ones, smile, rays of blue, yellow, red, and white light come forth from their mouths. Some go downward and some go upward. Those that go downward go to the hells Saṃjīva, Kālasūtra, Saṃghāta, Raurava, Mahāraurava, Tapana, Pratāpana, Avīci, Arbuda, Nirarbuda, Aṭaṭa, Huhuva, Hahava, Utpala, Padma, and Mahāpadma. In those that are hot hells they fall as coolness, and in those that are cold hells they fall as warmth. As a result, the particular torments of those beings are eased.

Then they think, "Oh! Have we died and passed on from here, or have we been born somewhere else?" Then, in order to arouse their faith, the Blessed One sends forth an emanation. Seeing the emanation, they think, "Oh! We have not died and passed on from here, nor have we been born somewhere else; rather, through the power of this being who has never appeared before, our

particular torments have been eased." Then, their minds rejoicing in the emanation, they exhaust the karma that was to be experienced in the hells, and they take rebirth among gods and humans, where they become fit vessels for the truths.

Those that go upward go to the gods of the Four Great Kings, the Thirty-Three, the Yāma gods, the Tuṣita gods, the Nirmāṇarati gods, the Paranirmitavaśavartin gods, the Brahmakāyika gods, the Brahmapurohita gods, the Mahābrahmā gods, the Parīttābha gods, the Apramāṇābha gods, the Ābhāsvara gods, the Parīttaśubha gods, the Apramāṇaśubha gods, the Śubhakṛtsna gods, the Anabhraka gods, the Puṇyaprasava gods, the Bṛhatphala gods, the Abṛha gods, the Atapa gods, the Sudṛśa gods, the Sudarśana gods, and as far as the gods of Akaniṣṭha, and there they proclaim the sounds of impermanence, suffering, emptiness, and selflessness. They also recite two verses:

"Set out upon renunciation;
Apply yourselves to the Buddha's teaching.
As an elephant tramples a house of reeds,
Crush the army of the Lord of Death.

Whoever, in this Dharma and Vinaya,
Conducts himself with heedfulness
Will abandon the cycle of births
And bring suffering to an end."

So they recite. Then those rays of light, having circled the great trichiliocosm, the world system of a billion worlds, follow behind the Blessed One himself. If the Blessed One wishes to explain a past deed, they vanish into the Blessed One's back. If he wishes to explain a future deed, they vanish into his front. If he wishes to foretell a birth in the hells, they vanish into the soles of his feet. If he wishes to foretell a birth as an animal, they vanish into his heels. If he wishes to foretell a birth as a preta, they vanish into his big toes. If he wishes to foretell a birth as a human, they vanish into his two knees. If he wishes to foretell a destiny as a balacakravartin, a wheel-turning king of force, they vanish into the palm of his left hand. If he wishes to foretell a destiny as a wheel-turning king, they vanish into the palm of his right hand. If he wishes to foretell a birth as a god, they vanish into his navel. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a śrāvaka, they vanish into his mouth. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a pratyekabuddha, they vanish into the tuft of hair between his

eyebrows. If he wishes to foretell unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening, they vanish into the crown protuberance on his head.

Then those rays of light circled the Blessed One three times and vanished into the tuft of hair between the Blessed One's eyebrows.

Then the venerable Ānanda, joining his palms, asked the Blessed One:

"Many-colored, interwoven with a thousand hues,
Many rays have come forth from the door of your mouth,
And they have illumined every direction
Just as the rising sun would do."

And again he said in verse:

"Buddhas free of agitation, who have abandoned pride and displeasure,
Who have become the supreme cause for beings,
Victors who have conquered their foes, do not without cause and condition
Display a smile the color of lotus root and conch.

Steadfast one, since by your own understanding you know the time has come,
Lord of victors, for the monks who listen and are in doubt,
Bull among sages, with your supreme and steadfast words,
Your excellent words, please dispel the doubts that have arisen.

Protectors, perfectly complete buddhas, steadfast as the ocean and the king of mountains,
Do not display a smile without reason.
The reason for which you, hero, have displayed a smile,
That the great multitude longs to hear from you."

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, so it is; it is just so. Ānanda, the tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas do not smile without cause and without condition. Ānanda, did you see this householder show me such honor?"

"Venerable One, I saw it."

"Ānanda, through this root of virtue of this householder, through this generation of the resolve, and through this relinquishing of a gift to be given, he will become a pratyekabuddha called Cool Light. His gift to be given is this: that he set his mind in faith on me. Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall show honor to buddhas, to pratyekabuddhas, and to śrāvakas.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Boatman.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, wealthy men, members of the royal court, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, while wandering through the land of Magadha together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, arrived at the bank of the river Ganges.

Then the Blessed One, attended by the assembly of monks and preceded by the Saṅgha of monks, went to where the boatmen were. Having arrived, he said to the boatmen, "Friends, ferry me across this river."

The boatmen said, "Give us the fare."

Then the Blessed One said to those boatmen, "I too was once a boatman. I ferried Nanda across when he had fallen into the river of desire. I ferried Aṅgulimāla across when he had fallen into the ocean of hatred. I ferried the brahmin's son who was swollen with pride across when he had fallen into the ocean of pride. I ferried Uruvilvā Kāśyapa across when he had fallen into the ocean of delusion. Yet I did not take a fare."

Even though he spoke thus, they did not agree to ferry him across.

Then one boatman, hearing the Blessed One's voice endowed with the eight qualities and seeing his perfect form, gained faith and said, "I wish to ferry the Blessed One across, together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas."

Then, as the monks boarded the boat, the Blessed One by his miraculous power arrived on the far bank even before that boatman. When the boatman saw that miraculous display, his mind was delighted, and he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet. The Blessed One then taught him the Dharma in such a way that he would come to realize the four noble truths. Having heard it, the boatman, with the vajra of wisdom, shattered the twenty towering peaks of the mountain of the view of the perishable collection, and he actualized the fruit of stream entry.

Having seen the truth, he three times uttered words of joy: "Venerable One, the Blessed One has dried up the ocean of my blood and tears, carried me

across the mountain of bones, closed the doors to the lower realms, opened the doors to the higher realms and to liberation, and established me among gods and humans. Such a thing was not done for me by my father, nor by my mother, nor by the king, nor by the gods, nor by my household and the host of my relatives, nor by the departed ancestors, nor by ascetics and brahmins."

And he said further:

"The path to the lower realms, fraught with many evils,
Utterly unbearable, by your power has been cut off.
The way to the higher realms, rich in merit, has been opened,
And I have gained the path to nirvāṇa as well.

Today, relying on you, I have gained
The utterly pure eye from which faults are removed.
I have crossed to the far shore of the ocean of suffering
And gained the state of peace in which the noble ones delight.

Supreme among humans, lord, worshiped by humans and gods,
You who have abandoned the sickness of birth, aging, and death,
Hard to behold even in a thousand existences,
O Sage, today I have seen you, and it has borne fruit."

Then one of the boatmen there was seized by great remorse. He bowed at the Blessed One's feet, confessed his fault, and served a meal to the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas.

Then the Blessed One smiled. It is the nature of things that whenever buddhas, blessed ones, smile, rays of blue, yellow, red, and white light come forth from their mouths. Some go downward and some go upward.

Those that go downward reach the hells Saṃjīva, Kālasūtra, Saṃghāta, Raurava, Mahāraurava, Tapana, Pratāpana, Avīci, Arbuda, Nirarbuda, Aṭaṭa, Huhuva, Hahava, Utpala, Padma, and Mahāpadma. Into the hot hells they descend as coolness, and into the cold hells they descend as warmth. In this way the various torments of those beings are relieved.

Then those beings think, "Oh! Have we died and passed away from here, or have we been born somewhere else?" Then, in order to inspire faith in them, the Blessed One sends forth an emanation. When they see the emanation, they think, "Oh! We have not died and passed away from here, nor have we been born somewhere else. Rather, through the power of this being, never seen before, our various torments have been relieved." Then their minds

rejoice in the emanation, the karma that was to be experienced in the hells is exhausted, and they take rebirth among gods and humans, where they will become worthy vessels for the truths.

Those that go upward reach as far as the gods of the Four Great Kings, the Thirty-Three, the Yāma gods, the Tuṣita gods, the Nirmāṇarati gods, the Paranirmitavaśavartin gods, the Brahmakāyika gods, the Brahmapurohita gods, the Mahābrahmā gods, the Parīttābha gods, the Apramāṇābha gods, the Ābhāsvara gods, the Parīttaśubha gods, the Apramāṇaśubha gods, the Śubhakṛtsna gods, the Anabhraka gods, the Puṇyaprasava gods, the Bṛhatphala gods, the Abṛha gods, the Atapa gods, the Sudṛśa gods, the Sudarśana gods, and the gods of Akaniṣṭha, and there they proclaim the sounds of impermanence, suffering, emptiness, and selflessness. They also recite two verses:

"Set out on renunciation,
Apply yourselves to the Buddha's teaching,
And as an elephant crushes a hut of reeds,
Crush the army of the Lord of Death.

Whoever, in this very Dharma and Discipline,
Practices with heedfulness,
Will abandon the cycle of births
And bring suffering to an end."

So they recite. Then those rays of light circle the great trichiliocosm and follow after the Blessed One himself. If the Blessed One wishes to explain past karma, they vanish into the Blessed One's back. If he wishes to explain future karma, they vanish into his front. If he wishes to foretell rebirth in the hells, they vanish into the soles of his feet. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as an animal, they vanish into his heels. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a hungry ghost, they vanish into his big toes. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a human, they vanish into his two knees. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a powerful wheel-turning king (balacakravartin), they vanish into the palm of his left hand. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a wheel-turning king, they vanish into the palm of his right hand. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a god, they vanish into his navel. If he wishes to foretell awakening as a śrāvaka, they vanish into his mouth. If he wishes to foretell awakening as a pratyekabuddha, they vanish into the tuft of hair between his eyebrows. If he wishes to foretell unsurpassed, perfect, and complete

awakening, they vanish into the crown protuberance on his head.

Then those rays of light circled the Blessed One three times and vanished into the tuft of hair between the Blessed One's eyebrows.

Then the venerable Ānanda joined his palms and said to the Blessed One:

"Many-colored, interwoven with a thousand hues,
A multitude of rays has come forth from your mouth.
They have illuminated every direction,
Just as the rising sun does."

And he further spoke in verse:

"The buddhas, free from levity, who have abandoned pride and discontent,
Who have become the supreme cause for beings,
The victors who have conquered their foes, do not without cause and condition
Display a smile the color of lotus fiber and conch.

O Steadfast One, since by your own understanding you know the time has come,
O Śramaṇa, Lord of Victors, for those who wish to hear and are in doubt,
O Bull among Sages, with your supreme, steadfast, and excellent words,
Please dispel the doubt that has arisen.

The protectors, the perfect buddhas, steadfast as the ocean and the king of mountains,
Do not display a smile without reason.
O Hero, the reason for which you display this smile,
The great multitude wishes to hear from you."

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, so it is. Ānanda, so it is. Ānanda, the tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas, do not smile without cause and without condition. Ānanda, do you see how this boatman has brought forth joy toward me?"

"Venerable One, I see it."

"Ānanda, through this root of virtue, through this arising of the mind, and through this giving away of something to be given, this boatman will in the future become a pratyekabuddha called Crosser of Saṃsāra. His gift is this: that he made his mind faithful toward me.

"Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We will show reverence to buddhas, pratyekabuddhas, and śrāvakas.' Monks, this is how you should

train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Wafting Fragrance.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was honored, revered, esteemed, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the royal court, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas, the Blessed One, the Buddha, the one who knows, possessed of great merit, who received robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and provisions for the sick, was dwelling together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove, at the Kalandaka Feeding Ground.

At that time the people who lived in the Middle Country, by custom, mostly anointed their bodies with various unguents. Now, at that time there was a householder's son who had a servant girl who was faithful, virtuous, and of good intentions, and she was grinding red sandalwood.

Then in the morning the Blessed One put on his lower robe and his Dharma robe, took up his alms bowl, and, attended by the assembly of monks and with the Saṅgha of monks going before him, went into Rājagṛha for alms. Then that girl saw the Blessed One, the Buddha, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, like a moving mountain of jewels, entirely beautiful. Seeing him, great faith arose in the girl. Having found faith, she thought, "Although I have found such a field of merit, if through the fault of poverty I am unable to show reverence to the Blessed One, what use is such a life as mine?"

Then, without regard even for her own life, she smeared both her hands with red sandalwood and anointed the Blessed One's two feet. And the Blessed One, by his miraculous power, filled the whole city of Rājagṛha with the scent of sandalwood. Then, when the girl saw that miracle, her mind was filled with joy. She bowed at the Blessed One's feet and made this resolve: "Through this root of virtue, this arising of the mind, and this giving away of something to be given, may I realize the awakening of a pratyekabuddha."

Then the Blessed One smiled. It is the nature of things that whenever buddhas, blessed ones, smile, rays of blue, yellow, red, and white light come forth from their mouths. Some go downward and some go upward.

Those that go downward reach the hells Saṃjīva, Kālasūtra, Saṃghāta, Raurava, Mahāraurava, Tapana, Pratāpana, Avīci, Arbuda, Nirarbuda, Aṭaṭa, Huhuva, Hahava, Utpala, Padma, and Mahāpadma. Into the hot hells they descend as coolness, and into the cold hells they descend as warmth. In this way the various torments of those beings are relieved.

Then those beings think, "Oh! Have we died and passed away from here, or have we been born somewhere else?" Then, in order to inspire faith in them, the Blessed One sends forth an emanation. When they see the emanation, they think, "Oh! We have not died and passed away from here, nor have we been born somewhere else. Rather, through the power of this being, never seen before, our various torments have been relieved." Then their minds rejoice in the emanation, the karma that was to be experienced in the hells is exhausted, and they take rebirth among gods and humans, where they will become worthy vessels for the truths.

Those that go upward reach as far as the gods of the Four Great Kings, the Thirty-Three, the Yāma gods, the Tuṣita gods, the Nirmāṇarati gods, the Paranirmitavaśavartin gods, the Brahmakāyika gods, the Brahmapurohita gods, the Mahābrahmā gods, the Parīttābha gods, the Apramāṇābha gods, the Ābhāsvara gods, the Parīttaśubha gods, the Apramāṇaśubha gods, the Śubhakṛtsna gods, the Anabhraka gods, the Puṇyaprasava gods, the Bṛhatphala gods, the Abṛha gods, the Atapa gods, the Sudṛśa gods, the Sudarśana gods, and the gods of Akaniṣṭha, and there they proclaim the sounds of impermanence, suffering, emptiness, and selflessness. They also recite two verses:

"Set out on renunciation,
Apply yourselves to the Buddha's teaching,
And as an elephant crushes a hut of reeds,
Crush the army of the Lord of Death.

Whoever, in this very Dharma and Discipline,
Practices with heedfulness,
Will abandon the cycle of births
And bring suffering to an end."

So they recite. Then those rays of light circle the great trichiliocosm and follow after the Blessed One himself. If the Blessed One wishes to explain past karma, they vanish into the Blessed One's back. If he wishes to explain future karma, they vanish into his front. If he wishes to foretell rebirth in the hells, they vanish into the soles of his feet. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as an animal, they vanish into his heels. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a hungry ghost, they vanish into his big toes. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a human, they vanish into his two knees. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a powerful wheel-turning king, they vanish into the palm of his left hand. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a wheel-turning king, they vanish into the palm of his right hand. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a god, they vanish into his navel.

If he wishes to foretell awakening as a śrāvaka, they vanish into his mouth. If he wishes to foretell awakening as a pratyekabuddha, they vanish into the tuft of hair between his eyebrows. If he wishes to foretell unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, they vanish into the crown protuberance on his head.

Then those rays of light circled the Blessed One three times and vanished into the tuft of hair between the Blessed One's eyebrows.

Then the venerable Ānanda joined his palms and said to the Blessed One:

"Many-colored, interwoven with a thousand hues,
A multitude of rays has come forth from your mouth.
They have illuminated every direction,
Just as the rising sun does."

And he further spoke in verse:

"The buddhas, free from levity, who have abandoned pride and discontent,
Who have become the supreme cause for beings,
The victors who have conquered their foes, do not without cause and condition
Display a smile the color of lotus fiber and conch.

O Steadfast One, since by your own understanding you know the time has come,
O Śramaṇa, Lord of Victors, for those who wish to hear and are in doubt,
O Bull among Sages, with your supreme, steadfast, and excellent words,
Please dispel the doubt that has arisen.

The protectors, the perfect buddhas, steadfast as the ocean and the king of mountains,
Do not display a smile without reason.
O Hero, the reason for which you display this smile,
The great multitude wishes to hear from you."

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, so it is. So it is. Ānanda, the tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas, do not smile without cause and without condition. Ānanda, do you see how this girl has shown me such reverence?"

"Venerable One, I see it."

"Ānanda, through this root of virtue, this arising of the mind, and this giving away of something to be given, this girl will in the future become a pratyekabuddha called Wafting Fragrance. Her gift is this: that she made her mind faithful toward me.

"Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We will show reverence to buddhas, pratyekabuddhas, and śrāvakas.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Vimala.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was honored, revered, esteemed, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the royal court, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas, the Blessed One, the Buddha, the one who knows, possessed of great merit, who received robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and provisions for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in Prince Jeta's Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time in Śrāvastī there was a park keeper. He took a tooth stick and went into Śrāvastī. A soothsayer was sitting at the city gate, and he said, "Whoever chews this tooth stick will come to eat food of a hundred flavors."

When the park keeper heard these words, he thought, "To whom should I give this tooth stick, so that because of it I might be greatly honored?" Then he further thought, "This Blessed One, the Buddha, is a field of merit in the world of the moving and the unmoving, a destination that bears fruit. I shall offer it

to the Blessed One, the Buddha."

Then the park keeper took that tooth stick and went to where the Blessed One was. When he arrived, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the park keeper said this to the Blessed One, the Buddha: "Blessed One, out of compassion for me, please accept this tooth stick."

Then the Blessed One, in order to benefit the park keeper, stretched out his golden-colored arm, which was like an elephant's trunk, and accepted it. Having accepted it, he chewed it in front of the park keeper. Having chewed it, he planted the tooth stick in the ground. The very instant it was planted, it became a great nyagrodha tree, as tall as it was broad, perfect in branches, leaves, flowers, and fruit. The Blessed One sat in its shade and taught the Dharma to many gods and humans. Then the householder Anāthapiṇḍada served him food of a hundred flavors.

Then the park keeper, his mind made faithful by the Blessed One's miracle, fell at his feet like a tree cut at the root, and made this aspiration: "Through this root of virtue, may I realize the awakening of a pratyekabuddha."

Then the Blessed One smiled. It is the nature of things that whenever buddhas, blessed ones, smile, rays of blue, yellow, red, and white light come forth from their mouths. Some go downward and some go upward.

Those that go downward reach the hells Saṃjīva, Kālasūtra, Saṃghāta, Raurava, Mahāraurava, Tapana, Pratāpana, Avīci, Arbuda, Nirarbuda, Aṭaṭa, Huhuva, Hahava, Utpala, Padma, and Mahāpadma. Into the hot hells they descend as coolness, and into the cold hells they descend as warmth. In this way the various torments of those beings are relieved.

Then those beings think, "Oh! Have we died and passed away from here, or have we been born somewhere else?" Then, in order to inspire faith in them, the Blessed One sends forth an emanation. When they see the emanation, they think, "Oh! We have not died and passed away from here, nor have we been born somewhere else. Rather, through the power of this being, never seen before, our various torments have been relieved." Then their minds rejoice in the emanation, the karma that was to be experienced in the hells is exhausted, and they take rebirth among gods and humans, where they will become worthy vessels for the truths.

Those that go upward reach as far as the gods of the Four Great Kings, the Thirty-Three, the Yāma gods, the Tuṣita gods, the Nirmāṇarati gods, the Paranirmitavaśavartin gods, the Brahmakāyika gods, the Brahmapurohita gods, the Mahābrahmā gods, the Parīttābha gods, the Apramāṇābha gods, the Ābhāsvara gods, the Parīttaśubha gods, the Apramāṇaśubha gods, the Śubhakṛtsna gods, the Anabhraka gods, the Puṇyaprasava gods, the Bṛhatphala gods, the Abṛha gods, the Atapa gods, the Sudṛśa gods, the Sudarśana gods, and the gods of Akaniṣṭha, and there they proclaim the sounds of impermanence, suffering, emptiness, and selflessness. They also recite two verses:

"Set out on renunciation,
Apply yourselves to the Buddha's teaching,
And as an elephant crushes a hut of reeds,
Crush the army of the Lord of Death.

Whoever, in this very Dharma and Discipline,
Practices with heedfulness,
Will abandon the cycle of births
And bring suffering to an end."

So they recite. Then those rays of light circle the great trichiliocosm and follow after the Blessed One himself. If the Blessed One wishes to explain past karma, they vanish into the Blessed One's back. If he wishes to explain future karma, they vanish into his front. If he wishes to foretell rebirth in the hells, they vanish into the soles of his feet. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as an animal, they vanish into his heels. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a hungry ghost, they vanish into his big toes. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a human, they vanish into his two knees. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a powerful wheel-turning king, they vanish into the palm of his left hand. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a wheel-turning king, they vanish into the palm of his right hand. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a god, they vanish into his navel. If he wishes to foretell awakening as a śrāvaka, they vanish into his mouth. If he wishes to foretell awakening as a pratyekabuddha, they vanish into the tuft of hair between his eyebrows. If he wishes to foretell unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, they vanish into the crown protuberance on his head.

Then those rays of light circled the Blessed One three times and vanished into the tuft of hair between the Blessed One's eyebrows.

Then the venerable Ānanda joined his palms and said to the Blessed One:

"Many-colored, interwoven with a thousand hues,
A multitude of rays has come forth from your mouth.
They have illuminated every direction,
Just as the rising sun does."

And he further spoke in verse:

"The buddhas, free from levity, who have abandoned pride and discontent,
Who have become the supreme cause for beings,
The victors who have conquered their foes, do not without cause and condition
Display a smile the color of lotus fiber and conch.

O Steadfast One, since by your own understanding you know the time has come,
O Śramaṇa, Lord of Victors, for those who wish to hear and are in doubt,
O Bull among Sages, with your supreme, steadfast, and excellent words,
Please dispel the doubt that has arisen.

The protectors, the perfect buddhas, steadfast as the ocean and the king of mountains,
Do not display a smile without reason.
O Hero, the reason for which you display this smile,
The great multitude wishes to hear from you."

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, so it is. So it is. Ānanda, the tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas, do not smile without cause and without condition. Ānanda, do you see how this park keeper has shown me such reverence?"

"Venerable One, I see it."

"Ānanda, through this root of virtue, this arising of the mind, and this giving away of something to be given, this park keeper will not fall into the lower realms for thirteen eons. Then, having attained his last existence, his last abode, his last body, and his last embodiment, he will become a pratyekabuddha called Vimala. His gift is this: that he made his mind faithful toward me.

"Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We will show reverence to buddhas, pratyekabuddhas, and śrāvakas.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Sweet Voice.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was honored, revered, esteemed, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the royal court, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas, the Blessed One, the Buddha, the one who knows, possessed of great merit, who received robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and provisions for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in Prince Jeta's Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

Then in the morning the Blessed One put on his lower robe and his Dharma robe, took up his alms bowl, and went into Śrāvastī for alms. Meanwhile a large band of companions, drunk and intoxicated with liquor, were making all kinds of music with lutes, flutes, clay drums, and round drums, dancing and singing. They had hung many garlands of flowers around their necks, of utpalas, padmas, kumudas, white lotuses, vārṣikī jasmine, and others, and wearing the finest clothes, they came out of Śrāvastī.

Then that band of companions saw the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, like a moving mountain of jewels, entirely beautiful. The moment they saw him, they sobered from their drunkenness. Sobered from their drunkenness, their minds became joyful and faithful, and they paid homage to the Blessed One with dancing, song, and the sound of music. They also scattered blue utpalas over the Blessed One, and these remained above the Blessed One, becoming like a blue pavilion, a blue chamber, and a blue parasol. When the Blessed One walked, they moved; when he stopped, they stayed. The Blessed One, too, sent forth blue light, and that light made Śrāvastī look the color of sapphire.

Then faith in the Blessed One arose in that band of companions, and they made this resolve: "Through this root of virtue, this arising of the mind, and this gift, may we realize the awakening of a pratyekabuddha."

Then the Blessed One smiled. It is the nature of things that whenever buddhas, blessed ones, smile, rays of blue, yellow, red, and white light come

forth from their mouths. Some go downward and some go upward.

Those that go downward reach the hells Saṃjīva, Kālasūtra, Saṃghāta, Raurava, Mahāraurava, Tapana, Pratāpana, Avīci, Arbuda, Nirarbuda, Aṭaṭa, Huhuva, Hahava, Utpala, Padma, and Mahāpadma. Into the hot hells they descend as coolness, and into the cold hells they descend as warmth. In this way the various torments of those beings are relieved.

Then those beings think, "Oh! Have we died and passed away from here, or have we been born somewhere else?" Then, in order to inspire faith in them, the Blessed One sends forth an emanation. When they see the emanation, they think, "Oh! We have not died and passed away from here, nor have we been born somewhere else. Rather, through the power of this being, never seen before, our various torments have been relieved." Then their minds rejoice in the emanation, the karma that was to be experienced in the hells is exhausted, and they take rebirth among gods and humans, where they will become worthy vessels for the truths.

Those that go upward reach as far as the gods of the Four Great Kings, the Thirty-Three, the Yāma gods, the Tuṣita gods, the Nirmāṇarati gods, the Paranirmitavaśavartin gods, the Brahmakāyika gods, the Brahmapurohita gods, the Mahābrahmā gods, the Parīttābha gods, the Apramāṇābha gods, the Ābhāsvara gods, the Parīttaśubha gods, the Apramāṇaśubha gods, the Śubhakṛtsna gods, the Anabhraka gods, the Puṇyaprasava gods, the Bṛhatphala gods, the Abṛha gods, the Atapa gods, the Sudṛśa gods, the Sudarśana gods, and the gods of Akaniṣṭha, and there they proclaim the sounds of impermanence, suffering, emptiness, and selflessness. They also recite two verses:

"Set out on renunciation,
Apply yourselves to the Buddha's teaching,
And as an elephant crushes a hut of reeds,
Crush the army of the Lord of Death.

Whoever, in this very Dharma and Discipline,
Practices with heedfulness,
Will abandon the cycle of births
And dispel suffering."

So they recite. Then those rays of light circle the great trichiliocosm and follow after the Blessed One himself. If the Blessed One wishes to explain past karma, they vanish into the Blessed One's back. If he wishes to explain future

karma, they vanish into his front. If he wishes to foretell rebirth in the hells, they vanish into the soles of his feet. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as an animal, they vanish into his heels. If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a hungry ghost, they vanish into his big toes.

If he wishes to foretell rebirth as a human being, they vanish into his two knees. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a king who turns the wheel by force, they vanish into the palm of his left hand. If he wishes to foretell that someone will become a wheel-turning king, they vanish into the palm of his right hand. If he wishes to foretell rebirth among the gods, they vanish into his navel. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a śrāvaka, they vanish into his mouth. If he wishes to foretell the awakening of a pratyekabuddha, they vanish into the tuft of hair between his eyebrows. If he wishes to foretell unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, they vanish into the crown protuberance on his head.

Then those rays of light circled the Blessed One three times and vanished into the tuft of hair between the Blessed One's eyebrows. Then the venerable Ānanda joined his palms and said to the Blessed One:

"Varied, interlaced with a thousand colors,
Many rays have come forth from your mouth;
They have made all the directions bright,
Just as the rising sun would do."

And again he spoke in verse:

"The buddhas, free of excitement, who have abandoned pride and displeasure,
Who have become the supreme cause for beings,
The victors who have conquered the foe, do not without cause or condition
Display a smile the color of lotus fiber and of conch.
Steadfast one, since you know by your own mind that the time has come,
For the śramaṇas, the kings, and the listeners who are seeking amid doubt,
With the supreme and steadfast speech of the Bull among Sages,
Excellent one, please dispel the doubt that has arisen.
The protectors, the perfect buddhas, steadfast like the ocean and the king of mountains,
Do not display a smile without purpose.
The reason for which the Hero displays a smile:
This the great multitude wishes to hear from you."

The Blessed One said, "So it is, Ānanda. So it is. Ānanda, the tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly complete buddhas, do not smile without cause and without condition. Ānanda, do you see the honor these members of the association have paid me?"

"Venerable One, I see it."

"Ānanda, through this root of virtue, through this arising of their resolve, and through this relinquishing of a gift, these members of the association will not fall into the lower realms for twenty eons. When they attain their final existence, their final abode, their final body and their final individual being, every one of them will become a pratyekabuddha called Sweet Voice. Their gift is this one that they gave to me with a faithful mind. Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall pay honor to the buddhas, the pratyekabuddhas and the śrāvakas.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

From the Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, the third set summarized by a verse is complete.

The Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, the eighth fascicle.

The summary verse:

Padma, and Morsel,
Dharmapāla, and likewise Peaceful,
Surūpa, Maitrakanyaka,
The Hare, and Dharmagaveṣin,
Anāthapiṇḍada, and Subhadra:
These are taught in this set.

Padma. The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, respected, revered and worshipped by kings, great ministers, wealthy men, townspeople, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. The Buddha, the Blessed One, known to and worshipped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, possessing great merit, receiving robes, alms food, bedding, seats, medicines for the sick and other requisites, was dwelling with the community of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

Then, in the autumn season, the monks were struck by jaundice and became emaciated and weak in body. The Blessed One was free of illness, unharmed,

untouched by sickness, and strong. When the monks saw this, they said to the Blessed One, "Venerable One, some monks have been struck by jaundice, a disease caused by grahas, and have become emaciated and weak in body. The Blessed One is free of illness and unharmed; he is strong, naturally free of illness, his digestive heat is even, and he digests well."

The Blessed One looked at them and said, "Monks, in other, former lives the Tathāgata himself performed and accumulated actions whose accumulations have come together, whose conditions have ripened, which approach like a flood, and which will inevitably come. Since I myself performed and accumulated those actions, who else would experience them? Monks, actions that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen on the external earth element; they do not ripen on the water element, the fire element or the wind element. Virtuous and nonvirtuous actions that have been performed and accumulated ripen solely on the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense bases.

The actions of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time has come,
They ripen as their very fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in the city of Vārāṇasī, a king called Padma ruled. During his reign the land was prosperous, flourishing and happy, with good harvests, and full of many people and folk. Fighting and quarrels had been quelled, and there was no unrest, internal strife, banditry, theft, famine or disease. It was rich in śāli rice, sugarcane, cattle and buffalo. Free of harm and with its thorns cleared away, he protected the kingdom as one would care for an only child.

That king, moreover, was full of faith, virtuous and of excellent intention, devoted to his own welfare and the welfare of others, greatly compassionate, magnanimous, a lover of the Dharma, kind to his subjects, one who gave everything, who gave everything away, who gave away without attachment, and who abided in great generosity.

At that time, because the seasons and their junctures fell out of balance, a great epidemic broke out in Vārāṇasī, and most beings were struck by jaundice. When the king saw them, compassion arose in him, and he thought, "I must protect these people and heal them." So he gathered the physicians who lived throughout the land and instructed them, and once they had

determined the basis of these beings' disease, its seat and its earlier origin, he himself had all the remedies and medicines collected. Then the sick were treated, and although they were provided with wealth, medicine and attendants, for a long time those beings could not be cured.

The king then summoned all the physicians, treated them with respect, and said, "Sirs, why have these beings become so hard to cure?"

The physicians examined the matter, weighed its merits and faults, and having reached agreement, they said, "Your Majesty, since this has come from an imbalance of the seasons and an imbalance of the elements, we have not fully understood it. Yet, Your Majesty, there is one medicine: there is a fish called the rohita, and if it can be found, it will be able to cure them."

So the king set about searching everywhere for the rohita fish. He sent out many people to search, but though they searched, they did not find it, and they reported this to the king.

Some time later, when the king went out for a walk, the sick gathered together, sat down, and said to the king, "Great king, please protect us from this disease and grant us our lives!"

When the king heard the words of the sick, crying "Have pity, have pity!" and crying "It hurts, it hurts!" and speaking in despair, his heart was stirred with compassion. Shedding tears and weeping, he thought, "If I cannot even bring relief to others who are tormented by suffering, what use to me is such a life as this, and such sovereignty over a kingdom?"

Having thought this, the king gave away most of his wealth. He installed his eldest son as king, confessed his faults to his relatives and the people, praised the townspeople and the ministers, and comforted the suffering sick. Then he took up the eightfold observance, went up onto the top of the palace, scattered incense, flowers, perfumes, garlands and ointments, faced east, and made this aspiration: "By the truth and the words of truth that, seeing beings fallen into dire need and tormented by disease, I have given up my own precious life, by this truth and these words of truth, may I be born as a rohita fish in this river, the Turner-Back!" When he had said this, he threw himself down from the top of the palace. The moment he landed there, he died, and he was born in the river Turner-Back as a great fish called a rohita.

Then the gods proclaimed throughout the whole land, "The great fish called the rohita that has been born in the river Turner-Back is like nectar for those

who have long been tormented by grave disease!"

As soon as they heard this, a great many people took weapons in their hands, carried baskets, and went there, and they began to cut the flesh from the living fish with sharp weapons of every kind. While his body was being cut in this way, that bodhisattva pervaded those beings with loving-kindness, and warm tears streamed down his face. He thought, "That these beings become well through my flesh and blood is a gain that I have truly gained!" In this way, for twelve years, he satisfied those beings with his own flesh and blood, and he never turned his mind away from unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

When the disease of those beings had subsided, the great rohita fish proclaimed, "O beings, listen! I am that king called Padma. For your sake I gave up my own life and took on such a body as this. So have a joyful mind toward me, and when I fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, I will again free you from disease forever, and I will establish you in nirvāṇa, the ultimate end, accomplished and blissful."

When they heard this, those crowds of people, the king, the ministers and the townspeople gained faith. They made offerings of flowers, garlands and ointments and made this aspiration: "You who do what is supremely difficult, when you fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, may we become your śrāvakas!"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who at that time, on that occasion, was the king called Padma was none other than I. Because I made such a sacrifice, while I wandered in saṃsāra I experienced boundless happiness, and now too, when I have fully awakened to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, my digestive heat is even and I digest well. Therefore what I eat, drink, chew and taste is digested well and comfortably, and I am free of illness, unharmed, and by nature free of disease. Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall cultivate compassion for all sentient beings.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Morsel. The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, respected, revered and worshipped by kings, great ministers, wealthy men, townspeople, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. The Buddha, the Blessed One, known to and worshipped by gods,

nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, possessing great merit, receiving robes, alms food, bedding, seats, medicines for the sick and other requisites, was dwelling with the community of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

There the Blessed One said to the monks, "Monks, if beings knew the fruit of giving and knew the ripened fruit of sharing out gifts, just as I know the fruit of giving and know the ripened fruit of sharing out gifts, then even with the very last morsel, the final morsel that remains, if they found a worthy recipient, they would not eat it until they had given it or shared it, and their minds would not remain entangled by the stinginess that arises. But because beings do not know the fruit of giving and do not know the ripened fruit of sharing out gifts, as I know the fruit of giving and know the ripened fruit of sharing out gifts, they eat with a grasping mind, without giving or sharing, and their minds remain entangled by the stinginess that arises."

When the Blessed One had said this, when the Sugata had spoken thus, the Teacher further said this:

"If beings knew, as the Great Sage has said,
How the ripening of sharing out
Comes to be of such great benefit,
They would not eat until they had given,
They would not become stingy,
And a grasping mind
Would never arise in them.
But because the childish, obscured
By delusion, do not know it,
With grasping minds
They always eat without giving.
And, stinginess having arisen in them,
Their minds remain entangled."

When the Blessed One had spoken this sūtra, doubt arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, it is wonderful that the Blessed One has spoken in praise of giving and has also spoken of the ripened fruit of sharing out gifts."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what is so very wonderful in the Tathāgata's speaking in praise of giving and speaking of the ripened fruit of sharing out gifts in this way? Listen well and carefully, and keep it in mind, and I shall tell

you how in a past time, for the sake of one who begged, I gave away even the morsel that had already reached my mouth as I was eating.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in the city of Vārāṇasī, a king called Brahmadatta ruled. During his reign the land was prosperous, flourishing and happy, with good harvests, and full of many people and folk. Quarrels and fighting had been quelled, and there was no unrest, internal strife, banditry, theft, famine or disease. It was rich in śāli rice, sugarcane, cattle and buffalo. Free of harm and with its thorns cleared away, he protected the kingdom as one would care for an only child. That king, moreover, was full of faith, virtuous and of excellent intention, devoted to his own welfare and the welfare of others, greatly compassionate, magnanimous, a lover of the Dharma, kind to his subjects, one who gave everything, who gave everything away, who gave away without attachment, and who abided in great generosity.

"Some time later a great famine broke out, like the intermediate eon of famine. Then crowds of people, afraid of dying before their time in the famine, starving, their throats and cheeks sunken, their bodies like those of hungry ghosts, gathered and assembled, thronged together, and went to the king. They praised him, saying, 'May you be victorious! May you live long!' and said, 'Your Majesty, please protect us from this terror of famine and grant us our lives!'

"Then the king called his treasurer and said, 'Hey, treasurer! Is there enough food and drink in the treasury for us and for these crowds of people?'

"When he heard this, the keeper of the treasury said, 'I would like to make a count and then report to Your Majesty.'

"Then those skilled in reckoning made the count and reported, 'For such and such a period, everyone living in the land may have one morsel each per day, and the king may eat two morsels.'

"Then the king called the crowds of people and told them, 'In that case, come to the royal palace every day, eat one morsel each, and go.'

"So every day they came, each person ate one morsel, and they went wherever they pleased.

"Then a certain other brahmin who had not been included in the count heard the news from others and said to the king, 'Your Majesty, I have heard among the people of the land about the count you made, so please grant me too that single morsel.'

"Then, of the two morsels he himself ate, the king gave one morsel to the brahmin, and ate one morsel, the same as the people of the land.

"Śakra, lord of the gods, turned his gaze of knowledge to the world below, and he thought, 'Oh! The one who rules as king in the land of Vārāṇasī is doing something extremely difficult. I shall test him.'

"Then Śakra, lord of the gods, magically transformed himself into the guise of a brahmin, and at mealtime he went before the king. Praising him with the words, 'Victory to you! May you live long!' he said, 'Your Majesty, I am hungry. Please help me with that single morsel of Your Majesty's own.'

"Then the king, resolved to give up his own life, out of compassion gave that single morsel of his to the brahmin and remained fasting. In this way he went without food for six days. Yet seeing all those many people eating, he felt supreme joy.

"Then Śakra, lord of the gods, seeing that the king was doing something extremely difficult, made his brahmin guise disappear, and, remaining in his own form, he praised the king: 'Excellent, great king! Well done! I am delighted by this hardship you have undertaken. Since there is such a protector of beings, this multitude of people has a guardian. Now have it proclaimed throughout the land: "Obtain every kind of seed!" In seven days I shall send down such a great downpour of rain that the grains will flourish.'

"The king had it done just so, and Śakra sent down just such a great downpour. Thereby the famine was averted, and there was a good harvest."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who at that time, on that occasion, was the king called Brahmadatta was none other than I. When such a famine occurred, I gave up my own life and gave such gifts. Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall give gifts; we shall make merit.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Dharmapāla.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace retinue, guild masters, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, renowned

and possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove at the Kalandaka Feeding Ground.

At that time the foolish man Devadatta, in order to kill the Blessed One, had sent out the elephant Dhanapāla, had scattered poisoned powder, and had dispatched assassins. For a long time he had been murderous, hostile, and unfriendly toward the Blessed One, while the Blessed One remained toward him with a mind of loving-kindness, a mind of benevolence, and a mind of compassion. Then the monks said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, see how this Devadatta strives to kill the Blessed One, while the Blessed One remains toward him with a mind of loving-kindness, a mind of benevolence, and a mind of compassion."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what is so wonderful in this, now that the Tathāgata is free of attachment, free of aversion, free of delusion, completely liberated from birth, old age, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness, and agitation, omniscient, knowing all aspects, and has attained mastery over all wisdom and all that is to be known? In the past, when I still had attachment, aversion, and delusion, even when he came to kill me while I was young in years, I did not harbor hatred toward him. Listen well and carefully, and bear it in mind, and I shall explain.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in the city of Vārāṇasī a king called Brahmadatta ruled. During his reign the land was prosperous, flourishing, happy, blessed with good harvests, and filled with many people and inhabitants. Strife and disputes were stilled, and there was no unrest, no internal conflict, no banditry, no famine, and no disease. It abounded in sāli rice, sugarcane, cattle, and buffalo. Without causing harm, having cleared away the thorns of the realm, he ruled his kingdom as one cares for an only son.

"That king was faithful, virtuous, and of good intention, devoted to his own welfare and the welfare of others, greatly compassionate, magnanimous, desirous of the Dharma, and loving toward his subjects. He gave everything, relinquished everything, and relinquished without attachment; he abided in great generosity.

"That king had a queen called Evil-Minded, who was fierce, wrathful, and cruel, and his only son, called Dharmapāla, was born of that same Evil-Minded. The young prince Dharmapāla was also faithful, virtuous, and of good intention,

devoted to his own welfare and the welfare of others, greatly compassionate, magnanimous, desirous of the Dharma, and loving toward beings. The brahmins and householders living in Vārāṇasī, whenever they saw him, held him dear, cherished, beloved, and pleasing. Then he went to a teacher and learned to read and write together with the other children.

"Some time later, in springtime, when the trees were in full blossom and the forest resounded with the calls of geese, cranes, peacocks, parrots, mynas, cuckoos, and jīvaṃjīvaka birds, the king, attended by his retinue of queens together with the chief queen, went to the pleasure garden. In that pleasure garden, while the king was sporting with his retinue of queens, Queen Evil-Minded, overcome by jealousy and anger, became enraged.

"The king sent her half of the drink he had been drinking, but she, enraged, sent a message to the king: 'If I should drink half of what you have drunk, then let me drink my son's blood!'

"For one given over to desire there is no evil deed that he will not do. Then King Brahmadatta, although he was righteous and had been free of entanglement in sensual passion, though the retinue of queens tried to calm him, blazed with the fire of anger. Growing ever more furious, he commanded, 'This very day cut the throat of the boy Dharmapāla and give her his blood to drink!'

"Then the boy Dharmapāla, who was in the children's schoolroom, heard this, and weeping he said, 'In saṃsāra, beings at enmity with one another are the lowest of all: thus, under the sway of anger, one will kill even the son born of one's own body.'

"Then the boy Dharmapāla adorned himself with all his ornaments, bowed at his father's feet, and said, 'Father, I bow to you. I am your beloved son, and I have done no wrong. Please grant that I not be killed.'

"The king said, 'Beloved son, if your mother forgives you, then I too shall forgive.'

"Then Dharmapāla, weeping, went before his mother, bowed at her feet, joined his palms, and said, 'Mother, have forbearance, and do not have me killed!'

"Though she heard him speaking thus, crying out 'Have pity, have pity!' and 'Alas, alas!' and speaking in anguish, she did not relent. Then the executioners cut the throat of the boy Dharmapāla with a sharp blade and gave the blood to

Queen Evil-Minded to drink, and even so Evil-Minded felt no remorse. The boy Dharmapāla died with a gladdened mind toward his father and mother and toward the executioners."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who at that time, on that occasion, was the boy called Dharmapāla was none other than I. Queen Evil-Minded was this very Devadatta. At that time, even when I had fallen into the hands of the executioners, I gave rise to a mind of loving-kindness toward him; and now too, while he strives to kill me, I regard him with loving-kindness, I regard him with benevolence, I regard him with compassion. Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall cultivate a mind of loving-kindness toward all sentient beings.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Peaceful.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace retinue, guild masters, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, renowned and possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time in Śrāvastī the monks had formed two great assemblies. One had undertaken to keep the rains retreat in the middle month of summer; the other had undertaken to keep the rains retreat until the full moon of the last month of autumn. There the monks were coloring their alms bowls, washing, boiling, and dyeing their robes, and sewing their seams.

Then at one point a certain monk, wanting to sew his robe, could not get the thread into the eye of the needle. Crying out "Have pity, have pity!" and "Alas, alas!" and speaking in anguish, he said, "Who in the world desires merit? Who in the world desires merit?"

The Blessed One was walking up and down on a walkway not far from him. Then the Blessed One stretched out his arm, like an elephant's trunk, and with

a voice deep, sweet, and articulate, pleasing like the song of the kalaviṅka bird, and resonant like the sound of a great drum, he said, "Monk, I am one in the world who desires merit."

Then that monk, hearing the Blessed One's voice endowed with the five qualities, with reverent and eager attention took hold of the Blessed One's hand, placed it on his own head, and said, "Blessed One, with this hand of yours you have accumulated generosity, moral discipline, patience, diligence, meditative concentration, and wisdom for three countless eons; and yet does the Blessed One still say, 'Monk, I am one in the world who desires merit'?"

The Blessed One said, "Monk, I am never sated with merit. Monk, because I have tasted the flavor of merit, I am never sated with merit."

Then doubt arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, the cutter of all doubts, "Blessed One, it is wondrous that the Blessed One is never sated with meritorious formations."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what is so wonderful in this, now that the Tathāgata is free of attachment, free of aversion, free of delusion, completely liberated from birth, old age, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness, and agitation, omniscient, knowing all aspects, and has attained mastery over all wisdom and all that is to be known? In the past, when I still had attachment, aversion, and delusion, and was not yet completely liberated from birth, old age, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness, and agitation, I was never sated with meritorious formations. Listen well and carefully, and bear it in mind, and I shall explain.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in the royal palace called Great Sound of Peace, a king called Peaceful ruled. During his reign the land was prosperous, flourishing, happy, blessed with good harvests, and filled with many people and inhabitants. Disputes and strife were stilled, and there was no unrest, no internal conflict, no banditry, no famine, and no disease. It abounded in sāli rice, sugarcane, cattle, and buffalo. Without causing harm, having cleared away the thorns of the realm, he ruled his kingdom as one cares for an only son.

"That king was faithful, virtuous, and of good intention, devoted to his own welfare and the welfare of others, greatly compassionate, magnanimous, desirous of the Dharma, and loving toward his subjects. He gave everything, relinquished everything, and relinquished without attachment; he abided in great generosity.

"He would rise early in the morning and go to the hall of offerings, and there he gave food to those who wanted food, drink to those who wanted drink, and clothing to those who wanted clothing, and he gave away wealth, grain, cowries, gold, jewels, pearls, beryl, conch, crystal, and coral. Yet even so he was not sated with meritorious formations. He went to the queens' quarters and gave food and drink to the retinue of queens. He gave food and drink to his sons, to the ministers, to the warriors, to the commanders, to the townspeople, and to the people of the countryside.

"Then King Peaceful thought, 'I have satisfied the people, but with what shall I satisfy the tiny creatures that remain?'

"Having given away all his possessions, he was left wearing no more than a single garment, with nothing but his body remaining, and he thought, 'I shall give my own body to the tiny creatures.' He bared his body and lay down where there were gadflies, mosquitoes, and the like, and he satisfied them with his blood, as one would care for a beloved only son.

"Śakra, lord of the gods, turned his gaze of knowledge to the world below, and he thought, 'Is this King Peaceful doing this for the sake of beings, or is he doing it out of compassion? I shall test him.'

"Then he magically transformed himself into a vulture of fearsome, overbearing aspect, black as ink, and went to King Peaceful. Yet even when the bird made as if to pluck out his eyes with its beak, the king was not frightened; looking at the vulture with great eyes of loving-kindness, he said, 'Son, take from my body whatever you wish, as much as you please.'

"Then Śakra, lord of the gods, was delighted. Transforming himself into the guise of a brahmin, he stood before King Peaceful and said, 'King, please give me your two eyes.'

"The king said, 'O brahmin, no one will hinder you from this body of mine. Take whatever you wish.'

"Then Śakra, lord of the gods, was even more delighted. He made his brahmin guise disappear, and, remaining in his own form, he encouraged the king and said, 'O king, excellent, excellent! Your mind is utterly resolute, and your aspiration cannot be shaken. The stream of your great compassion has flowed out toward beings. Since you are thus fearless in the face of things that inspire fear, through this effort you will before long fully awaken into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who at that time, on that occasion, was King Peaceful was none other than I. If even then I was not sated with performing meritorious deeds, what need is there to speak of now? Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall give gifts; we shall make merit.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Surūpa.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace retinue, guild masters, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, renowned and possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At one time the Blessed One, having risen from inward meditative seclusion, taught the fourfold assembly a teaching wholly imbued with the flavor of the Dharma, like honey from bees that has not been boiled. Many hundreds of people in the assembly listened to the Blessed One's teaching, wholly imbued with the flavor of the Dharma, with their senses unmoving. At that time doubt arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, the cutter of all doubts, "Venerable One, see how these beings have become vessels for the precious Dharma and are intent on listening with respect."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, listen well and carefully to how the Tathāgata, with respect, listened to the Dharma and held it in mind, and bear it in mind, and I shall explain.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in the city of Vārāṇasī a king called Surūpa ruled. During his reign the land was prosperous, flourishing, happy, blessed with good harvests, and filled with many people and inhabitants. Strife and disputes were stilled, and there was no unrest, no internal conflict, no banditry, no famine, and no disease. It abounded in sāli rice, sugarcane, cattle, and buffalo. Without causing harm, having cleared away the thorns of the realm, he ruled his kingdom as one cares for an only son.

"That king was faithful, virtuous, and of good intention, devoted to his own welfare and the welfare of others, greatly compassionate, magnanimous, desirous of the Dharma, and loving toward his subjects. He gave everything, relinquished everything, and relinquished without attachment; he abided in great generosity.

"That king had a queen called Sundarī, fair of form, lovely to behold, and beautiful, perfect in all her limbs and features. He also had an only son called Sundara, dear, cherished, beloved, and pleasing, patient and free of contrariness.

"Some time later King Surūpa came to long for the Dharma. He assembled all his ministers and commanded them, 'Leaders of the land, I long for the Dharma. Seek out the Dharma for me!'

"Then those ministers joined their palms and said, 'Great king, the Dharma is rare. It is said that only when a buddha appears in the world does the Dharma appear.'

"Then the king fastened a vessel containing a hundred thousand pieces of gold to the top of a banner and had a proclamation made by bell throughout the land: 'Whoever in my land can speak the Dharma, to him I shall give this vessel containing a hundred thousand pieces of gold, and I shall also honor and praise him with great honors.'

"Yet even after a long time had passed, no one who could speak the Dharma appeared. Then the king grieved and despaired for want of the Dharma.

"Śakra, lord of the gods, turned his gaze of knowledge to the world below, and seeing the king pining for the Dharma, he thought, 'I shall test King Surūpa.'

"Then he magically transformed himself into a yakṣa with hideous hands, feet, and eyes, and said to the king, who was seated amid his large retinue, 'If you long for the Dharma, I shall teach you the Dharma.'

"When the king heard the word 'Dharma,' joy and supreme delight arose in him, and he said to the yakṣa, 'O Guhyaka, speak the Dharma, and I shall listen.'

"The yakṣa said, 'Ah, great king, it is the one who sits at ease who speaks the Dharma, but I am hungry. Give me food first!'

"When the king heard this, he commanded his servants, 'Bring him all kinds of food and delicacies.'

"The yakṣa said, 'I eat the flesh and drink the blood of those freshly slain. Give me your only son, Sundara!'

"When the king heard this he became deeply unhappy, and he thought, 'Once in a hundred times, as today, one may meet with the sound of the Dharma, and that too is beyond price; it must be bought.'

"Then young Sundara heard this, bowed at his father's feet, and said, 'Your Majesty, be patient, fulfill Your Majesty's wish, and please give me as food to the Guhyaka.'

"Then the king, for the sake of the Dharma, gave to the yakṣa his only son, dear, cherished, beloved, and pleasing, patient and free of contrariness. Then the yakṣa, by the power of his magic, made it appear to the king and his retinue that he was cutting off the boy's limbs and parts one by one and eating them, and drinking his blood as well. When the king saw this, because he longed for the Dharma, he did not become displeased.

"Then the yakṣa said to the king, 'King, I am not satisfied. Give me more!'

"The king gave him his beloved wife as well. Then he made it appear that he ate her too in the very same way. Then again he said to the king, 'O king, I am still not satisfied.'

"Then the king said to the yakṣa, 'Son, I have given you my only son and my beloved wife; what more do you want?'

"The yakṣa said, 'Give me your own body, and then I will be satisfied.'

"The king said, 'If I give you my own body, how shall I hear the Dharma? First teach me the Dharma, and after I have heard the Dharma I shall give up my own body.'

"Then the yakṣa, having bound the king by his promise, taught the Dharma before many hundreds of people in the assembly:

'From what is dear arises sorrow;
From what is dear arises fear.
For those wholly freed from fears,
Having no sorrow, how could there be fear?'

"As soon as the king heard this verse, his mind was thoroughly refreshed; his senses rejoiced, gladness arose in him, and he said to the yakṣa, 'Yakṣa, do with this body of mine as you please.'

"Then Śakra, lord of the gods, knowing that the king was as unmoving as Mount Meru from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, made the yakṣa form disappear, and, remaining in his own form, with eyes shining with joy, holding the son with one hand and the wife with the other, he encouraged the king and said, 'Excellent, excellent, holy being! Through this effort of your steadfast armor, you will before long fully awaken into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. And here is your reunion with those dear to you.'

"Then the king said to Śakra, lord of the gods, 'Kauśika, excellent, excellent that you have fulfilled my wish for the Dharma!'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who at that time, on that occasion, was the king called Surūpa was none other than I. Young Sundara was Ānanda. Sundarī was Yaśodharā. Monks, if even at that time I gave up my dear kin and gave up my own life for the sake of the Dharma, what need is there to speak of now? Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall honor the Dharma, esteem it, revere it, and worship it.

Having honored, esteemed, revered, and worshiped the Dharma, we shall abide relying upon it.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, the ninth section.

Maitrakanyaka.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace retinue, guild masters, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, renowned and possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

There the Blessed One addressed the monks: "Monks, those households in which the mother and father are well revered, well worshiped, and well served are households that have Brahmā within them. Why is that? Because, monks, the mother and father of a son of good family are, rightly considered, like Brahmā.

"Monks, those households in which the mother and father are well revered, well worshiped, and well served are households that have teachers within them. Why is that? Because the mother and father of a son of good family are, rightly considered, like teachers.

"Monks, those households in which the mother and father are well revered, well worshiped, and well served are households that have those worthy of offerings within them. Why is that? Because, monks, the mother and father of a son of good family are, rightly considered, worthy of offerings.

"Monks, those households in which the mother and father are well revered, well worshiped, and well served are households that have the sacred fire within them. Why is that? Because, monks, the mother and father of a son of good family are, rightly considered, like the sacred fire.

"Monks, those households in which the mother and father are well revered, well worshiped, and well served are households that have the gods within them. Why is that? Because, monks, the mother and father of a son of good family are, rightly considered, like gods."

The Blessed One spoke thus, and when the Sugata had said this, the Teacher further declared:

"Mother and father are Brahmā,
And likewise they are the first teachers.
They are worthy of their son's offerings;
They are human, and they are gods as well.
Therefore those two are worthy of homage.
With massage and with bathing,
And with washing of their feet,
Or else with food and drink,
With clothing, bedding, and seats,
The wise should show them honor.
Because they have honored mother and father,
Those wise ones, therefore,
Are not reproached here in this life,
And when they die, they rejoice in the higher realms."

When the Blessed One had spoken this sūtra, doubt arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, the cutter of all doubts, "Venerable Blessed One, it is wondrous that the Blessed One has spoken praise of showing great respect to mother and father."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, now that the Tathāgata is free of attachment, free of aversion, free of delusion, completely liberated from birth, old age, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness, and agitation, omniscient, knowing all aspects, and has attained mastery over all wisdom and all that is to be known, what is so wonderful in his speaking such praise of showing great respect to mother and father? In the past, when I still had attachment, aversion, and delusion, and was not yet completely liberated from birth, old age, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness, and agitation, I experienced great suffering from doing my mother even a small harm, and I experienced great happiness from showing her even a little honor. Listen well and carefully, and bear it in mind, and I shall explain.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in the city of Vārāṇasī there lived a caravan leader called Maitra, rich, with much wealth and great means, with vast and extensive holdings, possessed of wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He took a wife from a family of equal rank, and he played, made love, and took his pleasure with her. As he played, made love, and took his pleasure, sons were born to them, but they died.

"He rested his cheek on his hand and sat brooding, thinking, 'Although my house is full of wealth, I have neither son nor daughter, so after my death, because I have no son, the king will take possession of everything I own.'

"Then someone gave him this advice: 'If a son is born to you, give him a girl's name. If you do that, he will live long.'

"Having no son and longing for one, he prayed to Śiva, Varuṇa, Kubera, Śakra, Brahmā and the rest, and to other particular gods as well: the gods of parks, the gods of forests, the gods of crossroads where four ways meet, the gods of junctions where three ways meet, the gods who receive bali offerings, the gods born together with him, the gods who share his nature, and the gods who constantly follow close behind him. To all these he prayed. In the world there is indeed a saying that sons and daughters are born because of prayer, but that is not so. If sons and daughters were born because of prayer, then each person would surely have a thousand sons, like a wheel-turning king. Rather, sons and daughters are born from the coming together of three conditions. What are the three? The father and mother come together, aroused by desire; the mother is in season and in her fertile time; and a gandharva, a being between death and rebirth, is present. From the coming together of these three conditions, sons and daughters are born.

"So he went on, devoted to prayer, and a certain being died, passed from some class of beings, and entered his wife's womb. Some women of wise nature have five special qualities. What are the five? They know when a man is attached to them and know when he is not; they know the right time and know their fertile season; they know when they have conceived; they know from whom they have conceived; and they know whether it is a boy or a girl: if it is a boy, it rests on the right side of the belly, and if it is a girl, it rests on the left side of the belly. Overjoyed, she told her husband, 'My lord, I have conceived a child. Since it rests on the right side of my womb, it will certainly be a boy. Rejoice!'

"He too was overjoyed. Raising the upper part of his body and stretching out his right hand, he spoke these words of joy: 'I shall see the face of the son I have long wished and prayed for! May my son be sound and not unsound. Once raised, may he do what I need done. May he repay the care of his raising. May he enjoy his inheritance. May my family line long endure. And after we have passed away and died, may he give gifts on our behalf, whether many or few, perform meritorious deeds, and dedicate the reward, saying, "Wherever those two are born and go, may this follow them there."'

"Then, knowing that she had conceived, he placed her at ease in the upper story of the mansion so that the child would be cared for. In cold weather she had what was needed against the cold, and in hot weather what was needed against the heat. She was sustained with the foods the physician prescribed: foods not too bitter, not too sour, not too salty, not too sweet, not too pungent, and not too astringent, foods free of bitterness, sourness, saltiness, sweetness, pungency and astringency. Her body was adorned with necklaces and half-necklaces. Like a daughter of the gods roaming in the Nandana Grove, she moved from couch to couch and from seat to seat and never stepped down to the ground below, and she was made to hear no unpleasant sound at all.

"After eight or nine months had passed, she gave birth to a son: a boy handsome and pleasing to behold, beautiful and of fine complexion, golden in color, with a head shaped like a parasol, long arms, a broad forehead, a high nose, a well-formed nose, thick eyebrows, and complete in all his limbs and lesser limbs. When he was born, they held a birth feast and then set about naming him, asking, 'What name shall be given to this boy?' The relatives said, 'This boy is the son of Maitra, and he is also a daughter. Therefore let this boy's name be Maitrakanyaka.'

"Then the boy Maitrakanyaka was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to hold him in their laps, two nurses to suckle him, two nurses to wash away his dirt, and two nurses to play with him. The eight nurses raised and nourished him with milk, curds, butter, ghee, cream of butter, and every other kind of excellent provision, and he grew swiftly, like a lotus in a lake.

"His father went to the great ocean and died there. Then, when Maitrakanyaka had grown up, he said to his mother, 'Mother, by what work did my father make his living in the past? I wish to follow him and do the same.'

"His mother thought, 'If I tell him that his father traded on the great ocean, he too will likely go to the great ocean and die there.' So she said, 'Son, your father used to be a local trader. If you wish, you too should be a local trader.'

"So he took up the work of a local trader, and on the first day he earned four kārṣāpaṇas. He gave them to his mother, saying, 'Mother, give these as gifts to ascetics and brahmins, to the wretched and destitute, and to beggars.'

"Some time later someone else said, 'Your father used to trade in perfumes.' So he gave up local trading and dealt in perfumes, and he earned eight kārṣāpaṇas. These too he gave to his mother.

"Some time later yet another said, 'Your father used to trade in gold and silver.' So he gave up selling perfumes and dealt in gold and silver. On the first day he earned sixteen kārṣāpaṇas, and these too he gave to his mother. On the next day he earned thirty-two kārṣāpaṇas, and these too he gave to his mother.

"Then, some time later, the gold and silver merchants, being of jealous nature and realizing that the boy understood the ways of buying and selling in every place, said to him, 'Maitrakanyaka, your father traded on the great ocean. What need have you of this unrighteous livelihood? Who put you to the petty trading work of lowly people?'

"Then, spurred on by the words of the gold and silver merchants, he went to his mother and said, 'Mother, they say that my father used to trade on the great ocean. I too wish to go out onto the great ocean, so please give me your permission.'

"His mother said, 'My only son, that is true. But you are a child, and you are my only son. Do not leave me and go out onto the great ocean.'

"But, led on by bad friends of jealous nature, he could not be turned back. He did not listen to his mother's words. He had a bell rung throughout the city of Vārāṇasī, proclaiming, 'Hear me, merchants who live in Vārāṇasī! The caravan leader Maitrakanyaka is setting out on the great ocean. Those among you who wish to go out onto the great ocean together with the caravan leader Maitrakanyaka, without paying customs dues, without paying tolls at the passes, and without paying boat fares, make ready your goods for the voyage on the great ocean!' Then he performed the rites for good fortune, auspiciousness and well-being, and set out with a company of five hundred merchants. They loaded the goods for the voyage on the great ocean onto carts, into loads carried on the back, into sacks and into baskets, and onto camels, oxen and donkeys.

"His mother, out of the love in her heart, did not know what to do. With tears streaming and weeping, she went out, clasped his feet, and said, 'My only son, do not leave me and go out onto the great ocean!' Though she cried out, 'Have pity, have pity!' and 'Alas, alas!' and raised wailing and lamenting cries, he hardened himself, struck his mother on the head with his foot, and set out with the travelers. Then his mother said, 'Son, may you not experience the ripening of this deed!'

"After some time, having seen towns, provinces, royal capitals and great countries, he reached the shore of the great ocean. There he bought a ship for five hundred kārṣāpaṇas and hired the five kinds of men who work for wages: a captain, a bailer, a boatman, a keeper of the shore-finding birds, and a helmsman. Three times he had the bell rung, and then they set out onto the great ocean.

"After some time, a makara, a sea monster of the fish kind, wrecked the ship and capsized it. Maitrakanyaka caught hold of a plank and reached dry land. Then, as he went on and on across the land, he saw from far off a city called Ramaṇaka. When he approached it, after a while four daughters of the gods came out of it, handsome, pleasing to behold and beautiful. They said, 'Maitrakanyaka, come here! Welcome! These are our storehouses for food, our storehouses for drink, our storehouses for clothing, and our bedchambers. They are filled with jewels, pearls, beryl, conch, crystal, coral, and gold and silver of every kind. Come here, and let us enjoy ourselves!' And with them he enjoyed delight for many years, because he was one who had made merit, one who had done virtue, and one of great miraculous power and great might.

"Then they would not let him go along the road to the south. Because they would not let him go along that southern road, he wanted all the more to go that way. After some time he went south again and saw a city called Sadāmatta. When he came to its gate, after a while eight daughters of the gods came out of it as well, even more handsome, even more pleasing to behold, and even more beautiful. They said, 'Maitrakanyaka, come here! Welcome! These are our storehouses for food, our storehouses for drink, our storehouses for clothing, and our bedchambers. They are filled with jewels, pearls, beryl, conch, crystal, coral, and gold and silver of every kind. Come here, and let us enjoy ourselves!' And with them he enjoyed delight for many years, because he was one who had made merit, one who had done virtue, and one of great miraculous power and great might.

"Then again they would not let him go along the road to the south. Because they would not let him go along that southern road, he wanted all the more to go that way. After some time he went south again and saw a city called Nandana. When he came to its gate, after a while sixteen daughters of the gods came out of it as well, even more handsome, pleasing to behold, and even more beautiful. They said, 'Maitrakanyaka, come here! Welcome! These are our storehouses for food, our storehouses for drink, our storehouses for clothing, and our bedchambers. They are filled with jewels, pearls, beryl, conch, crystal, coral, and gold and silver of every kind. Come here, and let us enjoy ourselves!' And with them he enjoyed delight for many years, because he was one who had made merit, one who had done virtue, and one of great miraculous power and great might.

"Then again they would not let him go along the road to the south. Because they would not let him go along that southern road, he wanted all the more to go that way. After some time he went south again and saw a palace called Brahmottara. When he came to its gate, after a while thirty-two daughters of the gods came out of it as well, even more handsome, even more pleasing to behold, and even more beautiful. They said, 'Maitrakanyaka, come here! Welcome! These are our storehouses for food, our storehouses for drink, our storehouses for clothing, and our bedchambers. They are completely filled with jewels, pearls, beryl, conch, crystal, coral, and gold and silver of every kind. Come here, and let us enjoy ourselves!' And with them he enjoyed delight for many years, because he was one who had made merit, one who had done virtue, and one of great miraculous power and great might.

"Then again they would not let him go to the south. Because they would not let him go along that southern road, he wanted all the more to go that way, and the farther south he went, the more his desire grew. After some time he went south again and saw a fortress of iron. He went inside it, and as soon as he had gone in, its gate was shut. Then he went still farther in, and that gate too was shut. He went still farther in, and after a while he saw a huge man. On that man's head an iron wheel was turning, blazing, ablaze, utterly ablaze, one single mass of flame, and the pus and blood that dripped from his head was what he ate as his food.

"Maitrakanyaka asked that man, 'Hey, man, who are you?'

"He replied, 'I am one who harmed his mother.'

"As soon as the man had said this, Maitrakanyaka remembered that deed and thought, 'I too am one who harmed his mother. I too must have been led here by that very deed.'

"Then at that moment a voice came from the sky, saying, 'Let whoever is bound be freed, and let whoever is free be bound.' As soon as it had said this, the wheel vanished from that man's head and appeared on Maitrakanyaka's head.

"Then the man, seeing Maitrakanyaka tormented by suffering, spoke these verses:

'You went past the palaces
Of Ramaṇaka and Sadāmatta,
Of Nandana and Brahmottara.
Why then have you come here?'

"Maitrakanyaka said:

'I went past the palaces
Of Ramaṇaka and Sadāmatta,
Of Nandana and Brahmottara,
And came here through great desire.
Karma leads one far away;
From far away, too, karma leads one back.
Wherever karma ripens,
There karma leads one.
By what ripening of karma
Has this wheel that takes my life,

Blazing and ablaze,
Come to turn upon my head?'

"The man said:

'With a heart full of hatred
You struck with your foot the head
Of your mother, who did so much that was hard for you.
This is the fruit of that deed.'

"Maitrakanyaka said:

'For how many thousands of years
Will this wheel that takes my life,
Blazing and ablaze,
Turn upon my head?'

"The man said:

'For sixty thousand years
And sixty hundred more,
The blazing iron wheel
Will turn upon your head.'

"Maitrakanyaka said, 'Hey, will anyone else come here?'

"The man said, 'Whoever does such deeds as this will come.'

"Then Maitrakanyaka, oppressed by the feeling of suffering, gave rise to compassion for beings and said to the man, 'Hey, I wish to bear this wheel upon my head for the sake of all beings. May no one else who does such deeds as this ever come here!'

"As soon as he had said this, the wheel of the bodhisattva Maitrakanyaka rose up from his head and stayed in the sky at the height of seven palm trees. He died and was reborn among the Tuṣita gods.

"The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? I myself was the one who at that time, on that occasion, was Maitrakanyaka. Through the ripening of that deed, my trading and giving kārṣāpaṇas to my mother, I experienced great happiness in the four great cities. Through the ripening of that deed, the small harm I did my mother, I experienced such suffering. Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: you should honor your father and mother, and you should not harm them. Further, monks, you should train in this way: 'May

faults such as those that befell Maitrakanyaka while he was an ordinary being not arise, and may we attain such qualities as he had there when he became a god.'

"Why is that? Because, monks, a son's father and mother do much that is hard for him: they give him drink, nurture him, raise him, suckle him, and show him the many-colored world of Jambudvīpa. Even if a son were to carry his father and mother, one on his right shoulder and one on his left, for a hundred years, or were to make them sovereign rulers over this great earth filled with jewels, pearls, beryl, conch, crystal, coral, gold, silver, emerald, sapphire, ruby, right-coiling conches and the like, that alone would not repay his father and mother's kindness or benefit them. But when he leads his father and mother from lack of faith to perfect faith, trains them, settles them and establishes them in it; when he leads them from broken moral discipline to perfect moral discipline, from miserliness to perfect generosity, and from faulty wisdom to perfect wisdom, and trains them, settles them and establishes them in these, by that much a son repays his father and mother's kindness and benefits them."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Hare.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the royal court, guild masters, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshiped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, renowned, the Buddha, the Blessed One, endowed with great merit, received robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and supplies for the sick. Together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, he was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time there lived in Śrāvastī a guild master who was rich, with great wealth and great possessions, with vast and extensive holdings, possessed of wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He took a wife from a family of equal rank, and he played, made love, and took his pleasure with her. As he played, made love, and took his pleasure, after some time his wife conceived, and when eight or nine months had passed she gave birth. A boy was born, and he was nurtured and raised until he grew up.

Then his father's wealth ran out, and his possessions ran out as well. But he had a great circle of friends, relatives and kin, and from time to time he would send his son to stay with the relatives. The boy grew so close to those relatives that they became ever more fond of one another.

Some time later he went to the Jeta Grove, and there he saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and made beautiful by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo of light a fathom wide, possessed of light surpassing a thousand suns, like a moving mountain of jewels, beautiful in every way. On seeing him he became joyful, and bowing his head at the feet of the Blessed One, he sat before the Blessed One to listen to the Dharma. The Blessed One then taught him a Dharma that brings disenchantment with saṃsāra. Hearing it, he came to see the faults of saṃsāra and the virtues of nirvāṇa, and with the permission of his father and mother he went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One.

Having gone forth in this way, he kept company and stayed with those relatives. The Blessed One turned him away from mixing with householders and set him to dwelling in the wilderness, but he took no pleasure there. Three times the Blessed One turned him away from mixing with householders, saying, "Son, this mixing with householders has many faults. There are forms known by the eye that are pleasing, dear, delightful and attractive, that arouse desire and lead to attachment, and that are like thorns; and there are sounds known by the ear, smells known by the nose, tastes known by the tongue, and tangibles known by the body that are pleasing, dear, delightful and attractive, that arouse desire and lead to attachment, and that are like thorns." And in many ways he praised the virtues of the wilderness, where, if one settles there, wholesome qualities increase.

Then after some time that son of good family, relying on the Blessed One as his spiritual friend, and through constant diligence, practice and effort in dwelling in the wilderness, understood that this five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra is unstable and unsteady. He thoroughly ascertained that all kinds of formations are subject to decay, to falling, to scattering and to destruction. Abandoning all afflictions, he realized arhatship directly. As an arhat, free of desire for the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal, and his mind was like space and like the palm of the hand. He became cool, like sandalwood paste. With knowledge he had broken the eggshell of ignorance. He had attained the knowledges, the superknowledges and the analytical knowledges. He turned away from the gains of existence, from attachment

and from honors, and he became one worshiped, revered and respectfully addressed by the gods, together with Indra and Upendra.

Then he recalled his former lives, and seeing the extremely difficult deeds the Blessed One had done, he went to the Blessed One and with reverence praised and honored him.

Then doubt arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, see how the Blessed One turned this son of good family back from the village three times, set him to dwelling in the wilderness, and brought him all the way to arhatship."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, now that the Tathāgata is free of desire, free of aversion, free of delusion, completely liberated from birth, aging, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness and distress, omniscient, possessing omniscience, and has gained mastery over wisdom and over all that is to be known, what wonder is there in this, that I turned this son of good family back from the village three times, set him to dwelling in the wilderness, and brought him all the way to arhatship? In the past, when I was still with desire, with aversion and with delusion, when I was not yet completely liberated from birth, aging, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness and distress, I gave up my own life to turn this son of good family back from the village and set him to dwelling in the wilderness. Listen well and carefully, and keep it in mind, and I shall tell you.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in a mountain valley where water flowed and which was rich in flowers, fruits and rocks, there lived a sage who practiced fierce austerities. He lived on fruits, roots and water for food, wore deerskins and bark, and performed the fire offering. That sage had a friend, a hare who understood human speech. Every day the hare went to the sage three times. Going there, he would speak to him respectfully and delight him with all kinds of talk, and the two became ever closer friends, like father and son.

"Some time later a great drought came. Because of it the rivers and wells ran low on water, and the trees bore neither flowers nor fruit. Then that sage, having nothing to eat in that place, grew unhappy there, and he rolled up his deerskins and his bark garments. The hare, seeing him like this, asked, 'Great sage, where are you going?'

"The sage said, 'Now I am going to the village. There I will live on alms of cooked food.'

"Hearing the sage's words, the hare was stricken with grief, feeling as if he were being parted from his father. He bowed at the sage's feet and said, 'Please do not abandon me. After all, the household life is full of many faults, while the life of the wilderness is endowed with perfect virtues.' Though he said this many times, the sage could not be turned back.

"Then the hare said, 'If you really must go, then at least stay just for today, and tomorrow go as you please.'

"The sage thought, 'Those born as animals are fond of hoarding and of what they have stored up. Perhaps this one wants to offer me some kinds of food today.' And so he agreed.

"Then, when the day's tasks were done and evening had come, the hare came, circled the sage respectfully, and asked his forgiveness: 'Great sage, since I was born as an animal and do not know what should and should not be done, please forgive me for whatever small wrong I may have done you.' Having said this, without hesitation he leapt into the fire.

"The sage was dismayed. Weeping, he snatched him up as one would a beloved only son and said, 'Son, what are you doing?'

"The hare said, 'Great sage, because you delight in the life of the wilderness, eat my flesh and sustain yourself for one day. As for me:

For a hare born in the forest thickets,
What lentils, sesame or rice are there to give?
Roast this body of mine in the fire,
Eat it, and stay just today in the grove of austerities.'

"Hearing the hare's words, the sage was dismayed and said, 'If that is so, then for your sake, dear to my heart, and for the sake of the wilderness, dear to my heart, I would sooner give up my life right here. I will not go to the village.'

"Hearing these words, the hare's mind was filled with joy. Looking up into the sky, he made this prayer:

'If, since I came to the wilderness,
My mind has delighted in solitude,
By the power of this truthful word,
May the rain of Mahendra fall!'

"As soon as he had said this, by the power of the bodhisattva the abode of Mahendra shook in every direction. The gods turned the sight of their

knowledge downward, wondering what had caused it, and they saw that it was the power of the bodhisattva. Then, after a while, Śakra, lord of the gods, sent down the rain of Mahendra on that dwelling place, and once again grass, shrubs, herbs, flowers and fruits flourished in abundance.

"Then that sage, relying on the hare as his spiritual friend and staying on in that place, directly realized the five superknowledges. The sage said to the hare, 'Hey, hare, what do you intend to accomplish by this difficult practice, this diligence and this compassionate nature?'

"The hare said, 'May I become a buddha who, for a blind world without a guide and without a leader, brings across beings who have not crossed over, frees those who are not freed, consoles those who are not consoled, and brings to complete nirvāṇa those who have not passed into complete nirvāṇa.'

"Hearing these words, the sage said to the hare, 'When you become a buddha, remember me too.'

"The hare said, 'I shall do so.'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? I myself was the one who at that time, on that occasion, was the hare. The sage was none other than this son of good family. Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: you should keep to a virtuous spiritual friend, a virtuous companion and a virtuous support, and you should not keep to an evil friend, an evil companion or an evil support. Monks, you should train in this way."

Then the venerable Ānanda said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable One, here, when I was alone in solitude and absorbed in inward meditation, this thought came to my mind: 'A virtuous spiritual friend, a virtuous companion and a virtuous support are half of the holy life, but an evil friend, an evil companion and an evil support are not so.'"

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, do not say, 'A virtuous spiritual friend, a virtuous companion and a virtuous support are half of the holy life, but an evil friend, an evil companion and an evil support are not so.' Why is that? Ānanda, a virtuous spiritual friend, a virtuous companion and a virtuous support are the entire holy life: unmixed, complete, pure and cleansed. An evil friend, an evil companion and an evil support are not so. Why is that? Ānanda, it is because, by relying on a virtuous spiritual friend, beings subject to birth become completely free of being subject to birth, and beings subject to aging, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness and distress

become completely free of being subject to aging, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness and distress. Therefore, Ānanda, by this very line of reasoning you should understand it thus: a virtuous spiritual friend, a virtuous companion and a virtuous support are the entire holy life, unmixed, complete, pure and cleansed, and an evil friend, an evil companion and an evil support are not so. Ānanda, you should train in this way."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Dharmagaveṣin.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered and worshiped by kings, great ministers, wealthy men, people of the royal court, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshiped and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, who received robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was staying at Śrāvastī, together with the saṅgha of śrāvakas, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time the householder Anāthapiṇḍada would, as was his custom, rise early in the morning and go to see the Blessed One, and he would sweep the Jeta Grove with his own hands. Then, on a later occasion, the householder Anāthapiṇḍada had some business to attend to. So, in order to show sentient beings who desire merit a field of merit, the Blessed One himself took up a broom and began to sweep the Jeta Grove. When the great śrāvakas Śāriputra, Maudgalyāyana, Kāśyapa, Ānanda, Revata and others saw the Blessed One, they too joined in the sweeping.

When the Blessed One and the great śrāvakas had swept the Jeta Grove, they went to the assembly hall and sat down on the seats prepared in the midst of the saṅgha of monks. Having sat down, the Blessed One said to the monks, "Monks, these five are the benefits of sweeping. What are the five? One's own mind becomes joyful; the minds of others become joyful; the gods are pleased; one gathers roots of virtue that lead to beauty; and after the breakup of the body one is reborn among the gods in the happy realms, in the heavenly world."

Then Anāthapiṇḍada too came to that place. When he heard that the Blessed One, together with the great śrāvakas, had taken up brooms and swept the Jeta Grove, he thought, "How could I walk over the ground where the Blessed

One, together with the great śrāvakas, has swept with brooms?" And so Anāthapiṇḍada, his mind full of great scruple and shame, stayed right where he was.

Buddhas, the blessed ones, ask even though they know, and so the Blessed One said to the monks, "Who is this?"

The monks replied, "Venerable One, it is Anāthapiṇḍada. With a mind full of great scruple and shame before the Blessed One, he does not dare to tread with his feet upon the ground that the Blessed One, together with the great śrāvakas, has swept with brooms in the Jeta Grove, and so to come into the Blessed One's presence."

Then the Blessed One said to him, "Householder, the buddhas, the blessed ones, revere the Dharma, and the Dharma is the teacher of the arhats. So recite the words of the Buddha and come in!"

Then Anāthapiṇḍada, reciting verses, went into the Blessed One's presence. Having arrived, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat before him in order to listen to the Dharma. The Blessed One then instructed him with a talk on the Dharma, inspired him, filled him with enthusiasm and delighted him. When the Blessed One had instructed him with talks on the Dharma in many ways, inspired him, filled him with enthusiasm and delighted him, Anāthapiṇḍada left the Blessed One's presence.

Then doubts arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable Blessed One, it is wonderful that the Blessed One, having developed esteem and reverence for the Dharma, speaks nothing but praise of the Dharma."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what is there so wonderful in this: that now the Tathāgata, free of attachment, free of aversion, free of delusion, completely liberated from birth, aging, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness and distress, all-knowing, knowing all aspects, having gained mastery over all wisdom and all that is to be known, has developed esteem and reverence for the Dharma and speaks nothing but praise of the Dharma? In times past, even when I still had attachment, aversion and delusion, and was not yet completely liberated from birth, aging, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness and distress, I gave up my own life for the sake of the Dharma. Listen well and carefully, keep it in mind, and I shall explain it.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, a king called Brahmadatta ruled in the city of Vārāṇasī. In his reign the land was rich, prosperous, peaceful, with good harvests, and full of people and many inhabitants. Quarrels and fighting were stilled; it was free of strife, internal unrest, robbers, famine and disease; and it was rich in śāli rice, sugarcane, cattle and buffalo. Without causing harm, with its thorns cleared away, he cared for his kingdom as one cares for an only son. That king was full of faith, virtuous and good-hearted, devoted to his own benefit and the benefit of others, of great compassion, magnanimous, loving the Dharma, kind to his subjects, one who gave everything, relinquished everything, relinquished without attachment, and abided in great generosity.

"Then, on a later occasion, he played, delighted and made love with his queen. After he had played, delighted and made love with her, at a later time the queen became pregnant, and a longing arose in her mind: 'I wish to hear well-spoken words.' She told this to the king. The king summoned the soothsayers and spoke to them, and they replied, 'Your Majesty, this is the power of that being.'"

Then, in order to find someone who could speak well-spoken words, the king had ten million pieces of gold carried around the villages, towns, provinces and royal capitals, but even so those well-spoken words were not found. In time, when nine months had passed, a child was born: a boy who was handsome, pleasing to behold and lovely, of fine complexion and golden hue, with a head shaped like a parasol, long arms, a broad forehead, a high nose, a well-formed nose, and thick eyebrows, complete in all his limbs and lesser limbs. When he was born, a birth feast was held, and they set about naming him, asking, "What name shall we give the boy?" The ministers said, "Since this boy was seeking well-spoken words even before he was born, let this boy be named Subhāṣitagaveṣin, Seeker of Well-Spoken Words." So he was named Subhāṣitagaveṣin.

Then the boy Subhāṣitagaveṣin was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry him on their laps, two nurses to suckle him, two nurses to wash away his dirt, and two nurses to play with him. The eight nurses raised and nourished him with milk, curds, butter, ghee, the finest cream of ghee, and every other excellent provision, and he grew swiftly, like a lotus in a lake. When he had grown up, he too searched for well-spoken words, but did not find them.

After his father died, he was placed on the throne, and he commanded his ministers, "Leaders of the land, I need well-spoken words. Seek out

well-spoken words for me!" Then, in order to search for well-spoken words, the ministers displayed ten million pieces of gold throughout all of Jambudvīpa, but even so they did not find any well-spoken words. Then they reported this to the king, and the king, longing to hear well-spoken words, was tormented and despondent.

Now Śakra, lord of the gods, directs his vision of knowledge toward those below. Seeing that the king was deprived for want of hearing well-spoken words, he thought, "I shall test the king." So Śakra transformed himself into the guise of a yakṣa with hideous hands, feet and eyes, and before the king he spoke this verse:

Practice the Dharma of good conduct;
Do not engage in bad conduct.
In this world and in the next,
The one who practices the Dharma rests in happiness.

At this the king was filled with wonder, his face brightened, and he said to the yakṣa, "Guhyaka, speak that verse so that I may hear it. Speak it!"

The yakṣa said to the king, "If you do just as I tell you, then I too will do whatever you command."

The king said, "What is it you command of me?"

The yakṣa said, "For seven days and nights, kindle a fire of khadira wood in a fire pit. If you then leap into it yourself, I will recite the verse for you."

When the king heard this, he was glad at heart and said to the yakṣa, "I shall do so."

Then the king, having bound the yakṣa by a pledge, had it proclaimed with bells throughout the whole country: "Seven days from today, in order to hear well-spoken words, the king is resolved to throw himself into a fire pit. Whoever among you wishes to see this marvel, come here!"

Then, wishing to understand the bodhisattva's pure superior intention and to behold the marvel, many hundreds of thousands of people gathered, and many hundreds of thousands of gods assembled and took their places in the sky. In their midst the yakṣa rose into the sky and said to the bodhisattva, "Great king, do just as you promised!"

Then the king consecrated his eldest son as king, asked forgiveness of the ministers, the townspeople and the people of the country for his faults, and,

having comforted the multitude, went to the edge of the fire pit and spoke this verse:

For the sake of the Dharma I am resolved to leap into this pit of embers,
Blazing like a blood-red sun, utterly terrifying; I have no fear for my life.
By the power of my merit, may this fire pit truly become a most excellent pool,
Filled with cool water fragrant with sandalwood paste, and filled with lotuses.

Having spoken these words, the bodhisattva leapt into the fire pit, and the moment he leapt, that fire pit became a pool.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, seeing this marvelous miracle that inspires faith in gods and humans, made the form of the yakṣa vanish, appeared in his own form, and spoke the verse:

Practice the Dharma of good conduct;
Do not engage in bad conduct.
In this world and in the next,
The one who practices the Dharma rests in happiness.

Then the bodhisattva committed the verse to memory, had it written on golden tablets, and had it carried around all the villages, towns, provinces and royal capitals throughout the whole of Jambudvīpa.

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? I was the one who was the king at that time, on that occasion. If even then I gave up my own life in order to hear well-spoken words, what need is there to speak of now? Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We will honor the Dharma, revere it, respect it and venerate it; and having honored, revered, respected and venerated the Dharma, we will abide in reliance upon it.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Anāthapiṇḍada.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, respected and venerated by kings, chief ministers, the wealthy, citizens, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras and mahoragas. Worshiped and acknowledged by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit and a receiver of robes, alms food, bedding, seats, medicine for the sick and other requisites, was staying together with his community of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in

the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

Then, in the morning, the Blessed One put on his lower robe and his Dharma robe, took up his alms bowl, and went into Śrāvastī for alms. After some time, proceeding gradually, he came onto the highway, and a brahmin also came onto that highway. The brahmin saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, wholly excellent, like a moving mountain of jewels. When he had seen him, he looked him over for a very long time, then drew a line on the ground and said to the Blessed One, "O Gautama, until you give me five hundred kārṣāpaṇas, you shall not cross this line."

Then the Blessed One, in order to show that karma is never wasted and to turn beings away from taking what is not given, remained standing there like a door-post set firmly in the ground.

Then word spread throughout the whole of Śrāvastī: "On the highway a brahmin will not let the Blessed One go, for the sake of five hundred kārṣāpaṇas."

The moment Prasenajit, king of Kosala, heard of it, he went, attended by his host of ministers, to where the Blessed One was, and when he arrived he said to the Blessed One, "I will pay it. Please go on, Blessed One."

The Blessed One said, "Great king, these are not for you to give; they must be given by someone else."

In the same way Viśākhā, the mother of Mṛgāra, Ṛṣidatta, the chief of the queen's retinue, and Purāṇa, as well as the gods, Śakra, Brahmā and the rest, and Vaiśravaṇa and others, brought gold and silver and went before the Blessed One; and to them too the Blessed One said, "These are not for you to give either."

Then, after a while, the householder Anāthapiṇḍada heard of it. He placed five hundred kārṣāpaṇas on top of a golden basin filled with gold and silver, went before the Blessed One, and said, "Blessed One, please accept this."

The Blessed One said, "Householder, these are for you to give. Give them to the brahmin."

Then the householder Anāthapiṇḍada gave the brahmin the full golden basin.

Then the monks, having become doubtful, asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Blessed One, consider how this brahmin would not even let the Blessed One go, and Anāthapiṇḍada had to pay the kārṣāpaṇas. Blessed One, since when has this debt been owed to him?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, do you wish to hear?"

"Venerable One, we wish to hear."

"Monks, then listen well and closely, and keep it in mind, and I shall tell you.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in the city of Vārāṇasī, a king named Brahmadatta ruled the kingdom. In his reign the land was prosperous, flourishing, peaceful and abundant in harvests, and filled with many people and folk. Quarrels and fighting had been quelled, and there was no tumult, no internal strife, no robbers, no famine and no disease. It was rich in sāli rice, sugarcane, cattle and buffalo. Without harm, with its thorns cleared away, he protected the kingdom as one would care for an only son.

"Later, at a time when his son was acting as viceroy, in springtime, in a forest where the trees were in full bloom and geese, ruddy geese, peacocks, parrots, mynas, cuckoos and pheasants were singing, the prince, attended by the sons of ministers, played, delighted and made merry. He had a friend, the son of a minister, who played at dice with another man, a gambler, and that man beat the minister's son by five hundred kārṣāpaṇas. The king's son had stood surety for him, but being powerful, and thinking, 'I am the king's son,' he did not pay.

"Monks, what do you think? I was the one who was the king's son at that time, on that occasion. The minister's son was the householder Anāthapiṇḍada. The gambler was none other than this brahmin. Because I stood surety and then, thinking, 'I am the king's son,' did not give the kārṣāpaṇas to that gambler, I experienced endless poverty of wealth in saṃsāra, and even now, when I have fully and perfectly awakened to enlightenment, this man has pressed me for the debt.

"So, monks, deeds that are wholly black have a ripening that is wholly black; deeds that are wholly white have a ripening that is wholly white; and mixed deeds have a ripening that is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon wholly black deeds and mixed ones, and devote yourselves solely to deeds that are wholly white. Strive also to abandon taking what is not given. Monks, you should train in such a way that you never fall into a fault such as this."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, tenth section.

Subhadra.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, respected and venerated by kings, chief ministers, the wealthy, citizens, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras and mahoragas. Worshiped and acknowledged by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit and a receiver of robes, alms food, bedding, seats, medicine for the sick and other requisites, was staying together with his community of śrāvakas near the city of Kuśinagara, at Upavartana of the Mallas, in the grove of the twin sāla trees.

Then, at the very time when the Blessed One was about to pass into parinirvāṇa, he said to the venerable Ānanda, "Ānanda, tonight at midnight the Tathāgata will pass into parinirvāṇa in the sphere of nirvāṇa without remainder of the aggregates. Prepare the Tathāgata's couch between the twin sāla trees, with its head toward the north."

"Venerable One, I will do so," said Ānanda. Having heard what the Blessed One had told him, he prepared the couch between the twin sāla trees with its head toward the north, and then went to where the Blessed One was. When he arrived, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the venerable Ānanda said to the Blessed One, "Venerable One, the Tathāgata's couch has been prepared between the twin sāla trees, with its head toward the north."

Then the Blessed One went to where the couch was, and when he arrived he lay down on his right side, placing one foot upon the other, with the perception of light, mindful and vigilant, and fixed his mind solely on the perception of nirvāṇa.

At that time there was in the city of Kuśinagara a wandering ascetic named Subhadra. He was old, aged and advanced in years, a hundred and twenty years since his birth, and the Mallas living in the city of Kuśinagara honored, revered, respected and venerated him, and held him to be an arhat.

Then the wandering ascetic Subhadra heard, "Tonight at midnight the ascetic Gautama will pass into parinirvāṇa in the sphere of nirvāṇa without remainder of the aggregates," and he thought, "I have uncertainties and doubts about

certain matters, and I have hope that this Gautama can dispel my uncertainty." As soon as he heard it, he went to Kuśinagara, to where the twin sāla trees were.

At that time the wandering ascetic Subhadra saw the venerable Ānanda walking up and down on the walking path in the open ground outside the dwelling. Seeing the venerable Ānanda from afar, he went to where the venerable Ānanda was, and when he arrived, he exchanged with the venerable Ānanda, face to face, many kinds of pleasant and cordial talk, and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the wandering ascetic Subhadra said to the venerable Ānanda:

"O Ānanda, I have heard that tonight at midnight the ascetic Gautama will pass into parinirvāṇa in the sphere of nirvāṇa without remainder of the aggregates. I have uncertainties and doubts about certain matters, and I have hope that this Gautama can dispel my uncertainty. So, Ānanda, if it is no trouble to you, and if he would grant me the opportunity to answer my questions, I would come in and ask about a few points."

Ānanda said, "Subhadra, the Blessed One is weary; the Sugata is exhausted. Subhadra, let it be. Do not trouble the Blessed One."

A second and a third time the wandering ascetic Subhadra said to the venerable Ānanda, "O Ānanda, I have heard that tonight at midnight the ascetic Gautama will pass into parinirvāṇa in the sphere of nirvāṇa without remainder of the aggregates. I have uncertainties and doubts about certain matters, and I have hope that this Gautama can dispel my uncertainty. So, Ānanda, if it is no trouble to you, and if he would grant me the opportunity to answer my questions, I would come in and ask about a few points."

A second and a third time the venerable Ānanda said to the wandering ascetic Subhadra, "Subhadra, the Blessed One is weary; the Sugata is exhausted. Subhadra, let it be. Do not trouble the Blessed One."

Even so, the wandering ascetic Subhadra spoke once more to the venerable Ānanda: "O Ānanda, I have heard from the great teachers of old, the aged and venerable wandering ascetics of the various schools, that tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas appear in the world only very rarely, now and then, like the udumbara flower; so it is said. And now this Gautama will pass into parinirvāṇa tonight at midnight in the sphere of nirvāṇa without remainder of the aggregates. I have uncertainties and doubts about certain matters, and I have hope that this Gautama can dispel my uncertainty. So,

Ānanda, if it is no trouble to you, and if he would grant me the opportunity to answer my questions, I would come in and ask about a few points."

Then once again the venerable Ānanda said to the wandering ascetic Subhadra, "Subhadra, the Blessed One is weary; the Sugata is exhausted. Subhadra, let it be. Do not trouble the Blessed One."

The Blessed One, with his divine hearing, purified and surpassing that of humans, heard the conversation that the venerable Ānanda was having with the wandering ascetic Subhadra. Having heard it, he said to the venerable Ānanda:

"Ānanda, do not speak so. Do not hold back the wandering ascetic Subhadra; let him come in and allow him to ask whatever he wishes. This will be my last conversation with wandering ascetics of other, non-Buddhist (tīrthika) schools. This wandering ascetic Subhadra will also be the last of the śrāvakas in my own presence to whom it is said, 'Come, monk, practice the holy life.'"

Then the wandering ascetic Subhadra, given leave by the Blessed One, was glad, pleased, delighted and overjoyed, and with joy and happiness arising in him he went to where the Blessed One was. When he arrived, he exchanged with the Blessed One, face to face, many kinds of pleasant and cordial talk, and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the wandering ascetic Subhadra said to the Blessed One, "O Gautama, there are in the world various non-Buddhist schools, namely those of Pūraṇa Kāśyapa, the wandering ascetic Maskarin Gośālīputra, Sañjayin Vairaṭṭīputra, Ajita Keśakambala, Kakuda Kātyāyana, and Nirgrantha Jñātiputra. Have these each realized what they profess?"

Then the Blessed One spoke these verses:

I was twenty-nine years of age
When I went forth to seek what is wholesome.
Subhadra, since I went forth,
Fifty-one years have passed.
Moral discipline, concentration, knowledge and conduct
I have cultivated with a one-pointed mind.
Outside of this, among other ascetics,
There is not even one who speaks a part of the Dharma of reason.

"Subhadra, in whatever Dharma and Vinaya the noble eightfold path is not found, there is no first ascetic, nor is there a second, third or fourth ascetic.

Subhadra, in whatever Dharma and Vinaya the noble eightfold path is found, there is a first ascetic, and there are a second, third and fourth ascetic as well. Subhadra, since the noble eightfold path is found in this Dharma and Vinaya, the first ascetic is found here, the second is found here, the third is found here, and the fourth is found here. Outside of this there are no ascetics or brahmins; the opposing schools are empty of ascetics and brahmins. Thus do I rightly roar the lion's roar here in this assembly."

When this discourse on the Dharma had been spoken, the stainless, immaculate eye of Dharma regarding phenomena arose in the wandering ascetic Subhadra. The wandering ascetic Subhadra saw the Dharma, attained the Dharma, understood the Dharma and fathomed the depths of the Dharma; he crossed beyond uncertainty and crossed beyond doubt, and in the Teacher's teaching he no longer depended on others and was no longer led by others. Having gained fearlessness regarding the Dharma, he rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, bowed with joined palms toward where the Blessed One was, and said to the venerable Ānanda, "Venerable Ānanda, that the Great Teacher has consecrated you with the consecration of the Great Teacher's personal attendant is a great gain well gained by the venerable Ānanda. For my part too, if I could go forth, receive full ordination and attain the state of a monk in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya, it would be a great gain well gained."

Then the venerable Ānanda said to the Blessed One, "Venerable One, this wandering ascetic Subhadra wishes to go forth, receive full ordination and become a monk in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya."

Then the Blessed One said to the wandering ascetic Subhadra, "Come, monk, practice the holy life." By that very word the venerable one went forth; that was his full ordination, and that was his becoming a monk.

Having gone forth in this way, the venerable one dwelt alone in seclusion, heedful, ardent and resolute. He realized in this very life, through his own higher knowledge, the final goal of the unsurpassed holy life, for the sake of which sons of good family shave off their hair and beards, put on saffron robes, and with genuine faith go forth from home into homelessness. Having realized it, he accomplished and understood it, and fully knew, "My birth is exhausted, the holy life has been lived, what had to be done has been done, and I know no further existence beyond this." The venerable one became an arhat, his mind fully liberated.

Then the venerable Subhadra, having attained arhatship and experiencing the joy and bliss of liberation, thought, "It is not my part to witness the Teacher's parinirvāṇa; surely I must pass into parinirvāṇa before him." So the venerable Subhadra passed into parinirvāṇa first, and after that the Blessed One passed into nirvāṇa.

When the Blessed One, lying on his final bed, experiencing feelings that struck at his vital points, as his vital points were giving way and his joints were parting, established Subhadra in arhatship and brought many of the Mallas of the city of Kuśinagara to the Dharma, the monks became doubtful, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, it is wonderful that even while the Blessed One's vital points were giving way and his joints were parting, he freed this wandering ascetic Subhadra from the grip of saṃsāra and established him in the accomplishment that is the final and ultimate security, the bliss of nirvāṇa."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what is so very wonderful in this: that now, when I am free from attachment, free from aversion, free from delusion, and completely liberated from birth, old age, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness and agitation, I have freed the wandering ascetic Subhadra from the grip of saṃsāra and established him in the accomplishment that is the final and ultimate security, the bliss of nirvāṇa? In times past, when I still had attachment, aversion and delusion, and was not yet liberated from birth, old age, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness and agitation, even when I was born in the womb of an animal that does not know what should and should not be done, I gave up my own life and brought the wandering ascetic Subhadra and the Mallas of the city of Kuśinagara from fear to fearlessness. Listen well and closely to this, keep it in mind, and I shall tell you.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, there lived in a mountain valley the leader of a herd of deer, with a following of many thousands of deer; he was wise, clear-minded and of upright mind. A hunter spied out the herd of deer and reported it to the king. Then the king set out with his fourfold army and surrounded that whole herd of deer.

"Then the leader of the herd thought, 'If I simply keep these deer together here, today they will be wiped out entirely.' So the leader of the herd looked all around, wondering, 'On which side might this herd of deer escape?' He saw a river flowing through that valley. The river was swift and strong and swept

things away violently, and the deer were all weak.

"Then, without hesitating, the leader of the herd entered the river and stood in the middle of it, and called out, 'Come here! Leap from this bank, use my back as a stepping-place for your feet, and cross to the far bank. By this means I see that you will escape; if you do not do this, you will die.'

"The deer did just as he said. As they planted their hooves on his back, his hide was torn open, until all that remained of him was flesh, blood and bone. Yet, moved by compassion for those deer, he did not give up his effort. When all the deer had crossed, he thought, 'Surely none are left here who have not crossed?' Looking back, he saw a single fawn that had not yet crossed. Then the leader of the herd, though his vital points were giving way and his joints were parting, heedless of his precious life, came to the bank, took the fawn onto his back, carried it across the river and set it down on the bank. Seeing that the whole herd of deer had crossed, at the point of death he made this aspiration: 'Just as I have saved the precious lives of these deer and of this fawn, and protected them from loss, so in the future, when I have fully awakened to unsurpassed, perfect and complete enlightenment, may I also free them from the grip of saṃsāra.'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? I was the one who was the leader of the herd of deer at that time, on that occasion. The deer were these Mallas of the city of Kuśinagara. The fawn was none other than this Subhadra."

Then the monks became doubtful, and asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what deeds did Subhadra do, that he became the last of the śrāvakas in your presence?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, Subhadra himself, in other former lives, did and accumulated deeds that have reached their accumulation, whose conditions have matured, that come on like a flood, and that are certain to come. Who else would experience the deeds that Subhadra did and accumulated? Monks, deeds done and accumulated do not ripen in the outer earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element or the wind element. Wholesome and unwholesome deeds that have been done and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense bases.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen into their fruits.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in this very Fortunate Eon, when the lifespan of beings was twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, guide of beings to be tamed, unsurpassed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One named Kāśyapa. He was staying near the city of Vārāṇasī, at Ṛṣivadana in the Deer Park.

"Now a nephew of the Blessed One, the perfectly complete Buddha Kāśyapa, named Aśoka, wishing for liberation, went forth under the Blessed One; but he regarded liberation as something merely within his own power, and made no effort. After a long time had passed, Aśoka undertook to spend the rains retreat in the countryside.

"The Blessed One, the perfectly complete Buddha Kāśyapa, having carried out all the activities of a buddha, was lying on his final bed, like a fire whose wood is exhausted. The monk Aśoka, meanwhile, had entered into inner meditative seclusion at the foot of an aśoka tree. The god who dwelt in that aśoka tree heard that the Blessed One, the perfectly complete Buddha Kāśyapa, was about to pass into parinirvāṇa, and sat weeping, and the tears he shed as he wept fell onto Aśoka's body.

"Then Aśoka looked up and said to the weeping god, 'Divine one, why are you weeping?'

"The god said, 'Tonight at midnight the Blessed One, the perfectly complete Buddha Kāśyapa, will pass into parinirvāṇa.'

"When Aśoka heard the god's words, he was stunned, as if struck in a vital point, and he too wept in a pitiful voice."

"Then the god asked him, 'Why are you weeping?'

"Aśoka said, 'Because I am being parted from a kinsman and parted from a preceptor. The perfectly complete Buddha Kāśyapa is my maternal uncle, and so I simply lived at my ease and did not exert myself with diligence. Now he is a long way off, and I am left an ordinary person. Because the way is so long, I am unable to attain any distinction.'

"The god said, 'If I were to bring you into the presence of the Blessed One, would you be able to attain some distinction?'

"Aśoka said, 'I feel in my mind that the very moment I see the Blessed One, I will attain distinction.'

"Then, by the power of his miraculous abilities, the god carried Aśoka into the presence of the Blessed One. When Aśoka saw the Blessed One, joy arose in him. When joy had arisen in him, the Blessed One Kāśyapa taught him the Dharma in such a way that, on hearing it, he would directly realize arhatship, and he did directly realize arhatship. First the venerable Aśoka passed into parinirvāṇa, and after that the Blessed One, the perfectly complete Buddha Kāśyapa, passed into parinirvāṇa.

"Then the god, seeing that the venerable Aśoka had passed into parinirvāṇa, felt joy and made this resolve: 'Whatever distinction this venerable one has attained, all of it came about through me. In the same way, in time to come, the Blessed One, the perfectly complete Buddha Kāśyapa, will prophesy to the brahmin youth Uttara, "Brahmin youth, when the lifespan of beings is a hundred years, you will become the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Śākyamuni." When that Buddha lies down on his final bed, may I too become his last disciple in his own presence, and pass into parinirvāṇa before the Blessed One, and may the Blessed One Śākyamuni pass into parinirvāṇa after that.'

"Monks, what do you think? The one who was the god at that time, on that occasion, is this Subhadra. Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall keep to spiritual friends, good companions and good support, and we shall not keep to evil friends, evil companions and evil support.' Monks, that is how you should train."

Then the venerable Ānanda said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable One, while I was here alone in seclusion, absorbed in inner meditative concentration, this reflection arose in my mind: 'Spiritual friends, good companions and good support are half of the holy life; evil friends, evil companions and evil support are not so.'"

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, do not say, 'Spiritual friends, good companions and good support are half of the holy life; evil friends, evil companions and evil support are not so.' Why is that? Ānanda, spiritual friends, good companions and good support are the whole of the holy life, unmixed, completely perfect, completely pure and completely cleansed; evil friends, evil companions and evil support are not so. Why is that? Because, Ānanda, by relying on a spiritual friend, beings subject to birth are completely

freed from being subject to birth, and beings subject to aging, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness and distress are completely freed from being subject to birth, aging, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness and distress. Therefore, Ānanda, by this very line of reasoning you should understand it in this way: 'Spiritual friends, good companions and good support are the whole of the holy life, unmixed, completely perfect, completely pure and completely cleansed; evil friends, evil companions and evil support are not so.' Ānanda, that is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

From the Hundred Avadānas, the fourth group of ten under a summary verse, the Birth Stories of the Bodhisattva, is complete.

The summary verse:

The sugar mill, the food,
The water, and the pots of excrement,
Maudgalyāyana, the lower stream,
The one born blind, the merchant,
The sons, and the cesspit:
These are taught in this group.

The story called "The Sugar Mill."

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered and worshiped by kings, great ministers, wealthy householders, members of the royal court, guild leaders, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. The Buddha, the Blessed One, worshiped and acknowledged by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was staying together with his saṅgha of śrāvakas at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove, at the Kalandaka Feeding Ground.

When the Blessed One had become fully and perfectly awakened into unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening, the two, the venerable Śāriputra and Maudgalyāyana, made this vow: "Until we have freed at least one single being from among the hell beings, animals and hungry ghosts, we will not eat food."

Then, from time to time, those two venerable ones would sometimes go wandering among the beings of the hells.

At other times they would go wandering among the animals, and at other times they would go wandering among the hungry ghosts. There they heard the wretched cries of beings tormented by all kinds of harm, and when they returned from their wanderings they would tell the fourfold assembly about it. Those who heard it were stricken with weariness of saṃsāra. Then the two of them, having described this, would teach the Dharma in accordance with it, and so many beings, on hearing it, attained distinction, and it became an occasion for hearing the Dharma and for discussion.

Some time later, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, while wandering among the hungry ghosts, saw a hungry ghost whose belly was the size of a mountain and whose mouth was the size of the eye of a needle, covered by its own hair, blazing, flaring and blazing all around, burning as a single mass of flame, uttering cries of distress, experiencing intense, unbearable, burning and disagreeable feelings of suffering, and wandering around wherever there was excrement and urine, yet unable to find even that with ease.

Then the elder asked that hungry ghost, "Hey, what deed did you do, that you are now experiencing such intense, unbearable, burning and disagreeable feelings of suffering?"

The hungry ghost said, "When the sun has risen, there is no need for a lamp. Ask the Blessed One about this matter, and he will explain to you the nature of my deeds."

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana went to where the Blessed One was. At that time the Blessed One had arisen from inner meditative concentration and was teaching the fourfold assembly the Dharma, rich in flavor like unboiled honey, and an assembly of many hundreds, their senses unmoving, was listening to the Blessed One's Dharma, rich in its flavor.

Now, the buddhas, the blessed ones, speak openly and speak sweetly, saying, "Come, welcome!" and smiling first. So the Blessed One said this to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana: "Maudgalyāyana, come here. Welcome to you. Where have you come from just now?"

Maudgalyāyana replied, "Venerable One, I have come back from going wandering among the hungry ghosts. There I saw a hungry ghost whose belly was the size of a mountain and whose mouth was the size of the eye of a

needle, covered by its own hair, who seeks as food excrement that stinks, utterly stinks, that is foul, utterly foul, and yet cannot find even that with ease."

And he said further:

"Its great body is like a lofty mountain;
Its lips and throat are parched, and it is wretched in the extreme.
Its face covered by its own hair, it goes about naked;
The opening of its lips is as narrow as a needle's eye, and it is utterly emaciated.
Thus naked and covered by its hair,
Like a skeleton standing upright,
Carrying a skull, unbearable to behold,
It weeps and runs about everywhere.
Exhausted by hunger and by thirst,
Tormented by sufferings,
It utters cries of distress
And experiences feelings of suffering.
What dreadful evil did it commit
In the world of humans,
That because of it it has come to experience
Suffering as terrible as this?"

The Blessed One said, "Maudgalyāyana, that hungry ghost was a doer of evil deeds. Do you wish to hear the nature of its deeds?"

"Venerable One, I wish to hear it."

"In that case, Maudgalyāyana, listen well and closely, and keep it in mind, and I shall explain.

"Maudgalyāyana, long ago, in times past, in the city of Rājagṛha there lived a guild leader who was rich, had much wealth and great possessions, with broad and extensive holdings, possessed of wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He had five hundred places for pressing sugarcane, and in them his sugarcane was pressed.

"At times when buddhas do not appear in the world, pratyekabuddhas appear in the world, compassionate toward the wretched and destitute, living in remote dwellings, the sole worthy recipients of offerings in the world. At one time a pratyekabuddha had appeared, compassionate toward the wretched

and destitute and living in a remote dwelling. In the morning he put on his lower robe and his Dharma robe, took his alms bowl, and went into Rājagṛha for alms.

"That venerable one had been struck by a wasting illness, and a physician had advised him that sugarcane juice would help it, so he went to that great guild leader. The guild leader saw the pratyekabuddha, beautiful in body and beautiful in mind as well, and on seeing him the guild leader said, 'Noble one, what do you wish?'

"The pratyekabuddha said, 'Householder, I would like some sugarcane juice.'

"Then the householder instructed a workman, 'Offer the noble one some sugarcane juice,' and the householder himself set out on some business.

"Then that man grew miserly over another's property, thinking, 'If I give him sugarcane juice now, he will keep coming back here later.' Inclined toward the precipice of the three unpleasant destinies, having cast away the two destinies that all desire, having put the noble paths far from himself, he gave rise to an evil thought and said to the pratyekabuddha, 'Monk, hand me your bowl and I will give you sugarcane juice.'

"Arhats among the śrāvakas, and pratyekabuddhas, do not engage their vision of knowledge unless they turn their attention to something. Out of compassion for the wretched and destitute, he thought, 'I shall benefit this man,' and gave him the bowl. Then that man of wicked conduct, with no compassion in his heart, took it, went to a hidden place, and filled it with urine, covered the top with the froth of sugarcane juice, and offered it to the pratyekabuddha. The pratyekabuddha perceived what it was and thought, 'This wretched man has committed a great evil, and there is no help for it.' He went off to one side, poured it out, and went away."

The Blessed One said, "Maudgalyāyana, what do you think? The one who was the workman at that time, on that occasion, is this hungry ghost. Through the karmic maturation of that deed he experienced endless suffering in saṃsāra, and now too he has become a hungry ghost and is experiencing unbearable suffering. Therefore, Maudgalyāyana, so that faults such as that hungry ghost's may not arise, you should strive to abandon miserliness."

"Thus, Maudgalyāyana, entirely black deeds have an entirely black maturation; entirely white deeds have an entirely white maturation; and mixed deeds have a mixed maturation as well. Therefore, Maudgalyāyana, abandon

entirely black deeds and mixed ones, and devote yourself solely to entirely white deeds. Maudgalyāyana, that is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, along with gods, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas and others, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called "Food."

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered and worshiped by kings, great ministers, wealthy householders, members of the royal court, guild leaders, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. The Buddha, the Blessed One, worshiped and acknowledged by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was staying together with his saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana was sitting at the foot of a tree for his daytime rest, and the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana heard the voice of a female hungry ghost, crying out in distress and experiencing intense, unbearable, burning and disagreeable feelings of suffering. Begging for food, she was saying, "Friends, I am hungry! Friends, I am thirsty!"

Then the elder Mahāmaudgalyāyana saw that female hungry ghost and asked her, "What deed did you do, that you are now experiencing sufferings such as these?"

The female hungry ghost said, "When the sun has risen, there is no need for a lamp. Ask the Blessed One about this matter, and he will explain to you the nature of my deeds."

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana went to where the Blessed One was. At that time the Blessed One had arisen from inner meditative concentration and was teaching the fourfold assembly the Dharma, rich in flavor like unboiled honey, and an assembly of many hundreds, their senses unmoving, was listening to the Blessed One's Dharma, rich in its flavor.

Now, the buddhas, the blessed ones, speak openly and speak sweetly, saying, "Come, welcome!" and smiling first. So the Blessed One said this to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana: "Maudgalyāyana, come here. Welcome to you. Where have you come from just now?"

Maudgalyāyana replied, "Venerable One, I have come back from going wandering among the hungry ghosts. There I saw a female hungry ghost whose belly was the size of a mountain and whose mouth was the size of the eye of a needle, covered by her own hair, going naked and crying out in distress, experiencing intense, unbearable, burning and disagreeable feelings of suffering."

And he said further:

"Her great body is like a lofty mountain;
Her lips and throat are parched, and she is wretched in the extreme.
Her face covered by her own hair, she goes about naked;
The opening of her lips is as narrow as a needle's eye, and she is utterly emaciated.
Thus naked and covered by her hair,
Like a skeleton standing upright,
Carrying a skull, unbearable to behold,
She weeps and runs about everywhere.
Exhausted by hunger and by thirst,
Tormented by sufferings,
She utters cries of distress
And experiences feelings of suffering.
What dreadful evil did she commit
In the world of humans,
That because of it she has come to experience
Suffering as terrible as this?"

The Blessed One said, "Maudgalyāyana, that female hungry ghost was a doer of evil deeds. Do you wish to hear the nature of her deeds?"

"Venerable One, I wish to hear it."

"In that case, Maudgalyāyana, listen well and closely, and keep it in mind, and I shall explain.

"Maudgalyāyana, long ago, in times past, in this very Fortunate Eon, when the lifespan of beings was twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, the unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One called Kāśyapa. He was staying near the city of Vārāṇasī, at Ṛṣivadana in the Deer Park.

"Now in that city of Vārāṇasī there was the wife of a certain householder who was miserly and stingy, clinging to all her possessions. She would not give even a bali offering to the crows, so what need is there to speak of other beggars? Whenever she saw ascetics, brahmins, the wretched and destitute, or the hungry, she felt hatred in her mind.

"One day a monk on his alms round came to her house. When she saw him, miserliness arose in her and her mind turned to hatred, and she thought, 'If I show him respect, he will keep coming back here later.' Then that wicked woman, disregarding the unpleasant consequences in her next life, called the monk inside, shut the door, and made him go without food. She reviled him at length as well, saying, 'Monk, this is the disrespect done to you. From now on, do not come to this house!'

"Then, because she had indulged in miserliness, cultivated it and made much of it, she was reborn as a hungry ghost, and experiences sufferings such as these.

"Therefore, Maudgalyāyana, so that faults such as that female hungry ghost's may not come about, you should strive to abandon miserliness."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Maudgalyāyana, along with gods, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas and others, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called "Water."

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered and worshiped by kings, great ministers, wealthy householders, members of the royal court, guild leaders, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. The Buddha, the Blessed One, worshiped and acknowledged by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was dwelling together with his saṅgha of śrāvakas at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove, at the Kalandaka Feeding Ground.

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, while wandering among the hungry ghosts, saw a female hungry ghost like a tree stump scorched by fire, covered by her own hair, her belly the size of a mountain and her mouth the size of the eye of a needle, blazing, flaring and blazing all around, burning as a single mass of flame, crying out in distress, tormented by thirst, experiencing intense, unbearable, burning and disagreeable feelings of suffering. At her

mere glance, rivers and wells would dry up, and whenever rain fell, a rain of embers shooting out sparks fell upon her.

On seeing her, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana said to her, "Hey, what evil did you do, that you are now experiencing suffering such as this?"

The female hungry ghost said, "Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, I was a doer of evil. Ask the Buddha, the Blessed One, about this matter, and he will explain to you the nature of my deeds. When they hear it, other beings too will give up evil deeds."

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana went to where the Blessed One was. At that time the Blessed One had arisen from inner meditative concentration and was teaching the fourfold assembly the Dharma, rich in flavor like unboiled honey, and an assembly of many hundreds, their senses unmoving, was listening to the Blessed One's Dharma, rich in its flavor.

Now, the buddhas, the blessed ones, speak openly and speak sweetly, saying, "Come, welcome!" and smiling first. So the Blessed One said this to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana: "Maudgalyāyana, come here. Welcome to you. Where have you come from just now?"

Maudgalyāyana replied, "Venerable One, I have come back from going wandering among the hungry ghosts. There I saw a female hungry ghost like a tree trunk scorched by fire, covered by her own hair, her belly the size of a mountain and her mouth the size of the eye of a needle, blazing, flaring and blazing all around, burning as a single mass of flame, crying out in distress, tormented by thirst, experiencing intense, unbearable, burning and disagreeable feelings of suffering. At her mere glance, rivers and wells dry up, and whenever rain falls, a rain of embers shooting out sparks falls upon her."

The Blessed One said, "Maudgalyāyana, that female hungry ghost was a doer of evil. Do you wish to hear the nature of her deeds?"

"Venerable One, I wish to hear it."

"In that case, Maudgalyāyana, listen well and closely, and keep it in mind, and I shall explain.

"Maudgalyāyana, long ago, in times past, in this very Fortunate Eon, when the lifespan of beings was twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, the unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed

One called Kāśyapa.

"While he was dwelling near the city of Vārāṇasī, at Ṛṣivadana in the Deer Park, a monk there set out on the road and became tormented by thirst. He went to a well, where a young woman was sitting with a pitcher filled with water, and the monk said to her, 'Sister, I am tormented by thirst. Please give me some water.'

"But she clung to her possessions, and miserliness arose in her, and she said to the monk, 'Monk, my pitcher would be diminished. Even if you die, I will not give you water.'

"Then the monk, still tormented by thirst, went away in despair.

"Then, because that young woman had indulged in miserliness, cultivated it and made much of it, she died and was reborn as a hungry ghost, and she is experiencing such intense, unbearable, burning and disagreeable feelings of suffering.

"Therefore, Maudgalyāyana, you should train in this way: 'We shall strive in order to abandon miserliness.' Maudgalyāyana, that is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, along with gods, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas and others, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, the eleventh section.

The story called "The Pot of Excrement."

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered and worshiped by kings, great ministers, wealthy householders, members of the royal court, guild leaders, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. The Buddha, the Blessed One, worshiped and acknowledged by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was dwelling together with his saṅgha of śrāvakas at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove, at the Kalandaka Feeding Ground.

Then, in the morning, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana put on his lower robe and his Dharma robe, took his alms bowl, and went into Rājagṛha for alms. Having gone on his alms round in Rājagṛha and eaten his meal, he gave up taking any further food, put away his bowl and robe, and went to Vulture Peak. When he arrived, he climbed Vulture Peak and sat at the foot of a tree

for his daytime rest.

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana saw a female hungry ghost like a tree stump scorched by fire, naked and covered by her own hair, her belly the size of a mountain and her mouth the size of the eye of a needle, blazing, flaring and blazing all around, burning as a single mass of flame, crying out in distress, experiencing intense, unbearable, burning and disagreeable feelings of suffering. She ate as her food excrement, stinking and utterly stinking like excrement, and yet could not find even that with ease.

When he saw her, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana was saddened, and he asked the female hungry ghost, "What evil did you do in the past, that you are now experiencing such a result?"

The female hungry ghost said, "Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, I was a doer of evil. Ask the Buddha, the Blessed One, about this matter, and he will explain to you the nature of my deeds. When they hear it, other beings too will give up evil deeds."

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana went to where the Blessed One was. At that time the Blessed One had arisen from inner meditative concentration and was teaching the fourfold assembly the Dharma, rich in flavor like unboiled honey, and an assembly of many hundreds, their senses unmoving, was listening to the Blessed One's Dharma, rich in its flavor.

Now, the buddhas, the blessed ones, speak openly and speak sweetly, saying, "Come, welcome!" and smiling first. So the Blessed One said this to the venerable Maudgalyāyana: "Maudgalyāyana, come here. Welcome to you. Where have you come from just now?"

Maudgalyāyana replied, "Venerable One, while I was going wandering among the hungry ghosts, I saw there a female hungry ghost like a tree stump scorched by fire, naked and covered by her own hair, her belly the size of a mountain and her mouth the size of the eye of a needle, blazing, flaring and blazing intensely, burning as a single mass of flame, crying out in distress, experiencing intense, unbearable, burning and disagreeable feelings of suffering. At her mere glance, rivers and wells dry up, and whenever rain falls, a rain of embers shooting out sparks falls upon her. She seeks as her food excrement, stinking and utterly stinking like excrement, and yet cannot find even that with ease."

And he said further:

"She utters cries of distress
And experiences feelings of suffering.
Wherever there is a place of excrement,
There she runs, wretched as she is.
When she longs to eat or drink excrement,
Even that she cannot easily find.
What dreadful evil did she commit
In the world of humans,
That because of it she experiences
Suffering as terrible as this?"

The Blessed One said, "Maudgalyāyana, that female hungry ghost was a doer of evil. Do you wish to hear the nature of her deeds?"

"Venerable One, I wish to hear it."

"In that case, Maudgalyāyana, listen well and closely, and keep it in mind, and I shall explain.

"Maudgalyāyana, long ago, in times past, in the city of Vārāṇasī there lived a pratyekabuddha, compassionate toward the wretched and destitute and living in a remote dwelling. He was unwell, and he went into Vārāṇasī for alms. On one occasion a physician had prescribed suitable food for him, and he went to where a certain guild leader lived. The guild leader saw him and asked, 'Noble one, what do you wish?'

"He said, 'I would like some suitable food.'

"Then the guild leader instructed his daughter-in-law, 'Offer the noble one some suitable food.'

"Then miserliness arose in his daughter-in-law, and she thought, 'If I give him food today, he will come back tomorrow as well.' She went off to one side, filled the bowl with excrement, covered the top with rice, and offered it to the pratyekabuddha.

"Śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas do not engage their vision of knowledge unless they turn their attention to something, so he accepted it. Having accepted it, he perceived what it was and thought, 'Since this stinks, she must certainly have filled it with excrement.' Then that great being threw it away somewhere and left."

The Blessed One said, "Maudgalyāyana, what do you think? The one who was the guild leader's daughter-in-law at that time, on that occasion, is this female

hungry ghost. Having committed such an evil deed, from then on she has always been born among the hell beings, animals and hungry ghosts, and has always eaten excrement as her food.

"Therefore, Maudgalyāyana, strive to abandon miserliness, so that faults such as that female hungry ghost's may not come about. Maudgalyāyana, that is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Maudgalyāyana, and the others as well, the gods, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas and so forth, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Maudgalyāyana.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed and worshipped by kings, by great ministers, by the wealthy, by the townspeople, by guild leaders, by caravan leaders, by gods, by nāgas, by yakṣas, by asuras, by garuḍas, by kinnaras and by mahoragas. Worshipped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, renowned, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, food, bedding, seats, medicines for the sick and other requisites, the Buddha, the Blessed One, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove, at the Kalandaka Feeding Ground.

At that time, beyond Rājagṛha and on this side of the Bamboo Grove, in the space between them, there were hungry ghosts like charred tree stumps, naked and covered only by their own hair, with bellies the size of mountains and mouths the size of a needle's eye. They were burning, blazing, blazing all over, ablaze as a single mass of flame, and as they burned they cried out in misery. Experiencing feelings that were fierce, harsh, burning and disagreeable, five hundred of them wheeled about in the sky like a hovering flock of crows, finding nowhere at all to rest.

Then in the morning the venerable Maudgalyāyana put on his lower robe and his Dharma robe, took his alms bowl, and went into Rājagṛha for alms, and he saw those hungry ghosts. The hungry ghosts too saw the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana. Then, crowding together, they went up to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, and crying out, "Pity, pity!" and "Misery, misery!" and wailing, they spoke with one voice:

"Venerable Maudgalyāyana, we were five hundred guild leaders in Rājagṛha. We were miserly and stingy, clinging to our possessions. Not only did we give

no gifts ourselves, we also obstructed others who were giving. We often reviled those worthy of gifts with words such as 'hungry ghost,' saying, 'You prowl around other people's houses like those born as hungry ghosts.' Because of that, after we died we were born as hungry ghosts such as these. Therefore, great venerable Maudgalyāyana, please make known to our relatives who live in Rājagṛha the nature of our deeds, and rouse their faith, and have them invite the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha to a meal and have the dedication of the offering recited for our sake. Then perhaps we may be freed from birth as hungry ghosts. Please tell them this."

The venerable Maudgalyāyana consented to the hungry ghosts by remaining silent. Then the venerable Maudgalyāyana went from house to house among their relatives, rousing their faith, and they invited the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha to a meal on the following day. He also informed the hungry ghosts, saying, "The Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of monks has been invited to a meal, so you too must come there." And to their relatives he said, "You too must come, and at the feast you are holding for your kin you will see those hungry ghosts." Then the venerable Maudgalyāyana himself took charge of overseeing the feast.

When dawn came the food was set out, but when midday arrived those hungry ghosts did not appear. Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana searched for those hungry ghosts with his divine eye, but they were not to be seen anywhere in the whole land of Magadha. He looked further and further, as far as the four continents, but they were not to be seen there either. Then he looked as far as the vision of his wisdom could reach, yet they were not to be seen there either.

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana grew dismayed and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, those patrons of mine are nowhere to be found."

The Blessed One said, "Maudgalyāyana, let it be; do not be dismayed. There are countless world systems that lie beyond the range of all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and they have been hurled into these by the wind of karma. Nevertheless, Maudgalyāyana, today behold the power of the Tathāgata. I shall make manifest the vision of omniscient wisdom, and I shall also display the miraculous transformation of the Tathāgata. Strike the gong."

When the gong was struck, the whole Saṅgha of monks assembled, and the relatives of the hungry ghosts and other beings who wished to see the hungry ghosts also came to watch the spectacle and gathered there. Then the Blessed

One displayed a miracle of such a kind that the hungry ghosts would see the Buddha, the Blessed One, together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas being served the meal, and would come to recall, "Our relatives are serving a meal to the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha for our sake, and they are seated here."

Then, with his voice endowed with five qualities, the Blessed One spoke the dedication of the offering:

"Whatever merit there is from this gift,
May it go after the hungry ghosts;
From the terrifying world of hungry ghosts
May they swiftly be set free!"

So he spoke. Then, on that basis, the Blessed One taught the Dharma in keeping with it, and when they had heard it, many hundreds of thousands of living beings abandoned the stain of miserliness and came to see the truths. Those hungry ghosts too became gladdened in mind toward the Blessed One, and when they died they were born in the excellent divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three.

It is the nature of things that not long after a god's son or a god's daughter is born, three thoughts arise in their mind: "From where have I died and passed on? Where have I been born? By what karma have I been born?"

They saw that they had died and passed on from among the hungry ghosts, that they had been born in the excellent divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, and that this was because their minds had become gladdened toward the Blessed One. Then those sons of the gods who had formerly been hungry ghosts thought, "It is not fitting for us to wait until the night has passed and only then go to see the Blessed One. We shall go to see the Blessed One before the night has passed."

Then those sons of the gods who had formerly been hungry ghosts, wearing earrings and bracelets that jingled and swayed, their bodies adorned with necklaces and half-necklaces, wearing diadems studded with all kinds of jewels, their bodies anointed with saffron, tamāla leaves, spṛkkā and the like, that very night filled their laps with divine flowers, utpalas, lotuses, kumudas, white lotuses and māndāravas. They lit up the whole of the Bamboo Grove at the Kalandaka Feeding Ground with a great radiance, strewed the flowers over the Blessed One, and sat down before the Blessed One in order to hear the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, understanding the inclinations, latent tendencies, constituents and natures of those sons of the gods who had formerly been hungry ghosts, taught them the Dharma in keeping with these. When they had heard it, those sons of the gods who had formerly been hungry ghosts attained a great distinction. Like merchants who have made a profit, they circumambulated the Blessed One three times and vanished on the spot.

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, "Maudgalyāyana, you established many hungry ghosts among the gods, and last night they came to me. I taught them the Dharma, and they gained what was to be gained, gained the vision of the truth, and departed. The oversight you undertook has borne fruit. Excellent, excellent!"

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana made this known to their relatives as well. When they heard it they were utterly amazed, their minds became gladdened toward the Blessed One, and they paid him honor.

"Therefore, Maudgalyāyana, you should strive to abandon miserliness, so that faults such as those of these hungry ghosts may not come about."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, and the others as well, the gods, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas and so forth, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Uttara.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed and worshipped by kings, by great ministers, by the wealthy, by the townspeople, by guild leaders, by caravan leaders, by gods, by nāgas, by yakṣas, by asuras, by garuḍas, by kinnaras and by mahoragas. Worshipped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, renowned, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, food, bedding, seats, medicines for the sick and other requisites, the Buddha, the Blessed One, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove, at the Kalandaka Feeding Ground.

At that time there lived in the city of Rājagṛha a guild leader who was rich, with much wealth and great means, with vast and extensive holdings, possessed of wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling Vaiśravaṇa in wealth. He took a wife from a family of equal standing, and he played with her, enjoyed himself and made love. From his playing, enjoying himself and making love, his wife conceived, and after eight or nine months had passed she gave birth to a boy.

When the boy was born they held a birth celebration for him, and when it came to naming him they asked, "What name shall we give this boy?" His relatives said, "Since this boy was born under the lunar mansion Uttarāṣāḍhā, let his name be Uttara." And so they named him Uttara.

Then the boy Uttara was raised and nourished until he grew up, and when his father died he became the master of his own household. He set up a shop in the market and traded, making his living by buying and selling, and every day he would go to the Blessed One. By seeing the Blessed One and hearing the true Dharma, he gained faith in the Blessed One's teaching, and the wish to go forth arose in him. He made this request to his mother: "Mother, I wish to go forth in the teaching of the Blessed One. Please give me your permission."

His mother replied, "Son, you are my only son. Do not go forth as long as I live. After I die, do whatever you wish."

So Uttara gave everything he earned to his mother, saying, "Mother, give gifts with this to śramaṇas and brahmins, and to the wretched, the needy and the destitute."

But his mother was greedy and stingy, clinging to her possessions. She hid those kārṣāpaṇa coins, and whenever monks or brahmins came to the house wanting food, she abused them, saying, "You go prowling around houses begging, like those born as hungry ghosts." She also deceived her son, saying, "Every day I give food to such and such a number of monks."

Some time later she died and was born as a hungry ghost, and her son Uttara mourned at being parted from his mother.

He gave gifts and made merit, and then went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One. Through striving, effort and exertion he understood that this five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra is moving and unstable. He fully ascertained that all kinds of formations are by nature subject to decay, to falling, to scattering and to destruction, and having abandoned all afflictions he directly realized arhatship. As an arhat, free from attachment to the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal; he had a mind like space and like the palm of his hand; he had become cool like sandalwood paste; he had broken the eggshell of ignorance with knowledge and attained the knowledges, the superknowledges and the analytical knowledges; he paid no heed to worldly gain, desire or honor; and he became worthy of the worship, veneration and respectful address of the gods together with Indra and Upendra. He made a hut of leaves on the bank of the river Ganges and

meditated there.

His mother, who had been born in the world of hungry ghosts, was like a charred tree stump, naked and covered only by her own hair, with a belly the size of a mountain and a mouth the size of a needle's eye. Burning, blazing, blazing all over, ablaze as a single mass of flame, she cried out in misery, and she went to the venerable Uttara. Then Uttara saw the female hungry ghost and asked her, "Who are you, looking like this?"

The female hungry ghost said:

"I am the loving mother
From whom you, my only son, were born.
I have been born among the hungry ghosts,
Deprived of food and drink.
Since the time of my death
Twenty-five years have passed;
I have not seen even a trace of water,
So how could I ever see food?
When I go to the foot of trees bearing fruit,
They become fruitless;
Even when I go to the shores of brimming lakes,
They too dry up.
Reverend one, the shade at the foot of your tree is pleasant,
And the water in your vessel is cool.
Take pity on me, destitute as I am;
I am tormented by thirst: give me water!"

Then Uttara said to his mother, "Mother, when you were human, did I not have you give gifts and make merit?"

The female hungry ghost said, "My only son, overcome by miserliness I gave no gifts and made no merit. With an evil mind I hid all the wealth I received in a pit. Therefore, my only son, rouse the faith of others, and for my sake invite the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha to a meal and request that the dedication of the offering be recited. Then perhaps I may be freed from birth as a hungry ghost."

Uttara said, "I will do so. And you too must sit in front of the elder at the head of the row."

The female hungry ghost said, "My only son, I am naked, and I am ashamed; I could not bear it."

Uttara said, "Mother, at the time you were doing evil you were not ashamed. Why are you ashamed now, when you are experiencing its result?"

The female hungry ghost said, "Then I shall come, just as you say."

Then Uttara went from house to house among his relatives rousing their faith, and they invited the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha to a meal on the following day. When midday came, the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha assembled, and the female hungry ghost sat in front of the elder at the head of the row. The many hundreds of thousands of living beings who had gathered saw the female hungry ghost. When they saw the repulsive body of the female hungry ghost, a deep weariness with saṃsāra arose in them, and their minds became gladdened toward the Blessed One.

Then the venerable Uttara, having satisfied the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha with fine food, requested that the dedication of the offering be recited for the female hungry ghost. Then the Blessed One himself, with his voice endowed with five qualities, spoke the dedication of the gift:

"Whatever merit there is from this gift,
May it go after the hungry ghost;
From the terrifying world of hungry ghosts
May she swiftly be set free!"

So he spoke. Then, on that basis, the Blessed One taught the female hungry ghost and many people the Dharma in keeping with it, and when they had heard it, many hundreds of thousands of living beings came to see the truths. The female hungry ghost too became gladdened in mind, and when she died she was born as a hungry ghost of great magical power. The venerable Uttara knew that she had been born as a hungry ghost of great magical power.

Then the venerable Uttara said, "Mother, now that you have power, give gifts generously."

The hungry ghost of great magical power said, "My only son, I take no delight in giving; I cannot do it."

Then the venerable Uttara said to the hungry ghost of great magical power:

"Your eyes were thoroughly veiled by the darkness of craving,
And so you brought about the world of hungry ghosts.

Your great bones without flesh,
Your bones, your skin and your hide, remain even now."

Then, after the venerable Uttara had spoken to her many times, reproaching her, he afterward obtained a pair of cloths from her. Uttara offered them to the Saṅgha, and the monk who acquired the pair of cloths from the Saṅgha placed it on his clothes rack. Then the female hungry ghost came at night and stole it. The monk reported this to the venerable Uttara, and Uttara went, reproached the female hungry ghost, took it back, and gave it to him. In the same way, three times she stole it from the monk, and three times the venerable Uttara took it back and gave it to him. Then the monk cut it up and patched it onto a seat for the Saṅgha of monks of the four directions, and after that she stole it no more.

Therefore, seeing how miserliness thus brings beings to grief, one should strive to abandon miserliness, so that faults such as those of that female hungry ghost may not come about.

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks, and the others as well, the gods, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas and so forth, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Blind Woman.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed and worshipped by kings, by great ministers, by the wealthy, by the townspeople, by guild leaders, by caravan leaders, by gods, by nāgas, by yakṣas, by asuras, by garuḍas, by kinnaras and by mahoragas. Worshipped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, renowned, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, food, bedding, seats, medicines for the sick and other requisites, the Buddha, the Blessed One, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

Then in the morning the venerable Nandana put on his lower robe and his Dharma robe, took his alms bowl, and went into Śrāvastī for alms. When he had gone on his alms round in Śrāvastī and eaten his meal, he refrained from taking any food afterward, put away his alms bowl and robe, and went wandering through the realm of the hungry ghosts. There the venerable Nandana saw a female hungry ghost like a charred tree stump, blind, covered by her own hair, with a belly the size of a mountain and a mouth the size of a

needle's eye. Foul smelling like a charnel ground, she was surrounded by crows, vultures, dogs and jackals, which tore and tore at her flesh from every side and devoured it. Struck in her vital points, in extreme agony, she cried out in misery, and she remained there experiencing suffering that was fierce, harsh, burning and disagreeable.

Then the venerable Nandana, dismayed, asked her, "Sister, what evil deed did you do in the past, that you are experiencing suffering such as this?"

The female hungry ghost said, "When the sun has risen there is no need for a lamp. Ask the Blessed One about this matter, and he will explain to you the nature of my deeds. When they hear it, other beings too will abandon evil."

Then the venerable Nandana went to where the Blessed One was. At that time the Blessed One had risen from his meditative absorption and was teaching the four assemblies a Dharma full of flavor, like pure honey from the bees, and an assembly of many hundreds, their senses unmoving, was listening to the Dharma full of flavor from the Blessed One.

Now the buddhas, the blessed ones, speak clearly, speak pleasantly, say "Come, welcome!", and smile before they speak. So the Blessed One said this to the venerable Nandana: "Nandana, come; welcome to you. Where have you come from just now?"

Nandana said, "Reverend, I have come from where the hungry ghosts wander. There I saw a female hungry ghost like a charred tree stump, blind, covered by her own hair, with a belly the size of a mountain and a mouth the size of a needle's eye. Foul smelling like a charnel ground, she was surrounded by crows, vultures, dogs and jackals, which tore and tore at her flesh from every side and devoured it. Struck in her vital points, in extreme agony, she cried out in misery, and she remained there experiencing suffering that was fierce, harsh, burning and disagreeable."

And he said further:

"Her great body is like a lofty mountain;
Her lips and throat are parched; she is utterly wretched.
Her face covered by her own hair, she goes naked;
Her mouth is narrow like a needle's eye; she is utterly emaciated.
Naked like this, covered by her hair,
Like a contraption of bones set upright,
She carries a skull cup, dreadful to see,

And runs about everywhere, weeping.
Worn out by hunger and thirst
And afflicted by sufferings,
She cries out in misery
And experiences painful feelings.
What terrible evil did she commit
In the world of humans,
That she should now experience
Suffering as frightful as this?"

The Blessed One said, "Nandana, that female hungry ghost was one who did evil deeds. Do you wish to hear the ripening of her karma?"

"Reverend, I wish to hear it."

"Then, Nandana, listen well and carefully and keep it in mind, and I shall explain.

"Nandana, long ago, in times past, in this very Fortunate Eon, when people lived for twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, a knower of the world, an unsurpassed guide of those to be tamed, a teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one called Kāśyapa. He was staying near the city of Vārāṇasī, at Ṛṣivadana, in the Deer Park.

"Now in that city of Vārāṇasī there lived a guild leader's daughter who longed for the Dharma. When she heard the Dharma, she came to see the faults of saṃsāra and the virtues of nirvāṇa, and having asked her parents' leave, she went forth in the teaching of that Blessed One. Then her relatives built a nunnery for her, and she lived there together with nuns who were still in training and nuns beyond training. After some time, under the sway of carelessness, she grew lax in the bases of training, and the nuns expelled her for her immoral conduct.

"Then she caused the patrons, the householders, to cut off even the regular offerings they made out of faith. She spoke dispraise of the nuns who were still in training and those beyond training. And whenever she saw monks of good moral discipline, she would sit with her eyes shut.

"Nandana, what do you think? The one who was the guild leader's daughter is this female hungry ghost. Because she was miserly about the nunnery, she

was born as a hungry ghost. Because she cut off the regular offerings, she is surrounded by crows, vultures, dogs and jackals. Because she spoke dispraise of the nuns who were still in training and those beyond training, her body has become foul smelling. Because she shut her eyes whenever she saw monks of good moral discipline, she has become blind.

"So, Nandana, wholly black deeds have a wholly black ripening; wholly white deeds have a wholly white ripening; and mixed deeds have a mixed ripening.

"Therefore, Nandana, abandon wholly black deeds and mixed ones, and devote yourself only to wholly white deeds. Nandana, that is how you should train."

When this Dharma discourse was taught, countless living beings came to see the truths.

Then the Blessed One said to the monks, "Monks, understand these and other drawbacks of miserliness and of misconduct in speech, and strive to abandon miserliness and misconduct in speech. Monks, that is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks, and the others as well, the gods, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas and so forth, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Guild Leader.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed and worshipped by kings, by great ministers, by the wealthy, by the townspeople, by guild leaders, by caravan leaders, by gods, by nāgas, by yakṣas, by asuras, by garuḍas, by kinnaras and by mahoragas. Worshipped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, renowned, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, food, bedding, seats, medicines for the sick and other requisites, the Buddha, the Blessed One, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time there lived in Śrāvastī a guild leader who was rich, with much wealth and great means, with vast and extensive holdings, possessed of wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling Vaiśravaṇa in wealth. One day he went to the Jeta Grove. There he saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body beautifully adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and graced with the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessed of a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, wholly lovely, like a Jewel

Mountain in motion. When he saw him, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat down before the Blessed One to hear the Dharma, and the Blessed One taught him a Dharma that brings weariness with saṃsāra. When he had heard it, he came to see the faults of saṃsāra and the virtues of nirvāṇa. He went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One and became renowned to all and possessed of great merit, a receiver of clothing, food, bedding, seats, medicines for the sick and other requisites.

He hoarded every requisite he received and held on to, and did not share it with his fellow practitioners of the holy life. Then, because he had indulged in, cultivated and repeatedly practiced miserliness, he died still greatly attached to his own possessions and was born as a hungry ghost in his own dwelling.

Then his fellow practitioners of the holy life struck the gong without pause and carried his remains outside. They performed the rites of veneration for his remains and returned to the monastery. Then they opened the door of his dwelling and began to distribute his robes and alms bowl in turn, and at once they saw a hungry ghost, with ugly hands, feet and eyes and a body most terrifying, sitting there clutching the robes and the alms bowl. When they saw this ugly being, the monks were dismayed, and they told the Blessed One.

Then the Blessed One, in order to benefit that son of good family, to rouse weariness in the assembly of his disciples, and to show plainly the ugly ripening of miserliness, went to that dwelling escorted by the assembly of monks, with the Saṅgha of monks going before him. Then the ghost saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body beautifully adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and graced with the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessed of a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, wholly lovely, like a Jewel Mountain in motion. The moment he saw him, his mind became gladdened toward the Blessed One, and he was filled with shame.

Then the Blessed One, with a voice deep as the thunder of rain clouds and like the sound of a drum, reproached the hungry ghost: "Good sir, to your own ruin you accumulated these robes and this alms bowl, and so you were born as a hungry ghost. Now gladden your mind toward me, and do not let your mind cling to these possessions either; that will be good. Otherwise, when you die from this state, you will be born among the beings of the hells."

Then the hungry ghost offered the robes and the alms bowl to the Saṅgha, bowed at the feet of the Blessed One, and confessed his fault. Then the

Blessed One spoke the dedication of the offering for the hungry ghost:

"Whatever merit there is from this gift,
May it go after the hungry ghost;
From the terrifying world of hungry ghosts
May he swiftly be set free!"

Then the hungry ghost became gladdened in mind toward the Blessed One, and when he died he was born as a hungry ghost of great magical power. Then that hungry ghost of great magical power, wearing earrings and bracelets that jingled and swayed, his body adorned with necklaces and half-necklaces, wearing a diadem studded with all kinds of jewels, his body anointed with saffron, tamāla leaves, spṛkkā and the like, that very night filled his lap with divine flowers, utpalas, lotuses, kumudas, white lotuses and māndāravas. He lit up the whole of the Bamboo Grove at the Kalandaka Feeding Ground with a great radiance, strewed the flowers over the Blessed One, and sat down before the Blessed One in order to hear the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One taught him the Dharma suited to him, and when he had heard it, joy arose in him and he departed. At that time the monks, who did not sleep in the first and last watches of the night but remained devoted to diligent practice, saw that a great radiance had appeared near the Blessed One. Seeing it, they were seized with doubt and asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, "Blessed One, what was it? Last night, did Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, or Śakra, lord of the gods, or the four world protectors come to see the Blessed One?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, it was not the lord of the Sahā world, nor Śakra, lord of the gods, nor the four world protectors who came to see me. That hungry ghost died and was reborn as a hungry ghost of great magical power. Last night he came to me, I taught him the Dharma, and joy arose in him and he departed. Therefore, monks, so that a fault such as that of the merchant who became a hungry ghost may not befall you, strive to abandon avarice. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks, and the gods, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas and others besides, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Sons.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, respected, revered and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshiped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, known far and wide, possessed of great merit, receiving robes, food, bedding, seats, medicine for the sick and other requisites, was staying with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove at the Kalandaka Feeding Ground.

Then early in the morning the venerable Maudgalyāyana put on his lower robe and his Dharma robe, took his alms bowl, and went into Rājagṛha for alms. Having gone for alms in Rājagṛha, he ate his meal and, having given up taking food afterwards, he put away his robe and bowl and went wandering in the realm of the hungry ghosts. Near Vulture Peak he saw a hungry ghost woman who looked like the sister of Yama. Her body was smeared with blood, and as though she dwelt in a charnel ground, she was surrounded by skeletons. Each day and each night she gave birth to five sons, and so she underwent such suffering; and although she loved her sons, tormented by hunger she was eating them.

Then the elder Maudgalyāyana asked her, "What deed did you do in the past, that you undergo suffering such as this?"

The hungry ghost woman said, "When the sun has risen, there is no need of a lamp. Ask the Blessed One about this matter, and he will explain to you the nature of my deeds. Having heard it, other beings too will give up evil deeds."

Then the venerable Maudgalyāyana went to where the Blessed One was. At that time the Blessed One had risen from his meditative absorption and was teaching the four assemblies a Dharma full of flavor, like honey from bees unboiled; and many hundreds in the assembly, their senses unmoving, were listening to the Dharma full of flavor from the Blessed One.

Now the buddhas, the blessed ones, speak openly, speak pleasantly, say "Come, welcome!", and smile before they speak. So the Blessed One said to the venerable Maudgalyāyana, "Maudgalyāyana, come! You are welcome. Where have you come from just now?"

Maudgalyāyana replied, "Venerable Blessed One, I have come back from going among the hungry ghosts. There I saw a hungry ghost woman who looked like the sister of Yama, her body smeared with blood, surrounded by skeletons as though she dwelt in a charnel ground." And he said further:

"'Every day I bear five sons,
And every night I bear five more;
Though I devour them once they're born,
I am never satisfied,' she says.
What terrible evil did she do
Within the world of human beings,
That she should come to undergo
Such dreadful suffering as this?"

The Blessed One said, "Maudgalyāyana, that hungry ghost woman is one who committed evil deeds. Do you wish to hear the nature of her deeds?"

"Venerable One, I wish to hear it."

"Then, Maudgalyāyana, listen well and closely, and keep it in mind, and I shall explain.

"Maudgalyāyana, long ago, in times past, in the city of Vārāṇasī there lived a merchant who was rich, of great wealth and abundant possessions, whose holdings were vast and extensive, who possessed the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa and rivaled the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He took a wife from a family equal to his own, and he played with her, made love, and enjoyed himself. But although he played, made love, and enjoyed himself, no son was born to him, nor any daughter. Resting his cheek on his hand, he sat brooding, thinking, 'Although my household has great wealth, I have neither son nor daughter. When I have passed away, since I have no son, everything I own will fall to the king.'

"Then that woman, wishing for a son, prayed to Śiva, Varuṇa, Kubera, Śakra, Brahmā and other eminent gods as well: to the gods of parks, the gods of forests, the gods of crossroads where four roads meet and where three roads meet, the gods who receive the torma offerings, and the gods born together with one, the gods who share one's nature, and the gods who constantly follow behind one. There is indeed a saying in the world that sons and daughters are born because of prayer, but that is not so. If sons and daughters were born because of prayer, then each person would surely have a thousand sons, like a universal monarch.

Rather, sons and daughters are born from the coming together of three conditions. What are the three? The father and mother come together, aroused by desire; the mother is in her season and has her menses; and a gandharva has arrived. From the coming together of these three conditions

sons and daughters are born. So although she propitiated the gods, neither son nor daughter was born.

Then such thoughts as these arose in him: "If I were to take a second wife, perhaps there is some chance that I would have a son." So he took a second wife from a family equal to his own, and he played with her, made love, and enjoyed himself. As he played, made love, and enjoyed himself, after some time she became pregnant. Delighted, pleased and overjoyed, she told her husband, "My lord, I have conceived a child, and since it rests on the right side of my womb, it will certainly be a boy. Please rejoice!"

He too was overjoyed. Raising the upper part of his body and stretching out his right hand, he uttered these words of joy: "I shall see the face of the son I have long wished and wished for! May my son be sound and not unsound! May he do my duties! May he repay us for raising him! May he enjoy his share of the wealth! May my family line long endure! And after we have passed away and died, may he give gifts, whether many or few, and make merit on our behalf, and dedicate the reward, saying, 'Wherever these two are born and go, may this follow them there!'"

Then, knowing that she was pregnant, in order to care for the child he settled her at ease in the upper storey of the mansion. In the cold season she was attended with things for the cold, in the hot season with things for the heat, and with foods prescribed by the physician: things not too bitter, not too sour, not too salty, not too sweet, not too pungent, not too astringent, foods free of bitterness, sourness, saltiness, sweetness, pungency and astringency. Her body was adorned with necklaces and half-necklaces, and like a divine maiden roaming in the Nandana Grove, she moved from couch to couch and from seat to seat and never set foot on the ground below, and he made sure that she heard no unpleasant sound at all.

Then the first wife, seeing how he honored and cherished her, grew jealous and thought, "If this woman gives birth to a son, he will do me harm. I must find some way to deal with this." For one who is wholly given over to desire there is no restraint whatever against doing evil deeds. Gazing over the precipice of the wretched destinies, she won the other's trust and gave her an abortifacient drug, such that merely from drinking it that afflicted woman's child miscarried.

Then the second wife gathered all the relatives and summoned the first wife to judgment, saying, "You won my trust and gave me an abortifacient drug, and

because of it my child has miscarried."

Then the first wife swore an oath among the relatives, saying, "If I gave you an abortifacient drug, may I become a hungry ghost woman and devour every son I bear!"

"Maudgalyāyana, what do you think? She who was the merchant's wife is that hungry ghost woman. Because of the jealousy she showed in the past, she was born as a hungry ghost woman. Through the karmic maturation of the deed of lying and swearing that oath, she gives birth to five sons each day and five each night, and devours them. Therefore, Maudgalyāyana, you should strive to abandon faults of speech, so that faults such as those of that hungry ghost woman do not arise. Maudgalyāyana, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Maudgalyāyana, and the gods, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas and others besides, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, twelfth fascicle.

Jāmbāla.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, respected, revered and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshiped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, known far and wide, possessed of great merit, receiving robes, food, bedding, seats, medicine for the sick and other requisites, was staying with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Vaiśālī, in the Kūṭāgāra Hall on the bank of the Monkey Pond.

At that time in Vaiśālī, in one of the city's moats, there lived five hundred hungry ghosts who ate vomit, ate what had been thrown away, lived on phlegm, snot and urine, and ate pus, blood and excrement, unbearable and miserable by their very nature. It is also said:

They eat vomit and eat what is thrown away,
They live on phlegm and snot and urine,
They eat pus and blood and excrement,
Unbearable and wretched by their nature.

In Vaiśālī there also lived a certain brahmin. He took a wife from a family equal to his own, and he played with her, made love, and enjoyed himself. As he played, made love, and enjoyed himself, his wife became pregnant, and her

body came to smell foul. Then the brahmin summoned the soothsayers and asked them, and they said, "This is the power of the boy who is in her womb."

After eight or nine months had passed, she gave birth, and the child she bore was a boy, ill-colored, unpleasant to look at, ugly, his body smeared with filth and foul-smelling. Though he was extremely unlovely, his parents raised him, bound to him by the force of love. He delighted only in filthy places: he would roll in heaps of refuse and in cesspits and put filth into his mouth, and so he came to be named "Cesspit," Jāmbāla.

One day, as he was wandering here and there, Pūraṇa Kāśyapa saw him and thought, "Since he delights in places like these, he must be a man of unbroken accomplishment. I shall ordain him." So he ordained him, and the boy went about naked, and he also settled into the practice of austerities.

Then, as he went wandering, he saw the five hundred hungry ghosts who dwelt in the moat of Vaiśālī, and because of his connection with the karmic maturation of his former deeds, he went down into that city moat, gathered and met with them, took delight in them, and became their friend.

Some time later the boy Jāmbāla, busy with some errand, went into Vaiśālī. The Blessed One too came to that city moat, and those hungry ghosts saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and made beautiful by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, wholly splendid, like a moving mountain of jewels. As soon as they saw him, they bowed at the Blessed One's feet and said, "Blessed One, we are in want."

The Blessed One said, "What do you lack?"

The hungry ghosts said, "Blessed One, we are thirsty."

Then from his five fingers the Blessed One sent down five streams of water possessing the eight qualities, and with them he satisfied those five hundred hungry ghosts. Then their minds became joyful toward the Blessed One, and when they died they were reborn in the fair realm of the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three.

It is the nature of things that when a god or goddess has been born, not long afterward three thoughts arise: "From where did I die and pass on? Where have I been born? Through what deed was I born here?" Then they saw that they had died and passed on from the hungry ghosts, that they had been born in the fair realm of the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, and that this

was because their minds had become joyful toward the Blessed One.

Then those gods who had formerly been hungry ghosts thought, "It would not be fitting for us to wait until a day has passed before going to see the Blessed One. We will go to see the Blessed One before the day is out." Then those gods who had formerly been hungry ghosts, wearing earrings and bracelets that jingled and swayed, their bodies adorned with necklaces and half-necklaces, wearing diadems studded with all kinds of jewels, their bodies anointed with saffron, tamāla leaves, spṛkkā and the like, that very night filled their laps with divine flowers, utpalas, lotuses, kumudas, white lotuses and māndāravas. They lit up the whole of the Kūṭāgāra Hall with a great radiance, strewed the flowers over the Blessed One, and sat down before the Blessed One in order to hear the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, understanding the dispositions, latent tendencies, constitutions and natures of those gods who had formerly been hungry ghosts, taught them the Dharma in such a way that they would realize the Four Noble Truths. Having heard it, the five hundred gods shattered with the vajra of wisdom the twenty lofty peaks of the mountain of the view of the perishable collection, and attained the fruit of stream entry. Having seen the truth, with the very splendor with which they had come before the Blessed One, a splendor like that of a merchant who has made a profit, a farmer whose crops have flourished, a hero victorious in battle, or a sick man freed from every illness, they circumambulated the Blessed One three times and went back to their own abode.

Then the boy Jāmbāla came to the city moat and did not see those hungry ghosts. He began to search, and searching everywhere for them he grew weary, but he did not find them.

Now there is nothing that the buddhas, the blessed ones, do not know, do not see, do not realize, or do not understand. Yet the buddhas, the blessed ones, possessed of great compassion, devoted to benefiting the world, the sole protectors, the sole heroes, without equal, whose speech is never double, who abide in calm abiding and insight, who make the three knowledges shine, who are well trained in the three trainings, who are skilled in the three bases of discipline, who have crossed the four floods, the soles of whose feet, the four bases of magical power, stand most firm, who have long been practiced in the four means of attraction, fearless through the four fearlessnesses, who proclaim the true and great lion's roar of a bull among men, who have entirely

abandoned the five factors, who have wholly passed beyond the five destinies, who possess the six factors, who have perfected the six perfections, who abide in the six constant abidings, who are rich in the flowers of the seven factors of awakening, who teach the eightfold path, who are skilled in the nine successive meditative attainments, who possess the strength of the ten powers, whose fame pervades the ten directions, who far surpass even the lord who holds sway over a thousand, by the nature of things survey the world with the eye of a buddha three times by day and three times by night. Their wisdom gaze proceeds, thinking: "Who is declining? Who is prospering? Who is in want? Who has fallen into distress? Who is afflicted with harm? Who is in want, distress and harm? Who is inclined toward the lower realms? Who is sliding into the lower realms? Who has fallen into the lower realms? Whom shall I draw out of the lower realms and establish in the higher realms, in liberation and in its fruits? Whom shall I take by the hand and pull out of the mire of sensual desire in which he is sinking? Whom, lacking the seven noble riches, shall I make master of the sovereignty of the seven noble riches? In whom who has not yet produced roots of virtue shall I produce them? In whom who has already produced roots of virtue shall I bring them to maturity? Whom who has already matured shall I liberate?"

Here it is said:

The ocean, dwelling place of sea monsters,
May perhaps let the time of its tide go by;
But for his children who are to be trained,
The Buddha never lets the time go by.

Then, in order to benefit the son of good family Jāmbāla, the Blessed One put on his lower robe and his Dharma robe early in the morning, took his alms bowl, and, attended by the assembly of monks and with the Saṅgha of monks going before him, went into Vaiśālī for alms. After some time, as he made his alms round in due order and came into a street, Jāmbāla too, wandering here and there, came and stood before the Blessed One.

Then he saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and made beautiful by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, wholly splendid, like a moving mountain of jewels. And as soon as he saw him, his mind became joyful toward the Blessed One. Joy having arisen, he bowed at the Blessed One's feet, joined his palms,

and said, "Blessed One, if even beings such as I may go forth in this well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya, and it would be fitting, then I too wish to go forth."

Then the Blessed One, possessed of great compassion, who knows the dispositions and latent tendencies of beings, understanding that he was supremely fortunate, stretched out his golden-colored arm, like the trunk of an elephant, and spoke these words: "Come, monk, live the pure life!" The moment the Blessed One had spoken these words, his hair and beard were shaven as if seven days before, and with the deportment of one fully ordained he stood as though he had been ordained a hundred years, holding an alms bowl and a water pot in his hands. Here it is said:

When the Tathāgata said to him, "Come!"
His head was shaven, his body clad in the patched robe;
Robed by the Buddha's intention,
At once he stood with his senses wholly calmed.

Then the Blessed One gave him instruction in mental cultivation. By striving, exerting himself and making effort, he understood that this very five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra is in motion and unstable. He saw thoroughly that all kinds of formations are by nature subject to decay, falling, scattering and destruction, and abandoning all afflictions he directly realized arhatship. As an arhat, free of attachment to the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal; his mind was like empty space and like the palm of his hand; he became cool like refined sandalwood; with knowledge he had broken the shell of the egg; he had attained the knowledges, the superknowledges and the analytical knowledges; he turned his back on worldly gain, attachment and honor; and he became one worthy to be worshiped, revered and respectfully addressed by the gods, together with Indra and Upendra.

Even after he had attained arhatship, he still delighted in what was lowly. So the Blessed One said to the monks, "Monks, this monk of mine, Jāmbāla, is foremost among my monk śrāvakas who are inclined toward what is lowly."

Then doubt arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts off all doubts, "Venerable One, what deed did the elder Jāmbāla do, that he underwent such suffering as this?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, Jāmbāla himself, in other, former lives, performed and accumulated deeds which, once their accumulation was complete and their conditions fulfilled, arise like a flood and come about

without fail. Since Jāmbāla himself performed and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element or the wind element. Virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense bases.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons;
When the conditions gather and their time arrives,
They ripen as their fruits.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in this very Fortunate Eon, when people lived for forty thousand years, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of those to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One, called Krakucchanda, and he was staying at a royal capital called Sundara.

"At that time a householder in that royal capital built a monastery, and he took care of the monks from various regions and lands who came, went and stayed there. In that monastery there lived a monk who was an ordinary person, and he was extremely possessive of his dwelling. When he saw monks newly arriving, he would seethe with resentment, become agitated and bear them ill will; he would sit sullen and stir up quarrels. But when he saw monks departing from the monastery, he would be greatly pleased and overjoyed, and would see them off and speak with them.

"Some time later a monk who was an arhat came from some other land. The owner of the monastery was a non-returner, and he knew from his deportment that he was an arhat. Then, joy having arisen, he invited him together with the Saṅgha of monks for the ceremonial bath and a meal on the following day. The resident monk was not there. When the next day came and the ceremonial bath had been offered and the meal set out, the resident monk too arrived. He went to the place of the ceremonial bath and saw the owner of the monastery, who had come early, attending to the newly arrived monk. Then jealousy arose in him, and with a hostile mind he spoke harsh words: 'Monk, you, whose body is smeared with filth, are not fit to accept the service of such a patron as this!'

"Then that arhat thought, 'It must not be that this poor afflicted man becomes destined for a fate still more terrible than this,' and saying nothing at all, he

bore it patiently.

"After some time, when the assembly had gathered and the morning had come, the resident monk heard people saying to him, 'You harbored hostility toward an arhat.' Having heard this, he was filled with remorse. Then he bowed at the feet of that monk who was an arhat and said, 'Noble one, I beg you to forgive the harsh words I spoke to you.'

"Then, in order to inspire faith in him, that arhat rose into the sky and displayed various kinds of miracles. At that his remorse grew still greater, and he confessed and acknowledged that wrongful deed before him and purified it by confession. Nevertheless, he was unable to give rise to the ultimate wisdom.

"Then after some time, when the hour of his death had come, he made this aspiration: 'May I not experience the karmic maturation of the deed of harboring hostility toward an arhat and speaking harsh words. By the karmic maturation of whatever deeds I have done in reading and reciting, in giving gifts and great gifts, and in serving the Saṅgha, may I in a future time please a Buddha, a Blessed One!'

"Monks, what do you think? The one who at that time and on that occasion was the resident monk is none other than this Jāmbāla. Because of the karmic maturation of the deed of speaking harsh words to an arhat, he experienced endless suffering in saṃsāra, and because a remainder of that same deed was left, even now that he has reached his last existence, he was foul-smelling, exceedingly foul-smelling, and delighted in filth and muck. And because he had practiced recitation, and had become skilled in the aggregates, skilled in the elements, skilled in the sense bases, skilled in dependent origination, and skilled in what is possible and what is impossible, he went forth in my teaching, abandoned all afflictions, and directly realized arhatship.

"Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: you should strive to abandon avarice. Why is that? So that faults such as those Jāmbāla had while he was an ordinary person do not arise, and so that you may come to have such a host of qualities as he gained in attaining arhatship. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks, and the gods, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas and others besides, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Here ends the fifth decade, with its summary verse, of the Hundred Avadānas.

The summary verse:

The Black Snake and the Moon,
The Sāla and Śrīmatī,
The Robe, the Parrot, the Messenger,
The Buffalo and the Poṣadha,
And the Goose, told last of all.

The Black Snake.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, respected, revered and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshiped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, known far and wide, possessed of great merit, receiving robes, food, bedding, seats, medicine for the sick and other requisites, was staying with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove at the Kalandaka Feeding Ground.

At that time in the city of Rājagṛha there lived a householder who was rich, of great wealth and abundant possessions, whose holdings were vast and extensive, who possessed the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa and rivaled the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. But he was avaricious and miserly, clinging to his possessions, one who would not give an offering even to a crow. Whenever he saw ascetics, brahmins, the wretched, the needy or beggars, his mind would turn hostile.

Then he hid a great heap of gold and silver in his own park, and he died still attached to it and clinging to it intensely. When he died, he was reborn right on top of it as a venomous snake, a great black snake with a poisonous gaze. Then whatever crowds of people went into that park, he would kill merely by looking at them. And word spread throughout the city of Rājagṛha: "Everyone who goes into such and such a park will perish."

The crowds of people reported this to King Bimbisāra. Then King Bimbisāra thought, "Apart from the Buddha, the Blessed One, who else is there who could tame it?"

Then King Bimbisāra, with a large retinue of people, went to where the Blessed One was. When he arrived, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. When he was seated to one side, the Blessed One instructed King Bimbisāra with a talk on the Dharma, inspired him, roused him

and delighted him. Having instructed, inspired, roused and delighted him with many kinds of talk on the Dharma, he remained silent.

Then King Bimbisāra rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, set his right knee on the ground, bowed toward the Blessed One with palms joined, and said this to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, here in Rājagṛha, in a certain pleasure garden, there lives a venomous snake, a great black snake with a poisonous gaze, and it is destroying many people. Out of compassion, may the Blessed One please tame it." The Blessed One consented to King Bimbisāra by remaining silent. Then King Bimbisāra, understanding that the Blessed One had consented by remaining silent, bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet, rose from his seat, and departed.

Then, when that very night had passed, the Blessed One dressed in the morning in his lower garment and robe, took his alms bowl, and went to the pleasure garden. Having arrived, the Blessed One sent forth golden-colored rays of light whose brilliance surpassed that of a thousand suns, and they lit up the whole of that pleasure garden. He also sent forth rays of loving-kindness, which he had thoroughly cultivated for a thousand eons, and as soon as they touched the snake's body, it became deeply soothed and cooled.

Then the venomous snake looked this way and that, wondering, "By whose power has my body become so soothed?" And it saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo of light a fathom wide, possessed of a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, like a moving mountain of jewels, beautiful in every way. As soon as it saw him, it gave rise to faith in the Blessed One. When it had come to have a mind of faith, the Blessed One taught it the Dharma in keeping with this: "Good sir, it is because you yourself amassed this wealth that you have been made to fall into the state of a venomous snake. Now arouse faith in me, and do not let your mind cling to this treasure either; that would be well. For when you die and pass on from here, you would otherwise be born among the beings of hell." Then, when the Blessed One caused it to remember its former lives, it wept. At that the Blessed One spoke these verses:

"You have been born as an animal;
Now there is nothing I can do.

Since you are already born in a state without freedom,
What good will pointless weeping do?
Here, toward me, the compassionate Victor,
Arouse a mind of faith.
It is well to leave behind an animal birth;
Then you will go to the higher realms."

Then, for a while, the Blessed One placed the snake inside his alms bowl and carried it to the Bamboo Grove. At that time the king and the people of the land of Magadha heard how the Blessed One had tamed the venomous snake. Then the venomous snake, loathing its own body, gave up eating, and with its mind rejoicing in the Blessed One, it died and was born in the fair divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three.

Not long after a son or daughter of the gods is born, three thoughts arise in them by the very nature of things: "From where did I die and pass on? Where have I been born? Through what karma was I born?" Then he saw that he had died and passed on from the state of a venomous snake, that he had been born in the fair divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, and that this was because his mind had rejoiced in the Blessed One.

Then the god's son who had formerly been the venomous snake thought, "It would not befit me to go and see the Blessed One only after a night has passed. I shall go to see the Blessed One before the night is out." Then the god's son who had formerly been the venomous snake, wearing earrings and bracelets that gleamed and swayed, his body adorned with necklaces and garlands, wearing a crown studded with all kinds of jewels, his body anointed with saffron, tamāla leaves, spṛkkā and other fragrances, filled the fold of his garment that very night with divine flowers: blue lotuses, lotuses, night lilies, white lotuses and māndārava blossoms. He lit up the whole of the Bamboo Grove, the Kalandaka Feeding Ground, with a great light, scattered the flowers over the Blessed One, and sat down before the Blessed One to hear the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, understanding the disposition, latent tendencies, constitution and nature of the god's son who had formerly been the venomous snake, taught him the Dharma in such a way that he would realize the Four Noble Truths. Having heard it, the god's son who had formerly been the venomous snake shattered with the vajra of wisdom the twenty towering

peaks of the mountain of the view of the perishable collection, and attained the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truths, he spoke these words of joy: "Venerable Blessed One, you have dried up for me the ocean of blood and tears, carried me across the mountain of bones, closed the doors to the lower realms, opened the doors to the higher realms and to liberation, and established me among gods and humans. Such a thing was not done for me by my father, nor by my mother, nor by the king, nor by the gods, nor by my household and kinsfolk, nor by my departed ancestors, nor by śramaṇas and brahmins."

And he said further:

"The path to the lower realms, beset with many faults,
Most terrible, has been cut off by your power.
The way to the higher realms, rich in merit, is opened,
And I have gained the path to nirvāṇa as well.
Today, relying on you, I have gained
The utterly pure eye from which all faults are gone.
I have crossed to the far shore of the ocean of suffering
And reached the state of peace in which the noble ones delight.
Supreme among humans, lord, worshipped by humans and gods,
You who are free of the sickness of birth, old age and death,
Hard to behold in a thousand existences:
Sage, today I have seen you, and it has borne fruit."

Then the wearer of the necklace, filled with joy,
Bowed and paid homage at his two feet,
And circling the Conqueror of Foes,
Turned toward the world of the gods and went to the divine realm.

Then, like a merchant who has made a profit, a farmer whose crops have flourished, a hero victorious in battle, or a sick man freed from every illness, the god's son who had formerly been the venomous snake, with the same splendor in which he had come before the Blessed One, went that very night to King Bimbisāra. He lit up the whole royal palace with a great light, roused the king, and said this: "Great King, get up! Why lie sleeping?" Then the king awoke and saw the great light and the god's son. Seeing them, delighted and glad, he asked, "Who are you?"

He replied, "I am the venomous snake that the Blessed One tamed in that pleasure garden. When I died, I was born in the fair divine realm of the Heaven

of the Thirty-Three. I have also paid homage to the Blessed One, and I have seen the truths. Now I shall show you something: go, and from a certain spot in that pleasure garden dig up a great treasure, and for my sake offer a meal to the Blessed One together with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas, and ask that the dedication of the offering be recited for me as well." King Bimbisāra assented to the god's son by remaining silent. Then the god's son who had formerly been the venomous snake, understanding that the king had assented by remaining silent, vanished on the spot.

Then that very night King Bimbisāra gave orders to the townspeople and the country people of the land of Magadha, went to that pleasure garden, and dug up the treasure. For three months he offered meals to the Blessed One together with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas, and he asked the Blessed One, "Blessed One, what karma did the god's son who had formerly been the venomous snake commit, that he was born as a venomous snake? And what karma did he perform, that he was born among the gods and came to see the truths?"

The Blessed One said, "Because he gave rise to intense attachment, and gave rise to hostile thoughts toward śramaṇas and brahmins, toward the wretched and destitute, and toward the poor, he was born as a venomous snake. Because he made his mind rejoice in me, he was born among the gods. In the time of Kāśyapa, the perfectly complete Buddha, he was a layman; because he went for refuge and took up the precepts, he came to see the truths. Therefore, Great King, you should train yourself thus: striving to abandon stinginess, so that faults such as becoming a venomous snake do not arise, and so that you come to have a host of good qualities like those of that very god's son."

Then King Bimbisāra praised and rejoiced in what the Blessed One had said, bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet, rose from his seat, and departed. When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story of Candra.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed and worshipped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, townspeople, guild masters, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshipped and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, who received robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and supplies

for the sick, was staying with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time there lived in Śrāvastī a brahmin farmer, who took a wife from a family of equal standing. He played with her, enjoyed himself, and made love with her. As he played, enjoyed himself and made love, his wife conceived a child, and after eight or nine months had passed, a child was born: she gave birth to a boy who was handsome, lovely to behold and beautiful, a delight to the eyes of all people. The brahmin had obtained him only with difficulty, for he had no other sons or daughters. The boy was nursed and raised and grew up, and because he delighted the whole world, the brahmins and householders gave the boy the name Candra, the Moon.

The brahmin boy Candra was passed from hand to hand and carried about all through the city, and the brahmin came to love the boy all the more, always taking great care to protect him well whenever he walked, sat or lay down. The brahmin's house stood near that of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada. Then the brahmin boy, keeping company with the householder Anāthapiṇḍada, went to the Jeta Grove, heard the Buddha's words, and found faith in the Blessed One's teaching. But he was short-lived; he died and was born in the fair divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three.

Not long after a son or daughter of the gods is born, three thoughts arise in them by the very nature of things: "From where did I die and pass on? Where have I been born? Through what karma was I born?" Then he saw that he had died and passed on from the human state, that he had been born in the fair divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, and that this was because his mind had rejoiced in the Blessed One.

Then the god's son who had formerly been a brahmin thought, "It would not befit me to go and see the Blessed One only after a night has passed. I shall go to see the Blessed One before the night is out." Then the god's son who had formerly been a brahmin, wearing earrings and bracelets that gleamed and swayed, his body adorned with necklaces and garlands, wearing a crown adorned with all kinds of jewels, his body anointed with saffron, tamāla leaves, spṛkkā and other fragrances, filled the fold of his garment that very night with divine flowers: blue lotuses, lotuses, night lilies, white lotuses and māndārava blossoms. He lit up the whole of the Jeta Grove with a great light, scattered the flowers over the Blessed One, and sat down before the Blessed One to hear the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, understanding the disposition, latent tendencies, constitution and nature of the god's son who had formerly been a brahmin, taught him the Dharma in such a way that he would realize the Four Noble Truths. Having heard it, the god's son who had formerly been a brahmin shattered with the vajra of wisdom the twenty towering peaks of the mountain of the view of the perishable collection, and attained the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truths, he spoke these words of joy three times: "Venerable Blessed One, you have dried up for me the ocean of blood and tears, carried me across the mountain of bones, closed the doors to the lower realms, opened the doors to the higher realms and to liberation, and established me among gods and humans. Such a thing was not done for me by my father, nor by my mother, nor by the king, nor by the gods, nor by my household and kinsfolk, nor by my departed ancestors, nor by śramaṇas and brahmins."

And he said further:

"The path to the lower realms, beset with many faults,
Most terrible, has been cut off by your power.
The way to the higher realms, rich in merit, is opened,
And I have gained the path to nirvāṇa as well.
Today, relying on you, I have gained
The utterly pure eye from which all faults are gone.
I have crossed to the far shore of the ocean of suffering
And reached the state of peace in which the noble ones delight.
Supreme among humans, lord, worshipped by gods and humans,
You who are free of the sickness of birth, old age and death,
Hard to behold in a thousand existences:
Sage, today I have seen you, and it has borne fruit."

Then he with the swaying necklace, filled with joy,
Bowed and paid homage at his two feet,
And circling the Conqueror of Foes,
Turned toward the world of the gods and went to the divine realm.

Then, like a merchant who has made a profit, a farmer whose crops have flourished, a hero victorious in battle, or a sick man freed from every illness, the god's son who had formerly been a brahmin returned to his own abode with the same splendor in which he had come before the Blessed One.

The monks, not sleeping in the first and last watches of the night, were intent on diligent practice, and they saw that a great light had appeared near the

Blessed One. Seeing it, doubts arose in them, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Blessed One, what was it? Last night, did Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, or Śakra, lord of the gods, or the four world protectors come to see the Blessed One?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, it was not Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, nor Śakra, lord of the gods, nor the four world protectors who came to see me. A brahmin's only son was short-lived and died. Because his mind had rejoiced in me, he was born in the fair divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three. Last night he came to me, and when I had taught him the Dharma, he came to see the truths and returned to his own abode.

"At that time the brahmin had carried his only son, beloved and cherished, dear to his heart and pleasing to his mind, patient and never contrary, to the charnel ground. He laid him in his lap and called out, crying, 'Alas, my son! Alas, my eldest son! Alas, my only son!' Though his relatives urged him to, they could not get him to rise, and he sat there surrounded by crows, magpies, vultures and jackals, keeping company with women with disheveled hair, while many people looked on.

"Then his son, reborn as a god, saw his father lamenting, and his heart was moved with compassion. To dispel his father's grief, he magically took on the appearance of a sage, and sat at the edge of the charnel ground practicing the five austerities. Then the brahmin asked the sage, 'O great sage, what are you trying to accomplish with these austerities?'

"The sage said, 'I am seeking kingship. I wish to have a golden chariot adorned with all kinds of jewels, with the sun and the moon as its two wheels, drawn in front by the four world protectors, and to ride in that chariot around this great earth.'

"The brahmin said:

'Even if for a full hundred years
You were to practice austerities without pause,
And even if you practiced the supreme austerity,
You could never hope to reach that state.'

"The sage said, 'And what are you trying to accomplish with this corpse, so utterly foul-smelling and impure, like a log of wood?'

"The brahmin said, 'My beloved only son has died, and I am trying to bring him back.'

"The sage said:

'Even if for a full hundred years
You were to keep on weeping without pause,
You could never hope to gain back that son.
What good does your weeping do?'

"Then the brahmin, thinking, 'The sage's words are true,' gave rise to faith. Having given rise to faith, he asked, 'Who are you?' Then the sage made that appearance vanish, remained in his own form, and said to his father, 'I am your only son. Because my mind rejoiced in the Blessed One, when I died I was born in the fair divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, and I have come here to dispel your grief. Father, come here! Go for refuge to the Blessed One, and you too may yet pass beyond saṃsāra.'

"Then the brahmin set down the remains of the dead, went to where the Blessed One was, and when he arrived, bowed at the Blessed One's feet and sat before the Blessed One to hear the Dharma. Then the Blessed One taught him the Dharma in such a way that he would realize the Four Noble Truths. Having heard it, the brahmin shattered with the vajra of wisdom the twenty towering peaks of the mountain of the view of the perishable collection, and attained the fruit of stream-entry."

Having attained distinction and gained what was to be gained, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet, circled him three times, and departed.

Then doubts arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Blessed One, behold how this god's son has dispelled his father's grief in this way and has also established him in seeing the truths."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what great wonder is there in this, that now, having seen the truths, he has completely saved his father? In the past too, while he was still an ordinary person, when his father came to the point of being executed, he saved him three times. Listen well and carefully to this, and keep it in mind, and I shall explain.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, there was in the city of Vārāṇasī a man who committed adultery with other men's wives. His son had faith, was virtuous and good-hearted, and was greatly esteemed by people. Then at one point his father committed a theft, and the king commanded the executioners, 'Kill him!' Then the son petitioned the king three times, and so his father was

granted his precious life."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The man who at that time, on that occasion, committed adultery with other men's wives was this brahmin. The adulterer's son was this brahmin youth."

The monks asked, "Blessed One, what karma did they perform, that both father and son came to see the truths?"

The Blessed One said, "In the time of Kāśyapa, the perfectly complete Buddha, both of them were laymen. Because they went for refuge and took up the precepts, they have therefore come to see the truths in this way. Therefore, monks, you should strive for nirvāṇa, thinking, 'All conditioned things are impermanent, all phenomena are without self, and nirvāṇa is peace.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks, and also others, gods, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas and the rest, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story of Sāla.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed and worshipped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, townspeople, guild masters, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshipped and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, who received robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and supplies for the sick, was staying with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time a festival called the Plucking of the Sāla took place in Śrāvastī. Many hundreds of thousands of living beings gathered there, picked the flowers of the sāla trees, and played, enjoyed themselves and made merry. At one point a merchant's daughter, having picked sāla flowers, was going into Śrāvastī. The Blessed One, attended by the assembly of monks and with the Saṅgha of monks going before him, had gone for alms in Śrāvastī and was returning, and the girl saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo of light a fathom wide, possessed of a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, like a moving mountain of jewels, beautiful in every way. Seeing him, she was filled with joy, and

scattered sāla flowers over the Blessed One. Then she circled the Blessed One and turned back, thinking, "I shall pick some more, since I need them for the house." And at one point, climbing a sāla tree, she fell and died. Having paid homage to the Blessed One, she was born in the fair divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three.

Then at one point, her body and her celestial mansion adorned with sāla flowers, she went into the assembly hall of the gods. At that time Śakra, lord of the gods, was in Sudharmā, the assembly hall of the gods, in the midst of the hosts of gods, speaking the praises of the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha. Śakra, lord of the gods, saw the goddess, her body and her celestial mansion adorned with sāla flowers, blazing with her roots of virtue. Seeing her, he addressed her in verse:

"Why has your body's hue become like pure gold, like the lotus and the blue lotus?
Here, you whose bodily splendor has no equal, from what have these lights streaming from your body come?
For what reason has the color of your face become like a blossoming lotus, like the hue of gold?
Of which deeds is this the fruit you now enjoy? Goddess, tell me this."

The goddess said:

"Over the Sun of Humanity, rich with the supreme marks,
Together with his śrāvakas,
I scattered well
Fine, spotless sāla flowers.
Because I did such a virtuous deed,
I am radiant beyond others,
My face like the lotus and the moon,
Pure, luminous and lovely to behold."

Śakra said:

"Ah! In that very field of good qualities,
Wholly free of every fault,
In order to be born in the lovely higher realms,
You have sown your seed.
O fair-faced one, with eyes like the broad petals of a lotus,
The Buddha, honored by the finest of women,
With eyes like the broad petals of a blossoming lotus,

Radiant like a heap of the finest gold: who would not worship him?"

Not long after a son or daughter of the gods is born, three thoughts arise in them by the very nature of things: "From where did I die and pass on? Where have I been born? Through what karma was I born?"

Then she saw that she had died and passed on from the human state, that she had been born in the fair divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, and that this was because her mind had rejoiced in the Blessed One. Then that goddess thought, "It would not befit me to go and see the Blessed One only after a night has passed. I shall go to see the Blessed One before the night is out."

Then the goddess, wearing earrings and bracelets that gleamed and swayed, her body adorned with necklaces and garlands, wearing a crown adorned with all kinds of precious jewels, her body anointed with saffron, tamāla leaves, spṛkkā and other fragrances, attended by many hundreds of thousands of goddesses, went that very night to the Blessed One, together with that same celestial mansion of sāla flowers. Then she scattered flowers over the Blessed One and sat down before the Blessed One to hear the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, understanding that goddess's disposition, latent tendencies, constitution and nature, taught her the Dharma in such a way that she would realize the Four Noble Truths. Having heard it, the goddess shattered with the vajra of wisdom the twenty towering peaks of the mountain of the view of the perishable collection, and attained the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truths, she spoke these words of joy three times: "Venerable Blessed One, you have dried up for me the ocean of blood and tears, carried me across the mountain of bones, closed the doors to the lower realms, opened the doors to the higher realms and to liberation, and established me among gods and humans. Such a thing was not done for me by my father, nor by my mother, nor by the king, nor by the gods, nor by my household and kinsfolk, nor by my departed ancestors, nor by śramaṇas and brahmins."

And she said further:

"The path to the lower realms, beset with many faults,
Most terrible, has been cut off by your power.
The way to the higher realms, rich in merit, is opened,
And I have gained the path to nirvāṇa as well.
Today, relying on you, I have gained

The utterly pure eye from which all faults are gone.
I have crossed to the far shore of the ocean of suffering
And reached the state of peace in which the noble ones delight.
Supreme among humans, lord, worshipped by gods and humans,
You who are free of the sickness of birth, old age and death,
Hard to behold in a thousand existences:
Sage, today I have seen you, and it has borne fruit."

Then she with the swaying necklace, filled with joy,
Bowed and paid homage at his two feet,
And circling the Conqueror of Foes,
Turned toward the world of the gods and went to the divine realm.

Then, like a merchant who has made a profit, a farmer whose crops have flourished, a hero victorious in battle, or a sick man freed from every illness, that goddess returned to her own abode with the same splendor in which she had come before the Blessed One.

The monks, not sleeping in the first and last watches of the night, were intent on diligent practice, and they saw that a great light had appeared near the Blessed One. Seeing it, doubts arose in them, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Blessed One, what was it? Last night, did Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, or Śakra, lord of the gods, or the four world protectors come to see the Blessed One?"

The Blessed One said, "It was not Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, nor Śakra, lord of the gods, nor the four world protectors who came to see me. Did you see the girl who scattered flowers on the road?"

"Venerable One, we saw her."

"Having made her mind rejoice in me, she died and was born in the fair divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three. She came to me, and when I had taught her the Dharma, she came to see the truths and returned to her own abode. Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall honor the Teacher, revere him, esteem him and worship him. Having honored, revered, esteemed and worshipped the Teacher, we shall live relying on him.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, the thirteenth section.

The story of Śrīmatī.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed and worshipped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, townspeople, guild masters, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshipped and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, who received robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and supplies for the sick, was dwelling with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove, the Kalandaka Feeding Ground.

At that time King Bimbisāra was reigning in the city of Rājagṛha. During his reign the land was prosperous, flourishing, peaceful, blessed with good harvests and filled with many people and inhabitants. Disputes and fights had been quelled, and there were no riots, no civil strife, no robbers, no famine and no diseases. It was rich in sāli rice, sugarcane, cattle and buffalo. Free from harm, with every thorn rooted out, he ruled his kingdom as one would care for an only son.

Then, from the time King Bimbisāra saw the truths through the Blessed One, he went to the Blessed One three times a day, together with his retinue of queens.

Then later, when the season of spring had come, and the trees were in full blossom, and geese, cranes, peacocks, parrots, mynas, cuckoos and jīvaṃjīvaka birds were calling in the groves, King Bimbisāra went to the pleasure garden together with his chief queen and his retinue of queens. There the retinue of queens said to the king, "Your Majesty, since we are not able to go to the Blessed One every day, would Your Majesty please build a stūpa of the Tathāgata's hair and nails here within the queens' quarters and consecrate it? We would then constantly honor it with lamps, incense, flowers, perfumes, garlands, ointments, parasols, victory banners and flags."

Then King Bimbisāra said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, please grant me hair and nails. I will build a stūpa of the Tathāgata within the women's quarters of the palace and consecrate it."

Then the Blessed One gave him hair and nails, and King Bimbisāra, together with his retinue of queens, with great reverence built a stūpa of the Tathāgata's hair and nails within the queens' quarters and consecrated it.

There the retinue of queens made offerings to it with lamps, incense, flowers, perfumes, garlands, ointments, parasols, victory banners and flags.

Then King Ajātaśatru, incited by Devadatta, killed his father, the righteous king who ruled according to the Dharma, and took the throne himself. At that time he cut off everything that was to be given to the Blessed One's teaching, and he also laid down a law: "No one is to honor the stūpa of the Tathāgata!"

Then, when the time of the festival on the fifteenth day came, no one swept the stūpa of hair and nails, nor offered it lamps, incense or flowers. The retinue of queens saw the stūpa of hair and nails in that state, and remembering King Bimbisāra, they wept piteously and lamented, "Alas! Parted from the righteous king, we have fallen away from merit!"

Among them, a queen called Śrīmatī, staking her own life, recollected the qualities of the Buddha, swept the stūpa of hair and nails, and lit a garland of lamps.

Then King Ajātaśatru came up onto the top of his many-storied palace, and seeing that great light, he asked, "What is this?" Someone answered, "It is Śrīmatī, who has lit a garland of lamps at the stūpa of hair and nails."

Then he summoned Śrīmatī and said, "Why have you broken the king's command?" She replied, "Although I have broken your command, I have not broken the command of the righteous King Bimbisāra."

At that he flew into a rage, hurled a discus, and killed her. Then, her mind gladdened toward the Blessed One, she died and was reborn in the excellent divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three.

At that time an assembly of gods had also gathered, and the goddess Śrīmatī, possessed of a halo, a maṇḍala of divine light that shone a full league all around, entered the gods' assembly hall. Then Śakra, lord of the gods, seeing that great radiance and divine light a league across, asked her:

"Why has the color of your body become like pure gold, like the lotus and the utpala?
O you whose bodily splendor here is unequaled, from what have these lights streaming from your body come?
Why has the complexion of your face become like a lotus in bloom, like the hue of gold?
Through what deeds do you now enjoy this fruit? Goddess, tell me this."

The goddess said:

"I saw the Buddha, protector of the three worlds,
The single lamp for beings, rich in the supreme marks.
To the supreme speaker, who dispels the darkness of afflictions,
I offered as a gift lamps that dispel the dark.

Seeing light the color of the moon's rays,
Faith in the Sage arose from my very heart.
Delighted at the sight of those rays,
I bowed down to the Teacher, supreme among speakers.

Because I did such a virtuous deed,
I am radiant beyond measure;
My face is like the lotus and the moon,
Pure, shining, and lovely to behold."

Śakra said:

"Ah! In that very field of qualities,
Who has utterly abandoned every fault,
So as to be born in lovely form in the heavens,
You have planted a seed.

O fair-faced one, whose eyes are like broad lotus petals,
Who would not worship the Buddha, honored by the finest of women,
Whose eyes are like the broad petals of a lotus in bloom,
Radiant and bright like a heap of the finest gold?"

By the nature of things, a god or goddess, not long after being born, gives rise to three thoughts: "From where did I die and pass on? Where have I been born? Through what karma was I born?" Then she saw that she had died and passed from among humans, that she had been born in the excellent divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, and that this was because her mind had been gladdened toward the Blessed One.

Then the goddess Śrīmatī thought, "It is not fitting for me to go and see the Blessed One only once a day has passed. I will go to see the Blessed One before the day is over."

Then that very night the goddess Śrīmatī, filled with the radiance of divine light, filled the fold of her garment with divine flowers: utpalas, lotuses, kumudas, white lotuses and māndāravas. Lighting up the whole of the Kalandaka Feeding Ground at Rājagṛha with a great light, she strewed the flowers over the Blessed One and sat down before him to listen to the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, knowing the goddess Śrīmatī's disposition, latent tendencies, constitution and nature, taught her the Dharma in such a way that she came to realize the four noble truths. Having heard it, the goddess Śrīmatī shattered with the vajra of wisdom the twenty lofty peaks of the mountain of the view of the perishable collection, and attained the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truths, she three times uttered words of joy:

"Venerable One, the Blessed One has dried up for me the ocean of blood and tears, has carried me over the mountain of bones, has shut the doors to the lower realms, has opened the doors to the higher realms and to liberation, and has established me among gods and humans. What he has done for me was not done by my father, nor by my mother, nor by the king, nor by the gods, nor by my kin and the host of my relatives, nor by the departed ancestors, nor by śramaṇas and brahmins."

And she said further:

"The path to the lower realms, fraught with many evils,
Utterly dreadful, has been cut off by your power.
The way to the heavens, richly endowed with merit, has been opened,
And I have also gained the path to nirvāṇa.

Today, relying on you, I have obtained
The eye that is utterly pure, rid of faults.
I have crossed to the far shore of the ocean of suffering,
And shall attain the state of peace in which the noble ones delight.

O lord of supreme humans, worshipped by humans and gods,
You who have abandoned the sickness of birth, aging and death,
O Sage, so hard to behold in a thousand existences,
To have seen you today has borne fruit."

Then, delighted, her necklace swaying,
She bowed down and paid homage at his two feet,
And having circumambulated the Conqueror of Foes,
She turned toward the world of the gods and went to the divine realm.

Then the goddess Śrīmatī, like a merchant who has made a profit, like a farmer whose crops have flourished, like a hero victorious in battle, like a sick person freed from every illness, went back to her own abode with the very same splendor with which she had come to the Blessed One.

The monks, not sleeping in the first and last watches of the night, were dwelling intent on diligence, and they saw that a great light had appeared near the Blessed One. When they had seen it, doubt arose in them, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Blessed One, what was it? Last night did Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, or Śakra, lord of the gods, or the four world protectors come to see the Blessed One?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, it was not Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, nor Śakra, lord of the gods, nor the four world protectors who came to see me. Rather, a queen of King Bimbisāra called Śrīmatī, staking her own life and recollecting the qualities of the Buddha, lit a garland of lamps at the stūpa of the Tathāgata's hair and nails, and King Ajātaśatru, in his anger, killed her. Having brought forth a mind of joy toward me, she died and was reborn in the excellent divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three. Last night she came to me, and when I had taught her the Dharma she saw the truths and went back to her own abode.

"Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall honor the Teacher. We shall esteem him. We shall revere him. We shall worship him. Having honored the Teacher, esteemed him, revered him and worshipped him, we shall dwell relying on him.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called The Garment.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered and worshipped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the townspeople, guild masters, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshipped and acknowledged by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, endowed with great merit, receiving robes, alms food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

Then, after the householder Anāthapiṇḍada had offered the Jeta Grove to the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha, and had gradually offered a hundred koṭis, that is, a billion, gold coins to the Blessed One's teaching, this thought arose in him: "What is so wonderful about my giving gifts and making merit in this way? To benefit the poor, I shall collect offerings of faith from the people living in Śrāvastī and serve the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of

śrāvakas. If I do so, I shall also benefit many people and generate much merit as well."

Then the householder Anāthapiṇḍada told the king what he had been thinking, and the king had a bell rung throughout all of Śrāvastī and proclaimed: "Listen, all you townspeople living in Śrāvastī! Seven days from today the householder Anāthapiṇḍada, riding on an elephant, wishes to collect offerings of faith for the śrāvakas of the Tathāgata. Whatever each of you intends to give, and however much, give it!"

Then, when seven days had passed, the householder Anāthapiṇḍada mounted an elephant and set out to collect offerings of faith for the śrāvakas of the Tathāgata. There, people gave as much as each of them had. Some gave necklaces, some gave bracelets, some gave armlets, some gave gold chains, some gave ornamental rings, some gave pearl necklaces, some gave gold, some gave silver, and some gave even as little as an eighth of a māṣaka. And the householder accepted it all in order to benefit others.

Now at that time a very poor woman, toiling to exhaustion, had after three months obtained a single length of cotton cloth. She was wearing that cloth and had gone out into the street, when she saw the householder Anāthapiṇḍada coming from afar, with conches blowing and round drums beating. She asked a layman, "How is it that this householder, who is rich, with great wealth and vast possessions, who can even see treasures hidden beneath the ground, goes around begging from other people's houses?"

The layman replied, "It is to benefit others. For the sake of those who are unable to offer a meal to the Blessed One and the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, he does them this kindness: he gathers together many small gifts and has them offered to the Blessed One."

Then this thought occurred to the young woman: "Well then, I am someone who has made no merit, and I have no means to offer a meal by myself to the Blessed One and the Saṅgha of śrāvakas. Surely I should offer him something, however little." Then she looked to see what she possessed, and saw nothing at all apart from that single length of cloth. She thought, "If I offer this cloth while I stand here, I will be left naked. I will go up onto the roof and throw the cloth down."

So she went up onto the roof, took the cloth off her body, and threw it down onto the householder Anāthapiṇḍada. The householder was taken aback, and thinking, "Since she threw it down from the roof, surely she has no possessions

beyond this," he ordered his servants, "Go and see who threw down this cloth." They looked, and soon they saw the young woman crouching there. When they questioned her, she said, "I heard the qualities of the Blessed One being proclaimed, and terrified by the fear of poverty, I offered the garment I had obtained to the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Tathāgata." They reported this to the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

The householder Anāthapiṇḍada was supremely amazed, and he clothed the young woman in garments and adorned her with ornaments of every kind.

Then, her life being short, she died and was reborn in the excellent divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three. As soon as she was born, garments appeared for her such as no other god or goddess possessed.

By the nature of things, a god or goddess, not long after being born, gives rise to three thoughts: "From where did I die and pass on? Where have I been born? Through what karma was I born?" Then she saw that she had died and passed from among humans, that she had been born in the excellent divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, and that she had offered a cloth to the Blessed One.

Then the goddess who had formerly offered the cloth, wearing earrings and rings that gleamed and swayed, her body adorned with necklaces and chains, wearing a crown adorned with all kinds of precious jewels, her body anointed with saffron, tamāla leaf, spṛkkā and other fragrances, that very night filled the fold of her garment with divine flowers: utpalas, lotuses, kumudas, white lotuses and māndāravas. Lighting up the whole of the Jeta Grove with a great light, she strewed the flowers over the Blessed One and sat down before him to listen to the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, knowing the disposition, latent tendencies, constitution and nature of the goddess who had formerly offered the cloth, taught her the Dharma in such a way that she would come to realize the four noble truths. Having heard it, the goddess who had formerly offered the cloth shattered with the vajra of wisdom the twenty lofty peaks of the mountain of the view of the perishable collection, and attained the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truths, she three times uttered words of joy:

"Venerable One, the Blessed One has dried up for me the ocean of blood and tears, has carried me over the mountain of bones, has shut the doors to the lower realms, has opened the doors to the higher realms and to liberation, and has established me among gods and humans. What he has done for me was

not done by my father, nor by my mother, nor by the king, nor by the gods, nor by my kin and the host of my relatives, nor by the departed ancestors, nor by śramaṇas and brahmins."

And she said further:

"The path to the lower realms, fraught with many evils,
Utterly dreadful, has been cut off by your power.
The way to the heavens, richly endowed with merit, has been opened,
And I have also gained the path to nirvāṇa.

Today, relying on you, I have obtained
The eye that is utterly pure, rid of faults.
I have crossed to the far shore of the ocean of suffering,
And have attained the state of peace in which the noble ones delight.

O lord of supreme humans, worshipped by humans and gods,
You who have abandoned the sickness of birth, aging and death,
O Sage, so hard to behold in a thousand existences,
To have seen you today has borne fruit."

Then, delighted, her necklace swaying,
She bowed down and paid homage at his two feet,
And having circumambulated the Conqueror of Foes,
She turned toward the world of the gods and went to the divine realm.

Then the goddess who had formerly offered the cloth, like a merchant who has made a profit, like a farmer whose crops have flourished, like a hero victorious in battle, like a sick person freed from every illness, went back to her own abode with the very same splendor with which she had come to the Blessed One.

The monks, not sleeping in the first and last watches of the night, were dwelling intent on diligence, and they saw that a great light had appeared near the Blessed One. When they had seen it, doubt arose in them, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Blessed One, what was it? Last night did Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, or Śakra, lord of the gods, or the four world protectors come to see the Blessed One?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, it was not Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, nor Śakra, lord of the gods, nor the four world protectors who came to see me. Rather, the woman who offered the cloth, having offered her cloth to the householder Anāthapiṇḍada while he was collecting offerings of faith, died and

was reborn in the excellent divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three. Last night she came to me, and when I had taught her the Dharma she saw the truths and went back to her own abode.

"Therefore, monks, you should train in this way: 'We shall honor the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha, and we shall not fail to honor them.' Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called The Parrot.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered and worshipped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the townspeople, guild masters, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshipped and acknowledged by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, endowed with great merit, receiving robes, alms food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time King Bimbisāra was reigning in the city of Rājagṛha. During his reign the land was prosperous, flourishing, peaceful, blessed with good harvests and filled with many people and inhabitants. Disputes and fights had been quelled, and there were no riots, no civil strife, no robbers, no famine and no diseases. It was rich in sāli rice, sugarcane, cattle and buffalo. Free from harm, with every thorn rooted out, he ruled his kingdom as one would care for an only son.

That king was full of faith, virtuous and of noble intent, devoted to his own welfare and the welfare of others, greatly compassionate, magnanimous, a lover of the Dharma, and loving toward his subjects.

Then one day, longing to see the Blessed One, he sat with his cheek resting on his hand, his mind turned inward in brooding thought. His ministers said, "Your Majesty, why are you so downcast?" The king said, "For a long time I have not seen the Blessed One. For a long time I have not seen the Sugata. Now I wish to see the Blessed One."

Then the Blessed One, who had entered upon his daytime retreat, heard King Bimbisāra's longing with his divine ear, pure and surpassing that of humans.

Now, there is nothing at all that the buddhas, the blessed ones, do not know, do not see, do not realize or do not comprehend. And the buddhas, the blessed ones, who possess great compassion, who are devoted to benefiting the world, who have the single guard, who are sole heroes, without equal, who never speak in two ways, who abide in calm abiding and insight, who illuminate the three knowledges, who are well trained in the three trainings, who are skilled in the three bases of discipline, who have crossed the four floods, the soles of whose feet, the four bases of miraculous power, stand perfectly firm, who for a long time have been practiced in the four means of attraction, who are fearless through the four fearlessnesses, who roar the great and true lion's roar of the supreme bull, who have fully abandoned the five factors, who have completely transcended the five destinies, who possess the six factors, who have perfected the six perfections, who dwell in the six constant abidings, who are rich in the flowers of the seven limbs of awakening, who teach the eightfold path, who dwell in the nine successive meditative attainments, who have the power of the ten powers, whose fame pervades the ten directions, and who are far more exalted than the lord of the thousand-fold world, by the nature of things look upon the world with the eye of a buddha three times by day and three times by night. Their vision of wisdom turns to this: "Who is declining? Who is flourishing? Who is in need? Who has fallen into danger? Who is afflicted by harm? Who is in need, in danger and afflicted by harm? Who is inclining toward the lower realms? Who is sliding toward the lower realms? Who has fallen into the lower realms? Whom shall I draw out of the lower realms and establish in the higher realms, in liberation and in its fruits? Whom, sunk in the mire of desire, shall I pull out by the hand? Whom, lacking the seven noble riches, shall I make master of the wealth of the seven noble riches? In whom who has not yet generated roots of virtue shall I generate them? In whom who has already generated roots of virtue shall I ripen them? Whom, already ripened, shall I liberate?"

On this it is said:

"The ocean, the dwelling of sea monsters,
May sometimes let the hour of its tide go by;
But for the children who are to be trained,
The Buddha never lets the time go by."

Then, in order to benefit King Bimbisāra, when the three months of the summer rains had passed and he had made his robes, the Blessed One, his robes finished, put on his robes, took up his alms bowl, and set out wandering

through the country. Traveling by stages, he came to a forest. In that forest lived a parrot that knew human speech, and it saw the Blessed One from a long way off. It went very swiftly to the Blessed One and said, "Come, Blessed One! Welcome, Blessed One, welcome! Please do me a kindness. Please consider staying in this very forest."

Then, in order to benefit the parrot, the Blessed One spread a mat of grass at the foot of the tree where the parrot lived and sat down with his legs crossed. The great śrāvakas settled at the feet of other trees. Then the parrot, fearing that humans or nonhumans, yakṣas or rākṣasas, wild animals or beasts of prey might harm the Blessed One and the śrāvakas, flew back and forth around that forest the whole night long.

Then, when dawn broke, it circumambulated the Blessed One three times and asked his forgiveness: "Blessed One, since I have been born in the womb of an animal, I have no means at all to honor the Blessed One, so please forgive me. Even so, I would like to go ahead and announce to King Bimbisāra that the Blessed One is coming." The Blessed One said, "Do so."

Then it set out ahead of the Blessed One, and in due course reached the king. At that time King Bimbisāra was on the upper floor of his palace with only his women, amusing himself with music, delighting and enjoying himself. Then the parrot that knew human speech said to the king, "O King, know this: the Blessed One, together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, is coming to your land, so it is fitting that Your Majesty prepare a meal."

Then the king came down very swiftly from the upper floor of the palace, and attended by a host of great ministers, he had seats prepared for the Blessed One and went out to meet the Blessed One with parasols, victory banners, flags, incense, perfumes and flowers of every kind. Then, with great reverence, he invited the Blessed One and the Saṅgha of śrāvakas inside and satisfied them with fine food.

Then the parrot thought, "All this abundance for the Saṅgha of the Blessed One's śrāvakas is my doing." Realizing this, it was joyful, glad and delighted, and with joy, gladness and happiness arising in it, it flew back and forth in front of the king, until a hawk carried it off and killed it. Because it died having brought forth a mind of joy toward the Blessed One, it was reborn in the excellent divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three.

By the nature of things, a god or goddess, not long after being born, gives rise to three thoughts: "From where did I die and pass on? Where have I been

born? Through what karma was I born?" Then he saw that he had died and passed from among the animals, that he had been born in the excellent divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, and that this was because his mind had been gladdened toward the Blessed One.

Then the god who had formerly been a parrot thought, "It is not fitting for me to go and see the Blessed One only once a day has passed. I will go to see the Blessed One before the day is over."

Then the god who had formerly been a parrot, wearing spotless, swaying ring earrings, his body adorned with necklaces and half-necklaces, wearing a crown adorned with various precious jewels, his body anointed with saffron, tamāla leaves, spṛkkā and the like, on that very night filled the fold of his garment with divine flowers: utpalas, lotuses, kumudas, white lotuses and mandāravas. Illuminating the whole of the Jeta Grove with a great radiance, he scattered the flowers over the Blessed One and sat down before the Blessed One in order to listen to the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, understanding the intentions, latent tendencies, constitution and nature of the god who had formerly been a parrot, taught him the Dharma in such a way that he would realize the Four Noble Truths. Having heard it, the god who had formerly been a parrot, with the vajra of wisdom, destroyed the twenty lofty peaks of the mountain of the view of the perishable collection, and attained the fruit of stream entry. Having seen the truths, he uttered words of joy three times: "Venerable One, the Blessed One has dried up for me the ocean of blood and tears, has carried me across the mountain of bones, has closed the doors to the lower realms, has opened the doors to the higher realms and to liberation, and has established me among gods and humans. Such a thing was not done for me by my father, nor by my mother, nor by the king, nor by the gods, nor by my household and the host of my kin, nor by my departed ancestors, nor by ascetics and brahmins."

And he said further:

"The path to the lower realms, so full of faults,
Utterly dreadful, you have cut off by your power.
You opened the way to the higher realms, rich in merit,
And I have gained the path to nirvāṇa as well.
Today, relying on you, I have obtained
The utterly pure eye that has cast off faults.
I have crossed to the far shore of the ocean of suffering

And gained the peaceful state in which the noble ones delight.
Lord, best of humans, honored by humans and gods,
Free of the sickness of birth, old age and death,
Sage so hard to see in a thousand existences,
Today I have seen you, and it has borne fruit."

Then, his necklace swaying, filled with joy,
He bowed and paid homage at his two feet,
And having circumambulated the Conqueror of Foes,
He turned toward the world of the gods and went to the divine realm.

Then, like a merchant who has made a profit, a farmer whose crops have flourished, a hero victorious in battle, or a sick man freed from every illness, the god who had formerly been a parrot went back to his own abode with the very same splendor with which he had come into the presence of the Blessed One.

The monks, not sleeping in the first and last watches of the night, were intent on exertion, and they saw that a great light had appeared near the Blessed One. Having seen it, doubt arose in them, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Blessed One, what was that? Last night, did Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, or Śakra, lord of the gods, or the four world protectors come to see the Blessed One?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, it was not Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, nor Śakra, lord of the gods, nor the four world protectors who came to see me. Did you see the parrot that invited me to that forest grove for a night's lodging?"

The monks replied, "Blessed One, we saw it."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, that very parrot died and was born in the excellent divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three."

The monks asked, "Venerable One, what deeds did the god who was formerly a parrot perform, by which he was born as a parrot? And what deeds did he perform, by which he was born among the gods and came to see the truths?"

The Blessed One said, "The god who was formerly a parrot himself performed and accumulated those deeds, whose accumulations are complete, whose conditions have ripened, which have come upon him like a flood, and which inevitably arrive. Since the god who was formerly a parrot performed and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds

performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element or the wind element. Virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense sources.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen into their very fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in this very Fortunate Eon, when people lived for twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, the guide who tames beings, the unsurpassed one, the teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One called Kāśyapa. He was dwelling near the city of Vārāṇasī. At one time a layman there was lax in the training, and through the ripening of that deed he was born as a parrot. Because he gladdened his mind toward me, he was born as a god. Because he kept the remaining points of training, he came to see the truths.

"Thus, monks, the ripening of entirely black deeds is entirely black; the ripening of entirely white deeds is entirely white; and the ripening of mixed deeds is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon entirely black deeds and mixed deeds, and devote yourselves solely to entirely white deeds. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Messenger.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace retinue, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshiped and renowned among gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, had committed himself, together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, to spend the rains retreat at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove at the Kalandaka Feeding Ground.

Then the householder Anāthapiṇḍada went to where Prasenajit, king of Kosala, was, and on arriving he praised the king, saying, "May you be victorious! May you live long!" and made this request: "Your Majesty, please know that I have not seen the Blessed One for a long time, and I thirst with longing to see the Blessed One. I wish to see the Blessed One."

Then the king said to the householder Anāthapiṇḍada, "Householder, what have you heard about where the Blessed One now intends to spend the rains retreat?"

Anāthapiṇḍada said, "Your Majesty, I have heard that the Blessed One has committed himself to spend the rains retreat at Rājagṛha."

Then Prasenajit, king of Kosala, the householder Anāthapiṇḍada and the others, the people of the palace retinue, the townspeople and the ministers, summoned a man as a messenger and instructed him: "Come here, man. Go to where the Blessed One is, and on arriving, bow your head at the Blessed One's feet and, on our behalf, ask, 'Blessed One, are you free of ailment, free of discomfort? Do you move about with ease? Are you well, are you strong, are you at ease, without distress, and do you dwell in comfort?' And say this: 'Venerable One, the king of Kosala and the people of the palace retinue living in Śrāvastī long to behold the face of the Blessed One. Since we have not seen the Blessed One for a long time, we thirst with longing to see the Blessed One. As we long to see the Blessed One, out of compassion, may the Blessed One please come to Śrāvastī.' That is what they say."

Then that man heeded the instructions of Prasenajit, king of Kosala, the ministers, the people of the palace retinue and the townspeople, and set out for Rājagṛha. Traveling by stages, he arrived at the city of Rājagṛha. Then, after searching all through the city of Rājagṛha, he went to where the Blessed One was, and on arriving, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable One, please know that Prasenajit, king of Kosala, and the people of the palace retinue living in Śrāvastī bow their heads at the Blessed One's feet and ask, 'Blessed One, are you free of ailment, free of discomfort? Do you move about with ease? Are you well, are you strong, are you at ease, without distress, and do you dwell in comfort?' And they also say this: 'Since we have not seen the Blessed One for a long time, we thirst with longing to see the Blessed One. As we long to see the Blessed One, out of compassion, may the Blessed One please come to Śrāvastī.'"

The Blessed One said, "Friend, if King Bimbisāra permits me to go, I will go."

Then that messenger made the request to King Bimbisāra, and said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, King Bimbisāra has given his consent for the Blessed One to go. Since the Blessed One now knows that the time for it has come, may he please set out." So he urged him.

Then the Blessed One consented to that man by remaining silent. Then, when the three months of the summer rains had passed, the Blessed One, having made his robes and finished the robes, put on his robes, took up his alms bowl, and set out for Śrāvastī with a large retinue of attendants.

The messenger, too, mounted a chariot and set out. Then, seeing the Buddha, the Blessed One, going on foot, he got down from the chariot, and bowing with palms joined toward the Blessed One, he said this to the Blessed One: "Out of compassion, may the Blessed One please accept my chariot."

The Blessed One said:

"Abiding in the chariot of the bases of miraculous power
And of right effort,
Unharmed by the thorns of the afflictions,
I travel all over the earth."

The messenger said, "Although the Blessed One travels on the feet of miraculous power, still, to benefit me and out of compassion, please ride."

Then, in order to benefit the messenger, the Blessed One, by miraculous power, sat upon the chariot. Then the Blessed One, riding in the chariot, arrived at Śrāvastī, and the messenger announced it to the king. Then the king, the ministers, the people of the palace retinue and the townspeople went out to receive the Blessed One, and that night they stayed in that very Jeta Grove in order to listen to the Dharma.

That messenger was short-lived: after hearing the Dharma, he died that very night, and having died, he was born in the excellent divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three. Not long after being born, a god or goddess, by the nature of things, gives rise to three thoughts: "From where did I die and pass on? Where have I been born? Through what karma was I born?" Then he saw that he had died and passed from among humans, that he had been born in the excellent divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, and that this was because his mind had been gladdened toward the Blessed One.

Then the god who had formerly been the messenger thought, "It is not fitting for me to go and see the Blessed One only once a day has passed. I will go to

see the Blessed One before the day is over."

Then the god who had formerly been the messenger, wearing spotless, swaying ring earrings, his body adorned with necklaces and half-necklaces, wearing a crown adorned with various precious jewels, his body anointed with saffron, tamāla leaves, spṛkkā and the like, on that very night filled the fold of his garment with divine flowers: utpalas, kumudas, lotuses, white lotuses and mandāravas. Illuminating the whole of the Jeta Grove with a great radiance, he scattered the flowers over the Blessed One and sat down before the Blessed One in order to listen to the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, understanding the intentions, latent tendencies, constitution and nature of the god who had formerly been the messenger, taught him the Dharma in such a way that he would realize the Four Noble Truths. Having heard it, the god who had formerly been the messenger, with the vajra of wisdom, destroyed the twenty lofty peaks of the mountain of the view of the perishable collection, and attained the fruit of stream entry. Having seen the truths, he uttered words of joy three times: "Venerable One, the Blessed One has dried up for me the ocean of blood and tears, has carried me across the mountain of bones, has closed the doors to the lower realms, has opened the doors to the higher realms and to liberation, and has established me among gods and humans. Such a thing was not done for me by my father, nor by my mother, nor by the king, nor by the gods, nor by my household and the host of my kin, nor by my departed ancestors, nor by ascetics and brahmins."

And he said further:

"The path to the lower realms, so full of faults,
Utterly dreadful, you have cut off by your power.
You opened the way to the higher realms, rich in merit,
And I have gained the path to nirvāṇa as well.
Today, relying on you, I have obtained
The utterly pure eye that has cast off faults.
I have crossed to the far shore of the ocean of suffering
And gained the peaceful state in which the noble ones delight.
Lord, best of humans, honored by humans and gods,
Free of the sickness of birth, old age and death,
Sage so hard to see in a thousand existences,
Today I have seen you, and it has borne fruit."

Then, his necklace swaying, filled with joy,
He bowed and paid homage at his two feet,
And having circumambulated the Conqueror of Foes,
He turned toward the world of the gods and went to the divine realm.

Then, like a merchant who has made a profit, a farmer whose crops have flourished, a hero victorious in battle, or a sick man freed from every illness, the god who had formerly been the messenger went back to his own abode with the very same splendor with which he had come into the presence of the Blessed One.

Then Prasenajit, king of Kosala, who was on the upper floor of his palace, saw that great light, and when day broke he asked the Blessed One, "Blessed One, what was that? Last night, did Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, or Śakra, lord of the gods, or the four world protectors come to see the Blessed One?"

The Blessed One said, "Great king, it was not Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, nor Śakra, lord of the gods, nor the four world protectors who came to see me. Rather, that messenger of yours, his mind gladdened toward me, died and was born in the excellent divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three. Last night he came into my presence; I taught him the Dharma, he came to see the truths, and he went back to his own abode."

Then the king was amazed and said, "Oh, the Buddha! Oh, the Dharma! Oh, the Saṅgha! Even a small thing done toward these becomes a great ripening!"

Then Prasenajit, king of Kosala, praised and rejoiced in what the Blessed One had said, bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet, rose from his seat and departed.

Then the Blessed One said to the monks, "Monks, there are these three that are declared supreme. What are the three? The Buddha, declared supreme; the Dharma, declared supreme; and the Saṅgha, declared supreme.

"What is the Buddha, declared supreme? Among whatever beings there are, whether footless, two-footed, four-footed or many-footed, whether having form or formless, whether having perception, without perception, or neither having perception nor without perception, among them the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha is taught to be supreme. Whoever delights in the Buddha delights in the supreme, and it should be known that for those who delight in the supreme, the ripening too will be only the supreme, whether among gods as gods or among humans as humans. This is called the Buddha,

declared supreme.

"What is the Dharma, declared supreme? Among whatever phenomena there are, whether conditioned or unconditioned, among them the Dharma of freedom from attachment is taught to be supreme. Whoever delights in the Dharma delights in the supreme, and it should be known that for those who delight in the supreme, the ripening too will be only the supreme, whether among gods as gods or among humans as humans. This is called the Dharma, declared supreme.

"What is the Saṅgha, declared supreme? Among whatever groups, gatherings, multitudes or assemblies there are, among them the Saṅgha of the Tathāgata's śrāvakas is taught to be supreme. Whoever delights in the Saṅgha delights in the supreme, and it should be known that for those who delight in the supreme, the ripening too will be only the supreme, whether among gods as gods or among humans as humans. This is called the Saṅgha, declared supreme."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, section fourteen.

The Buffalo.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace retinue, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshiped and renowned among gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was wandering through the land of Kosala together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, and came to a certain forest. In that forest there were a great herd of buffalo and five hundred buffalo herders.

Now, among them there was a buffalo that was strong, possessed of supreme strength, and whenever it caught the scent of other people, it would chase after them. The Blessed One, too, went in that direction. Then the buffalo herders saw the Blessed One and the Saṅgha of śrāvakas from far away, and they called out loudly, "Blessed One, there is a vicious buffalo here! Please do not come along this path!"

The Blessed One said, "Friends, I know that the time for this has come here, so do not be afraid."

Then that buffalo, seeing the Blessed One from far away, raised its tail straight up and charged toward where the Blessed One was. Then the Blessed One emanated in front of himself five maned lions with tossing manes, emanated five great men on his right and left flanks, and above emanated a great boulder of iron. Then the buffalo, seeing great terror in every direction, went to the Blessed One's feet, licked the Blessed One's feet with its tongue, and looked up at the Blessed One with a cowed face.

Then the Blessed One, in a language it could understand, taught it three phrases of Dharma: "Good friend, it is thus: all formations are impermanent; all phenomena are without self; nirvāṇa is peace." He also caused it to remember its former lives, and hearing this, it wept. Then the Blessed One spoke these verses to it:

"You have been born as an animal;
What can I do for you now?
You have already been born in a state without freedom;
What good is it to weep in vain?
Here, toward me, the compassionate Victor,
Give rise to a mind of faith.
It would be well to leave the animal birthplace,
And then you will go to the higher realms."

Then that vicious buffalo, scorning its own body, stopped eating; and since creatures born in the animal birthplace have a fierce digestive fire, it quickly died and was born in the excellent divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three. Not long after being born, a god or goddess, by the nature of things, gives rise to three thoughts: "From where did I die and pass on? Where have I been born? Through what karma was I born?" Then he saw that he had died and passed from among the animals, that he had been born in the excellent divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, and that this was because his mind had been gladdened toward the Blessed One.

Then the god who had formerly been the buffalo thought, "It is not fitting for me to go and see the Blessed One only once a day has passed. I will go to see the Blessed One before the day is over."

Then the god who had formerly been the buffalo, wearing spotless, swaying ring earrings, his body adorned with necklaces and half-necklaces, wearing a

crown adorned with various precious jewels, his body anointed with saffron, tamāla leaves, spṛkkā and the like, on that very night filled the fold of his garment with divine flowers: utpalas, lotuses, kumudas, white lotuses and mandāravas. Illuminating all those forests with a great radiance, he scattered the flowers over the Blessed One and sat down before the Blessed One in order to listen to the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, understanding the intentions, latent tendencies, constitution and nature of the god who had formerly been the buffalo, taught him the Dharma in such a way that he would realize the Four Noble Truths. Having heard it, the god who had formerly been the buffalo, with the vajra of wisdom, destroyed the twenty lofty peaks of the mountain of the view of the perishable collection, and attained the fruit of stream entry. Having seen the truths, he uttered words of joy three times: "Venerable One, the Blessed One has dried up for me the ocean of blood and tears, has carried me across the mountain of bones, has closed the doors to the lower realms, has opened the doors to the higher realms and to liberation, and has established me among gods and humans. Such a thing was not done for me by my father, nor by my mother, nor by the king, nor by the gods, nor by my household and the host of my kin, nor by my departed ancestors, nor by ascetics and brahmins."

And he said further:

"The path to the lower realms, so full of faults,
Utterly dreadful, you have cut off by your power.
You opened the way to the higher realms, rich in merit,
And I have gained the path to nirvāṇa as well.
Today, relying on you, I have obtained
The utterly pure eye that has cast off faults.
I have crossed to the far shore of the ocean of suffering
And gained the peaceful state in which the noble ones delight.
Lord, best of humans, honored by humans and gods,
Free of the sickness of birth, old age and death,
Sage so hard to see in a thousand existences,
Today I have seen you, and it has borne fruit."

Then, his necklace swaying, filled with joy,
He bowed and paid homage at his two feet,
And having circumambulated the Conqueror of Foes,
He turned toward the world of the gods and went to the divine realm.

Then, like a merchant who has made a profit, a farmer whose crops have flourished, a hero victorious in battle, or a sick man freed from every illness, the god who had formerly been the buffalo went back to his own abode with the very same splendor with which he had come into the presence of the Blessed One.

Then those buffalo herders saw that great light. Having seen it, doubt arose in them, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Blessed One, who was it that came into the Blessed One's presence last night and made everything bright with divine radiance?"

The Blessed One said, "That buffalo of yours, his mind gladdened toward me, died and was born in the excellent divine realm of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three. Last night he came into my presence; I taught him the Dharma, he came to see the truths, and he went back to his own abode."

Then those buffalo herders were utterly astonished and amazed. They thought, "If even this one, born in the animal birthplace, met the Blessed One, a spiritual friend, was born among the gods and came to see the truths, why should we not attain something special too?"

Then they satisfied the Buddha, the Blessed One, and the Saṅgha of śrāvakas with fine food, and went forth in the presence of the Blessed One. Through diligence, practice and effort they abandoned all afflictions and directly realized arhatship.

Then doubt arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what deeds did the god who was formerly a buffalo perform, by which he was born as a buffalo? What deeds did he perform, by which he was born among the gods and came to see the truths? What deeds did these buffalo herders perform, by which they became buffalo herders? And by performing what deeds did they go forth and directly realize arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, in other former lives these very ones performed and accumulated deeds whose accumulations are complete, whose conditions have ripened, which have come upon them like a flood, and which inevitably arrive. Since these very ones performed and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element or the wind element. Virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates,

elements and sense sources.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen into their very fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in this very Fortunate Eon, when people lived for twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, the guide who tames beings, the unsurpassed one, the teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One called Kāśyapa. He was dwelling near the city of Vārāṇasī, at Ṛṣivadana in the Deer Park.

"At that time, when the monks were holding an assembly to settle questions of doctrine, a monk who was a master of the three baskets was present in that assembly with a following of five hundred. In it there were also monks who were still in training and monks beyond training, and they put questions to the master of the three baskets. He was unable to answer them, and growing angry, he let fly harsh words: 'What do these creatures, like buffalo of the forest, know?' And his disciples too said, 'What do these, who are like buffalo herders, know?'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The monk who was the master of the three baskets is this very buffalo, and those disciples are these buffalo herders. Through that deed he was born as a buffalo for five hundred lifetimes, and the disciples became five hundred buffalo herders. Because his mind was gladdened toward me, he was born as a god. Because they had obtained the state of a monk and kept moral discipline, they came to see the truths and directly realized arhatship.

"Therefore, monks, you should strive to abandon faults of speech, so that such faults as those of the buffalo and the buffalo herders do not arise, and so that you may attain such a wealth of good qualities as that god's. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Upoṣadha.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace retinue, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshiped and renowned among gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was dwelling together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time, among the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, there was a son of the gods called Upoṣadha, who would always go into the presence of the Blessed One in order to hear the Dharma. Then, on a later occasion, the son of the gods Upoṣadha, together with a retinue of five hundred attendants, went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, he bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One and sat down to one side in order to hear the Dharma. Then the Blessed One, having understood the intentions, the latent tendencies, the constitution and the nature of the son of the gods Upoṣadha, taught him the Dharma in such a way that he would realize the Four Noble Truths. When he had heard it, the son of the gods Upoṣadha, with the vajra of wisdom, shattered the twenty towering peaks of the mountain of the view of a real self (satkāyadṛṣṭi), and attained the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truth, he uttered words of joy three times:

"Venerable Blessed One, you have dried up for me the ocean of blood and tears, carried me over the mountain of bones, closed the doors to the lower realms, opened the doors to the higher realms and to liberation, and established me among gods and humans. Such a thing as this was not done for me by my father, nor by my mother, nor by the king, nor by the gods, nor by my household and the host of my kinsmen, nor by my departed ancestors, nor by śramaṇas and brahmins."

And he said further:

"The path to the lower realms, so very fierce,
Laden with many evils, you have cut off by your power.
The way to the higher realms, rich in merit, you have opened,
And I have gained as well the path to nirvāṇa.
Today, relying on you, I have gained
The utterly pure eye, free of all faults.
I have crossed beyond the ocean of suffering

And gained the peaceful state that delights the noble ones.
Lord, supreme among humans, worshiped by humans and gods,
Free of the sickness of birth, old age and death,
O Sage, hard to see in a thousand existences,
To have seen you today bears fruit."

Then, with his necklace swaying, filled with joy,
He bowed down and paid homage at his two feet,
And having circumambulated the Conqueror of Foes,
He turned toward the world of the gods and went to the divine realm.

Then, like a merchant who has made a profit, like a farmer whose crop has flourished, like a hero victorious in battle, like a sick man freed from every illness, the son of the gods Upoṣadha returned to his own abode with the very same splendor with which he had come into the presence of the Blessed One.

At that time the monks, not sleeping in the first and last watches of the night, were devoted to diligent practice, and they saw that a great radiance had appeared around the Blessed One. When they saw it, a doubt arose in them, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Blessed One, what was it? Last night did Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, or Śakra, lord of the gods, or the four world protectors come to see the Blessed One?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, it was not Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, nor Śakra, lord of the gods, nor the four world protectors who came to see me. The son of the gods Upoṣadha, together with a retinue of five hundred attendants, came to see me. I taught him the Dharma, he saw the truth, and he went back to his own abode."

Then a doubt arose in those monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, where did the son of the gods Upoṣadha come from? From what was his name given?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, do you wish to hear?"

They replied, "Venerable One, we wish to hear."

He said, "Then, monks, listen well and carefully and keep it in mind, and I shall explain.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in this very Fortunate Eon, when people lived for twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the

arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, guide who tames beings, unsurpassed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One called Kāśyapa. He was dwelling near the city of Vārāṇasī, at Ṛṣivadana, in the Deer Park.

"On a later occasion King Kṛkin went to see the Blessed One and to honor him. Then at one time two brahmins went to Ṛṣivadana on some business, and the two of them saw that king, endowed with great royal splendor and royal might. Then a longing for kingship arose in the two of them, and they asked a certain layman, 'O layman of the Buddha, what deed must one do so that whatever one thinks of and whatever one wishes will all be accomplished?'

"The layman said, 'Whoever keeps the eight-branched Upoṣadha in complete purity, whatever he thinks of and whatever he wishes will all be accomplished.'

"Then those two brahmins took the eight-branched Upoṣadha from the householder Chutö and kept it. One of them kept it in complete purity. When he died, he was born as the son of King Kṛkin; the son was given the name Sujāta, and after his father died he was placed on the throne. The other let his Upoṣadha lapse, and when he died he was born among the nāgas. Every single day, seven times over, burning sand rained down upon him, so that nothing but his bones was left.

"Then he thought, 'Of what is this the fruit? Of what is this the fruit and ripening, that I go on experiencing suffering such as this?' Then he thought, 'Because I was lax in the training of the eight-branched Upoṣadha that I had taken, I am experiencing suffering such as this, while the one who took it and kept it has gained a kingdom.' And again he thought, 'Even now I shall keep the eight-branched Upoṣadha. Then perhaps I may be freed from birth as a nāga.'

"Then, magically transforming himself into the guise of a brahmin, he came into the presence of the king. Having arrived, he praised the king, saying, 'May you be victorious! May you live long!' and said, 'Great king, I seek from you the eight-branched Upoṣadha. Your Majesty, please grant me the eight-branched Upoṣadha. If you do not grant it, Your Majesty's head will without doubt split into seven pieces.' Having said this, he vanished on the spot.

"Then the king was afraid and terrified; he was unhappy and dejected. He had a vessel holding a hundred thousand pieces of gold tied to the top of a banner, and had it proclaimed with bells throughout his whole land: 'Whoever teaches

me the eight-branched Upoṣadha, to him I shall give these hundred thousand pieces of gold, and I shall honor him with great honors as well.' So he ordered.

"Then at one time an old woman, a carpenter's daughter, who lived there, pointed out a pillar to the king and said, 'In the past my father always made offerings to this pillar with incense, fumigants and flowers. Have it dug out and see.' Then the king ordered his attendants, 'Dig out this pillar!' When the king's servants had dug out the pillar, they found beneath it, written on golden plates, the eight-branched Upoṣadha, the five bases of training of a layman, and the thirty-seven factors conducive to awakening. Then the king wrote out the eight-branched Upoṣadha and gave it to that nāga. And twelve thousand sages dwelling at Ṛṣivadana directly realized the thirty-seven factors conducive to awakening.

"That nāga, too, kept the eight-branched Upoṣadha. He came out onto open ground and, abandoning his body, lay there while creatures fed upon him. Then he died and, together with a retinue of five hundred attendants, was born in the fine divine realm of the Thirty-Three. Monks, that is where Upoṣadha came from, and from that his name was given."

When the Blessed One had said this, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called The Geese.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace retinue, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshiped and renowned among gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was dwelling together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time Prasenajit, king of Kosala, was reigning in Śrāvastī. During his reign the land was prosperous, flourishing, peaceful and blessed with good harvests, filled with many folk and people; quarrels and fighting were stilled; it was free of unrest, internal strife, robbers, famine and disease, and rich in śāli rice, sugarcane, cattle and buffalo. Without causing harm, and with its thorns cleared away, he ruled the kingdom as one cares for an only son.

On a later occasion, when Prasenajit, king of Kosala, went to the Jeta Grove to see the Blessed One and to pay him homage, the king of Pañcāla had sent five hundred geese as a gift to Prasenajit, king of Kosala, and when the king went to the Jeta Grove he presented those five hundred geese. Then King Prasenajit granted those geese safety and released them in that very Jeta Grove.

Whenever the Blessed One, with his great retinue of śrāvakas, sat taking his meal, those geese would go into the presence of the Blessed One, and the Blessed One and those great śrāvakas would give them morsels of food. When they had eaten, they settled down content and delighted, their senses refreshed. Whenever the Blessed One rose from inner meditative absorption and taught the Dharma to the four assemblies, those geese would go into the presence of the Blessed One and listen to the Dharma.

Then, being short-lived, they died and were born in the fine divine realm of the Thirty-Three. Not long after a son or daughter of the gods is born, by the nature of things three thoughts arise: "From where did I die and pass on? Where have I been born? By what karma was I born here?" Then they saw that they had died and passed on from being geese, that they had been born in the fine divine realm of the Thirty-Three, and that this was because their minds had been gladdened by the Blessed One.

Then the sons of the gods who had formerly been geese thought, "It is not fitting for us to wait until a night has passed before going to see the Blessed One. We shall go to see the Blessed One before the night has passed."

Then the sons of the gods who had formerly been geese, wearing earrings and bracelets that glittered as they moved, their bodies adorned with necklaces and half necklaces, with crowns adorned with various precious jewels, their bodies anointed with saffron, tamāla leaves, spṛkkā and the like, on that very night filled their laps with divine flowers, utpalas, lotuses, kumudas, white lotuses and māndārava flowers. Illuminating the whole of the Jeta Grove with a great light, they strewed the flowers over the Blessed One and sat before the Blessed One in order to hear the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, having understood the intentions, the latent tendencies, the constitution and the nature of the sons of the gods who had formerly been geese, taught them the Dharma in such a way that they would realize the Four Noble Truths. When they had heard it, the sons of the gods who had formerly been geese, with the vajra of wisdom, shattered the twenty towering peaks of the mountain of the view of a real self, and attained the fruit

of stream-entry. Having seen the truth, they uttered words of joy three times:

"Venerable Blessed One, you have dried up for us the ocean of blood and tears, carried us over the mountain of bones, closed the doors to the lower realms, opened the doors to the higher realms and to liberation, and established us among gods and humans. Such a thing as this was not done for us by our fathers, nor by our mothers, nor by the king, nor by the gods, nor by our households and the host of our kinsmen, nor by our departed ancestors, nor by śramaṇas and brahmins."

And they said further:

"The path to the lower realms, so very fierce,
Laden with many evils, you have cut off by your power.
The way to the higher realms, rich in merit, you have opened,
And we have gained the path to nirvāṇa.
Today, relying on you, we have gained
The utterly pure eye, free of all faults.
We have crossed beyond the ocean of suffering
And gained the peaceful state that delights the noble ones.
Lord, supreme among humans, worshiped by gods and humans,
Free of the sickness of birth, old age and death,
O Sage, hard to see in a thousand existences,
To have seen you today bears fruit."

Then, with their necklaces swaying, filled with joy,
They bowed down and paid homage at his two feet,
And having circumambulated the Conqueror of Foes,
They turned toward the world of the gods and went to the divine realm.

Then, like merchants who have made a profit, like farmers whose crops have flourished, like heroes victorious in battle, like sick men freed from every illness, the sons of the gods who had formerly been geese returned to their own abode with the very same splendor with which they had come into the presence of the Blessed One.

At that time the monks, not sleeping in the first and last watches of the night, were devoted to diligent practice, and they saw that a great radiance had appeared around the Blessed One. When they saw it, a doubt arose in them, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Blessed One, what was it? Last night did Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, or Śakra, lord of the gods, or the four world protectors come to see the Blessed

One?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, it was not Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, nor Śakra, lord of the gods, nor the four world protectors who came to see me. Monks, did you see the five hundred geese that Prasenajit, king of Kosala, released here?"

"Venerable One, we saw them."

He said, "Their minds became gladdened toward me, and when they died they were born in the fine divine realm of the Thirty-Three. Last night they came into my presence; I taught them the Dharma, they saw the truth, and they went back to their own abode."

Then a doubt arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what deeds did the sons of the gods who had formerly been geese do, by which they were born as geese? What deeds did they do, by which they were born among the gods and saw the truth?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, in other, earlier lives these very beings did and accumulated deeds whose causes had gathered and whose conditions had ripened, which bear down like a flood and inevitably come to pass. The deeds that the sons of the gods who had formerly been geese did and accumulated, who else will experience them? Monks, deeds that have been done and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element or the wind element. Virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds that have been done and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense bases.

"The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen as their very fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in this very Fortunate Eon, when people lived for twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, guide who tames beings, unsurpassed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One called Kāśyapa. He was dwelling near the city of Vārāṇasī, at Ṛṣivadana, in the Deer Park.

"At that time these beings had gone forth, and because they were lax in the training, they were born as geese. Because they gladdened their minds toward me, they were born as gods. Because they kept the rest of the training, they came to see the truth.

"Therefore, monks, the ripening of wholly black deeds is wholly black, the ripening of wholly white deeds is wholly white, and the ripening of mixed deeds is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon wholly black deeds and mixed deeds, and devote yourselves to wholly white deeds alone. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had said this, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Here ends the sixth section of summary verses from the Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa.

The summary:

Suvarṇābha and Fragrant One,
Handsome, Strong, and Dugu,
Lotus Eyes and Drum Sound,
Son, Sun, and the Malla.

The story called Suvarṇābha.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace retinue, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshiped and renowned among gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was dwelling together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Kapilavastu, in the Nyagrodha Park.

At that time there lived in Kapilavastu a Śākya who was rich, with great wealth and abundant possessions, with vast and extensive holdings, possessed of the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He took a wife from a family equal to his own, and he played, enjoyed himself and made love with her. As he played, enjoyed himself and made love, his wife became pregnant, and after eight or nine months had passed, she gave birth to a son: a boy handsome, good to look at and beautiful, surpassing human complexion though not attaining the complexion of the gods, the color of gold from the

Jambu River. His golden light illuminated the whole city of Kapilavastu.

Then his parents and other beings, seeing him, came to gaze at him, and were utterly amazed, wondering, "Where has such an extraordinary being come from?"

Then, when the birth celebration had been held, they set about naming him, asking, "What name shall we give this boy?" His relatives said, "When he was born, the whole city of Kapilavastu was illuminated with golden light. Therefore let this boy be named Suvarṇābha."

Then the boy Suvarṇābha was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry him in their laps, two nurses to suckle him, two nurses to wash away his dirt, and two nurses to play with him. These eight nurses raised and nourished him with milk, curd, butter, ghee, cream of butter and every other kind of excellent provision, and he grew quickly, like a lotus in a lake. He was learned, clear-minded and upright, full of faith, virtuous and of good intentions, engaged in benefiting both himself and others, compassionate, magnanimous, and a lover of the Dharma.

Some time later, intoxicated with pride in his good looks, he was amusing himself outside the city. A large number of Śākyas were going to the Nyagrodha Park. The boy Suvarṇābha saw them and asked, "Where are you going?"

They said, "We are going to the Nyagrodha Park to see the Buddha, the Blessed One."

When the boy Suvarṇābha heard the word "Buddha", a name he had never heard before, all the hair on his body stood on end. Utterly amazed, he thought, "Why, I too had better go and see the Buddha, the Blessed One." So he too went to the Nyagrodha Park. There the boy Suvarṇābha saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, with a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, like a moving mountain of jewels, wholly excellent. The moment he saw him, his pride in his looks vanished. He bowed at the feet of the Blessed One and sat before the Blessed One in order to hear the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One taught him the Dharma, and when he had heard that Dharma, he wished to go forth. Then, at one time, having asked leave of his parents, he went into the presence of the Blessed One. Having arrived, he

bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, and bowing with joined palms toward where the Blessed One was, he said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable One, if I may go forth and receive full ordination in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya, and attain the state of a monk, I too wish to practice the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One."

Then the Blessed One stretched out his golden-colored hand, which was like the trunk of an elephant, and said this to the boy Suvarṇābha: "Come, young man, practice the holy life!" The instant he said this, his hair and beard were shaven, as though seven days had passed since they were shaved; his deportment was like that of one who had been fully ordained for a hundred years; and in his hands he held an alms bowl and a water vessel. Here it is said:

When the Tathāgata said to him, "Come,"
His head was shaven and his body clad in the patched robe.
Dressed in robes by the Buddha's intent,
At once he abode with his senses fully calmed.

Then he sat before the Blessed One, and the Blessed One gave him instruction in attention. Through effort, exertion and striving, he understood that this very wheel of saṃsāra with its five spokes is moving and unstable. Having fully ascertained that all kinds of conditioned things are by nature subject to decay, falling, scattering and destruction, he abandoned all afflictions and realized arhatship. As an arhat, free of attachment to the three realms, regarding gold and a clod of earth as equal, with a mind like the sky and the palm of the hand alike, cool as sandalwood paste, having broken the eggshell with knowledge, having attained the knowledges, the higher perceptions and the analytical knowledges, indifferent to worldly gain, attachment and honors, he became worthy of the offerings, homage and respectful address of the gods, together with Indra and Upendra.

Then a doubt arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what deeds did Suvarṇābha do, by which he became so handsome, good to look at and beautiful, and, having gone forth, realized arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, in other, earlier lives Suvarṇābha himself did and accumulated deeds whose causes had gathered and whose conditions had ripened, which bear down like a flood and inevitably come to pass. The deeds that Suvarṇābha himself did and accumulated, who else will experience them?

Monks, deeds that have been done and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element or the wind element. Virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds that have been done and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense bases.

"The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen as their very fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, ninety-one eons ago, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, guide who tames beings, unsurpassed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One called Vipaśyin. He was dwelling near the royal capital Bandhumatī. At one time the perfectly awakened Buddha Vipaśyin, having carried out all the activities of a buddha, passed into complete nirvāṇa in the element of nirvāṇa without remainder of the aggregates, like a fire whose fuel is spent.

"Then King Bandhumat performed the funeral honors for the remains of the Blessed One, and built a stupa made of the four kinds of precious substances, one yojana in circumference and one krośa in height, and he also instituted a festival for the stupa.

"Then at one time a certain householder went to the place where the stupa festival was being held, and he saw that a golden mirror had fallen from that stupa. He made it into an ear ornament for it, fastened it to the stupa, made offerings with incense, fumigants and flowers, bowed at its feet, and made this aspiration: 'May I too attain such qualities as these! May I please such a teacher as this, and may I never displease him!'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who was the householder at that time, on that occasion, is this boy Suvarṇābha. Because he paid honor to the stupa of the perfectly awakened Buddha Vipaśyin, he came to have such exceptional good looks. Because he made that aspiration, he realized arhatship in this life.

"Thus, monks, the ripening of wholly black deeds is wholly black, the ripening of wholly white deeds is wholly white, and the ripening of mixed deeds is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon wholly black deeds and mixed deeds, and

devote yourselves to wholly white deeds alone. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had said this, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Sugandhi.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace retinue, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshiped and renowned among gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was dwelling together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas in the land of Kapilavastu, in the Nyagrodha Park.

At that time there lived in Kapilavastu a householder who was rich, with great wealth and abundant possessions, with vast and extensive holdings, possessed of the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He took a wife from a family equal to his own, and he played, enjoyed himself and made love with her. As he played, enjoyed himself and made love, his wife became pregnant, and after eight or nine months had passed, she gave birth to a son: a boy handsome, good to look at and beautiful, surpassing human complexion though not attaining the complexion of the gods. From his mouth came the scent of the utpala flower, and from his whole body came the scent of sandalwood.

Then, when the birth celebration had been held, they set about naming him, asking, "What name shall we give this boy?" His relatives said, "Since the scent of the utpala comes from his mouth and the scent of sandalwood comes from his whole body, let this boy be named Sugandhi."

Then the boy Sugandhi was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry him in their laps, two nurses to suckle him, two nurses to wash away his dirt, and two nurses to play with him. These eight nurses raised and nourished him with milk, curd, butter, ghee, cream of butter and every other kind of excellent provision, and he grew quickly, like a lotus in a lake.

Moreover, through the force and power of his former causes he was endowed with faith; he was virtuous and good-hearted, devoted to the welfare of himself and others, compassionate, magnanimous, and a lover of the Dharma.

Whenever the boy Sugandhi, adorned with armlets, necklace and bracelets, went out into the street, the fragrance of sandalwood would pervade the whole city. Many people, catching the scent of divine incense, were filled with the greatest wonder and would say, "Oh, the power of merit!"

Some time later, the boy Sugandhi went to the Nyagrodha Park. There he saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo of light a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, wholly excellent, like a mountain of jewels in motion. As soon as he saw him, joy toward the Blessed One arose in his mind. Having become joyful, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat down before the Blessed One to listen to the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, understanding his disposition, latent tendencies, constitution and nature, taught him the Dharma in such a way that he would realize the Four Noble Truths. Having heard it, the boy Sugandhi, with the vajra of wisdom, shattered the mountain of the view of a real self in the perishing aggregates, with its twenty towering peaks, and directly realized the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truths, he asked his parents' leave and went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One.

Striving, exerting himself and making effort, he understood that this very five-sectioned wheel of saṃsāra is unsteady and unstable. He ascertained that all kinds of formations are by nature subject to decay, falling, dispersal and destruction, and, abandoning all afflictions, he directly realized arhatship. As an arhat, free of attachment to the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal; his mind was like space and like the palm of his hand; he became cool like sandalwood paste; with knowledge he had broken the shell of the egg; he attained the knowledges, the superknowledges and the analytical knowledges; he turned his back on the gains, attachments and honors of existence; and he became one worthy of the worship, reverence and respectful address of the gods, including Indra and Upendra.

Then the monks, having become curious, asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what deeds did Sugandhi perform, such that the scent of the utpala comes from his mouth, and the scent of sandalwood comes from his whole body?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, in other former lives Sugandhi himself performed and accumulated deeds whose collected causes have come

together and whose conditions have ripened, which have become like a flood and will inevitably come to pass. Since Sugandhi himself performed and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element or the wind element. Deeds performed and accumulated, whether virtuous or non-virtuous, ripen solely in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense sources.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen as their fruit.

"Monks, long ago in times past, ninety-one eons ago, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, guide who tames beings, unsurpassed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One called Vipaśyin. He lived in dependence on the royal capital Bandhumatī. Some time later, the perfectly complete Buddha Vipaśyin, having carried out all the deeds of a buddha, passed completely into nirvāṇa in the sphere of nirvāṇa without remainder of the aggregates, like a fire whose fuel is exhausted.

"Then King Bandhumat, having performed the funeral honors for the Blessed One's relics, built a stūpa made of the four kinds of precious substances, one league in circumference and one krośa in height, and also instituted a festival for the stūpa. A certain householder, having developed faith in it, offered various kinds of incense and perfumed unguents, made offerings of fumigants and flowers, and made this aspiration: 'Through this root of virtue, this arising of the mind, and this giving away of what is to be given, may I too attain qualities such as these! May I please such a teacher as this, and may I not displease him!'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who was the householder at that time, on that occasion, was none other than this boy Sugandhi. Because he paid honor to the stūpa of the perfectly complete Buddha Vipaśyin, he has become fragrant in this way. Through the aspiration he made, he has directly realized arhatship in this life.

"Thus, monks, the ripening of entirely black deeds is entirely black, the ripening of entirely white deeds is entirely white, and the ripening of mixed

deeds is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon entirely black deeds and mixed deeds, and devote yourselves solely to entirely white deeds. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, the fifteenth fascicle.

The story called Fair Form.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the citizens, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshiped and renowned among gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, food, bedding, seats, medicines for the sick and other requisites, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas in Kapilavastu, in the Nyagrodha Park.

At that time there lived in Kapilavastu a Śākya who was rich, of great wealth and great resources, with vast and extensive possessions, possessed of wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling Vaiśravaṇa in wealth. He took a wife from a family of equal standing, and he played, made love and took his pleasure with her. As he played, made love and took his pleasure, his wife became pregnant, and after eight or nine months had passed she gave birth to a son. She bore a boy who was handsome, good to look upon and beautiful, surpassing the complexion of humans though not attaining the complexion of the gods, incomparable in form, soft of complexion, with the seven parts of his body full and raised, and widely renowned for his greatness.

After they had held the birth celebration for him, they set about naming him, asking, "What name shall we give this boy?" His relatives said, "Since his body is incomparable, let this boy be named Fair Form."

Then the boy Fair Form was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry him in their laps, two nurses to suckle him, two nurses to wash away his dirt, and two nurses to play with him. These eight nurses raised and nourished him with milk, curd, butter, ghee, cream of butter and every other kind of excellent provision, and he grew quickly, like a lotus in a lake.

Moreover, he was endowed with faith, virtuous and good-hearted, devoted to the welfare of himself and others, compassionate, magnanimous, and a lover

of the Dharma. He became one worthy of the worship, reverence and respectful address of the whole world, even of non-human beings. Wherever he set his foot, those places too became pure. Thus he was renowned as one of great merit and greatness.

Some time later, he went to the Nyagrodha Park. There he saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo of light a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, wholly excellent, like a mountain of jewels in motion. As soon as he saw him, joy toward the Blessed One arose in his mind. Having become joyful, he bowed at the Blessed One's feet and sat down before the Blessed One to listen to the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, understanding his disposition, latent tendencies, constitution and nature, taught him the Dharma in such a way that he would realize the Four Noble Truths. Having heard it, the boy Fair Form, with the vajra of wisdom, shattered the mountain of the view of a real self in the perishing aggregates, with its twenty towering peaks, and directly realized the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truths, he asked his parents' leave and went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One.

Striving, exerting himself and making effort, he understood that this very five-sectioned wheel of saṃsāra is unsteady and unstable. He ascertained that all kinds of formations are by nature subject to decay, falling, dispersal and destruction, and, abandoning all afflictions, he directly realized arhatship. As an arhat, free of attachment to the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal; his mind was like space and like the palm of his hand; he became cool like sandalwood paste; with knowledge he had broken the shell of the egg; he attained the knowledges, the superknowledges and the analytical knowledges; he turned his back on the gains, attachments and honors of existence; and he became one worthy of the worship, reverence and respectful address of the gods, including Indra and Upendra.

Then the monks, having become curious, asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what deeds did Fair Form perform, such that his body has become like this and he has attained arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, in other former lives Fair Form himself performed and accumulated deeds whose collected causes have come

together and whose conditions have ripened, which have become like a flood and will inevitably come to pass. Since Fair Form himself performed and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element or the wind element. Deeds performed and accumulated, whether virtuous or non-virtuous, ripen solely in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense sources.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen as their fruit.

"Monks, long ago in times past, ninety-one eons ago, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, guide who tames beings, unsurpassed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One called Vipaśyin. He lived in dependence on the royal capital Bandhumatī. Some time later, the perfectly complete Buddha Vipaśyin, having carried out all the deeds of a buddha, passed completely into nirvāṇa in the sphere of nirvāṇa without remainder of the aggregates, like a fire whose fuel is exhausted.

"Then King Bandhumat, having performed the funeral honors for the Blessed One's relics, built a stūpa made of the four kinds of precious substances, one league in circumference and one krośa in height. There King Bandhumat, together with his host of kinsmen and attended by his host of ministers, held a festival for the stūpa.

"Some time later, one day, a poor man went into the circumambulation path of the stūpa, and there he saw withered flowers and the stūpa covered with dust. Then, recollecting the qualities of the Buddha, he gave rise to faith. He took up a broom, swept the stūpa and cleared away the withered flowers. Then, seeing the stūpa free of dust and free of dirt, he was filled with joy, bowed at its feet, and made this aspiration: 'Through this root of virtue and this arising of the mind, may I too attain qualities such as these! May I please such a teacher as this, and may I not displease him!'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who was the poor man at that time, on that occasion, was none other than this Fair Form. Because he swept the stūpa, he has come to have a fair and beautiful form.

Through the aspiration he made, he has directly realized arhatship in this very life.

"Thus, monks, the ripening of entirely black deeds is entirely black, the ripening of entirely white deeds is entirely white, and the ripening of mixed deeds is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon entirely black deeds and mixed deeds, and devote yourselves solely to entirely white deeds. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Mighty.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the citizens, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshiped and renowned among gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, food, bedding, seats, medicines for the sick and other requisites, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas in Kapilavastu, in the Nyagrodha Park.

At that time there lived in Kapilavastu a Śākya who was rich, of great wealth and great resources, with vast and extensive possessions, possessed of wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling Vaiśravaṇa in wealth. He took a wife from a family of equal standing, and he played, made love and took his pleasure with her. As he played, made love and took his pleasure, his wife became pregnant, and after eight or nine months had passed she gave birth to a son. She bore a boy who was handsome, good to look upon and beautiful, surpassing others in the force of his strength.

After they had held the birth celebration for him, they set about naming him, asking, "What name shall we give this boy?" His relatives said, "Since this boy is endowed with the force of strength, let this boy be named Mighty."

Then the boy Mighty was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry him in their laps, two nurses to suckle him, two nurses to wash away his dirt, and two nurses to play with him. These eight nurses raised and nourished him with milk, curd, butter, ghee, cream of butter and every other kind of excellent provision, and he grew quickly, like a lotus in a lake.

Moreover, he was endowed with faith, virtuous and good-hearted, devoted to his own welfare and the welfare of others, compassionate, magnanimous, and a lover of the Dharma.

Then, some time later, he went to the Nyagrodha Park. There he saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo of light a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, wholly excellent, like a mountain of jewels in motion. As soon as he saw him, joy toward the Blessed One arose in his mind. Having become joyful, he bowed at the Blessed One's feet and sat down before the Blessed One to listen to the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, understanding his disposition, latent tendencies, constitution and nature, taught him the Dharma in such a way that he would realize the Four Noble Truths. Having heard it, the boy Mighty, with the vajra of wisdom, shattered the mountain of the view of a real self in the perishing aggregates, with its twenty towering peaks, and directly realized the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truths, he asked his parents' leave and went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One.

Striving, exerting himself and making effort, he understood that this very five-sectioned wheel of saṃsāra is unsteady and unstable. He ascertained that all kinds of formations are by nature subject to decay, falling, dispersal and destruction, and, abandoning all afflictions, he directly realized arhatship. As an arhat, free of attachment to the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal; his mind was like space and like the palm of his hand; he became cool like sandalwood paste; with knowledge he had broken the shell of the egg; he attained the knowledges, the superknowledges and the analytical knowledges; he turned his back on the gains, attachments and honors of existence; and he became one worthy of the worship, reverence and respectful address of the gods, including Indra and Upendra.

Then the monks, having become curious, asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what deeds did Mighty perform, such that his body has become endowed with strength and he has attained arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, in other former lives Mighty himself performed and accumulated deeds whose collected causes have come together and whose conditions have ripened, which have become like a flood and will

inevitably come to pass. Since Mighty himself performed and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element or the wind element. Deeds performed and accumulated, whether virtuous or non-virtuous, ripen solely in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense sources.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen as their fruit.

"Monks, long ago in times past, ninety-one eons ago, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, guide who tames beings, unsurpassed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One called Vipaśyin. He lived in dependence on the royal capital Bandhumatī. Some time later, the perfectly complete Buddha Vipaśyin, having carried out all the deeds of a buddha, passed completely into nirvāṇa in the sphere of nirvāṇa without remainder of the aggregates, like a fire whose fuel is exhausted.

"Then King Bandhumat, having performed the funeral honors for that Blessed One's relics, built a stūpa made of the four kinds of precious substances, one league in circumference and one krośa in height. When the festival of the stūpa was held there, a great crowd of people sang and danced, so that the stūpa became covered with dust.

"Some time later, a householder went into the circumambulation path of the stūpa, and he saw that the circumambulation path of the stūpa was covered with dust. Then that householder, recollecting the qualities of the Buddha, gave rise to faith. He offered a fragrant paste mixed with sesame oil and made this aspiration: 'May I too attain qualities such as these! May I please such teachers as this, and may I not displease them!'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who was the householder at that time, on that occasion, was none other than this Mighty. Because he paid honor to the stūpa of the Blessed One Vipaśyin, he has become endowed with strength. Through the aspiration he made, he has now directly realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, the ripening of entirely black deeds is entirely black, the ripening of entirely white deeds is entirely white, and the ripening of mixed deeds is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon entirely black deeds and mixed deeds, and devote yourselves solely to entirely white deeds. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Dugu.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the citizens, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshiped and renowned among gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, food, bedding, seats, medicines for the sick and other requisites, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas in Kapilavastu, in the Nyagrodha Park.

At that time there lived in Kapilavastu a Śākya who was rich, of great wealth and great resources, with vast and extensive possessions, possessed of wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling Vaiśravaṇa in wealth. He took a wife from a family of equal standing, and he played, made love and took his pleasure with her. As he played, made love and took his pleasure, his wife became pregnant, and after eight or nine months had passed she gave birth to a son. She bore a boy who was handsome, good to look upon and beautiful, widely renowned for his greatness, and a delight to behold. When he was born, the whole city of Kapilavastu was filled with his renown.

After they had held the birth celebration for him, they set about naming him, asking, "What name shall we give this boy?" His relatives said, "Since this boy, as soon as he was born, was dear to the hearts of all people, let this boy be named Dugu."

Then the boy Dugu was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry him in their laps, two nurses to suckle him, two nurses to wash away his dirt, and two nurses to play with him. These eight nurses raised and nourished him with milk, curd, butter, ghee, cream of butter and every other kind of excellent provision, and he grew quickly, like a lotus in a lake.

Moreover, he was endowed with faith, virtuous and good-hearted, devoted to his own welfare and the welfare of others, compassionate, magnanimous, a lover of the Dharma, eager to give, delighting in generosity, rejoicing in giving abundantly, and abiding in great liberality. He gave many kinds of gifts to ascetics, brahmins, the destitute, and the wretched and needy, and so drew them to him.

Then, some time later, the boy Dugu went to the Nyagrodha Park. There he saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo of light a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, wholly excellent, like a mountain of jewels in motion. As soon as he saw him, joy toward the Blessed One arose in his mind. Having become joyful, he bowed at the Blessed One's feet and sat down before the Blessed One to listen to the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, understanding his disposition, latent tendencies, constitution and nature, taught him the Dharma in such a way that he would realize the Four Noble Truths. Having heard it, the boy Dugu, with the vajra of wisdom, shattered the mountain of the view of a real self in the perishing aggregates, with its twenty towering peaks, and directly realized the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truths, he asked his parents' leave and went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One.

Striving, exerting himself and making effort, he understood that this very five-sectioned wheel of saṃsāra is unsteady and unstable. He ascertained that all kinds of formations are by nature subject to decay, falling, dispersal and destruction, and, abandoning all afflictions, he directly realized arhatship. As an arhat, free of attachment to the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal; his mind was like space and like the palm of his hand; he became cool like sandalwood paste; with knowledge he had broken the shell of the egg; he attained the knowledges, the superknowledges and the analytical knowledges; he turned his back on the gains, attachments and honors of existence; and he became one worthy of the worship, reverence and respectful address of the gods, including Indra and Upendra.

Then the monks, having become curious, asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what deeds did Dugu perform, such that he has come to have great renown and to be dear and pleasing, and, having gone forth, has directly realized arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, in other former lives Dugu himself performed and accumulated deeds whose collected causes have come together and whose conditions have ripened, which have become like a flood and will inevitably come to pass. Since Dugu himself performed and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element or the wind element. Deeds performed and accumulated, whether virtuous or non-virtuous, ripen solely in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense sources.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen as their fruit.

"Monks, long ago in times past, ninety-one eons ago, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, guide who tames beings, unsurpassed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One called Vipaśyin. He lived in dependence on the royal capital Bandhumatī. Some time later, the perfectly complete Buddha Vipaśyin, having carried out all the deeds of a buddha, passed completely into nirvāṇa in the sphere of nirvāṇa without remainder of the aggregates, like a fire whose fuel is exhausted.

"Then King Bandhumat, having performed the funeral honors for that Blessed One's relics, built a stūpa made of the four kinds of precious substances, one league in circumference and one krośa in height.

"Then some time later, in springtime, when the trees were in bloom and flowers of every kind had appeared, a householder said to the king, 'Together with Your Majesty, I wish to hang flowers on the stūpa of the Blessed One Vipaśyin.' The king said, 'Do so.' Then that householder, the king, the ministers and the attendants had it proclaimed with bells, prepared flowers of every kind, and hung the flowers on the stūpa of the Blessed One Vipaśyin. There many hundreds of thousands of living beings felt joy in their minds and generated roots of virtue."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who was the householder at that time, on that occasion, was none other than this Dugu. Because he generated roots of virtue together with a great many people, this

became the cause of his being dear and pleasing to the hearts of a great many people. By that very cause he became good to look upon and beautiful, and he has directly realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, the ripening of entirely black deeds is entirely black, the ripening of entirely white deeds is entirely white, and the ripening of mixed deeds is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon entirely black deeds and mixed deeds, and devote yourselves solely to entirely white deeds. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Lotus Eye.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and great mahoragas. Venerated and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and great mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, food, bedding, seats, medicines for the sick and other requisites, was staying with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Kapilavastu, in the Nyagrodha Park.

At that time there lived in Kapilavastu a Śākya who was rich, with much wealth and great means, with vast and extensive possessions, possessed of wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He took a wife from a family of equal standing, and he played, made love and enjoyed himself with her. As he played, made love and enjoyed himself, his wife conceived, and when eight or nine months had passed she gave birth to a son: a boy handsome, good to look upon and beautiful, with eyes like blue lotuses, born bearing on his head a precious divine jewel of sapphire blue. He made the whole city of Kapilavastu take on the color of that sapphire jewel.

Then, when they had held the birth celebration, they set about naming him, asking, "What name shall be given to this boy?" His relatives said, "Since this boy's eyes are like lotuses, let this boy be named Lotus Eye."

Then the boy Lotus Eye was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry him on their laps, two nurses to suckle him, two nurses to wash away his dirt, and two nurses to play with him. Those eight nurses raised and nourished him with milk, curds, butter, ghee, cream of butter and every other kind of fine

provision, and he grew up quickly, like a lotus in a lake.

He was endowed with faith, virtuous and of good intentions, devoted to benefiting himself and benefiting others, compassionate and magnanimous, a lover of the Dharma, eager to give, delighting in generosity, rejoicing in lavish giving, and abiding in great liberality. Wherever he went, there he was worshiped and honored by gods and humans.

Then, some time later, the boy Lotus Eye went to the Nyagrodha Park, and there he saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, with a radiance surpassing that of a thousand suns, like a moving Jewel Mountain, lovely in every way. The moment he saw him, his mind was filled with joy toward the Blessed One. Having given rise to joy, he bowed at the feet of the Blessed One and sat down before the Blessed One to listen to the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, having understood his disposition, latent tendencies, constitution and nature, taught him the Dharma in such a way that he would realize the Four Noble Truths. When he had heard it, the boy Lotus Eye shattered with the vajra of wisdom the twenty lofty peaks of the mountain of the view of the perishable collection, and directly realized the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truths, he gave gifts and lavish gifts, satisfying monks, brahmins, the destitute and the poor and needy. Then he asked leave of his father and mother and went forth into the teaching of the Blessed One.

Through striving, effort and exertion he came to know that this five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra is moving and unstable. Having seen through every form of formation as subject to decay, falling, scattering and destruction, he abandoned all afflictions and directly realized arhatship. As an arhat, free of attachment toward the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal; his mind was like the sky and like the palm of his hand; he had become cool like refined sandalwood; by knowledge he had broken the shell of the egg; he had attained the knowledges, the higher perceptions and the analytical knowledges; he turned away from worldly gain, attachment and honors; and he became one to be worshiped, honored and respectfully addressed by the gods together with Indra and Upendra.

Then one time, when he went for alms, a great many people looked at him and were amazed. So Lotus Eye went to the Blessed One and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, please make it so that my precious jewel is no more."

The Blessed One said, "Son, since this has arisen from karma, the precious jewel cannot be made to disappear. Nevertheless, it shall be made so that those who have faith see it, and those without faith do not see it." And the Blessed One did just that.

Then the monks, having become doubtful, asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what deeds did Lotus Eye perform, that he has become so greatly renowned and has attained arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Lotus Eye himself, in other, former lives, performed and accumulated deeds whose causes were gathered and whose conditions had matured, which came on like a flood, and whose results must inevitably come. Since Lotus Eye himself performed and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the outer earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element or the wind element. Rather, virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense sources.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen as their very fruits.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in the ninety-first eon, there appeared in the world a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, accomplished in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one, called Vipaśyin. He dwelt depending on the royal capital of Bandhumatī. Then at a certain time the perfectly complete buddha Vipaśyin, having performed all the deeds of a buddha, like a fire whose fuel is spent, passed into complete nirvāṇa in the realm of nirvāṇa without remainder of the aggregates.

"Then King Bandhumat, having performed the funeral honors for the relics of that Blessed One, built a stūpa made of the four kinds of precious substances, one league in circumference and one krośa in height. Many hundreds of thousands of living beings paid homage there and went on to the higher realms and to liberation.

"Then at a certain time, a caravan leader accomplished his aim in a voyage on the great ocean. On his return he brought back from it a great precious

sapphire jewel. Seeing the stūpa of the Blessed One, he recalled the qualities of the Tathāgata and fastened that precious jewel to the finial of the stūpa of the Blessed One Vipaśyin. By its power he made all the directions and intermediate directions appear the color of sapphire. He also made offerings of lotus flowers and made this aspiration: 'May I too attain such qualities as these! May I please such a teacher as this, and may I not displease him!'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who was the caravan leader at that time, on that occasion, was this very Lotus Eye. Through the ripening of that deed of fastening the precious jewel to the stūpa of the Blessed One Vipaśyin, a precious jewel appeared on his head. Because he made offerings of blue lotuses, his eyes became like blue lotuses. Because he made that aspiration, he directly realized arhatship in this very life.

"Thus, monks, the ripening of entirely black deeds is entirely black, the ripening of entirely white deeds is entirely white, and the ripening of mixed deeds is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon entirely black deeds and mixed deeds, and devote yourselves solely to entirely white deeds. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Drum Sound.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and great mahoragas. Venerated and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and great mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, food, bedding, seats, medicines for the sick and other requisites, was staying with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Kapilavastu, in the Nyagrodha Park.

At that time there lived in Kapilavastu a Śākya who was rich, with much wealth and great means, with vast and extensive possessions, possessed of wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He took a wife from a family of equal standing, and he played, made love and enjoyed himself with her. As he played, made love and enjoyed himself, his wife conceived, and when eight or nine months had passed she gave birth to a son: a boy handsome, good to look upon and renowned for his great beauty, with a voice as sweet as the kalaviṅka bird's, with a tone as pleasing as the sound of a

drum.

Then, when they had held the birth celebration, they set about naming him, asking, "What name shall be given to this boy?" His relatives said, "Since this boy has a voice like the sound of a drum, let this boy be named Drum Sound."

Then the boy Drum Sound was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry him on their laps, two nurses to suckle him, two nurses to wash away his dirt, and two nurses to play with him. Those eight nurses raised and nourished him with milk, curds, butter, ghee, cream of butter and every other kind of fine provision, and he grew up quickly, like a lotus in a lake.

He was endowed with faith, virtuous and of good intentions, devoted to benefiting himself and benefiting others, compassionate and magnanimous, a lover of the Dharma, eager to give, delighting in generosity, rejoicing in lavish giving, and abiding in great liberality.

Then, some time later, the boy Drum Sound went to the Nyagrodha Park, and there he saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, with a radiance surpassing that of a thousand suns, like a moving Jewel Mountain, lovely in every way. The moment he saw him, his mind was filled with joy toward the Blessed One. Having given rise to joy, he bowed at the feet of the Blessed One and sat down before the Blessed One to listen to the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, having understood his disposition, latent tendencies, constitution and nature, taught him the Dharma in such a way that he would realize the Four Noble Truths. When he had heard it, the boy Drum Sound shattered with the vajra of wisdom the twenty lofty peaks of the mountain of the view of the perishable collection, and directly realized the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truths, he gave gifts and lavish gifts, satisfying monks, brahmins, the destitute and the poor and needy. Then he asked leave of his father and mother and went forth into the teaching of the Blessed One.

Through striving, effort and exertion he came to know that this five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra is moving and unstable. Having seen through every form of formation as subject to decay, falling, scattering and destruction, he abandoned all afflictions and directly realized arhatship. As an arhat, free of attachment toward the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal; his mind was like the sky and like the palm of his hand; he had become cool like refined sandalwood; by knowledge he had broken the shell of the egg;

he had attained the knowledges, the higher perceptions and the analytical knowledges; he turned away from worldly gain, attachment and honors; and he became one to be worshiped, honored and respectfully addressed by the gods together with Indra and Upendra.

Then the monks, having become doubtful, asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what deeds did Drum Sound perform, that he has become handsome, good to look upon and beautiful, and has also attained arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Drum Sound himself, in other, former lives, performed and accumulated deeds whose causes were gathered and whose conditions had matured, which came on like a flood, and whose results must inevitably come. Since Drum Sound himself performed and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the outer earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element or the wind element. Rather, virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense sources.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen as their very fruits.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in the ninety-first eon, there appeared in the world a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, accomplished in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one, called Vipaśyin. He dwelt depending on the royal capital of Bandhumatī. Then at a certain time the perfectly complete buddha Vipaśyin, having performed all the deeds of a buddha, like a fire whose fuel is spent, passed into complete nirvāṇa in the realm of nirvāṇa without remainder of the aggregates.

"Then King Bandhumat, having performed the funeral honors for the relics of that Blessed One, built a stūpa made of the four kinds of precious substances, one league in circumference and one krośa in height. Many hundreds of thousands of living beings paid homage there and went on to the higher realms and to liberation.

"Then at a certain time, a householder had people trained in music, with all kinds of musical instruments, and offered them to that stūpa. Every day they

honored that stūpa with excellent strains of music.

"Monks, what do you think? The one who was the householder at that time, on that occasion, was this very Drum Sound. Because he offered all kinds of musical instruments to the stūpa of the Blessed One Vipaśyin, he came to have a voice like the sound of a drum, and by that very cause he has now directly realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, the ripening of entirely black deeds is entirely black, the ripening of entirely white deeds is entirely white, and the ripening of mixed deeds is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon entirely black deeds and mixed deeds, and devote yourselves solely to entirely white deeds. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Son.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and great mahoragas. Venerated and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and great mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, food, bedding, seats, medicines for the sick and other requisites, was staying with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Kapilavastu, in the Nyagrodha Park.

At that time there lived in Kapilavastu a Śākya who was rich, with much wealth and great means, with vast and extensive possessions, possessed of wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He took a wife from a family of equal standing, and he played, made love and enjoyed himself with her. As he played, made love and enjoyed himself, his wife conceived, and when eight or nine months had passed she gave birth, and what came forth was a great lump of flesh and blood. When the parents, the others living in that house, the servants and the relatives saw it, they were displeased, saying, "What is this that has been born?"

Then, after a while, that householder went into the chamber of sorrow and sat there with his cheek resting on his hand, brooding, thinking, "What is this? To whom should I tell it? Who would know?"

Then the thought came to him: "This Buddha, the Blessed One, is all-knowing and all-seeing. He will know. I shall tell the Buddha, the Blessed One." So he went to where the Blessed One was, and when he had arrived he told the Blessed One.

The Blessed One said, "Householder, do not be afraid, do not be afraid! Place that lump of flesh and blood in well-carded cotton, and for seven days stroke it with your hand three times each day, and sprinkle it again and again with milk. After that it will burst open and a hundred sons will come forth, and all of them will have the strength of great wrestlers."

When the householder heard this, he was supremely amazed, and he thought, "That such sons should come to be mine is a gain well gained indeed!" He did just so, and when seven days had passed, that lump of flesh and blood burst open and a hundred sons came forth, every one of them handsome, good to look upon and beautiful, complete in all their limbs and features, and every one possessed of the strength of a great wrestler.

Then, as time went on, they were gradually raised and nourished until they were grown. All of them were proud, intoxicated with their good looks and youth, and as they roamed about here and there they went to the Nyagrodha Park. There they saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, with a radiance surpassing that of a thousand suns, like a moving Jewel Mountain, lovely in every way. The moment they saw him, their minds were filled with joy toward the Blessed One. Having given rise to joy, they bowed at the feet of the Blessed One and sat down before the Blessed One to listen to the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, having understood their dispositions, latent tendencies, constitutions and natures, taught them the Dharma in such a way that they would realize the Four Noble Truths. When they had heard it, all of them shattered with the vajra of wisdom the twenty lofty peaks of the mountain of the view of the perishable collection, and directly realized the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truths, they asked leave of their father and mother and went forth into the teaching of the Blessed One.

Through striving, effort and exertion all of them came to know that this five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra is moving and unstable. Having seen through every form of formation as subject to decay, falling, scattering and destruction, they abandoned all afflictions and directly realized arhatship. As

arhats, free of attachment toward the three realms, they regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal; their minds were like the sky and like the palm of the hand; they had become cool like refined sandalwood; by knowledge they had broken the shell of the egg; they had attained the knowledges, the higher perceptions and the analytical knowledges; they turned away from worldly gain, attachment and honors; and they became ones to be worshiped, honored and respectfully addressed by the gods together with Indra and Upendra.

Then the monks, having become doubtful, asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what deeds did these hundred young men perform, that they have become brothers and possess the strength of great wrestlers?"

The Blessed One said, "These men, in other, former lives, performed and accumulated deeds whose causes were gathered and whose conditions had matured, which came on like a flood, and whose results must inevitably come. Since they themselves performed and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the outer earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element or the wind element. Rather, virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense sources.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen as their very fruits.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in the ninety-first eon, there appeared in the world a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, accomplished in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one, called Vipaśyin. He dwelt depending on the royal capital of Bandhumatī. Then at a certain time the perfectly complete buddha Vipaśyin, having performed all the deeds of a buddha, like a fire whose fuel is spent, passed into complete nirvāṇa in the realm of nirvāṇa without remainder of the aggregates.

"Then King Bandhumat, having performed the funeral honors for the relics of that Blessed One, built a stūpa made of the four kinds of precious substances, one league in circumference and one krośa in height. Many hundreds of thousands of living beings paid homage there and went on to the higher

realms and to liberation.

"Then at a certain time a company of a hundred friends went out, and when they saw that stūpa they recalled the qualities of the Tathāgata. Together they anointed it with fragrant sesame oil and also paid homage with offerings of flowers, garlands and lamps. Then together they made this aspiration: 'Wherever we are born, may we be born there as brothers, coming forth together from one and the same womb! May we gain the might of great wrestlers' strength, and may we be endowed with good looks! In the future, too, may we please the perfectly complete buddhas, and may we not displease them!'

"Monks, what do you think? Those who were the company of friends at that time, on that occasion, are these great wrestlers. Because they honored that stūpa together, they have been born together in this way and have gained the might of great wrestlers' strength. Because they made that aspiration, they went forth in harmony as one and attained arhatship.

"Thus, monks, the ripening of entirely black deeds is entirely black, the ripening of entirely white deeds is entirely white, and the ripening of mixed deeds is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon entirely black deeds and mixed deeds, and devote yourselves solely to entirely white deeds. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, the sixteenth fascicle.

Sun.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and great mahoragas. Venerated and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and great mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, food, bedding, seats, medicines for the sick and other requisites, was staying with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas in the land of Kapilavastu, in the Nyagrodha Park.

At that time there lived in Kapilavastu a Śākya who was rich, with much wealth and great means, with vast and extensive possessions, possessed of wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He took a wife from a

family of equal standing, and he played, made love and enjoyed himself with her. As he played, made love and enjoyed himself, his wife conceived, and when eight or nine months had passed she gave birth to a son: a boy handsome, good to look upon and beautiful, born bearing a precious jewel on his head. From it, rays like the rays of the sun streamed out all around, and its light pervaded the whole city of Kapilavastu at night, making it bright as day.

When the parents, the servants living in that house, the relatives and the Śākyas dwelling in Kapilavastu saw this, they were amazed and swelled with joy.

Then, when they had held the birth celebration, they set about naming him, asking, "What name shall be given to this boy?" His relatives said, "Since, as soon as this boy was born, he made the whole city of Kapilavastu bright as the sun, let this boy be named Sun."

Then the boy Sun was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry him on their laps, two nurses to suckle him, two nurses to wash away his dirt, and two nurses to play with him. Those eight nurses raised and nourished him with milk, curds, butter, ghee, cream of butter and every other kind of fine provision, and he grew up quickly, like a lotus in a lake.

He was endowed with faith, virtuous and of good intentions, devoted to benefiting himself and benefiting others, compassionate and magnanimous, a lover of the Dharma, loving toward all creatures, eager to give, delighting in generosity, rejoicing in lavish giving, and abiding in great liberality.

Then, some time later, the boy Sun went to the Nyagrodha Park, and there he saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, with a radiance surpassing that of a thousand suns, like a moving Jewel Mountain, lovely in every way. The moment he saw him, his mind was filled with joy toward the Blessed One. Having given rise to joy, he bowed at the feet of the Blessed One and sat down before the Blessed One to listen to the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, having understood his disposition, latent tendencies, constitution and nature, taught him the Dharma in such a way that he would realize the Four Noble Truths. When he had heard it, the boy Sun shattered with the vajra of wisdom the twenty lofty peaks of the mountain of the view of the perishable collection, and directly realized the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truths, he gave gifts and lavish gifts, satisfying śramaṇas, brahmins,

the destitute and the poor and needy. Then he asked leave of his father and mother and went forth into the teaching of the Blessed One.

Through striving, effort and exertion he came to know that this five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra is moving and unstable. Having seen through every form of formation as subject to decay, falling, scattering and destruction, he abandoned all afflictions and directly realized arhatship. As an arhat, free of attachment toward the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal; his mind was like the sky and like the palm of his hand; he had become cool like refined sandalwood; by knowledge he had broken the shell of the egg; he had attained the knowledges, the higher perceptions and the analytical knowledges; he turned away from worldly gain, attachment and honors; and he became one to be worshiped, honored and respectfully addressed by the gods together with Indra and Upendra.

Then, whenever the venerable Sun went for alms, the brahmins and householders who lacked faith would scorn and revile him and mock him behind his back, saying, "Since he roams the highways, streets, crossroads and junctions like this, wearing a precious jewel on his head, the way of life of the śramaṇas who are sons of the Śākya is ruined! Their brahmin way of life is ruined!"

Then, deeply ashamed, he went to where the Blessed One was. When he arrived, he bowed at the Blessed One's feet and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, please make my precious jewel disappear somehow."

The Blessed One said, "Son, since this was born of karma, it cannot be made to disappear. Even so, I shall make it so that those who have faith see it, and those without faith do not see it." And the Blessed One did just that.

Then doubts arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, the one who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what karma did Sun perform that he has become so greatly renowned and has attained arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "In other, former lives, Sun himself performed and accumulated deeds that have reached maturity, whose conditions have ripened, that have come upon him like a flood, and that are bound to bear fruit. Since Sun himself performed and accumulated these deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element, or the wind element. Virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in

the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen into their fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in the ninety-first eon, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, the guide who tames beings, the unsurpassed, the teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One called Vipaśyin. He lived in dependence on the royal capital Bandhumatī. Then, after some time, the perfectly complete Buddha Vipaśyin, having carried out all the activities of a buddha, passed into complete nirvāṇa, like a fire whose fuel is spent, into the realm of nirvāṇa in which no remainder of the aggregates is left.

"Then King Bandhumat performed the funeral rites for that Blessed One's remains and built a stūpa made of the four kinds of precious substances, one league in circumference and one krośa in height. Many hundreds of thousands of living beings paid homage to it there and went on to the higher realms and to liberation. Then, when the time came for worship at that stūpa, the faithful brahmins and householders worshiped it with incense, garlands of flowers, unguents of many kinds, parasols, victory banners, flags, and the sound of music.

"Then, after some time, a certain man played dice with the king, and as his winnings he gained a precious sunstone. Then, having developed faith, he fastened it to the pinnacle of the Blessed One Vipaśyin's stūpa, bowed at its foot, and made this aspiration: 'By this root of virtue, by this generation of the mind, and by this complete giving up of something to be given, may I too attain such qualities as these! May I please such a Teacher as this, and never displease him! And may I come forth from my mother's womb wearing just such a precious jewel on the crown of my head!'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who was the gambler at that time, on that occasion, was none other than this Sun. Because he paid homage to the stūpa of the Blessed One Vipaśyin and fastened the precious jewel to it, a precious jewel appeared on his head; and by that very cause he became handsome, good to look upon, and beautiful, and he realized arhatship.

"So, monks, the result of wholly black deeds is wholly black, the result of wholly white deeds is wholly white, and the result of mixed deeds is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon wholly black deeds and mixed deeds, and devote yourselves to wholly white deeds alone. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Banner of the Mallas.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, respected, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped and acknowledged by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, receiving robes, food, bedding, seats, medicines for the sick, and other requisites, was staying with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas in the country of Kapilavastu, in the Nyagrodha Park.

At that time there lived in Kapilavastu a Śākya who was rich, with much wealth and great means, with vast and extensive holdings, possessing wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He took a wife from a family of equal standing, and he played, made love, and enjoyed himself with her. As he played, made love, and enjoyed himself, his wife became pregnant, and when eight or nine months had passed she gave birth to a son, a boy who was handsome, good to look upon, and beautiful, surpassing the complexion of humans, though not reaching the complexion of the gods. At the moment the boy was born, the gods raised divine banners all around, and they beat divine musical instruments as well.

They also scattered divine blue lotuses, lotuses, white water lilies, and white lotuses, and the whole city of Kapilavastu was filled with his renown. In every house, too, banners were raised on his account. Then, when the birth feast for his birth had been held, they set about naming him, asking, "What name shall we give this boy?" His relatives said, "Since, when this boy was born, renown spread throughout the whole world, let this boy be named Renown."

Then the boy Renown was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry him on their laps, two nurses to suckle him, two nurses to wash away his dirt, and two nurses to play with him. These eight nurses raised and nourished him with milk, curds, butter, ghee, the cream of butter, and every other fine provision besides, and he grew quickly, like a lotus in a lake. He was a person of faith,

virtuous and of good intent, devoted to his own welfare and the welfare of others, compassionate, magnanimous, and a lover of the Dharma.

Then, some time later, the boy Renown went to the Nyagrodha Park. There he saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessed of a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, like a moving Jewel Mountain, beautiful in every way. As soon as he saw him, joy toward the Blessed One arose in his mind. When joy had arisen, he bowed at the Blessed One's feet and sat before the Blessed One in order to hear the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, understanding his intentions, latent tendencies, constitution, and nature, taught him the Dharma in such a way that he would realize the Four Noble Truths. When he had heard it, the boy Renown shattered with the vajra of wisdom the twenty high mountain peaks of the view of the perishable collection, and attained the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truths, he gave gifts and abundant gifts, satisfied the śramaṇas, brahmins, the destitute, and the poor and needy, and then, asking leave of his father and mother, he went forth into the teaching of the Blessed One.

Through diligence, effort, and exertion, he understood this very wheel of saṃsāra with its five spokes to be unsteady and unstable; he ascertained that all kinds of formations are of a nature to decay, to fall, to scatter, and to perish; and having abandoned all afflictions, he realized arhatship. As an arhat, free of attachment to the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal; his mind was the same toward empty space and the palm of his hand; he became cool, like refined sandalwood; with knowledge he broke the shell of the egg; he obtained the knowledges, the higher perceptions, and the analytical knowledges; he turned away from worldly gain, attachment, and honors; and he became one to be worshiped, honored, and respectfully addressed by the gods together with Indra and Upendra.

He used robes that were offered on request, and seldom used those not offered on request. He used food, bedding, seats, medicines for the sick, and other requisites that were offered on request, and seldom used those not offered on request.

Then doubts arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, the one who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what karma did Renown

perform that, as soon as he was born, the gods raised banners and he became renowned throughout the world, and that, having gone forth, he attained arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, in other, former lives, Renown himself performed and accumulated deeds that have reached maturity, whose conditions have ripened, that have come upon him like a flood, and that are bound to bear fruit. Since Renown himself performed and accumulated these deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element, or the wind element. Virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen into their fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in the ninety-first eon, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, the guide who tames beings, the unsurpassed, the teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One called Vipaśyin. He lived in dependence on the royal capital Bandhumatī. Then, after some time, the perfectly complete Buddha Vipaśyin, having carried out all the activities of a buddha, passed into complete nirvāṇa, like a fire whose fuel is spent, into the realm of nirvāṇa in which no remainder of the aggregates is left.

"Then King Bandhumat performed the funeral rites for that Blessed One's remains and built a stūpa made of the four kinds of precious substances, one league in circumference and one krośa in height. Many hundreds of thousands of living beings paid homage to it there and went on to the higher realms and to liberation.

"Then, after some time, King Bandhumat held a festival at that stūpa, and at that stūpa festival the wrestlers raised banners. Then, after some time, one of the king's wrestlers threw another wrestler and won the wrestler's banner. He took it and, with a retinue of many hundreds of thousands of living beings playing music of every kind, went to where the stūpa of the Blessed One Vipaśyin stood. When he arrived, he called to mind the qualities of the Blessed

One, fastened the banner to the central pole on top of the stūpa, and made this aspiration: 'May I too attain such qualities as these! May I please such a Teacher as this, and never displease him!'

"Monks, what do you think? The one who was the wrestler at that time, on that occasion, was this very Renown. Because he paid homage and service to the stūpa of the Blessed One Vipaśyin, he experienced boundless happiness in saṃsāra, and by that very cause he has now also realized arhatship.

"So, monks, the result of wholly black deeds is wholly black, the result of wholly white deeds is wholly white, and the result of mixed deeds is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon wholly black deeds and mixed deeds, and devote yourselves to wholly white deeds alone. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

From the Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, the section called Various Avadānas, the seventh summary verse, is complete.

The summary verse:

Suprabhā and Supriyā,
Śuklā, Somā, Kuvalayā,
Sundarī and Muktā,
Kacaṅgalā, Kṣemā,
And Virūpā are taught as a set.

Suprabhā.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, respected, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped and acknowledged by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, receiving robes, food, bedding, seats, medicines for the sick, and other requisites, was staying with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time there lived in Śrāvastī a merchant who was rich, with much wealth and great means, with vast and extensive holdings, possessing wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He took a wife from a family of equal standing, and he played, made love, and enjoyed himself with her. As he played, made love, and enjoyed himself, his wife became pregnant,

and when eight or nine months had passed she gave birth to a daughter who was beautiful, good to look upon, and lovely, clothed in divine ornaments and wearing a precious jewel at her throat. A light came forth from it that illuminated all of Śrāvastī.

Then, when the birth feast for her birth had been held, they set about naming her, asking, "What name shall we give this girl?" Her relatives said, "Since, as soon as this girl was born, all of Śrāvastī was illuminated by the light of the precious jewel, let this girl be named Suprabhā, Fair Radiance."

Then the girl Suprabhā was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry her on their laps, two nurses to suckle her, two nurses to wash away her dirt, and two nurses to play with her. These eight nurses raised and nourished her with milk, curds, butter, ghee, the cream of butter, and every other fine provision besides, and she grew quickly, like a lotus in a lake. That girl was a person of faith, virtuous and of good intent, devoted to her own welfare and the welfare of others. Whoever came to her to beg, she would unfasten the ornament from her throat and give it to them. And after she had given it, another ornament would appear.

Then, when the girl had gradually grown up, many sons of kings, sons of ministers, and sons of merchants came to ask for her hand. Harassed by them, her father sat with his cheek resting on his hand and thought, "If I give her to one, the others will become my enemies." And he sat there downcast.

Then, after some time, the girl saw her father downcast and said, "Father, why are you sitting there so downcast?" He then told her the matter in full. The girl said, "Father, do not be troubled. Seven days from now I myself will choose a husband."

Then the merchant informed King Prasenajit, and had it proclaimed throughout Śrāvastī with a bell: "Seven days from now the girl Suprabhā will choose a husband herself. Whatever you have to do, do it."

When the seven days had passed, the girl Suprabhā mounted a chariot, raised a banner made of a dyed monastic robe, had the form of the Buddha, the Blessed One, painted in a picture, and entered the street reciting praises. Then, to the sons of kings, the sons of ministers, and the sons of merchants there, who were gazing at her with longing, she explained clearly, with many kinds of words, "I do not wish to slight you in any way; it is only that I am not one who seeks sensual pleasures at all. I have gone for refuge to the Buddha, and I shall go forth in his presence." And with that, they turned back.

The girl Suprabhā went into the presence of the Blessed One, bowed at the Blessed One's feet, and sat before the Blessed One in order to hear the Dharma. Then the Blessed One, understanding her intentions, latent tendencies, constitution, and nature, taught her the Dharma in such a way that she would realize the Four Noble Truths. When she had heard it, the girl Suprabhā shattered with the vajra of wisdom the twenty high mountain peaks of the view of the perishable collection, and attained the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truths, she also accomplished the higher perceptions.

Then the girl Suprabhā rose from her seat, draped her upper robe over one shoulder, placed her right knee on the ground, bowed toward the Blessed One with palms joined, and said this to the Blessed One:

"Venerable One, if I too may go forth in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya, receive full ordination, and attain the state of a nun, then I too wish to practice the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One."

Then the Blessed One, knowing that she would lead many who were to be trained into this teaching, said, "Girl, go, and look to your assembly as well."

Then the girl Suprabhā came out of the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta and went into the midst of a great crowd that had gathered. There each of them thought, "I shall carry her off by force," and they tried to seize her. Then, as they pressed upon her, the girl Suprabhā rose up into the sky like a king of geese spreading his wings, and displayed miracles of many kinds. Ordinary people are quickly won over to faith by miraculous power, and so they saw that miracle that brings gods and humans to faith. When they saw it, their hair stood on end, and, falling like trees cut off at the root, they bowed at her feet and entreated her, "Noble lady, come down, come down! Since you have realized such qualities as these, it is impossible that you would now indulge in sensual pleasures."

Then the girl Suprabhā descended from the sky, sat in the midst of the great crowd, and taught the Dharma in such a way that, on hearing it, many hundreds of thousands of living beings saw the truths. Then the Blessed One entrusted her to Mahāprajāpatī, who gave her the going forth and full ordination.

Then, through diligence, effort, and exertion, she understood this very wheel of saṃsāra with its five spokes to be unsteady and unstable; she ascertained that all kinds of formations are of a nature to decay, to fall, to scatter, and to

perish; and having abandoned all afflictions, she realized arhatship. As an arhat, free of attachment to the three realms, she regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal; her mind was the same toward empty space and the palm of her hand; she became cool, like refined sandalwood; with knowledge she broke the shell of the egg; she obtained the knowledges, the higher perceptions, and the analytical knowledges; she turned away from worldly gain, attachment, and honors; and she became one to be worshiped, honored, and respectfully addressed by the gods together with Indra and Upendra.

Then doubts arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, the one who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what karma did Suprabhā perform that she is beautiful, good to look upon, and lovely, that a precious jewel appeared at her throat, and that, having gone forth, she realized arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, in other, former lives, Suprabhā herself performed and accumulated deeds that have reached maturity, whose conditions have ripened, that have come upon her like a flood, and that are bound to bear fruit. Since Suprabhā herself performed and accumulated these deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element, or the wind element. Virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

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"Monks, long ago, in times past, in the ninety-first eon, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, the guide who tames beings, the unsurpassed, the teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One called Vipaśyin. He lived in dependence on the royal capital Bandhumatī. Then, after some time, the perfectly complete Buddha Vipaśyin, having carried out all the activities of a buddha, passed into complete nirvāṇa, like a fire whose fuel is spent, into the realm of nirvāṇa in which no remainder of the aggregates is left.

"Then King Bandhumat performed the funeral rites for that Blessed One's remains and built a stūpa made of the four kinds of precious substances, one league in circumference and one krośa in height.

"Then, after some time, King Bandhumat's chief queen, having grown old, took the many kinds of ornaments off her body and offered them to that stūpa. Then she bowed at its foot and made this aspiration: 'By this root of virtue, by this generation of the mind, and by this complete giving up of something to be given, may I too attain arhatship!'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who was King Bandhumat's chief queen at that time, on that occasion, is this Suprabhā. Because she fastened ornaments of many kinds to the stūpa of the Blessed One Vipaśyin, she became beautiful, good to look upon, and lovely, complete in all her major and minor limbs; and through the aspiration she made, she has now realized arhatship.

"So, monks, the result of wholly black deeds is wholly black, the result of wholly white deeds is wholly white, and the result of mixed deeds is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon wholly black deeds and mixed deeds, and devote yourselves to wholly white deeds alone. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Supriyā.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, respected, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped and acknowledged by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, receiving robes, food, bedding, seats, medicines for the sick, and other requisites, was staying with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time the wife of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada became pregnant, and when eight or nine months had passed she gave birth to a daughter who was beautiful, good to look upon, and lovely, complete in all her major and minor limbs, and utterly dear to the hearts of all the people living in Śrāvastī.

Then, when the birth feast for her birth had been held, they set about naming her, asking, "What name shall we give this girl?" Her relatives said, "Since this

girl is dear to the hearts of all people, let this girl be named Supriyā, the Very Dear."

She remembered her former lives, and as soon as she was born she spoke this verse:

Whatever gift is given, be it much or little,
Grows from the ground of an excellent field.
Therefore the wise, with diligence, here in the world,
Give with faith to the Buddha, lord of gods and humans.

When her father and mother and the others living in that household heard her speak these words, they were frightened and alarmed and grew uneasy. With their hair standing on end, they said, "Alas! This girl is a piśācī!"

She said, "Mother, I am neither a piśācī nor a rākṣasī. I am a girl, and I wish to give gifts."

Then her mother told the householder Anāthapiṇḍada, "The girl says this." The householder was delighted, pleased, and overjoyed, and he invited the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of monks to a meal in his house, and on her behalf he had the dedication of the gift recited.

Then, when the girl had gradually reached seven years of age, she asked leave of her father and mother and went forth into the teaching of the Blessed One, and she became beloved, cherished, dear to the heart, and pleasing to all the nuns.

Then, at one time, there came a great famine like an intermediate eon of famine, and many hundreds of thousands of living beings died there for lack of food and drink. Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda, "Ānanda, go and tell Supriyā on my behalf: 'For three months, provide the four assemblies with robes, food, bedding, seats, medicines for the sick, and other requisites.'"

Then the venerable Ānanda went to Supriyā and said, "The Blessed One has commanded: 'For three months, provide the four assemblies with robes, food, bedding, seats, medicines for the sick, and other requisites.'"

Supriyā joined her palms, received the Blessed One's command upon the crown of her head, and said, "As commanded."

Then Supriyā set out for Śrāvastī to visit the town where she would go for alms. Then, after a while, the householder Anāthapiṇḍada heard this news and

came before Supriyā in great haste. He said, "Supriyā, where are you going?"

She said, "The Blessed One has commanded it. I have been appointed to the work of a provider for three months."

Anāthapiṇḍada said, "I will provide all of that for you. You need not do it."

Supriyā said, "Father, since you have seen the truths and directly perceive even the treasures hidden beneath the earth, what would be so wonderful in your providing this? But I am acting as a provider in order to benefit the poor."

In the same way, five hundred laymen, Queen Mallikā, the kṣatriya maiden Rainy Season, Ṛṣidatta the overseer of the queens' household, Purāṇa, Viśākhā the mother of Mṛgāra, and King Prasenajit each offered, saying, "You need not do it." Then she went into a forest, and there nonhuman beings in human guise also made her the same offer.

Even after these offers had been made, she herself served the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas for three months with robes, food, bedding, seats, medicines for the sick, and other requisites.

During those same three months, through diligence, effort, and exertion, she understood this very wheel of saṃsāra with its five spokes to be unsteady and unstable; she ascertained that all kinds of formations are of a nature to decay, to fall, to scatter, and to perish; and having abandoned all afflictions, she realized arhatship. As an arhat, free of attachment to the three realms, she regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal; her mind was the same toward empty space and the palm of her hand; she became cool, like refined sandalwood; with knowledge she broke the shell of the egg; she obtained the knowledges, the higher perceptions, and the analytical knowledges; she turned away from worldly gain, attachment, and honors; and she became one to be worshiped, honored, and respectfully addressed by the gods together with Indra and Upendra.

Then, when the three months had passed, the Blessed One made his robes, and when the robes were finished, he put on his robes, took up his alms bowl, and set out with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas from Śrāvastī for Rājagṛha. Supriyā met the Blessed One on the road and said, "I hope you are not weary."

Then, after a while, they reached a forest with water, and as it was midday and there were no provisions, she asked the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas to sit down.

Then she placed the alms bowl in her left hand and spoke these words: "If there is a maturation of merits, may my alms bowl become filled with food of various kinds, both soft and hard." Then the gods filled it with divine nectar. Then Supriyā, following the order of the rows, filled the alms bowls of the entire Saṅgha of monks with food, and there the Blessed One said to the monks, "Monks, foremost among my śrāvaka nuns who have made merit is this nun Supriyā."

Then doubts arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, the cutter of all doubts, "Venerable One, what deeds did Supriyā perform, that she was born into a wealthy family, beautiful, good to look upon, and lovely, honored by all people, and, having gone forth, directly realized arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, in other, former lives Supriyā herself performed and accumulated deeds whose accumulations were complete and whose conditions had matured, which have come on like a flood and will come without fail. Since Supriyā herself performed and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element; they do not ripen in the water element, the fire element, or the wind element. Virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

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"Monks, long ago, in times past, in this very Fortunate Eon, when the lifespan of beings was twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world a perfectly complete buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, guide who tames those to be trained, unsurpassed, teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one, called Kāśyapa. He was dwelling near the city of Vārāṇasī, at Ṛṣivadana, in the Deer Park.

"Then early one morning the perfectly complete Buddha Kāśyapa put on his lower robe and his Dharma robe, took up his alms bowl, and, attended by the assembly of monks and leading them, went into Vārāṇasī for alms. At that time a certain merchant had gone with his servants to a pleasure garden, taking with them a great deal of food, both soft and hard. Then a servant girl of his, carrying a basket of cooked rice, was following behind her master. That

servant girl saw the Blessed One with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas on the road, and she was filled with joy, and this thought arose in her: 'What can my master do to me? Make me a slave twice over? I must not let slip this chance to offer a meal to the Blessed One.'

"Then, resigning herself to being killed, bound, and beaten, she opened the basket of cooked rice and satisfied the Blessed One with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas with various kinds of food. Then she went to the merchant, and after a while the merchant asked, 'Girl, where is that basket of cooked rice?' She said, 'I offered food to the Blessed One, the perfectly complete Buddha Kāśyapa.' When the merchant heard this, he was utterly amazed. Then, glad, pleased, and overjoyed, he said, 'Girl, from this day on you are released from slavery; go! While I lay asleep, you kept watch for me.'

"Then she joined her palms and said to the householder, 'Will you permit me to go forth in the teaching of the Blessed One?' Then the householder gave her an alms bowl and robes as well, and she took the alms bowl and robes her master had given her and went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One. For nine thousand years she did the work of an attendant in the teaching of the Blessed One Kāśyapa, and she offered cooked rice, porridge, soups and drinks, regular meals in turn, invitations as guests, garlands of lamps, and kaṭhina robes, and she offered gifts and great gifts. And she made this aspiration: 'By this root of virtue of having offered gifts and great gifts to the Blessed One Kāśyapa, accomplished through hardship, by the resolve I have raised, and by giving away the things to be given, may I attain going forth in the teaching of the Blessed One Śākyamuni.'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? She who at that time, on that occasion, was the servant girl is this very Supriyā. Because she offered food to the Blessed One Kāśyapa, she was born into a wealthy family, beautiful, good to look upon, and lovely, and honored by all people. Through the aspiration she made, she has now directly realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, deeds that are entirely black have a maturation that is entirely black as well. Deeds that are entirely white have a maturation that is entirely white as well. Mixed deeds have a maturation that is mixed as well. Therefore, monks, abandon entirely black deeds and mixed deeds, and apply yourselves solely to entirely white deeds. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Śuklā.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, receiving robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Kapilavastu, in the Nyagrodha Park.

At that time, among the Śākyas, there lived a Śākya called Rohiṇa, who was rich, with much wealth and great means, with vast and extensive possessions, possessed of the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He took a wife from a family of equal standing, and he played, enjoyed himself, and made love with her. But though he played, enjoyed himself, and made love, he had neither son nor daughter, and resting his cheek on his hand, he thought, "Although I possess much household wealth, I have neither son nor daughter. So after I pass away, since I have no son, all that I have will pass into the king's control." And he sat brooding.

Then śramaṇas, brahmins, soothsayers, friends, relatives, and other kinsfolk urged him, "Make supplication to the gods!" So, sonless and wanting a son, he made supplication to Śiva, Varuṇa, Kubera, Śakra (Indra), Brahmā, and the rest, and to other special gods as well; that is, he also made supplication to the gods of parks, the gods of forests, the gods of crossroads, the gods of three-way junctions, the gods who receive bali offerings, the gods born together with one, the gods who share one's nature, and the gods who constantly follow one.

There is a saying in the world that sons and daughters are born because of supplication, but that is not so. If sons and daughters were born because of supplication, each person would surely have a thousand sons, like a wheel-turning king. Rather, sons and daughters are born from the coming together of three conditions. What are the three? The father and mother come together, aroused with desire; the mother is in season and has her menses; and a gandharva has arrived. From the coming together of these three conditions sons and daughters are born.

So he went on devoting himself to supplication, and a certain being died and passed from one class of beings and entered his wife's womb, and she

conceived. Then the master of the house said, "My good lady, if you give birth to a boy, that is well. But if instead you give birth to a girl, I will drive you out of the house together with her."

Then after a while, when eight or nine months had passed, she gave birth. She bore a girl who was beautiful, good to look upon, and lovely, surpassing human complexion though not attaining that of the gods, clothed in a white garment, and unstained by the impurities of the womb.

Then after a while the Śākya Rohiṇa heard, "Your wife has given birth; she has borne a girl," and he went inside in a rage. Then his wife presented the girl clothed in a divine garment. When the Śākya Rohiṇa saw the girl, he was utterly amazed. He held the birth celebration and then held a naming, asking, "What name shall be given to this girl?" The relatives said, "Since she was born wearing a white garment, let this girl be named Śuklā."

Then the girl Śuklā was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry her on their laps, two nurses to suckle her, two nurses to wash away her dirt, and two nurses to play with her. These eight nurses raised and nourished her with milk, curd, butter, ghee, cream of butter, and every other excellent provision, and she grew quickly, like a lotus in a lake. As much as the girl Śuklā grew, so much did her garment also grow, and it never became soiled, nor did any dirt stain her body.

Then, when the girl Śuklā had gradually grown up, many princes and sons of merchants came to ask for her hand. Troubled by them, her father rested his cheek on his hand and thought, "If I give her to one, the others will become my enemies." And he sat brooding.

Then after a while the girl saw her father sitting brooding and said, "Father, why are you sitting there brooding?" Then he explained the matter to her in full. Then the girl said, "Father, do not be unhappy. I do not seek the pleasures of the senses. I will go forth in the teaching of the Blessed One. Father, please give me your permission."

Then after a while, having asked her parents, she went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One, and the very garment in which she had been born became the complete set of five Dharma robes. Then, through diligence, application, and effort, she understood that this five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra is unstable and impermanent; she realized with certainty that all kinds of formations are by nature subject to decay, falling, scattering, and destruction; she abandoned all afflictions and directly realized arhatship. As an arhat, free of attachment to

the three realms, regarding gold and a clod of earth as equal, with a mind like space and like the palm of the hand, cool as sandalwood paste, having broken the eggshell of ignorance with knowledge, having attained the knowledges, the superknowledges, and the analytical knowledges, indifferent to worldly gain, attachment, and honor, she became one to be worshiped, honored, and respectfully addressed by the gods together with Indra and Upendra.

Then doubts arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, the cutter of all doubts, "Venerable One, what deeds did Śuklā perform, that she was born into a wealthy family, beautiful, good to look upon, and lovely, clothed in a white garment, and, having gone forth, directly realized arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, in other, former lives Śuklā herself performed and accumulated deeds whose accumulations were complete and whose conditions had matured, which have come on like a flood and will come without fail. Since Śuklā herself performed and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element; they do not ripen in the water element, the fire element, or the wind element. Virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

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They ripen into their fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in this very Fortunate Eon, when the lifespan of beings was twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world a perfectly complete buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, guide who tames those to be trained, unsurpassed, teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one, called Kāśyapa. He was dwelling near the city of Vārāṇasī, at Ṛṣivadana, in the Deer Park.

"Then at one time there was the wife of a merchant, a woman endowed with faith, virtuous and of good intention, who went to Ṛṣivadana on some business. There she saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, like a moving mountain of jewels, wholly

excellent. As soon as she saw him, she bowed at the Blessed One's feet and sat before the Blessed One in order to hear the Dharma. Then the Blessed One Kāśyapa taught her the Dharma, and she gained faith. She offered a meal in her house to the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, and she offered kaṭhina robes to the Saṅgha of monks. Then in time, having asked her parents, she went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One.

"Monks, what do you think? She who at that time, on that occasion, was the merchant's wife is this nun Śuklā. Because she offered kaṭhina robes to the Saṅgha of monks, she was born wearing a white garment. Because she kept the state of pure conduct, she has directly realized arhatship in this life.

"Thus, monks, deeds that are entirely black have a maturation that is entirely black as well. Deeds that are entirely white have a maturation that is entirely white as well. Mixed deeds have a maturation that is mixed as well. Therefore, monks, abandon entirely black deeds and mixed deeds, and apply yourselves solely to entirely white deeds. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, the seventeenth section.

The story called Candra.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, receiving robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time there lived in Śrāvastī a brahmin who was rich, with much wealth and great means, with vast and extensive possessions, possessed of the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He had mastered the three Vedas, and he was able to explain word by word the glossaries of names together with the ritual lore, the analysis of letters, and, as the fifth, the legendary histories. He served as teacher to five hundred brahmin youths, instructing them in reciting the brahmanical mantras.

Then, wanting a son, he took a wife from a family of equal standing, and he played, enjoyed himself, and made love with her. As he played, enjoyed himself, and made love, his wife conceived, and when eight or nine months had passed, she gave birth. She bore a girl who was beautiful, good to look upon, and lovely, complete in all her major and minor limbs.

Then they held the birth celebration and then held a naming, asking, "What name shall be given to this girl?" The relatives said, "Since most of the children in our family are named Candra, let this girl be named Candra."

Then the girl Candra was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry her on their laps, two nurses to suckle her, two nurses to wash away her dirt, and two nurses to play with her. These eight nurses raised and nourished her with milk, curd, butter, ghee, cream of butter, and every other excellent provision, and she grew quickly, like a lotus in a lake. Then, as the girl Candra gradually grew up, she became learned, clear-minded, and quick of intellect, skilled in her tasks, endowed with mindfulness, and able to retain what she had heard.

Then after a while, when her father was teaching the mantras to the brahmin youths, she learned them merely by hearing them. And having heard them, she was able to explain those treatises, connecting what came before with what came after. Then her fame spread throughout all Śrāvastī. Even non-Buddhist teachers (tīrthikas) came every day to see her and debated with her.

Then, when the Blessed One had fully awakened into unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening, he came to Śrāvastī, and most of the learned, and those reckoned learned, went there to see the Blessed One. Then, no longer seeing them, she said to the people of her household, "Why do those who know the treatises not come? What is the reason for this?" They said, "The Blessed One, the omniscient Śākyamuni, has come here, and they have all turned to him."

Then, hearing the word "buddha," which she had never heard before, she felt every hair on her body stand on end. Then the girl Candra, having heard the word "buddha," went to the Blessed One. There she saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, like a moving mountain of jewels, wholly excellent. As soon as she saw him, she bowed at the Blessed One's feet and sat before the Blessed One in order to hear the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, knowing the girl Candra's disposition, latent tendencies, constitution, and nature, taught her the Dharma in such a way that she would realize the four noble truths. Having heard it, the girl Candra, with the vajra of wisdom, shattered the twenty towering peaks of the mountain of the view of the perishing collection, and directly realized the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truths, she went forth under Mahāprajāpatī.

Then, through diligence, practice, and effort, she understood that this five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra is unstable and impermanent; she realized with certainty that all kinds of formations are by nature subject to decay, falling, scattering, and destruction; she abandoned all afflictions and directly realized arhatship. As an arhat, free of attachment to the three realms, regarding gold and a clod of earth as equal, with a mind like space and like the palm of the hand, cool as sandalwood paste, having broken the eggshell of ignorance with knowledge, having attained the knowledges, the superknowledges, and the analytical knowledges, indifferent to worldly gain, attachment, and honor, she became one to be worshiped, honored, and respectfully addressed by the gods together with Indra and Upendra.

Then, when the Blessed One told the monks, "Monks, you must recite the Prātimokṣa Sūtra every half month," Mahāprajāpatī said at that time, "May the Blessed One please transmit the Prātimokṣa Sūtra! May the Sugata please transmit the Prātimokṣa Sūtra!" The Blessed One said, "The Tathāgatas, the perfectly complete buddhas, do not transmit the Dharma to nuns word by word. If there is someone among you who can retain it from a single telling, then I will transmit it."

Now at that time the nun Candra was seated, gathered in that very assembly. Then the nun Candra rose from her seat, bowed with joined palms toward the Blessed One, and said to the Blessed One, "I will retain it from a single telling. May the Blessed One please transmit the Prātimokṣa Sūtra! May the Sugata please transmit the Prātimokṣa Sūtra!" Then the Blessed One transmitted it in full, and from that single telling the nun Candra learned it.

There the Blessed One said to the monks, "Foremost among my śrāvaka nuns who are greatly learned and who retain what they have heard is this nun Candra."

Then doubts arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, the cutter of all doubts, "Venerable One, what deeds did the nun Candra perform and accumulate, that she was born into a wealthy family, beautiful,

good to look upon, and lovely, and became one who retains what she has heard?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, in other, former lives Candra herself performed and accumulated deeds whose accumulations were complete and whose conditions had matured, which have come on like a flood and will come without fail. Since Candra herself performed and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element; they do not ripen in the water element, the fire element, or the wind element. Virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen into their fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in this very Fortunate Eon, when the lifespan of beings was twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world a perfectly complete buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, guide who tames those to be trained, unsurpassed, teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one, called Kāśyapa. He was dwelling near the city of Vārāṇasī, at Ṛṣivadana, in the Deer Park.

"Then at one time the daughter of a brahmin went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One Kāśyapa. She received the scriptural transmission from her preceptor, studied it, and learned it by heart, and she became skilled in the aggregates, skilled in the elements, skilled in the sense sources, skilled in dependent origination, and skilled in what is possible and what is impossible. But she was not able to give rise to the ultimate wisdom. The preceptor under whom she had gone forth had been declared by the Blessed One Kāśyapa foremost among those who retain what they have heard."

"Then, at the time of her death, that nun made this aspiration: 'Just as my preceptor was declared foremost among those who retain what they have heard, so may I too, in the future, go forth in the teaching of that Blessed One of whom the Blessed One Kāśyapa prophesied to the brahmin youth Uttara, "Brahmin youth, when the lifespan of beings is a hundred years, you will become the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha called Śākyamuni," and may the Blessed One Śākyamuni declare me foremost

among those who retain what they have heard.'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? She who at that time, on that occasion, was the brahmin's daughter is this nun Candra. Because she made that aspiration, she has been declared foremost among those who retain what they have heard. Because she received the scriptural transmission there, studied it, and learned it by heart, she has now directly realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, deeds that are entirely black have a maturation that is entirely black as well. Deeds that are entirely white have a maturation that is entirely white as well. Mixed deeds have a maturation that is mixed as well. Therefore, monks, abandon entirely black deeds and mixed deeds, and apply yourselves solely to entirely white deeds. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Kuvalayā.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, receiving robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was dwelling together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove, at the Kalandaka Feeding Ground.

At that time in the city of Rājagṛha there took place the festival called the Meeting of the Nāga Kings Giri and Valgu, and many people gathered there from all of the six great cities. Then a master of the dance came from the south, and he had a daughter called Kuvalayā, beautiful, good to look upon, and lovely, complete in all her major and minor limbs, and proud with the intoxication of youth and health. Whenever she came among the spectators, all the spectators gazed at her with longing, and she captivated even those of little discernment.

When the festival took place there, the six teachers beginning with Pūraṇa also came. Then the girl Kuvalayā said to the crowd, "Hey! In the city of Rājagṛha, is there anyone among humans who equals me in beauty, or surpasses me?" The crowd said, "There is the śramaṇa Gautama with his following." Kuvalayā said, "Is he a human, or is he a god?" The crowd said, "He

is a human, but he is omniscient."

Then, having heard those words, Kuvalayā adorned herself with all her ornaments and went to the Blessed One. Having arrived, she stood before the Blessed One and danced, sang, and played music. She also displayed the signs of a woman, the marks of a woman, the gestures of a woman, and the playful wiles of a woman. Those monks there who were not free of desire were thrown into confusion by her, not knowing what to do.

Then, in order to train the monks in whom desire was strong and to remove Kuvalayā's intoxication with her beauty and youth, the Blessed One performed a miracle, a miracle of such a kind that Kuvalayā became old and decrepit, gray-headed, her teeth broken, bent like a roof beam. Then, the moment this was emanated, Kuvalayā saw herself as ugly, and her intoxication with beauty and youth vanished. And the monks in whom desire was strong became disenchanted.

Then Kuvalayā, freed of her intoxication, bowed her head at the Blessed One's feet and implored the Blessed One, "May the Blessed One please teach me the Dharma in such a way that I may be completely freed, with little difficulty, from this body full of pus."

Then the Blessed One, knowing the disposition, latent tendencies, constitution, and nature of Kuvalayā and of those monks who were not free of desire, taught the Dharma in such a way that they would realize the four noble truths. Having heard it, some, with the vajra of wisdom, shattered the twenty towering peaks of the mountain of the view of the perishing collection and directly realized the fruit of stream-entry. Some directly realized the fruit of once-returning. Some directly realized the fruit of non-returning. And some went forth, abandoned all afflictions, and directly realized arhatship.

Kuvalayā too gained faith and went forth in the presence of the Blessed One. Through effort, application, and striving she understood that this very five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra is unsteady and unstable, and she cut through to the certainty that all forms of conditioning factors are subject to decay, collapse, scattering, and destruction. She abandoned all afflictions and directly realized arhatship. As an arhat she became free of attachment to the three realms. Her mind held gold and a clod of earth as equal, and the sky and the palm of her hand as equal. She became cool like refined sandalwood. With knowledge she had broken the shell of the egg. She attained the knowledges, the superknowledges, and the analytical knowledges. She turned her face

away from the gains, cravings, and honors of existence, and she became worthy of the worship, veneration, and respectful address of the gods, together with Indra and Upendra.

Those actors too, through that very weariness, abandoned all afflictions and directly realized arhatship.

Then doubt arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable, it is wonderful that the Blessed One made the actress's daughter Kuvalayā, who was intoxicated with her looks and her youth, weary through old age, and established her all the way to the consummation of utmost security, nirvāṇa."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, now that I am free of desire, free of aversion, free of delusion, completely liberated from birth, old age, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness, and turmoil, now that I am all-knowing, possessed of omniscience, and have gained mastery over wisdom and over all that is to be known, what is so wonderful in my making the girl Kuvalayā, proud with the intoxication of her looks and youth, weary through old age, and establishing her all the way to the consummation of utmost security, nirvāṇa? In a past time, while I still had desire, still had aversion, still had delusion, and was not yet completely liberated from birth, old age, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness, and turmoil, I made the girl Kuvalayā weary through old age and established her in the five bases of discipline. Listen well and carefully to that, and keep it in mind, and I shall explain.

"Monks, long ago, in a past time, in the city of Vārāṇasī, a king called Brahmadatta ruled. During his reign the land was prosperous, flourishing, peaceful, and blessed with good harvests, full of people and of many inhabitants. Disputes and quarrels were stilled; there was no turmoil, no internal strife, no banditry or theft, no famine, and no disease; and it was rich in sāli rice, sugarcane, cattle, and buffalo. He protected the kingdom without harm, its thorns cleared away, as one cares for an only son.

"Then at one time the king played, enjoyed himself, and made love with his queen. Afterward, from their playing, enjoying, and making love, the queen became pregnant. When eight or nine months had passed, a son was born: she gave birth to a boy who was handsome, good to look at, and beautiful, of fine complexion, golden in color, with a head shaped like a parasol, long arms, a broad forehead, a high nose, a well-formed nose, and thick eyebrows,

complete in all his limbs and lesser limbs.

"Then, when the birth festival for his birth had been held, they set about naming him, asking what name should be given to this boy. The relatives said, 'This boy's father is the king of the land of Kāśi, and the boy himself is handsome, good to look at, and beautiful. Therefore this boy shall be named Kāśisundara.'

"Then the boy Kāśisundara was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry him on their laps, two wet nurses to suckle him, two nurses to wash away his dirt, and two nurses to play with him. These eight nurses raised and nourished him with milk, curd, butter, ghee, the cream of butter, and every other excellent kind of provision, and he grew quickly, like a lotus in a lake.

"When he had grown up, he was consecrated as crown prince. Then, while he was ruling as king, he understood that kingship is full of many faults and is the root of many harms, and he went forth among the sages. He dwelled in a hollow of the snow mountains, living on fruits, roots, and water, wearing deerskin and bark, and performing fire offerings.

"Some time later he went into a mountain hollow for fruits and roots. There, at one point, a kinnarī girl saw the young sage and became enamored of him. She danced, sang, and played music, and she displayed a woman's marks, a woman's signs, a woman's gestures, and a woman's amorous play.

"Then at one point the sage Kāśisundara taught the Dharma to that girl: 'Lady, you have grown old. Your voice, which at first was sweet and soft, has at the end become harsh.' When he had taught such a Dharma and she had heard it, the kinnarī girl was no longer intoxicated with her looks. Then faith arose in her, and she made this aspiration: 'When you fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, may I become your disciple.'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? I was the one who at that time, on that occasion, was the young sage. That kinnarī girl is this very Kuvalayā."

Then the monks asked the Blessed One, "Venerable, what deeds did Kuvalayā do, by which she became handsome, good to look at, and beautiful? What deeds did she do, by which she directly realized arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, Kuvalayā herself, in other former lives, did and accumulated deeds whose accumulation had come together and whose conditions had matured, which were bound to arise like a rushing flood, and

which would inevitably come to fruition. Since Kuvalayā herself did and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds done and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element, or the wind element. Rather, good and bad deeds that have been done and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense bases.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When they have gathered and their time has come,
They ripen as their fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in a past time, in this very Fortunate Eon, when the lifespan of beings was forty thousand years, there appeared in the world the perfectly and completely awakened Buddha, the Blessed One called Krakucchanda, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, guide who tames beings, unsurpassed, teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one. He dwelled relying on the royal palace of Sundara.

"Then at one time a master of actors came from the south. At that time, when the Blessed One had led King Sundara to see the truths, the king commanded the master of actors, 'Perform for me a drama about the Buddha.' They received the king's command on the crowns of their heads and said, 'Your Majesty, we shall do as you command.' Then they composed a drama of the Buddha, rehearsed it well, and performed it before the king together with his assembly of ministers. There the master of the actors himself entered in the guise of the Buddha, and the other actors entered in the guise of monks. The king was delighted, pleased, and overjoyed, and he gave a great heap of wealth to the troupe of actors headed by their master.

"Then they gained faith in the teaching of the Blessed One. Having given gifts and great gifts, they made a true aspiration: 'By this root of virtue, by the generating of this intention, and by this relinquishing of things to be given, may we too please the buddhas of the future, and may we not displease them.'

"Monks, what do you think? Those who were the actors are these, Kuvalayā and the others. Through the aspiration they made then, they have now directly realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, the ripening of wholly black deeds is wholly black, the ripening of wholly white deeds is wholly white, and the ripening of mixed deeds is

mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon wholly black deeds and mixed deeds, and devote yourselves to wholly white deeds alone. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Sundarī.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace retinue, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped and acknowledged by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, receiving robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines for the sick and other requisites, was dwelling together with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Vārāṇasī, at Ṛṣivadana in the Deer Park.

At that time, in the city of Vārāṇasī, King Brahmadatta ruled. During his reign the land was prosperous, flourishing, peaceful, and blessed with good harvests, full of people and of many inhabitants. Disputes and quarrels were stilled; there was no turmoil, no internal strife, no banditry or theft, no famine, and no disease; and it was rich in sāli rice, sugarcane, cattle, and buffalo. He protected the kingdom without harm, its thorns cleared away, as one cares for an only son.

Then at one time the king played, enjoyed himself, and made love with his queen. Afterward, from their playing, enjoying, and making love, the queen became pregnant. When eight or nine months had passed, a child was born: she gave birth to a daughter who was handsome, good to look at, and beautiful, complete in all her limbs and lesser limbs.

Then, when the birth festival for her birth had been held, they set about naming her, asking what name should be given to this girl. The relatives said, "This girl is the daughter of the king of Kāśi, and her looks are fine. Therefore this girl shall be named Kāśisundarī."

Then the girl Kāśisundarī was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry her on their laps, two wet nurses to suckle her, two nurses to wash away her dirt, and two nurses to play with her. These eight nurses raised and nourished her with milk, curd, butter, ghee, the cream of butter, and every other excellent kind of provision, and she grew quickly, like a lotus in a lake.

Then, when the girl Kāśisundarī had grown up, six kings of the land sent messengers to King Brahmadatta with this message: "I have heard that a daughter was born to you. Do not give her to anyone else; give her to my son."

Then King Brahmadatta entered his chamber of sorrow, rested his cheek on his hand, and thought, "If I give her to one, the others will become my enemies." And he sat there brooding.

Then at one point the girl Kāśisundarī, adorned with every ornament, went to her father. Seeing her father overcome with sorrow, she asked him, "Father, why are you grieving?" Her father told her what had happened. Then the girl Kāśisundarī said to her father, "Father, please send messengers to the kings of the land saying, 'Seven days from now the girl Kāśisundarī will choose her own husband. Do whatever you must do.'"

When seven days had passed, those six kings of the land assembled. The girl Kāśisundarī, riding in a chariot and raising a banner of dyed monastic robes, holding in her hand an image of the Buddha, the Blessed One, went into the gathering of kings and said, "O kings of the land, listen! I do not care for your looks, your youth, your lineage, your wealth, or your power. I am not one who seeks sensual pleasures. I am a disciple of the Buddha, the Blessed One, whose image is painted on this cloth, and I shall go forth in his teaching."

Having said this, she went to Ṛṣivadana, bowed at the feet of the Blessed One, and said to the Blessed One, "Venerable, if I may go forth in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya and receive full ordination and the state of a nun, I too wish to practice the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One."

Then the Blessed One entrusted her to Mahāprajāpatī, who gave her the going forth and full ordination. Through effort, application, and striving she understood that this very five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra is unsteady and unstable, and she cut through to the certainty that all forms of conditioning factors are subject to decay, collapse, scattering, and destruction. She abandoned all afflictions and directly realized arhatship. As an arhat she became free of attachment to the three realms. Her mind held gold and a clod of earth as equal, and the sky and the palm of her hand as alike. She became cool like refined sandalwood. With knowledge she had broken the shell of the egg. She attained the knowledges, the superknowledges, and the analytical knowledges. She turned her face away from the gains, cravings, and honors of existence, and she became worthy of the worship, veneration, and respectful address of the gods, together with Indra and Upendra.

Then those princes, remembering her looks, her youth, and her beauty, became drunk with the intoxication of desire, and even though she had gone forth, they kept pressing their suit. When they had made their appeal, she rose up into the sky like a king of geese spreading its wings and displayed various kinds of miracles. Ordinary people are quickly brought to faith by miraculous power. When those princes saw that utterly marvelous miracle, which brings gods and humans to faith, their hair stood on end. They bowed at her feet and begged her forgiveness: "Sister, since you have directly realized such qualities, it is impossible that you would indulge in sensual pleasures. Please forgive us."

Then the girl Kāśisundarī descended from the sky, sat down in the midst of a great crowd of people, and taught them such teachings. When they had heard it, many hundreds of thousands of living beings attained great distinction.

Then doubt arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable, what deeds did Kāśisundarī do, by which she became handsome, good to look at, and beautiful, and by which, having gone forth, she directly realized arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, Kāśisundarī herself, in other former lives, did and accumulated deeds whose accumulation had come together and whose conditions had matured, which were bound to arise like a rushing flood, and which would inevitably come to fruition. Since Kāśisundarī herself did and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds done and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element, or the wind element. Rather, good and bad deeds that have been done and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense bases.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When they have gathered and their time has come,
They ripen as their fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in a past time, in this very Fortunate Eon, when the lifespan of beings was thirty thousand years, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened Buddha, the Blessed One called Kanakamuni, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, guide who tames beings, unsurpassed, teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one.

"Then at one time there was a princess, full of faith, virtuous, and of good intention. She had a monastery built, filled it with every requisite, and offered it to the Blessed One together with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas. And during the time of the perfectly awakened Buddha Kāśyapa, she also went forth and cultivated loving-kindness for ten thousand years.

"Monks, what do you think? The one who at that time was the princess is this Kāśisundarī. Because she offered the monastery, she became handsome, good to look at, and beautiful. Because she went forth during the time of the Blessed One Kāśyapa and cultivated loving-kindness for ten thousand years, she has now directly realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, the ripening of wholly black deeds is wholly black.

The ripening of wholly white deeds is wholly white, and the ripening of mixed deeds is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon wholly black deeds and mixed deeds, and devote yourselves to wholly white deeds alone. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Muktā.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace retinue, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped and acknowledged by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, receiving robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines for the sick and other requisites, was dwelling together with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time there lived in Śrāvastī a merchant called Jaya, rich, with much wealth and great means, with vast and extensive holdings, possessed of wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He took a wife from a family of equal standing, and he played, enjoyed himself, and made love with her. Afterward, from their playing, enjoying, and making love, his wife became pregnant. When eight or nine months had passed, a child was born: she gave birth to a daughter who was handsome, good to look at, and beautiful, with a garland of pearls on her head.

Then, when the birth festival for her birth had been held, they set about naming her, asking what name should be given to this girl. The relatives said, "As soon as this girl was born, a garland of pearls appeared on her head. Therefore this girl shall be named Muktā."

Then the girl Muktā was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry her on their laps, two wet nurses to suckle her, two nurses to wash away her dirt, and two nurses to play with her. These eight nurses raised and nourished her with milk, curd, butter, ghee, the cream of butter, and every other excellent kind of provision, and she grew quickly, like a lotus in a lake.

Then, as the girl Muktā gradually grew up, whenever her garland of pearls was taken off, it appeared again. Seeing the destitute and the needy, the girl distributed her wealth among them.

Then, when she reached the age to be given in marriage, princes, ministers' sons, and many merchants' sons came to ask for her. Her father entered his chamber of sorrow, rested his cheek on his hand, and thought, "If I give her to one, the others will become my enemies." And he sat there brooding.

Then the girl said to her father, "Father, why are you troubled?" He told her everything that had happened. The girl said, "Father, I am not one who seeks sensual pleasures. I wish to go forth in the teaching of the Blessed One."

Then at a later time the youngest son of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada, called Supriya, said to his father, "Please ask for that girl as my bride." So the householder Anāthapiṇḍada sent a messenger to the merchant Jaya, saying, "Give the girl Muktā to my son. If you do so, we will become kin, and we will be friends for as long as we live."

Then the householder Jaya told his daughter of this matter. She said, "If he promises that, once he has matured and grown up, he will go forth together with me in the teaching of the Blessed One, then I will make him my husband." He did so, and some time later, on a certain occasion, both of them left home and went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One.

Then, through her own effort, application, and striving, she understood that this very five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra is unsteady and unstable, and she cut through to the certainty that all forms of conditioning factors are subject to decay, collapse, scattering, and destruction. She abandoned all afflictions and directly realized arhatship. As an arhat she became free of attachment to the three realms. Her mind held gold and a clod of earth as equal, and the sky and

the palm of her hand as alike. She became cool like refined sandalwood. With knowledge she had broken the shell of the egg. She attained the knowledges, the superknowledges, and the analytical knowledges. She turned her face away from the gains, cravings, and honors of existence, and she became worthy of the worship, veneration, and respectful address of the gods, together with Indra and Upendra.

Then doubt arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable, what deeds did Muktā do, by which she was born wearing a garland of pearls on her head, and by which, having gone forth, she directly realized arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, Muktā herself, in other former lives, did and accumulated deeds whose accumulation had come together and whose conditions had matured, which were bound to arise like a rushing flood, and which would inevitably come to fruition. Since Muktā herself did and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds done and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element, or the wind element. Rather, good and bad deeds that have been done and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense bases.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When they have gathered and their time has come,
They ripen as their fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in a past time, in this very Fortunate Eon, when the lifespan of beings was twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened Buddha, the Blessed One called Kāśyapa, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, guide who tames beings, unsurpassed, teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one. He dwelled in the city of Vārāṇasī, at Ṛṣivadana in the Deer Park.

"Then at one time a caravan leader set out on the great ocean, accomplished the purpose of his voyage without mishap, and returned. He brought back with him a supremely fine garland of pearls. His wife was handsome, good to look at, and beautiful, and she fastened it on her head.

"Now there lived in Vārāṇasī a householder who was full of faith, virtuous, and of good intention, devoted to his own benefit and the benefit of others,

compassionate, magnanimous, and a lover of the Dharma. This thought occurred to him: 'Let me collect offerings from the people, so that the quinquennial festival in the teaching of the Blessed One Kāśyapa is not interrupted.' So he petitioned King Kṛkin: 'I wish to collect offerings and hold the quinquennial festival of the Blessed One.' The king commanded, 'Do so.'

"Then the householder mounted an elephant and went through the highways, crossroads, and junctions of the city of Vārāṇasī, collecting offerings. At one point the caravan leader's wife took the garland of pearls off her head and gave it to the collection.

"Some time later the caravan leader came and, seeing that the garland of pearls had been taken from her head, asked, 'My good lady, where is the garland of pearls?' She said, 'My lord, I have given it to the collection of offerings for the teaching of the Blessed One. Please be glad of it; please have faith in it.'

"Then at one point the caravan leader bought it back for a price in jewels and gave it to his wife, but she would not take it back, saying, 'I have given it away completely.' Her husband said, 'My good lady, I have bought this with a great deal of gold and silver; why do you not want it?' Then the young woman took it, gathered many flowers, and also taking incense, garlands of flowers, and the like, went to Ṛṣivadana. There she anointed the perfumed chamber with incense and strewed it with flowers, and she placed the garland of pearls on the head of the Blessed One, and it stayed on the head of the Blessed One Kāśyapa.

"Then faith arose in her, and she made this aspiration: 'May I too attain such qualities as these. May I please just such a teacher as this, and may I not displease him.'

"Monks, what do you think? The one who at that time, on that occasion, was the caravan leader's wife is this Muktā. Because she paid honor to the Blessed One Kāśyapa, she became handsome, good to look at, and beautiful, and a garland of pearls appeared on her head. And for that very reason she has now also directly realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, the ripening of wholly black deeds is wholly black, the ripening of wholly white deeds is wholly white, and the ripening of mixed deeds is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon wholly black deeds and mixed deeds, and devote yourselves to wholly white deeds alone. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Kacaṅgalā.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace retinue, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped and acknowledged by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, receiving robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines for the sick and other requisites, was dwelling together with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas in the land of Kacaṅgalā, in the Kacaṅgalā forest.

At that time there lived in the land of Kacaṅgalā an old woman called Kacaṅgalā. Carrying a pitcher, she went to a well to draw water. Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda, "Ānanda, go and tell that old woman, 'Give water for the Blessed One to drink.'" When Ānanda had told her, she said, "Noble one, I will bring it myself."

Then, at one point, Kacaṅgalā filled the pitcher with water and went to the Blessed One. Kacaṅgalā saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, well adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessed of a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, wholly excellent like a moving mountain of jewels. The moment she saw him, a mother's love for a son arose in her, and streams of milk flowed from both her breasts. Saying, "My son, my son!" she went to embrace the Blessed One.

Then the monks tried to stop her, and the Blessed One said, "Monks, do not stop this old woman. Why is that?

For five hundred lifetimes
She was my mother without a break.
With a mother's love for her son,
She embraces my body.
If she were prevented
From embracing my body,
She would at that very moment
Vomit warm blood from her mouth.
Seeing this love for a son,

And mindful of gratitude for her kindness,
With a heart full of tenderness and compassion,
I let her embrace my body."

Then, after a while, when her love for her son had calmed, she sat before the Blessed One to listen to the Dharma. The Blessed One understood her disposition, her latent tendencies, her elements and her nature, and taught her the Dharma in such a way that she came to realize the Four Noble Truths. When she had heard it, Kacaṅgalā, with the vajra of wisdom, shattered the twenty towering peaks of the mountain of the view of the perishing aggregates (satkāyadṛṣṭi) and directly realized the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truths, she spoke these verses:

What a good son ought to do
For a mother who has borne hardships,
That which brings the mind to liberation,
You have done for me.
Exerting yourself for me,
You drew me up out of the lower realms
And set me in the higher realms and in liberation;
You have raised me to an exceedingly great distinction.

Then, after a while, she made her request to the Lord and went forth into the teaching of the Blessed One. Through diligence, striving and effort she came to know that this very wheel of saṃsāra with its five sections is in motion and unstable. She determined that all kinds of formations are by nature subject to decay, to falling, to scattering and to destruction. Abandoning all afflictions, she directly realized arhatship. As an arhat, she was free of attachment to the three realms. To her, gold and a clod of earth were the same; her mind was like space and like the palm of the hand; she had become cool like sandalwood paste; with knowledge she had broken the eggshell of ignorance; she had attained the knowledges, the superknowledges and the analytical knowledges; she paid no heed to the gains, attachments and honors of existence; and she became one to be worshipped, honored and respectfully addressed by the gods, together with Indra and Upendra.

Thereafter, whenever the Blessed One gave the nuns a brief instruction and then withdrew into seclusion, Kacaṅgalā would explain it to the nuns. On that account the Blessed One said to the monks, "Monks, among my nun disciples

who expound the discourses in detail, the foremost is the nun Kacaṅgalā."

Then doubts arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, the one who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what actions did Kacaṅgalā perform, that she went forth only when she was old? What action did she perform, that she became a slave woman? What action did she perform, that she did not come to carry the Blessed One in his last dwelling in a womb? And why was it that she went forth, directly realized arhatship, and was declared foremost among those who expound the discourses in detail?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, Kacaṅgalā herself, in other, former lives, performed and accumulated actions whose accumulations have come together and whose conditions are fulfilled, which come on like a flood and will inevitably come to pass. Who else would experience the actions that Kacaṅgalā herself performed and accumulated? Monks, actions that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element or the wind element. Rather, virtuous and nonvirtuous actions that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense sources.

The actions of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen as their fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, when I was practicing the conduct of a bodhisattva, she was my mother for five hundred lifetimes in succession. Whenever I wished to go forth, she obstructed me, and by the ripening of that action she went forth only when she was old. When I was practicing generosity, she put obstacles in the way of my giving, and because of that she became a pauper. Because she did not perform the kind of action that would have made her renowned for greatness, as Mahāmāyā was, she did not carry me in my last dwelling in a womb.

"Furthermore, she went forth in the time of the Blessed One Kāśyapa, and there she called the nuns, both those still in training and those beyond training, by the word 'slave woman,' and because of that she became a slave woman. There she trained, recited the texts, and became skilled in the aggregates, skilled in the elements, skilled in the sense sources, skilled in dependent origination, and skilled in what is possible and what is impossible; because of that, she has now directly realized arhatship and been declared

foremost among those who expound the discourses in detail.

"Thus, monks, wholly black actions have a wholly black ripening; wholly white actions have a wholly white ripening; and mixed actions have a mixed ripening. Therefore, monks, abandon wholly black actions and mixed actions, and devote yourselves to wholly white actions alone. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, Eighteenth Section. The story called Kṣemaṅkarā.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was respected, revered, honored and worshipped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshipped and renowned among gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and supplies for the sick, was staying together with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time King Prasenajit of Kosala and King Brahmadatta were at odds with each other. Then, at one point, King Prasenajit of Kosala went to the border of Brahmadatta's country and set up camp there. King Brahmadatta, for his part, armed his fourfold army, the elephant corps, the cavalry, the chariot corps and the infantry, and set up camp on the bank of a river.

Then, at one point, King Prasenajit of Kosala brought his chief queen there, and he played, made merry and enjoyed himself with her. King Brahmadatta too played, made merry and enjoyed himself with his queen. Then, on one and the same day, a daughter was born to King Prasenajit of Kosala and a son was born to King Brahmadatta. Then, for a time, drums of rejoicing were beaten in the palaces of both kings, and gifts were given to the beggars.

Then, at one point, King Prasenajit asked his men, "What has happened in Brahmadatta's palace, that they are celebrating like this?" and they told him, "A son has been born to King Brahmadatta." King Brahmadatta asked in the same way, and was told, "A daughter has been born to King Prasenajit."

Then King Brahmadatta sent a messenger to King Prasenajit, saying, "I have heard that you are holding a festival because a daughter has been born to you. A son has been born to me as well, so give that daughter to my son. If we do this, we shall become kin, and there will be no enmity between us for as long as we live." King Prasenajit agreed, saying, "Let it be so." Then the two became friends with each other and lived at ease.

King Brahmadatta held a birth celebration for the boy who had been born to him and gave the boy the name Kṣemaṅkara. King Prasenajit of Kosala also held a birth celebration for the daughter who had been born to him and gave the girl the name Kṣemaṅkarā. Then both were nursed and raised, and in time they gradually grew up.

Then the boy sent the girl necklaces, bracelets, garlands, earrings and neck ornaments. When the girl had grown up, she found faith in the teaching of the Blessed One and came to see the faults in sensual pleasures. She asked her attendants, "Where have these gifts come from?" and the attendants explained it all to her in detail, with the reasons.

When she heard this, she said to her father, "Father, I have no interest in sensual pleasures. I wish to go forth into the teaching of the Blessed One, so please, Father, give me your permission."

The king said, "Daughter, because I came to be at ease when you were born, this is not something I can undo."

Then King Prasenajit of Kosala sent a messenger to King Brahmadatta, saying, "This girl wants to go forth, so come and take her." Then, at one point, King Brahmadatta set a date, saying, "I will come seven days from now, so make whatever arrangements and preparations are needed."

Then the girl Kṣemaṅkarā heard the talk that she would be taken as a bride in seven days. Kṣemaṅkarā was frightened, terrified and unhappy, and shuddering, she went up onto the roof of the palace. Turning toward the Jeta Grove, she prayed to the Buddha, the Blessed One.

And she said:

Great sage, who abides in love and compassion and dwells in meditative concentration,
Tamer, possessed of a peaceful mind, knower of the ways of perfect peace and discipline,
I go to you, Protector, for refuge; so, Protector, I pray,

Free me, who have no protector, from the lower realms, as is fitting.

On that occasion, there is nothing that the buddhas, the blessed ones, do not know, do not see, do not perceive or do not understand. The buddhas, the blessed ones, possessed of great compassion, intent on benefiting the world, possessed of a single guardianship, sole heroes, without equal, who do not speak in two ways, abiding in calm abiding and insight, illuminators of the three knowledges, well trained in the three trainings, skilled in the three bases of discipline, who have crossed the four floods, the soles of whose feet are firmly planted on the four bases of miraculous power, long familiar with the four means of attraction, fearless with the four fearlessnesses, who roar the great true lion's roar of the bull, who have entirely abandoned the five factors, who have wholly passed beyond the five destinies, endowed with the six factors, who have perfected the six perfections, who abide in the six constant abidings, rich with the flowers of the seven limbs of awakening, teachers of the eightfold path, skilled in the nine successive meditative attainments, possessed of the strength of the ten powers, whose renown pervades the ten directions, and who are far more exalted even than those who hold sway over a thousand worlds, by their very nature look upon the world with the eye of a buddha three times by day and three times by night. Their wisdom-vision engages, thinking: "Who is declining? Who is prospering? Who is in want? Who has fallen into danger? Who is beset by harm? Who is in want, in danger and beset by harm? Who is inclining toward the lower realms? Who is sliding toward the lower realms? Who has fallen into the lower realms? Whom shall I draw out of the lower realms and set in the higher realms, in liberation and in the fruit? Whom, sunk in the mire of sensual desire, shall I pull out by the hand? Whom, lacking the seven noble riches, shall I establish in sovereign mastery of the seven noble riches? In whom shall I generate roots of virtue not yet generated? In whom shall I ripen the roots of virtue already generated? Whom, already ripened, shall I liberate?"

Here it is said:

The ocean, the dwelling of sea monsters,
May perhaps let the hour of its tide pass by,
But toward his children who are to be trained
The Buddha never lets the time pass by.

Then the Blessed One saw that the time had come to train Kṣemaṅkarā. He went there by miraculous power, and having arrived, taught her the Dharma in such a way that she came to realize the Four Noble Truths. When she had heard it, Kṣemaṅkarā attained the fruit of non-returning and also gained the superknowledges. Then Kṣemaṅkarā, having passed beyond the desire realm and gained the remedy, came to abide in fearlessness.

Then, at one point, when the seven days had passed and the time had come to take the bride, the prince arrived together with many hundreds of people and came before the sacrificial altar. The family priest gave out parched rice, butter and unbroken white mustard seeds. Then, just as the young man and the girl were about to join hands, Kṣemaṅkarā rose up into the sky like a king of geese spreading its wings, and many living beings saw her display miracles of various kinds.

Then King Prasenajit of Kosala, King Brahmadatta, the prince Kṣemaṅkara, and the other beings who had come to see the spectacle were utterly amazed. They bowed at her feet and implored her, "Young woman, since you have directly realized such qualities as these, it is impossible for you to engage in sensual pleasures. Please forgive us."

Then Kṣemaṅkarā came down from the sky and sat in the midst of the great crowd, and she taught the Dharma in such a way that, on hearing it, many hundreds of thousands of living beings saw the truths.

Then the girl Kṣemaṅkarā asked her father's leave and went to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One entrusted her to Mahāprajāpatī. She was given the going forth, and through diligence, striving and effort she came to know that this very wheel of saṃsāra with its five sections is in motion and unstable. She determined that all kinds of formations are by nature subject to decay, to falling, to scattering and to destruction. Abandoning all afflictions, she directly realized arhatship. As an arhat, she was free of attachment to the three realms. To her, gold and a clod of earth were the same; her mind was like space and like the palm of the hand; she had become cool like sandalwood paste; with knowledge she had broken the eggshell of ignorance; she had attained the knowledges, the superknowledges and the analytical knowledges; she paid no heed to the gains, attachments and honors of existence; and she became one to be worshipped, honored and respectfully addressed by the gods, together with Indra and Upendra.

On that account the Blessed One said to the monks, "Monks, among my nun disciples of great wisdom and great eloquence, the foremost is this nun Kṣemaṅkarā."

Then doubts arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, the one who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what actions did Kṣemaṅkarā perform, that she has been declared foremost among those of great wisdom and great eloquence?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, Kṣemaṅkarā herself, in other, former lives, performed and accumulated actions whose accumulations have come together and whose conditions are fulfilled, which come on like a flood and will inevitably come to pass. Who else would experience the actions that Kṣemaṅkarā herself performed and accumulated? Monks, actions that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element or the wind element. Rather, virtuous and nonvirtuous actions that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense sources.

The actions of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen as their fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in this very Fortunate Eon, when the lifespan of beings was twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the Perfectly Complete Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One called Kāśyapa. He was staying near the city of Vārāṇasī, at Ṛṣivadana, in the Deer Park.

"Then, at one point, the daughter of a merchant there went forth into the teaching of the Blessed One Kāśyapa. She made gifts and donations to the teaching of the Blessed One Kāśyapa, and for twelve thousand years she kept the state of celibate conduct, yet she attained no store of qualities at all. The preceptor under whom she had gone forth had been declared by the Blessed One Kāśyapa foremost among the wise. Then she made this aspiration: 'Just as my preceptor has been declared foremost among the wise, so too in the future, may I go forth into the teaching of the one whom the Blessed One

Kāśyapa prophesied when he said to the brahmin youth Uttara, "Brahmin youth, when the lifespan of beings is a hundred years, you will become the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the Perfectly Complete Buddha called Śākyamuni," and may I become foremost among the wise.'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who was the merchant's daughter at that time, on that occasion, is this nun Kṣemaṅkarā. Because she made gifts and donations, she was born into a wealthy royal family. Because she kept the state of celibate conduct for twelve thousand years, she has now directly realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, wholly black actions have a wholly black ripening; wholly white actions have a wholly white ripening; and mixed actions have a mixed ripening. Therefore, monks, abandon wholly black actions and mixed actions, and devote yourselves to wholly white actions alone. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Virūpā.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was respected, revered, honored and worshipped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshipped and renowned among gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and supplies for the sick, was staying together with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time King Prasenajit of Kosala was reigning in Śrāvastī. During his reign the land was wealthy, prosperous, at ease, blessed with good harvests and full of people and inhabitants; quarrels and fighting had been stilled; there was no strife, no civil unrest, no banditry, no famine and no disease; and it was rich in śāli rice, sugarcane, cattle and buffalo. Free of harm, its thorns cleared away, he ruled the kingdom as one cares for an only son.

Then, at one point, the king played, made merry and enjoyed himself with one of his queens. As he played, made merry and enjoyed himself with her, the queen conceived, and after eight or nine months had passed she gave birth:

she bore a daughter marked by eighteen kinds of ugliness. A birth celebration was held for her, and she was given the name Rastha.

Then, when in due course she was ready to be given in marriage, no matter to whom she was offered, no one would take her, because she was so very ugly.

Then, at one point, a very wealthy caravan leader named Gaṅga came from the south. King Prasenajit thought, "This caravan leader Gaṅga knows nothing of her defects, so I really must give her to him." Then, when night had fallen and it was dark, the king summoned Gaṅga by messenger, adorned the girl with every ornament, and gave her to him as his wife. Since Rastha had been given to Gaṅga, the name "Gaṅga's Rastha" came into being.

Then, the next day, when dawn broke, the caravan leader Gaṅga looked at the girl and saw that she was exceedingly ugly. When he saw her he was alarmed, but out of regard for the king he did not dare to cast her off, and he kept her shut away in his own house.

Then, at one point, the caravan leader Gaṅga set out for a festival and went to join his circle of friends. His friends had made a rule among themselves: "Whoever does not come to a certain pleasure garden together with his wife must pay a fine of five hundred kārṣāpaṇas to the friends." Then Gaṅga came back to his house, went into the chamber of sorrow, and sat brooding, his cheek propped on his hand. Then he thought, "It would be far better for me to pay the fine. I cannot show her to them; the moment they saw her, there would be ugly gossip."

Then Gaṅga locked the door, took the five hundred kārṣāpaṇas for the fine, and went off to join his friends.

Then great sorrow arose in the girl, and she thought, "What good is it to live a life like this? As long as I stay alive, my husband will be unhappy and I will be unhappy too. Now the time has come for me to kill myself." Then she took a rope and went into an inner room to hang herself.

On that occasion, there is nothing that the buddhas, the blessed ones, do not know, do not see, do not perceive or do not understand. The buddhas, the blessed ones, possessed of great compassion, intent on benefiting the world, possessed of a single guardianship, sole heroes, without equal, who do not speak in two ways, abiding in calm abiding and insight, illuminators of the three knowledges, well trained in the three trainings, skilled in the three bases of discipline, who have crossed the four floods, the soles of whose feet are

firmly planted on the four bases of miraculous power, long familiar with the four means of attraction, fearless with the four fearlessnesses, who roar the great true lion's roar of the bull, who have entirely abandoned the five factors, who have wholly passed beyond the five destinies, endowed with the six factors, who have perfected the six perfections, who abide in the six constant abidings, rich with the flowers of the seven limbs of awakening, teachers of the eightfold path, skilled in the nine successive meditative attainments, possessed of the strength of the ten powers, whose renown pervades the ten directions, and who are far more exalted even than those who hold sway over a thousand worlds, by their very nature look upon the world with the eye of a buddha three times by day and three times by night. Their wisdom-vision engages, thinking: "Who is declining? Who is prospering? Who is in want? Who has fallen into danger? Who is beset by harm? Who is in want, in danger and beset by harm? Who is inclining toward the lower realms? Who is sliding toward the lower realms? Who has fallen into the lower realms? Whom shall I draw out of the lower realms and set in the higher realms, in liberation and in the fruit? Whom, sunk in the mire of sensual desire, shall I pull out by the hand? Whom, lacking the seven noble riches, shall I establish in sovereign mastery of the seven noble riches? In whom shall I generate roots of virtue not yet generated? In whom shall I ripen the roots of virtue already generated? Whom, already ripened, shall I liberate?"

Here it is said:

The ocean, the dwelling of sea monsters,
May perhaps let the hour of its tide pass by,
But toward his children who are to be trained
The Buddha never lets the time pass by.

Then the Blessed One, while staying in the Jeta Grove, sent forth golden-colored rays of light. With them he lit up that house as if a thousand suns had risen, and he also went there by miraculous power. He untied the noose from her neck and let the girl breathe again.

There are six marvelous and wondrous things that arise in the world: a tathāgata; the Dharma and Vinaya taught by a tathāgata; being born as a human; being born where the noble ones dwell; having complete faculties; and aspiring to virtuous qualities. These marvelous and wondrous things arise in the world.

Then the Blessed One taught the girl the Dharma suited to her. When she had heard it, the girl, with the vajra of wisdom, shattered the twenty towering peaks of the mountain of the view of the perishing aggregates and directly realized the fruit of stream-entry. Then, having found faith, she served the Blessed One a meal and also offered him robes. Then the girl's ugliness disappeared; she became beautiful, and like a daughter of the gods she sat there lighting up the inner room with radiance. The Blessed One then went back.

Then the friends thought, "Surely this man's wife must be extraordinarily beautiful, and out of a jealous nature he would rather pay the fine than show her. Let us get him drunk on various kinds of liquor, take his keys, go to his house and look at his wife." Then they made him dead drunk on various strong liquors, took his keys, went to his house, opened the doors and saw the girl. When they saw her they were amazed, and thought, "No wonder Gaṅga would not show her to us!"

Then they went back, roused Gaṅga from where he lay asleep under the influence of the liquor, and said, "Gaṅga, to have so beautiful a wife, you have truly found a fine prize!"

At this Gaṅga became even more unhappy, thinking, "I have paid the fine, and on top of that I have become the butt of ugly talk." Then, still unhappy, he came back to his house, opened the door and looked at his wife. Seeing her as exceedingly beautiful, like a forest goddess sitting in a grove of blossoming flowers, he asked, "Good lady, what is this? What did you do to come to have such an exceptional form?" Then she told her husband everything that had happened, and when he heard it, he too found faith in the Blessed One.

Then, at one point, the girl in due course asked her husband's leave and went forth into the teaching of the Blessed One. Through diligence, striving and effort she came to know that this very wheel of saṃsāra with its five sections is in motion and unstable. She determined that all kinds of formations are by nature subject to decay, to falling, to scattering and to destruction. Abandoning all afflictions, she directly realized arhatship. As an arhat, she was free of attachment to the three realms. To her, gold and a clod of earth were the same; her mind was like space and like the palm of the hand; she had become cool like sandalwood paste; with knowledge she had broken the eggshell of ignorance; she had attained the knowledges, the superknowledges and the analytical knowledges; she paid no heed to the gains, attachments

and honors of existence; and she became one to be worshipped, honored and respectfully addressed by the gods, together with Indra and Upendra.

Then the monks, feeling doubt, asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what deeds did Rastha do that she was born into a wealthy family? What deeds did she do that she became ugly, yet went forth and directly realized arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, Rastha herself, in other, former lives, performed and accumulated deeds that have reached their fullness, whose conditions have come together, which bear down like a flood, and which will inevitably come about. Since Rastha herself performed and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element or the wind element. Virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds that have been performed and accumulated ripen solely in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense sources.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen as their very fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in the city of Vārāṇasī there lived the wife of a merchant who was fierce, coarse and harsh-tempered.

"When buddhas do not appear in the world, pratyekabuddhas appear in the world: compassionate toward the wretched and destitute, living in remote dwellings, the sole recipients of the world's offerings. Then, at one time, an ugly pratyekabuddha came to her house, and she reviled him at length, saying, 'What does an ugly one like this want in my house?' and she drove him out of the house.

"Then, to benefit her, that pratyekabuddha rose up into the sky like a king of geese spreading his wings, and displayed miracles of many kinds. Then the merchant's wife was filled with remorse. She begged his forgiveness, offered him food, and made this aspiration: 'May I not experience the karmic ripening of having reviled a pratyekabuddha. May I attain qualities such as these. May I please a teacher even more exalted than this one, and may I not displease him.'

"Monks, what do you think? She who at that time, on that occasion, was the merchant's wife is this very Rastha. Through the karmic ripening of having offered food to the pratyekabuddha, she was born into a wealthy royal family. Because she spoke ugly words and drove him from the house, she became ugly. Moreover, she went forth under the Blessed One Kāśyapa. There she trained and recited the teachings, and became skilled in the aggregates, skilled in the elements, skilled in the sense sources, skilled in dependent origination, and skilled in what is possible and what is impossible, and she guarded the state of the holy life. Because of that she has now directly realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, the ripening of wholly black deeds is wholly black; the ripening of wholly white deeds is wholly white; and the ripening of mixed deeds is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon wholly black deeds and mixed deeds, and devote yourselves to wholly white deeds alone. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Here ends the eighth summary verse of the Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa.

The summary:
Samudra and Sumanas,
Hiraṇyapāṇi, Tripiṭa,
Yaśomitra, the Apparitionally Born,
Sundara and Kapphiṇa,
Bhadrika and Rāṣṭrapāla:
These are taught in this section.

The story called Samudra.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered and worshipped by kings, great ministers, wealthy men, palace attendants, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshipped and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, receiving robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and supplies for the sick, was staying with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time there lived in Śrāvastī a caravan leader who took a wife from a family of equal standing, and he sported, delighted and made love with her. As he sported, delighted and made love, at one point this thought arose in him: "As long as I am in the prime of youth, I should increase my wealth. Later, when I am old, I will enjoy it in comfort."

Then the caravan leader bought an oceangoing ship along with a company of five hundred merchants as his attendants, and together with his wife he set out onto the great ocean. Then, after a time, his wife became pregnant, and on that very ocean the child was born: she gave birth to a boy who was beautiful, handsome and lovely. Having held a birth celebration for him, they gave him the name Samudra, Ocean.

Then, after a time, the caravan leader accomplished the purpose of the voyage and returned from the great ocean without mishap. Later, when the boy Samudra had grown up, his father appointed him caravan leader and sent him off to the great ocean with five hundred merchants as his attendants. Travelling on by stages, he saw villages, towns, cities, provinces, royal capitals and markets, and came to the shore of the ocean. There he hired a ship for five hundred kārṣāpaṇas, and he also took on the five kinds of hired men who live by wages: those who launch the ship, those who bail out the water, the oarsmen, the bird-handlers, and the helmsmen. Then, having proclaimed the departure three times by ringing a bell, he set out upon the great ocean.

When they had gone out onto the great ocean, the black wind of the rākṣasas drove the ship this way and that. Samudra the caravan leader favored the non-Buddhist teachers (tīrthikas), and, terrified of an untimely death, he set about praying to the six teachers; yet the wind drove the ship around all the more. Then, after a time, the other merchants too set about praying to thousands of gods, and they said:

"Śiva, Varuṇa, Kubera, Vāyu, Agni and Mahendra,
The various sages and gods, and the many nāgas dwelling on the earth:
In you we have faith, yet here the harm of death has come upon us.
Swiftly dispel these sufferings, we pray, and protect us travellers!"

But though they cried out in lament like this, there was no one at all to give them refuge.

Then, after a time, a layman who was aboard that ship said, "O friends, neither the six teachers nor the other gods can do anything for you. Go for refuge from the depths of your hearts to the god who is truly present, the Buddha, the

Blessed One, and he will be your refuge."

Then the five hundred merchants headed by Samudra the caravan leader cried out with one voice and went for refuge to the buddhas, the blessed ones.

Now, there is nothing at all that the buddhas, the blessed ones, do not know, do not see, do not perceive or do not understand. The buddhas, the blessed ones, possess great compassion and are devoted to benefiting the world. They are the sole protectors, the sole heroes, without equal, never speaking with a double tongue. They abide in calm abiding and insight, illuminate the three knowledges, are well trained in the three trainings, and are skilled in the three bases of discipline. They have crossed the four floods; the soles of their feet stand firmly on the four bases of miraculous power; they have long been versed in the four means of attracting others; through the four fearlessnesses they are without fear; and they roar the great and genuine lion's roar of the bull among men. They have entirely abandoned the five factors and have completely passed beyond the five destinies. They possess the six qualities, have perfected the six perfections, and dwell in the six constant abidings. They are rich in the flowers of the seven limbs of awakening, teach the eightfold path, and are skilled in the nine successive meditative attainments. They possess the strength of the ten powers, their fame spreads throughout the ten directions, and they are far more exalted even than those who hold sway over a thousand.

As is the very nature of things, three times by day and three times by night they survey the world with the buddha eye, and their vision of wisdom proceeds with the thought: "Who is declining? Who is prospering? Who is in want? Who has fallen into danger? Who is afflicted by harm? Who is in want, in danger and afflicted by harm? Who is inclined toward the lower realms? Who is sliding into the lower realms? Who has fallen into the lower realms? Whom shall I draw out of the lower realms and establish in the higher realms, in liberation and in the fruit? Whom, sunk in the mire of sense desire, shall I pull out by the hand? Whom, lacking the seven noble riches, shall I set in sovereign command of the seven noble riches? In whom shall I produce the roots of virtue not yet produced? In whom shall I ripen the roots of virtue already produced? Whom, already ripened, shall I set free?"

On this it is said:

The ocean, home of the sea monsters,
May perhaps let the time of its tide pass by;

But for the children who are to be trained,
The Buddha never lets the time pass by.

Then the Blessed One, while staying in the Jeta Grove, sent forth rays of light the color of gold, more brilliant than a thousand suns, and these lit up those merchants on every side. He also sent forth rays of loving-kindness, cultivated fully over a thousand eons; these refreshed them, and turned back the black wind of the rākṣasas.

Then, after a time, Samudra the caravan leader accomplished the purpose of the voyage and returned from the great ocean without mishap. Made weary of the world by that very brush with death, he gave gifts and lavish gifts, brought relief to his kinsfolk, and satisfied ascetics, brahmins, the destitute, the wretched and the needy. Then, with his whole retinue of five hundred merchants, he went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One. Through striving, exertion and effort he understood that this very five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra is moving and unstable, and he ascertained that every kind of formation is by nature subject to decay, to falling, to scattering and to destruction. Abandoning all afflictions, he realized arhatship. As an arhat, free from attachment to the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal, his mind was like empty space and like the palm of the hand, he became cool like sandalwood paste, with knowledge he had broken the shell of the egg, and he had attained the knowledges, the superknowledges and the discriminating knowledges. He turned away from the gains, the cravings and the honors of existence, and he became one to be worshipped, revered and respectfully addressed by the gods together with Indra and Upendra.

Then the monks, having become doubtful, asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts: "Venerable Blessed One, it is wondrous that the Blessed One gave back to these five hundred merchants headed by Samudra the lives they held so dear, saved them from distress, and established them in nirvāṇa, the utmost and final goal."

The Blessed One said: "Monks, now that I am free from attachment, free from aversion and free from delusion, completely freed from birth, old age, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness and agitation, all-knowing, knowing all aspects, and have gained mastery over all wisdom and all that is to be known, what great wonder is there in this, that I gave these five hundred merchants headed by Samudra the lives they held so dear,

saved them from distress, and established them in nirvāṇa, the utmost and final goal? Even in the past, when I still had attachment, still had aversion, still had delusion, and was not yet completely freed from birth, old age, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness and agitation, I protected these very merchants. Listen to that well and closely, keep it in mind, and I shall explain.

"Monks, long ago in times past, on the shore of an ocean, there lived a sage endowed with the five superknowledges, who practiced fierce austerities, ate roots and fruits for food, wore deerskins and bark for clothing, and performed the fire offering. He was compassionate, magnanimous, a lover of the Dharma, loving toward all creatures, and one who protected those who had fallen into distress.

"Then, at one time, five hundred merchants of Vārāṇasī wished to go out onto the great ocean. Travelling on by stages, they reached the shore of the ocean. When they saw that sage, faith arose in them; they bowed at his feet and made this request: 'Lord, if any distress should befall us when we have gone out onto the ocean, we pray that you, Lord, will protect us.' He consented, saying, 'I shall do so.'

"Then those merchants gathered jewels and set out back toward Jambudvīpa. Then, at one point, they were driven all around by the black wind of the rākṣasas, and that sage protected them. Then, having accomplished the purpose of the voyage, they returned without mishap, went to the sage and said: 'O great sage, what is it you are seeking to accomplish, dwelling here in hard striving and with this compassionate nature?'

"He said: 'May I become a buddha who, for a blind world without a guide and without a leader, ferries across beings who have not crossed over, frees those not yet free, comforts those not yet comforted, and brings to complete nirvāṇa those who have not yet attained complete nirvāṇa.'

"They said: 'When you have become a buddha, please think of us as well.'

"The sage said: 'I shall do so.'"

The Blessed One said: "Monks, what do you think? The one who was the sage at that time, on that occasion, was I. Those merchants were these men headed by Samudra; at that time too I protected them. Moreover, they went forth in the time of the Blessed One Kāśyapa, and since they brought their faculties to maturity there, they have now realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, the ripening of wholly black actions is wholly black; the ripening of wholly white actions is wholly white; and the ripening of mixed actions is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon wholly black actions and mixed actions, and devote yourselves solely to wholly white actions. Monks, you should train in this way."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Sumanas.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered and venerated by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace, guild masters, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshipped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the renowned Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, alms food, bedding, seats, and medicines and supplies for the sick, was staying with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time in Śrāvastī there lived a householder who was rich, of great wealth and great possessions, with vast and extensive holdings, endowed with wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, a rival to Vaiśravaṇa in wealth. He took a wife from a family of equal standing, and he played, delighted and made love with her. As he played, delighted and made love, every son that was born to them died.

At that time the elder Aniruddha used to go about that household for alms. Then the thought arose in the householder: "This elder Aniruddha is renowned as great through the ripening of his merit. I shall make a request of him, saying, 'If a son is born to me, I will offer him to you as your disciple.'"

Then the householder invited the elder Aniruddha into his house, served him a meal, and made this request: "Elder, if a son is born to me and does not die, I will offer him to the elder as a disciple."

The elder Aniruddha said: "Do not forget the promise you have made."

Then, some time later, he again played, delighted and made love. As he played, delighted and made love, his wife conceived, and a sweet fragrance came forth from her body. Then, after a time, when eight or nine months had passed, the child was born: she gave birth to a boy who was beautiful, handsome and lovely, wearing a small garland of the heavenly sumanas flowers.

Then, having held a birth celebration for him, they gave him the name Sumanas. Then they invited the elder Aniruddha into the house for a meal and offered the boy to him. The elder Aniruddha then gave him dyed robes and also pronounced a blessing, saying, "May you live long!" Later, when seven years had passed since his birth, his parents gave him over to the elder Aniruddha. The elder Aniruddha gave him the going forth and gave him instruction in meditative attention. Through striving, exertion and effort he understood that this very five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra is moving and unstable, and he ascertained that every kind of formation is by nature subject to decay, to falling, to scattering and to destruction. Abandoning all afflictions, he realized arhatship. As an arhat, free from attachment to the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal, his mind was like empty space and like the palm of the hand, he became cool like sandalwood paste, with knowledge he had broken the shell of the egg, and he had attained the knowledges, the superknowledges and the discriminating knowledges. He turned away from the gains, the cravings and the honors of existence, and he became one to be worshipped, revered and respectfully addressed by the gods together with Indra and Upendra.

He was one of keen faculties: when he was sewing a robe made of rags from the rubbish heap, at each single stitch of the needle he would enter into and arise from the eight liberations.

Then, some time later, the elder Aniruddha instructed him: "Son, go and fetch water from the river Khangden."

So the novice Sumanas took a water jar and went to the bank of the river Khangden. Having bathed there and filled the jar with water, he went through the sky. At times he sent the jar on ahead and the novice Sumanas came along behind it; at times the novice Sumanas went ahead and the jar came along behind him.

At that time the Blessed One had arisen from his meditative seclusion and was teaching the Dharma to the fourfold assembly. There the Blessed One said to the venerable Śāriputra: "Śāriputra, do you see this novice coming along with his jar filled with water, mindful, his faculties perfectly composed?

"Having thoroughly abandoned desire and aversion,
And being free of ignorance,
He bears his final body:
How very beautiful is that little one!"

When the Blessed One had thus praised and extolled the novice Sumanas before the Saṅgha of monks, the monks became doubtful and asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts: "Venerable One, what actions did this Sumanas perform, that he was born beautiful, handsome and lovely, as if wearing a garland of heavenly sumanas flowers, and that he is of keen faculties and has realized arhatship?"

The Blessed One said: "Monks, the actions that Sumanas himself performed and accumulated in other, former lives have gathered their conditions, their causes have matured, and they now come upon him like a flood, inescapably. Since Sumanas himself performed and accumulated those actions, who else would experience them? Monks, the actions one has performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element or the wind element. Virtuous and non-virtuous actions that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense sources.

"The actions of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons;
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen into their fruit.

"Monks, long ago in times past, in the ninety-first eon, there appeared in the world a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, a sugata, a knower of the world, an unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, a teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one, called Vipaśyin. He was staying near the royal capital of Bandhumat.

"At that time there lived a caravan leader in whom, from his youth, the wish to go forth had arisen, but he had been unable to go forth. When he grew old, regret arose in him and he thought, 'I did not do well in failing to go forth in the teaching of the Blessed One.' Then he hung sumanas flowers on the stupa of the Blessed One's hair and nails. He also served a meal to the perfectly complete Buddha Vipaśyin together with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas, bowed at his feet, and made this aspiration: 'By this root of virtue, by this arousing of the mind, and by this giving away of things to be given, may I please the future tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas, blessed ones, and may I not displease them. In whosever teaching I go forth, may I there realize the noble qualities while still in my youth.'

"Moreover, he went forth in the time of the Blessed One Kāśyapa, and there for ten thousand years he kept the conduct of pure life; because of that, he has now realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, the ripening of wholly black actions is wholly black; the ripening of wholly white actions is wholly white; and the ripening of mixed actions is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon wholly black actions and mixed actions, and devote yourselves solely to wholly white actions. Monks, you should train in this way."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Hiraṇyapāṇi.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered and venerated by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the people of the palace, guild masters, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshipped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the renowned Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, alms food, bedding, seats, and medicines and supplies for the sick, was staying with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time in Śrāvastī there lived a householder who was rich, of great wealth and great possessions, with vast and extensive holdings, endowed with wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, a rival to Vaiśravaṇa in wealth. He had no son and no daughter. He sat with his cheek resting on his hand, brooding, and thought: "Although my house is full of riches, I have no son and no daughter, so after I am gone, since I have no son, everything I own will pass to the king."

Then ascetics, brahmins, soothsayers, friends, relatives and other kinsfolk urged him, "Pray to the gods!" In the world, indeed, there is the saying that sons and daughters are born through prayer. But it is not so: if sons and daughters were born through prayer, then each person would have a thousand sons, like a wheel-turning king. Rather, sons and daughters are born when three conditions come together. What are the three? The father and mother, roused by desire, come together; the mother is in season and fertile; and a gandharva is present. It is when these three conditions come together that sons and daughters are born.

So he was devoting himself to prayer, and a certain being died and passed from another class of beings and entered his wife's womb.

Some women of a wise nature have five special qualities. What are the five? They know when a man is impassioned and when he is not; they know the right time and the fertile season; they know when they have conceived; they know by whom they have conceived; and they know whether it is a boy or a girl: if it is a boy, it lies on the right side of the womb, and if it is a girl, it lies on the left side of the womb.

Then she, overjoyed, told her husband: "My lord, I have conceived a child. Since it lies on the right side of my womb, it will surely be a boy. Please rejoice!"

He too was overjoyed. Raising the upper part of his body and stretching out his right hand, he uttered words of joy: "I shall see the face of the son I have long wished for! May my son be worthy and not unworthy! May he do my duties! May he support us in return for our raising him! May he enjoy his inheritance! May my family line long endure! And after we have passed away and died, may he give gifts, whether many or few, and make merit on our behalf, and dedicate the offering, saying, 'Wherever these two have been born and gone, may this follow them there!'"

Then, knowing that she had conceived, in order to care for the child he kept her at ease in the upper story of the mansion. In cold weather she was given things to keep her warm, in hot weather things to keep her cool, and the foods the physician prescribed: foods not too bitter, not too sour, not too salty, not too sweet, not too pungent and not too astringent, foods free of bitterness, sourness, saltiness, sweetness, pungency and astringency. She was adorned with necklaces and garlands, and like a daughter of the gods roaming in the Nandana Grove, she moved from couch to couch and from seat to seat, never coming down to the ground below, and she was kept from hearing any unpleasant sound at all.

Then, when eight or nine months had passed, the child was born: she gave birth to a boy who was beautiful, handsome and lovely, complete in all his limbs and parts. On his two hands there appeared two gold coins stamped with marks, which had arisen from the ripening of his karma; and whenever these were taken, others would appear.

Then, having held a birth celebration for him, they set about naming him, asking, "What name shall we give this boy?" His relatives said: "As soon as he

was born, two gold coins arising from the ripening of his karma appeared on his two hands. Therefore let this boy's name be Hiraṇyapāṇi, Gold in Hand."

Then the boy Hiraṇyapāṇi was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry him on their laps, two wet nurses, two nurses to wash away dirt, and two nurses to play with him. Those eight nurses raised and nourished him with milk, curd, butter, ghee, the cream of butter, and every other kind of fine provision, and he grew quickly, like a lotus in a lake.

He was full of faith, virtuous and of good intentions, devoted to the benefit of himself and others, and compassionate. Whenever he went out into the street and saw ascetics, brahmins, the destitute, the wretched and the needy, he would stretch out his two hands, and from them would come heaps of gold and silver coins stamped with marks, as many as were needed. Then his fame spread throughout all Śrāvastī.

Then, some time later, the boy Hiraṇyapāṇi went to the Jeta Grove. There he saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, wholly excellent, like a moving mountain of jewels. As soon as he saw him, joy toward the Blessed One arose in his mind. With joy arisen, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat before the Blessed One to listen to the Dharma.

Then, after the Blessed One had taught him the Dharma, he said to the venerable Ānanda: "Master, I wish to serve a meal to the Blessed One together with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas."

The elder Ānanda said: "Son, kārṣāpaṇas are needed."

Then the boy Hiraṇyapāṇi stood before the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha, stretched out his two hands, and piled up a great heap of gold and silver. When the elder of the Saṅgha, the other monks and the elder Ānanda saw this, they were utterly amazed.

Then the boy Hiraṇyapāṇi served a meal to the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha, and sat before the Blessed One to listen to the Dharma. Then the Blessed One, understanding his intention, latent tendencies, disposition and nature, taught him the Dharma in such a way that he would realize the four noble truths. On hearing it, the boy Hiraṇyapāṇi shattered with the vajra of wisdom the mountain of the view of the perishing aggregates with its twenty

lofty peaks, and realized the fruit of stream entry. Having seen the truths, he divided his wealth among his relatives, satisfied ascetics, brahmins, the destitute, the wretched and the needy, asked leave of his parents, and went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One.

Through striving, exertion and effort he understood that this very five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra is moving and unstable, and he ascertained that every kind of formation is by nature subject to decay, to falling, to scattering and to destruction. Abandoning all afflictions, he realized arhatship. As an arhat, free from attachment to the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal, his mind was like empty space and like the palm of the hand, he became cool like sandalwood paste, with knowledge he had broken the shell of the egg, and he had attained the knowledges, the superknowledges and the discriminating knowledges. He turned away from the gains, the cravings and the honors of existence, and he became one to be worshipped, revered and respectfully addressed by the gods together with Indra and Upendra.

Then the monks, having become doubtful, asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts: "Venerable One, what actions did Hiraṇyapāṇi perform, that two gold coins stamped with marks came forth from his two hands, and that he went forth and realized arhatship?"

The Blessed One said: "Monks, the actions that Hiraṇyapāṇi himself performed and accumulated in other, former lives have gathered their conditions, their causes have matured, and they now come upon him like a flood, inescapably. Since Hiraṇyapāṇi himself performed and accumulated those actions, who else would experience them? Monks, the actions one has performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element or the wind element. Virtuous and non-virtuous actions that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense sources.

"The actions of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons;
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen into their fruit.

"Monks, long ago in times past, in this very Fortunate Eon, when the lifespan of beings was twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, a sugata, a knower of the world, an unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, a

teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one, called Kāśyapa. He was staying near the city of Vārāṇasī, at Ṛṣivadana in the Deer Park.

"Then the perfectly complete Buddha Kāśyapa, having carried out all the deeds of a buddha, passed into complete nirvāṇa in the sphere of nirvāṇa without remainder of the aggregates, like a fire whose fuel is spent. King Kṛkin performed the funeral honors for his relics and built a stupa of the four kinds of precious substances, one league in circumference and one krośa in height.

"When the festival of that stupa was being held, a gambler fastened two gold coins to the central pole of the stupa. Then he bowed at its foot and made this aspiration: 'Wherever I am born, may I always have gold in my hands!'"

The Blessed One said: "Monks, what do you think? The one who was the gambler at that time, on that occasion, was this Hiraṇyapāṇi. Because he fastened two gold coins to the stupa, he has come to have this distinction; and through the aspiration he made, he has now realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, the ripening of wholly black actions is wholly black; the ripening of wholly white actions is wholly white; and the ripening of mixed actions is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon wholly black actions and mixed actions, and devote yourselves solely to wholly white actions. Monks, you should train in this way."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, the nineteenth section.

The story called Tripiṭa.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was honored, esteemed, respected and worshipped by kings, by great ministers, by the wealthy, by the people of the royal court, by merchants, by caravan leaders, by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnarīs and mahoragas. Worshipped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnarīs and mahoragas, the renowned Blessed One, the Buddha, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and supplies for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time Prasenajit, king of Kosala, was ruling as king in Śrāvastī. During his reign the land was prosperous, flourishing, happy and blessed with good harvests, and filled with many people and inhabitants. Quarrels and fighting

had been quelled, and there was no strife, no internal unrest, no banditry, no famine and no disease. It was rich in sāli rice, sugarcane, cattle and buffalo. Free of harm, with all thorns removed, he protected his kingdom as one cares for an only son.

Then, after some time, he played, made love and enjoyed himself with his queen. As he played, made love and enjoyed himself, the queen conceived a child, and when eight or nine months had passed a child was born: a boy, clothed in a dyed robe, wearing the dress of a renunciant, and remembering his former lives. As soon as he was born he asked, "Are the Blessed One and the great śrāvakas, Śāriputra, Maudgalyāyana, Kāśyapa, Ānanda and the others, staying right here in Śrāvastī?"

His mother was amazed and, swelling with joy, said, "Son, the Blessed One and the great śrāvakas are staying right here in Śrāvastī."

Then, after some time, she told the matter to King Prasenajit: "A son of yours has been born, clothed in a dyed robe, wearing the dress of a renunciant, and remembering his former lives, and he asks where the Blessed One and the great śrāvakas are staying."

Then, in order to benefit the child, King Prasenajit invited the Blessed One, together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, to a meal. The Blessed One, attended by the assembly of monks and placed at the head of the Saṅgha of monks, went to where King Prasenajit's meal was laid out, and on arriving sat down on the seat prepared in the midst of the Saṅgha of monks.

Then Prasenajit, king of Kosala, took the child in his lap, brought him before the Blessed One, and said, "Blessed One, as soon as this son of mine was born he remembered the Blessed One and the great śrāvakas."

The Blessed One then said to the child, "Tripiṭa, may you be free from illness."

And the child said, "Homage to the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha."

King Prasenajit was utterly amazed.

Then, when seven years had passed since his birth, still wearing those very dyed robes, he went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One. Striving, exerting himself and making effort, he understood that this very wheel of saṃsāra with its five spokes is unsteady and unstable, and he ascertained that all kinds of formations are by nature subject to decay, to falling, to scattering and to destruction. Abandoning all afflictions, he realized arhatship. As an

arhat, free of attachment to the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal, and had a mind like empty space and the palm of the hand. He became cool, like sandalwood paste. With knowledge he had broken the shell of the egg. He attained the knowledges, the superknowledges and the analytical knowledges. He turned away from the gains of existence, from craving and from honors. He became one worshipped by the gods together with Indra and Upendra, one to be praised and spoken of with reverence.

Then doubt arose in the monks, and they asked the Blessed One, the Buddha, the one who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what actions did Tripiṭa perform, that he was born clothed in a dyed robe, wearing the dress of a renunciant, and remembering his former lives, and that after going forth he realized arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, Tripiṭa himself, in other, former lives, performed and accumulated those actions which, once the accumulations are gathered and the conditions come together, come forth like a flood and will without fail bear their fruit. Since Tripiṭa himself performed and accumulated those actions, who else would experience them? Monks, actions that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the outer element of earth, nor do they ripen in the element of water, the element of fire or the element of wind. Actions performed and accumulated, whether virtuous or non-virtuous, ripen solely in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense sources.

The actions of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the accumulation is complete and the time has come,
They ripen as their fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in this very Fortunate Eon, when beings lived for twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world the perfectly complete Buddha called Kāśyapa, endowed with knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one. He was staying near the city of Vārāṇasī, at Ṛṣivadana in the Deer Park.

Then, at one time, the son of King Kṛkin went to Ṛṣivadana. There he saw the Blessed One, the Buddha, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and made beautiful by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing that of a thousand suns, wholly excellent, like a moving mountain of jewels; and as

soon as he saw him, faith arose in him. Faith having arisen, he bowed at the feet of the Blessed One and sat before the Blessed One in order to hear the Dharma. The Blessed One, understanding his disposition, latent tendencies, constitution and nature, taught him the kind of Dharma that brings disenchantment with saṃsāra, and on hearing it he came to see the faults of saṃsāra and the virtues of nirvāṇa.

Then he made a request to the king: "Father, I wish to go forth in the teaching of the Blessed One. Please grant me permission."

The king said, "Before long you must be consecrated as regent, so I can do nothing about this."

The son said, "I have no wish for a kingdom, which is full of faults and has become an enemy of the Dharma. If you will not permit me to go forth in the teaching of the Blessed One, I will not eat." Then, since his father did not give permission, he went without food for one day, two days, three days, up to six days.

Then his companions made a request to the king: "Please consider, Your Majesty: it would be good if the prince went forth, but it would not be good if he were to die here."

So the king gave his permission, but bound him to a promise, commanding him, "Until you have learned the Tripiṭaka, the Three Baskets, do not come to meet me."

Then, after some time, having received his father's permission, he went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One. Striving, exerting himself and making effort, before long he had learned the Three Baskets and became a teacher of the Dharma, eloquent in knowledge and in liberation. He then thought, "Surely I have not broken the promise I made before." Thinking this, he went to his father, and when they met, his father asked, "Son, have you learned even a little?"

He said, "I have learned the Three Baskets."

Then he taught his father such Dharma that, on hearing it, the king was delighted. Joy arose in him, and he said, "My only son, what do you need?"

He said, "I wish to invite the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas and to offer them the six requisites."

The king said, "The royal palace is vast; do whatever you please."

Then Tripiṭa satisfied the Blessed One and his retinue of twenty thousand monks with excellent food, and to each monk he offered a set of the six requisites. Then, bowing at his feet, he made this aspiration: "Having now obtained going forth with difficulty, by this root of virtue of honoring the Tathāgata together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, by this generating of the mind, and by this complete relinquishing of things to be given, wherever I am born, may I be clothed in a dyed robe, possessed of this dress of a renunciant, and remember my former lives."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who at that time, on that occasion, was the son of King Kṛkin is this very Tripiṭa. For that very reason he was born into a wealthy family, handsome, good to look upon and beautiful, and remembering his former lives.

"Thus, monks, the ripening of wholly black actions is wholly black; the ripening of wholly white actions is wholly white; and the ripening of mixed actions is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon wholly black actions and mixed actions, and devote yourselves solely to wholly white actions. Monks, you should train in this way."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Yaśomitra.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was honored, esteemed, respected and worshipped by kings, by great ministers, by the wealthy, by the people of the royal court, by merchants, by caravan leaders, by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnarīs and mahoragas. Worshipped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnarīs and mahoragas, the renowned Blessed One, the Buddha, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and supplies for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time there lived in Śrāvastī a caravan leader who was rich, with much wealth and great possessions, with vast and extensive holdings, possessing wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He took a wife from a family of equal standing, and he played, made love and enjoyed himself with her.

At that time a terrible famine struck, and even by begging one could not obtain food. The soothsayers too had foretold that no rain would fall. Then, after some time, the caravan leader's wife conceived a child, and when eight or nine months had passed a child was born: a boy, handsome, good to look upon and beautiful, complete in all his major and minor limbs. And on the very day the boy was born, the drought came to an end. Then his fame spread throughout all of Śrāvastī.

Then, having held the birth celebration for him, they set about naming him, asking, "What name shall we give this boy?" His relatives said, "Since his fame has spread everywhere, let this boy be named Yaśomitra."

Then the boy Yaśomitra was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry him in their laps, two wet nurses to suckle him, two nurses to wash away his dirt, and two nurses to play with him. Those eight nurses raised and nourished him with milk, curds, butter, ghee, cream of butter, and every other excellent kind of provision, and he grew quickly, like a lotus in a lake.

Then, when the boy Yaśomitra had grown up, he went to the Jeta Grove on some business. There he saw the Blessed One, the Buddha, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and made beautiful by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing that of a thousand suns, wholly excellent, like a moving mountain of jewels; and as soon as he saw him, faith arose in him. Faith having arisen, he bowed at the feet of the Blessed One and sat before the Blessed One in order to hear the Dharma.

The Blessed One then taught him the kind of Dharma that brings disenchantment with saṃsāra, and on hearing it he came to see the faults of saṃsāra and the virtues of nirvāṇa. Having asked his father and mother, he went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One. Striving, exerting himself and making effort, he understood that this very wheel of saṃsāra with its five spokes is unsteady and unstable, and he ascertained that all kinds of formations are by nature subject to decay, to falling, to scattering and to destruction. Abandoning all afflictions, he realized arhatship. As an arhat, free of attachment to the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal, and had a mind like empty space and the palm of the hand. He became cool, like sandalwood paste. With knowledge he had broken the shell of the egg. He attained the knowledges, the superknowledges and the analytical knowledges. He turned away from the gains of existence, from craving and

from honors. He became one worshipped by the gods together with Indra and Upendra, one to be praised and spoken of with reverence.

From his two eyeteeth flowed water possessing the eight qualities, and so he was never troubled by thirst. When, in the hot season, the thirsty monks gathered in the Saṅgha for the midday drink, he did not come. Then the monks who were his friends asked him, "Why are you never troubled by thirst?"

He said, "From my two eyeteeth flows water possessing the eight qualities, and so I am never troubled by thirst."

Then doubt arose in the monks, and they asked the Blessed One, the Buddha, the one who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what actions did this Yaśomitra perform, that he is handsome, good to look upon and beautiful, that water possessing the eight qualities flows from his two eyeteeth, and that after going forth he realized arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, Yaśomitra himself, in other, former lives, performed and accumulated those actions which, once the accumulations are gathered and the conditions come together, come forth like a flood and will without fail bear their fruit. Since Yaśomitra himself performed and accumulated those actions, who else would experience them? Monks, actions that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the outer element of earth, nor do they ripen in the element of water, the element of fire or the element of wind. Actions performed and accumulated, whether virtuous or non-virtuous, ripen solely in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense sources.

The actions of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the accumulation is complete and the time has come,
They ripen as their fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in this very Fortunate Eon, when beings lived for twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world the perfectly complete Buddha called Kāśyapa, endowed with knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one. He was staying near the city of Vārāṇasī, at Ṛṣivadana in the Deer Park.

"Then, at one time, the son of a merchant went forth under an old monk. But he was lazy and did not want to serve others. So his fellow practitioners of the

holy life had that same elder appoint him as an attendant. Then, thinking, 'I am the attendant,' he grew full of himself, and he took to accepting service from monks far senior to him. Because of this his roots of virtue were exhausted.

"Later, at one time, he was struck by illness, and the elder, following the physician's instructions, had him drink medicinal ghee. During the night he grew thirsty and, at a loss what to do, thought, 'I will drink some water.' He went to his own water vessel and saw that there was no water. In the same way he went to his preceptor, his teacher, and the Saṅgha's quarters, and saw that they too had no water. Then, after a while, he went to the bank of the river Varaṇā, and it too was without water.

"Displeased, in order to make his fellow practitioners of the holy life disenchanted, and to show that what is given in faith is a heavy thing, he climbed a tree that stood on the far side of the river Varaṇā, tied a cloth there, reflected on his own deeds, and remained there, resting on his deeds.

"Then, after a while, when the next day dawned, he told the story to his fellow practitioners of the holy life. When his fellow practitioners of the holy life heard what had happened they were displeased and told one another of it. Then his preceptor gave him water, but he could not see that either.

"Displeased, the preceptor informed the Blessed One Kāśyapa, and the Blessed One Kāśyapa declared, 'Strike the gaṇḍī gong!' The keeper of the monastery struck the gaṇḍī, and the Saṅgha of monks, headed by the Buddha, assembled. The story spread throughout the city of Vārāṇasī, and many hundreds of thousands of beings gathered. Then his preceptor had him sit before the head of the row, filled a pitcher with water, gave it to him and said, 'Son, distribute this water to the Saṅgha.'

"Then, seeing the result directly before his eyes, that very disenchantment led him to generate faith in the Blessed One and the śrāvakas, and with intense resolve he distributed that water to the Saṅgha. Then, in order to benefit him, the Blessed One stretched out his arm, like the trunk of an elephant, and with the hand that gives relief from all fears received that water. And though the great śrāvakas also took of it, it was not exhausted; even when it had been distributed to the entire Saṅgha, it was not exhausted.

"Then, seeing that wondrous miracle, which inspires faith in gods and humans, many hundreds of thousands of living beings came to see the truth. And in his own mind stream too, the roots of virtue were restored.

"When he had recovered from his illness, he made sure that the Saṅgha of monks, headed by the Buddha, never lacked for water, and for twelve thousand years he distributed water to the Saṅgha. Later, when the time of his death arrived, he made this aspiration: 'By this root of virtue, this generating of the mind, and this complete relinquishing of things to be given, may I please, and never displease, the one of whom the Blessed One Kāśyapa prophesied to the brahmin youth Uttara, "Brahmin youth, when beings live for a hundred years, you will become the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Śākyamuni." And from between my eyeteeth too may water possessing the eight qualities flow.'

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who at that time, on that occasion, was that monk is this very Yaśomitra. Because for twelve thousand years he distributed water to the Saṅgha and made that aspiration, in this life water flows from between his eyeteeth; and for that very reason he has realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, the ripening of wholly black actions is wholly black; the ripening of wholly white actions is wholly white; and the ripening of mixed actions is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon wholly black actions and mixed actions, and devote yourselves solely to wholly white actions. Monks, you should train in this way."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called The Apparitionally Born.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, was honored, esteemed, respected and worshipped by kings, by great ministers, by the wealthy, by the people of the royal court, by merchants, by caravan leaders, by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnarīs and mahoragas. Worshipped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnarīs and mahoragas, the renowned Blessed One, the Buddha, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and supplies for the sick, together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, had undertaken to spend the rains retreat in the realm of the gods of the Thirty-Three, not far from the Pārijāta, king of trees, upon a stone slab like a white woolen blanket; and there he was teaching the Dharma to the mother who bore him and to the other gods of the Thirty-Three.

At that time the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana had undertaken to spend the rains retreat at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada. Then the fourfold assembly went to where the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana was, and on arriving they bowed their heads at the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana's feet and sat down to one side. When they were seated to one side, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana instructed them with a talk on the Dharma, inspired them, roused them and delighted them. Having instructed, inspired, roused and delighted them with many kinds of talk on the Dharma, he fell silent.

Then the fourfold assembly rose from their seats, arranged their upper robes over one shoulder, bowed with palms joined toward the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, and said to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, "Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, have you heard anything of where the Blessed One has now undertaken to spend the rains retreat?"

The venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana said, "Friends, I have heard that the Blessed One has undertaken to spend the rains retreat in the realm of the gods of the Thirty-Three, not far from the Pārijāta, king of trees, upon a stone slab like a white woolen blanket, and that he is staying there teaching the Dharma to the mother who bore him and to the other gods of the Thirty-Three."

Then the fourfold assembly praised and rejoiced in what the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana had said, bowed at his feet, rose from their seats and departed.

Then, when the three months of the rains had passed, the fourfold assembly went to where the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana was, and on arriving they bowed their heads at the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana's feet and sat down to one side. The venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana instructed the fourfold assembly with a talk on the Dharma, inspired them, roused them and delighted them. Having instructed, inspired, roused and delighted them with many kinds of talk on the Dharma, he fell silent.

Then the fourfold assembly rose from their seats, arranged their upper robes over one shoulder, bowed with palms joined toward the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, and said to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana:

"Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, please be aware: it has been a long time since we saw the face of the Blessed One, and we thirst for the sight of the Blessed One. We wish to see the Blessed One. If it would be no trouble for the

venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, may the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana go to where the Blessed One is, and on arriving, pay homage at his feet and ask, 'Are you free of trouble? Are you free of ailment? Do you move about with ease? Are you keeping well? Are you strong? Are you at ease? Are you free of discomfort? Do you abide in comfort?' And please also tell him this: 'Venerable One, the fourfold assembly of Jambudvīpa wish to see the Blessed One. They say this: "Venerable One, the people of Jambudvīpa do not have such miraculous power and might as would let them go to the realm of the gods of the Thirty-Three in order to see the Blessed One, approach him and serve him. But the gods of the Thirty-Three do have such miraculous power and might as lets them go to Jambudvīpa in order to see the Blessed One, approach him and serve him. Therefore, out of compassion, may the Blessed One please come down from the realm of the gods of the Thirty-Three to Jambudvīpa."'"

The venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana consented to the fourfold assembly by remaining silent. Then the fourfold assembly, understanding that the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana had consented by remaining silent, bowed their heads at the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana's feet, rose from their seats and departed.

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, knowing that the fourfold assembly had not long departed, entered into such a meditative absorption that, as his mind settled in equipoise, in the time it takes a strong man to stretch out his bent arm or bend his outstretched arm, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana vanished from Śrāvastī and arrived in the realm of the gods of the Thirty-Three, not far from the Pārijāta, king of trees, where the stone slab like a white woolen blanket lay.

At that time the Blessed One was seated in the midst of an assembly of many hundreds of gods, teaching the Dharma. The venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana saw the Blessed One seated in the midst of an assembly of many hundreds of gods, teaching the Dharma, and when he saw this he smiled and thought, "Just as in Jambudvīpa the Blessed One is surrounded by the fourfold assembly, so here too he is seated with a great assembly."

Then the Blessed One, knowing in his own mind the mind of the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, said to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, "Maudgalyāyana, these beings have no independence of their own. When I think, 'Go,' then they go; when I think, 'Come,' then they come. Knowing my intention with their minds, they come and go."

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana went to where the Blessed One was and, on arriving, bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana looked over the whole assembly of gods and said to the Blessed One, "Venerable One, oh, what a varied assembly of gods has gathered and is seated here! Within this assembly of gods there are gods who, endowed with faith grounded in understanding of the Buddha, were born here after leaving their bodies. There are also those who, endowed with faith grounded in understanding of the Dharma, of the Saṅgha, and of the moral discipline dear to the noble ones, were born here after leaving their bodies."

Then the Blessed One, agreeing with what the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana had said, spoke to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana: "Mahāmaudgalyāyana, it is so; it is just so. Oh, what a varied assembly of gods has gathered and is seated here! Within this assembly of gods there are gods who, endowed with faith grounded in understanding of the Buddha, were born here after leaving their bodies. There are also gods who, endowed with faith grounded in understanding of the Dharma, of the Saṅgha, and of the moral discipline dear to the noble ones, were born here after leaving their bodies."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, agreeing with what the Blessed One had said and with what the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana had said, spoke to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana: "Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, it is so; it is just so. Oh, what a varied assembly of gods has gathered and is seated here! Within this assembly of gods there are gods who, endowed with faith grounded in understanding of the Buddha, were born here after leaving their bodies. There are also those who, endowed with faith grounded in understanding of the Dharma, of the Saṅgha, and of the moral discipline dear to the noble ones, were born here after leaving their bodies."

Then another son of the gods, agreeing with what the Blessed One had said and with what the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana and Śakra, lord of the gods, had said, spoke to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana: "Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, it is so; it is just so. Oh, what a varied assembly of gods has gathered and is seated here! Within this assembly of gods there are gods who, endowed with faith grounded in understanding of the Buddha, were born here after leaving their bodies. There are also those who, endowed with faith grounded in understanding of the Dharma, of the Saṅgha, and of the moral discipline dear to the noble ones, were born here after leaving their bodies."

Then some of the gods rose from their seats, arranged their upper robes over one shoulder, bowed with palms joined toward the Blessed One, and said to the Blessed One, "Venerable One, we, endowed with faith grounded in understanding of the Buddha, were born here after leaving our bodies." And other gods said this: "Venerable One, we, endowed with faith grounded in understanding of the Dharma, of the Saṅgha, and of the moral discipline dear to the noble ones, were born here after leaving our bodies."

Then and there many hundreds of gods, many thousands of gods, and many hundreds of thousands of gods, having each declared in the presence of the Blessed One the fruit of stream-entry that they had attained, vanished on the spot.

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, knowing that the gods had departed, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, bowed with palms joined toward the Blessed One, and said to the Blessed One, "Venerable One, the fourfold assembly in Jambudvīpa bow at the feet of the Blessed One, and they ask: Are you free from harm? Are you free from trouble? Do you move about with ease? Are you well? Are you strong? Are you at ease? Are you free from discomfort? Do you dwell in comfort?"

The Blessed One said, "Maudgalyāyana, may you and the fourfold assembly dwelling in Jambudvīpa be well."

Maudgalyāyana said, "Venerable One, the fourfold assembly in Jambudvīpa long to see the face of the Blessed One, and they also say this: 'Venerable One, the people of Jambudvīpa do not have such miraculous power and might as to go to the divine realm of the Thirty-Three in order to see the Blessed One, to approach him, and to honor and serve him. But the gods of the Thirty-Three do have such miraculous power and might that the gods of the Thirty-Three can come to Jambudvīpa in order to see the Blessed One, to approach him, and to honor and serve him. Therefore, out of compassion, we pray that the Blessed One come down from the divine realm of the Thirty-Three to Jambudvīpa.'"

The Blessed One said, "In that case, Maudgalyāyana, go to Jambudvīpa and announce to the fourfold assembly: 'Listen! Seven days from now the Blessed One will come down from the divine realm of the Thirty-Three to Jambudvīpa, to the foot of the udumbara tree in the Apadjara Forest, near the city of Sāṃkāśya.'"

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, having heard what the Blessed One had said, bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One and entered into such a meditative absorption that, as soon as he settled his mind, just as a strong man might stretch out his bent arm or bend his outstretched arm, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana vanished from the divine realm of the Thirty-Three and arrived in Jambudvīpa.

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana came to Jambudvīpa and announced to the fourfold assembly, "Listen! Seven days from now the Blessed One will come down from the divine realm of the Thirty-Three to Jambudvīpa, to the foot of the udumbara tree in the Apadjara Forest, near the city of Sāṃkāśya."

Then, when seven days had passed, the Blessed One came down from the divine realm of the Thirty-Three to Jambudvīpa, to the foot of the udumbara tree in the Apadjara Forest, near the city of Sāṃkāśya. When the Blessed One came to the city of Sāṃkāśya, many hundreds of thousands of living beings gathered in order to see the Blessed One.

Then there appeared there a monk who was apparitionally born. He invited the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, and the gods, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas, to a meal. Then, when the time of the midday meal arrived, the moment he formed the thought, there appeared divine seats covered with great canopies of silk, and divine food, both soft and hard. Then that apparitionally born monk satisfied the Blessed One with divine food, and he also showed fine hospitality to the gods, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas.

Then the Blessed One, having understood his disposition, his latent tendencies, his constitution, and his nature, taught him the Dharma accordingly. Having heard it, the apparitionally born monk realized that this very five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra is moving and unstable, and he thoroughly ascertained that all kinds of formations are by nature subject to decay, falling, scattering, and destruction. Abandoning all afflictions, he directly realized arhatship. Having become an arhat, free from attachment to the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal; his mind was like empty space and the palm of the hand; he became cool like sandalwood paste; with knowledge he had broken the shell of the egg; he attained the knowledges, the superknowledges, and the analytical knowledges; he turned away from the gains, attachments, and honors of existence; and he became one worthy of offerings, veneration, and respectful address from the gods together with

Indra and Upendra.

Then the monks, having grown doubtful, asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who resolves all doubts, "Venerable One, what deeds did the Apparitionally Born perform, so that he was born apparitionally, and so that whatever he thinks of and whatever he wishes for is all accomplished the very moment he forms the thought?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, the Apparitionally Born himself, in other, former lives, performed and accumulated deeds that have come to maturity, whose conditions have been fulfilled, that arise like a flood, and that will inevitably come. Since the Apparitionally Born himself performed and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element, or the wind element. Rather, virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds that have been performed and accumulated ripen solely in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen into their fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in the ninety-first eon, when beings lived for eighty thousand years, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of those to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One called Vipaśyin. He dwelt near the city of Bandhumatī.

"Some time later, five monks undertook to spend the rains retreat in a secluded forest dwelling far from any village. Of these, one monk served as attendant to the other four monks, and through their diligence, practice, and effort those four abandoned all afflictions and directly realized arhatship. The remaining monk bowed at their feet and made an aspiration: 'Just as these have directly realized arhatship by relying on me, so by this root of virtue, by this resolve, and by this giving away of things to be given, may I go forth and never be troubled over the finest requisites.'

"Monks, what do you think? The monk who served as attendant at that time, on that occasion, was none other than this Apparitionally Born."

The monks asked, "Venerable One, what deeds did the Apparitionally Born perform, so that he was born apparitionally?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, long ago, in times past, in this very Fortunate Eon, when beings lived for twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of those to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One called Kāśyapa. He dwelt near the city of Vārāṇasī, at Ṛṣivadana in the Deer Park.

"At that time there lived a merchant there. When his wife was giving birth to a child, she was racked by painful feelings, and she cried out in distress and wept. When he heard her cries, he became deeply unhappy. He went into the chamber of sorrow and sat brooding, his cheek resting on his hand, and this thought occurred to him: 'Oh, what if I were to go forth in the teaching of the Blessed One, and make the aspiration that I may never experience dwelling in a womb!' Through that very disenchantment he went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One Kāśyapa, and he made this aspiration: 'By this root of virtue and this resolve, wherever I am born, may I be born apparitionally there. May I never experience dwelling in a womb.'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who was the merchant at that time, on that occasion, was none other than this Apparitionally Born. Because he made that aspiration, he was born apparitionally. And because he brought his faculties to maturity there, he has now directly realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, the ripening of entirely black deeds is entirely black as well; the ripening of entirely white deeds is entirely white as well; and the ripening of mixed deeds is mixed as well. Therefore, monks, abandon entirely black deeds and mixed deeds, and devote yourselves solely to entirely white deeds. Monks, you should train in this way."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Sundara.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, palace attendants, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras,

and mahoragas, renowned, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Kapilavastu, in the Nyagrodha Park.

At that time in Kapilavastu there lived a Śākya who was rich, with much wealth and great means, with vast and extensive holdings, possessed of wealth like Vaiśravaṇa's, rivaling the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He took a wife from a family of equal standing, and he played, made love, and enjoyed himself with her. As he played, made love, and enjoyed himself, his wife conceived, and after eight or nine months had passed she gave birth to a son, a boy who was handsome, good to look upon, and beautiful, surpassing the complexion of humans though not attaining the complexion of the gods. When he was born, many most wondrous things occurred, and these adorned the entire city of Kapilavastu.

Then, having celebrated his birth with a birth feast, they set about naming him, asking, "What name shall be given to this boy?" His relatives said, "Since the city of Kapilavastu was made beautiful when he was born, this boy shall be named Sundara."

Then the boy Sundara was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry him on their laps, two nurses to suckle him, two nurses to clean him, and two nurses to play with him. Those eight nurses raised and nourished him with milk, curd, butter, ghee, the cream of ghee, and all other kinds of fine provisions, and he grew quickly, like a lotus in a lake.

Then, when he had grown up, he went to the Nyagrodha Park in order to see the Blessed One. There he saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, like a moving mountain of jewels, wholly excellent. The moment he saw him, his mind filled with joy toward the Blessed One. Filled with joy, he bowed at the feet of the Blessed One and sat down before the Blessed One in order to listen to the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, having understood his disposition, his latent tendencies, his constitution, and his nature, taught him the Dharma in such a way that he would realize the Four Noble Truths. Having heard it, the boy Sundara shattered with the vajra of wisdom the twenty towering peaks of the mountain of the view of the perishable collection (satkāyadṛṣṭi), and directly

realized the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truths, he asked his father and mother for permission and went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One. Through diligence, practice, and effort he realized that this very five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra is moving and unstable, and he thoroughly ascertained that all kinds of formations are by nature subject to decay, falling, scattering, and destruction. Abandoning all afflictions, he directly realized arhatship. Having become an arhat, free from attachment to the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal; his mind was like empty space and the palm of the hand; he became cool like sandalwood paste; with knowledge he had broken the shell of the egg; he attained the knowledges, the superknowledges, and the analytical knowledges; he turned away from the gains, attachments, and honors of existence; and he became one worthy of offerings, veneration, and respectful address from the gods together with Indra and Upendra.

Then the monks, having grown doubtful, asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who resolves all doubts, "Venerable One, what deeds did Sundara perform, so that he is handsome, good to look upon, and beautiful, surpassing the complexion of humans though not attaining the complexion of the gods, and so that when he was born many most wondrous things occurred, which made the whole city of Kapilavastu beautiful?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, Sundara himself, in other, former lives, performed and accumulated deeds that have come to maturity, whose conditions have been fulfilled, that arise like a flood, and that will inevitably come. Since Sundara himself performed and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element, or the wind element. Rather, virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds that have been performed and accumulated ripen solely in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen into their fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in this very Fortunate Eon, when beings lived for forty thousand years, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of those to be tamed, teacher of gods

and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One called Krakucchanda. He dwelt near the royal capital, the city of Śobhāvatī. Later King Śobha built a stupa for his hair and nail clippings.

"Then, some time afterward, when a festival took place, a group of friends went to that stupa. When they saw the stupa, faith arose in them and they hung flowers on it. One of those friends said, 'I have nothing, so I will not do anything,' and he left the group of friends. But then regret arose in him, and he gathered flowers of many kinds and offered them to that same stupa."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The friend who at that time, on that occasion, felt regret and offered flowers at the stupa of the hair and nails of the perfectly complete Buddha Krakucchanda was none other than this Sundara.

"Monks, Sundara also performed and accumulated other deeds. Monks, long ago, in times past, there lived a merchant in the city of Vārāṇasī who saw a pratyekabuddha who was ill. Faith arose in him, and he bowed at his feet and offered him almsfood, and he also offered him clothing. Monks, what do you think? The one who was the merchant at that time, on that occasion, was none other than this Sundara.

"Furthermore, during the time of the Blessed One Kāśyapa, he was a poor woodgatherer. He went to gather wood in a mountain valley, and there he saw a stupa, and grass had grown up in the courtyard around that stupa. Faith arose in him, and he pulled out the grass, took up a broom, and swept the stupa and the courtyard of the stupa. Then he bowed at its foot and made this aspiration: 'By this root of virtue and this resolve, may I become handsome, good to look upon, and beautiful. In the future, may I please the perfectly complete buddhas, and may I never displease them.'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who was the poor woodgatherer at that time, on that occasion, was none other than this very Sundara. Because he swept the stupa and the courtyard of the stupa, wherever he has been born he has been handsome, good to look upon, and beautiful. And for that very reason he has now directly realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, the ripening of entirely black deeds is entirely black as well; the ripening of entirely white deeds is entirely white as well; and the ripening of mixed deeds is mixed as well. Therefore, monks, abandon entirely black deeds and mixed deeds, and devote yourselves solely to entirely white deeds. Monks, you should train in this way."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, the twentieth section.

The story called Kapphiṇa.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, palace attendants, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas, renowned, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time in the south a king called Thoughtful was ruling. During his reign the land was prosperous, flourishing, peaceful, with good harvests, and filled with many people and inhabitants. Quarrels and fighting had ceased; there was no unrest, no internal strife, no banditry, no famine, and no disease; and it abounded in sāli rice, sugarcane, cattle, and buffalo. He ruled his kingdom without harm, with its thorns removed, as one would care for an only son.

Then, some time later, he played, made love, and enjoyed himself with his queen. As he played, made love, and enjoyed himself, the queen conceived, and after eight or nine months had passed she gave birth to a son, a boy who was handsome, good to look upon, and beautiful, complete in all his major and minor limbs. Then, having celebrated his birth with a birth feast, they named him Kapphiṇa.

Then the boy Kapphiṇa was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry him on their laps, two nurses to suckle him, two nurses to clean him, and two nurses to play with him. Those eight nurses raised and nourished him with milk, curd, butter, ghee, the cream of ghee, and all other kinds of fine provisions, and he grew quickly, like a lotus in a lake.

On the very day that the king's son Kapphiṇa was born, sons were also born to eighteen thousand ministers, and every one of them had the strength of a great champion. Each of them, too, was given a name suited to his own circumstances.

Then, some time later, King Thoughtful died, and after him his son Kapphiṇa was installed as king. All of those eighteen thousand sons of ministers were

appointed as the king's ministers.

Later, King Mahākapphiṇa went hunting, attended by the eighteen thousand ministers. Looking at his whole great army before him and behind him, he asked the ministers, "Tell me, who else is there now who has a great army such as mine?"

The ministers, speaking to please him, said, "Your Majesty, there is no one who has one."

Then some merchants who had traveled from the Middle Country to the south presented gifts to King Mahākapphiṇa. The king said, "Merchants, who is the king of that country?"

The merchants replied, "Your Majesty, in some lands an assembly of many rules; in some lands a king rules."

Then, some time later, King Mahākapphiṇa sent messengers to the six great cities, beginning with Śrāvastī, saying, "Even if you happen to be standing, do not sit down, but come quickly! If you do not do so, you will be severely punished."

When they heard these words, the kings who lived in the six great cities were frightened, terrified, and dismayed, and they shuddered. They assembled, gathered together, reached an agreement, and came to Śrāvastī. Then they went to the Blessed One and told the Blessed One the matter in full. The Blessed One reassured them and said, "Bring that messenger to me." So they instructed the messenger, "There is a king above our kings; go before him for now."

Then the Blessed One, knowing that the messenger was coming, transformed the Jeta Grove, the park of the prince, into the four kinds of jewels, so that it resembled Sudarśana, the city of the gods. He stationed the Four Great Kings as its gatekeepers. He also arrayed elephants like Airāvaṇa, horses like Balāhaka, chariots like Nandighoṣa, and men like fearsome yakṣas. The Blessed One emanated himself in the guise of a universal monarch. He also emanated a lion throne about seven palm trees high, and the Blessed One sat upon it.

When the messenger saw such splendors, he was utterly amazed. Then the Blessed One wrote a letter and said to the messenger, "Tell King Kapphiṇa that I say: 'The moment you see this letter, even if you happen to be standing, do not sit down, but come quickly! If you do not come, I will come with a great

host of troops.'"

The messenger went and delivered the letter and the message to King Mahākapphiṇa, and did all that he had been told. Then King Mahākapphiṇa, attended by the eighteen thousand ministers, traveled stage by stage until he reached Śrāvastī. The kings of the land went out to meet King Mahākapphiṇa, invited him into the city with great honor, and when he had rested from his journey they informed the Blessed One.

Then the Blessed One, knowing that he was coming, emanated everything as before. When King Mahākapphiṇa went to the Jeta Grove, the moment he saw it, the pride he took in his appearance and the pride he took in his power vanished. But his arrogance about his strength still remained.

Then the Blessed One formed a worldly thought, thinking, "It would be good if Śakra, lord of the gods, came bringing Indra's bow." The very moment the Blessed One formed that thought, Śakra, lord of the gods, in the guise of a charioteer, presented Indra's bow.

Then the Blessed One gave it to King Mahākapphiṇa, but King Mahākapphiṇa could not even lift it, let alone draw it. Then the Blessed One emanated seven great iron drums, and he himself drew that bow into the shape of a half moon and shot an arrow, which pierced all seven great iron drums straight through. From them came forth a sound:

Set out on renunciation!
Apply yourselves to the Buddha's teaching!
As an elephant crushes a hut of reeds,
Crush the army of the Lord of Death!
Whoever, in this very Dharma and Vinaya,
Conducts himself with heedfulness
Will fully abandon the cycle of births
And bring suffering to an end.

That sound rang out as far as the realm of the Akaniṣṭha gods. Then King Mahākapphiṇa's arrogance about his strength vanished as well, and the thought occurred to him, "Oh! What is this?"

Then the Blessed One, understanding the workings of King Mahākapphiṇa's mind, made the guise of a universal monarch disappear and spoke this sūtra:

"Monks, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, possesses the ten powers, is fearless with the four fearlessnesses, claims the lofty place

of the leader of the herd, turns the Brahmā wheel, and in the assembly roars the true lion's roar, namely: When this exists, that comes to be; from the arising of this, that arises. That is to say: conditioned by ignorance are formations; conditioned by formations is consciousness; conditioned by consciousness are name and form; conditioned by name and form are the six sense sources; conditioned by the six sense sources is contact; conditioned by contact is feeling; conditioned by feeling is craving; conditioned by craving is grasping; conditioned by grasping is becoming; conditioned by becoming is birth; conditioned by birth arise old age and death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness, and distress. Thus this whole great mass of suffering comes to be.

"That is to say: When this does not exist, that does not come to be; from the cessation of this, that ceases. That is to say: from the cessation of ignorance, formations cease; from the cessation of formations, consciousness ceases; from the cessation of consciousness, name and form cease; from the cessation of name and form, the six sense sources cease; from the cessation of the six sense sources, contact ceases; from the cessation of contact, feeling ceases; from the cessation of feeling, craving ceases; from the cessation of craving, grasping ceases; from the cessation of grasping, becoming ceases; from the cessation of becoming, birth ceases; from the cessation of birth, old age and death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness, and distress cease. Thus this whole great mass of suffering ceases.

"Monks, my Dharma is well spoken, clearly laid open, cuts off the flow, and is rightly and well taught, down to gods and humans. In a Dharma thus well spoken, clearly laid open, cutting off the flow, and rightly and well taught, down to gods and humans, it is only fitting that a son of good family who has gone forth out of faith should strive in the Teacher's teaching. It is fitting that he apply himself. It is fitting that he be heedful. It is an easy thing for the flesh and blood of the body to dry up entirely, until only skin, sinews, and bones are left. But one who has undertaken diligence in the Dharma, who is capable, diligent, enthusiastic, and valiant, should never give up diligence midway, until he has attained whatever is to be attained through unrelenting effort. Why is that? The lazy person dwells in suffering, mingled with evil, unwholesome states that are defiling, that bring renewed existence, that are feverish, that have suffering as their ripening, and that lead to future birth, old age, and death; and his great aim falls utterly into ruin. One who has undertaken diligence dwells in happiness, unmingled with evil, unwholesome states that

are defiling, that bring renewed existence, that are feverish, that have suffering as their ripening, and that lead to future birth, old age, and death; and his great aim is brought to complete fulfillment.

"Monks, the Teacher himself is present here before you and teaches the Dharma, which brings peace, leads to complete nirvāṇa, and leads to perfect awakening. This scripture spoken by the Sugata is worthy to be drunk as the very essence. Therefore, monks, those who rightly see their own aim, the aim of others, and the aim of both should each train well in this, thinking, 'How can our going forth become meaningful, fruitful, productive of happiness, and ripen in happiness? And how can the honor shown by those whose clothing, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick we enjoy become of very great fruit, very great benefit, very great splendor, and very great extent?' Monks, you should train in this way."

When this discourse on the Dharma had been spoken, King Mahākapphiṇa, together with his retinue of eighteen thousand ministers, shattered with the vajra of wisdom the twenty towering peaks of the mountain of the view of the perishable collection (satkāyadṛṣṭi), and directly realized the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truths, he went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One. Through exertion, striving, and effort he understood that this very wheel of saṃsāra with its five spokes is moving and unstable, and he ascertained that all forms of conditioning factors are by nature subject to decay, to falling, to scattering, and to destruction. Abandoning all afflictions, he directly realized arhatship. As an arhat, free of attachment to the three realms, with a mind for which gold and a clod of earth were equal and to which space and the palm of the hand were alike, become cool like refined sandalwood, having broken the shell of the egg with knowledge, having obtained the knowledges, the superknowledges, and the analytical knowledges, turning away from gain, from attachment, and from honors in existence, he became one worthy of the worship, veneration, and respectful address of the gods, including Indra and Upendra.

Then the monks, having become doubtful, asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what actions did the venerable Kapphiṇa perform, that he was handsome, good to look upon, and beautiful, that together with his retinue of eighteen thousand ministers he came to possess the strength of a great champion, and that, having gone forth, he also directly realized arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, Kapphiṇa himself, in other, former lives, performed and accumulated actions whose accumulations have come together, whose conditions have ripened, which are present like a rushing flood, and which inevitably come to pass. Since Kapphiṇa himself performed and accumulated these actions, who else would experience them? Monks, actions that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen on the external earth element, nor do they ripen on the water element, the fire element, or the wind element. Rather, virtuous and nonvirtuous actions that have been performed and accumulated ripen solely on the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

The actions of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the accumulation is complete and the time arrives,
They ripen as their very fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, ninety-one eons ago, when people lived for eighty thousand years, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Vipaśyin, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One. He dwelt in dependence on the royal capital Bandhumatī. Then, at one time, a ship captain returned from the great ocean bringing many precious jewels, and he invited the perfectly complete Buddha Vipaśyin, together with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas, for meals for three months. He also built a monastery and offered it to the Saṅgha of the four directions. Monks, what do you think? The one who at that time, on that occasion, was the ship captain was none other than this Kapphiṇa.

"Monks, Kapphiṇa also performed and accumulated other actions. Monks, long ago, in times past, in the city of Vārāṇasī, a king called Brahmadatta ruled. During his reign the land was prosperous, flourishing, peaceful, with good harvests, and filled with many people and inhabitants. Disputes and quarrels were stilled; there were no disturbances, no uprisings, no robbers, no famines, and no diseases; and it was rich in śāli rice, sugarcane, cattle, and buffalo. Endowed with the Dharma, a Dharma king, he ruled in accordance with the Dharma. Later, attended by eighteen thousand ministers, he went to a pleasure grove whose trees were in full bloom, a woodland resounding with the calls of geese, cranes, peacocks, parrots, mynas, cuckoos, and jīvaṃjīvaka birds. In that pleasure grove he saw a pratyekabuddha who was ill, and for

three months he served him with wholesome food. After the pratyekabuddha had passed into complete nirvāṇa, he built a stūpa for his relics and, together with his assembly of ministers, anointed it with sesame oil. Because of this, he and his retinue came to possess the strength of a great champion. Moreover, during the time of the Buddha Kāśyapa he went forth, and because he ripened his faculties there, he has now directly realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, the ripening of entirely black actions is entirely black. The ripening of entirely white actions is entirely white. The ripening of mixed actions is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandoning entirely black actions and mixed actions, you should devote yourselves solely to entirely white actions. Monks, you should train in this way."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Bhadrika. The Buddha, the Blessed One, honored, esteemed, revered, and worshipped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, palace attendants, merchants, ship captains, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas; the Buddha, the Blessed One, worshipped and renowned among gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was staying together with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

Then, twelve years after the Blessed One had attained perfect, complete awakening, when those twelve years had passed and he came to the city of Kapilavastu, many thousands of Śākyas, Droṇodana, Amṛtodana, and others, saw the truths; only King Śuddhodana did not. Then King Śuddhodana, seeing those excellent qualities of his son, was supremely amazed, and this thought arose in him: "If my son had not gone forth, he would have become a wheel-turning king, victorious to the four frontiers, endowed with the Dharma, a Dharma king. Now that he has gone forth as a shaven renunciant, he is most unbecomingly attended. I had better have one person from each Śākya household go forth."

Then King Śuddhodana had a bell sounded in the city to assemble all the Śākyas. When all the Śākyas had gathered, King Śuddhodana said, "O Śākyas, listen! Even if Prince Sarvārthasiddha had not gone forth, you alone would have had to serve him. Now that he has gone forth, let one person from each Śākya household go forth in order to serve him."

Then five hundred sons of the Śākyas, Bhadrika, Aniruddha, Revata, Devadatta, and others, set out to go forth. Then Upāli, their barber and attendant, seeing them going forth, wept. The Śākyas asked him, "Upāli, why are you crying?" Crying out "Alas, alas! Woe, woe!" and lamenting, he said, "If you go forth, who will there be now to support me with food and clothing?" The Śākyas said, "Then, Upāli, spread out a cloth." When he had spread out the cloth, the Śākyas heaped up in a great pile the necklaces, half-necklaces, jewels, pearls, beryls, armlets, and finger rings that they wore on their bodies, and gave them to him.

Then the barber Upāli, seeing them going forth and looking at the many kinds of ornaments, gave rise to proper attention: "These Śākyas are endowed with lineage, good looks, youth, and wealth. Yet they have cast off their wives and these ornaments like spittle and gone forth. Then why should I, who own nothing at all, send these ornaments home? I had better leave them and go forth after these men myself."

Then the barber Upāli went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, if even such as we may go forth in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya, and may go forth, receive full ordination, and attain the state of a monk, then I too wish to practice the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One." Then the Blessed One said, "Come, monk," and so he went forth.

Then the five hundred Śākyas, Bhadrika and the others, now in the garb of monks, were made to bow to the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha. But they recognized Upāli's feet, and because they were endowed with lineage, good looks, and wealth, they could not bring themselves to bow to Upāli. Thereupon the Blessed One said to the venerable Bhadrika, "Bhadrika, since in this teaching of mine there is no regard for lineage, good looks, youth, power, or the purity of the four castes, bow to him!" Then the five hundred Śākyas, Bhadrika and the others, letting the nature of the Dharma prevail, bowed at his feet like a tree cut down at the root. The very moment they bowed at his feet, this great earth quaked in six ways.

Then the venerable Bhadrika, through exertion, striving, and effort, understood that this very wheel of saṃsāra with its five spokes is moving and unstable, and he ascertained that all forms of conditioning factors are by nature subject to decay, to falling, to scattering, and to destruction. Abandoning all afflictions, he directly realized arhatship. As an arhat, free of

attachment to the three realms, with a mind for which gold and a clod of earth were equal and to which space and the palm of the hand were alike, become cool like refined sandalwood, having broken the shell of the egg with knowledge, having obtained the knowledges, the superknowledges, and the analytical knowledges, turning away from gain, from attachment, and from honors in existence, he became one worthy of the worship, veneration, and respectful address of the gods, including Indra and Upendra.

He was a great being, compassionate toward the miserable and the destitute. Later, one morning, having put on his lower garment and his Dharma robe and taken his alms bowl, he set out into Śrāvastī for alms. Then, at one point, he went for alms to the house of a lowborn family. At that time King Prasenajit of Kosala, mounted on his chief elephant called Ekapuṇḍarīka, had set out with his driver Dīrgha Cārāyaṇa to see the Blessed One. King Prasenajit of Kosala saw Bhadrika, his faculties calm, his mind calm, possessed of a supremely disciplined and utterly peaceful mind, wearing robes of rags from a rubbish heap and carrying poor food, coming out of that lowborn family's house. Seeing him, he asked his driver Dīrgha Cārāyaṇa, "Is that not the monk Bhadrika?" The driver said, "It is as Your Majesty says; it is he." Then King Prasenajit of Kosala fainted, swooned, and fell to the ground. When he had been sprinkled with water, he revived, and once he had recovered his senses, his driver Dīrgha Cārāyaṇa helped him up.

Then King Prasenajit went before the Blessed One, bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet, and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, I have seen something marvelous. Bhadrika, the king of the Śākyas, wearing robes of rags from a rubbish heap and carrying poor food, having received alms with a most peaceful deportment that inspires faith in gods and humans, was coming back out of the house of a lowborn family. At that, I thought this:

'The teaching of the Blessed One is truly what brings perfect discipline. When one relies on it, one comes to such contentment, and it is most wondrous that even those raised in comfort become so disciplined in their ways.'"

The Blessed One said, "Great king, there is something else about Bhadrika that is even more wondrous; listen! Great king, whether this Bhadrika dwells in the wilderness, at the foot of a tree, or in an empty house, he utters these words of joy three times: 'Oh, what happiness! Oh, what happiness! When I had not yet gone forth, I lived within the royal palace, very well guarded by great ministers, townspeople, and country people, and protected by walls, moats,

gates, and bolts; yet my heart feared others and was without joy, I was suspicious of everyone, and I could not even sleep. Now that I have no regard even for body and life, I can dwell at ease wherever I am.'"

Then the monks, having become doubtful, asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what actions did the venerable Bhadrika perform and accumulate in other, former lives, that he was handsome, good to look upon, and beautiful, that he was born into a wealthy royal family, and that, having gone forth, he also directly realized arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, Bhadrika himself, in other, former lives, performed and accumulated actions whose accumulations have come together, whose conditions have ripened, which are present like a rushing flood, and which inevitably come to pass. Since Bhadrika himself performed and accumulated these actions, who else would experience them? Monks, actions that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen on the external earth element, nor do they ripen on the water element, the fire element, or the wind element. Rather, virtuous and nonvirtuous actions that have been performed and accumulated ripen solely on the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

The actions of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
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"Monks, long ago, in times past, a beggar lived in the city of Vārāṇasī. Overcome by a hungry body and weakness, he was wandering here and there when he saw a girl carrying cakes. Wanting the cakes, the beggar went after the girl, snatched one cake by force, and ran off this way and that. The girl followed close behind him. Then the beggar, without hesitating, plunged into the river Varaṇā.

"At times when buddhas do not appear, pratyekabuddhas appear in the world, compassionate toward the miserable and the destitute, living in remote dwellings, the sole field of offering for the world. At one point a pratyekabuddha came before that beggar. When the beggar saw the pratyekabuddha's peaceful deportment, great joy arose in him, and with that great joy, offering it up along with his own misery, he presented the cake to the pratyekabuddha. Then, in order to make his joy vast, the pratyekabuddha rose up into the sky like a king of geese spreading his wings and displayed

various kinds of miracles. When the beggar saw that utterly marvelous miracle, which inspires faith in gods and humans, he bowed at his feet like a tree cut down at the root and made this aspiration: 'Through this root of virtue of offering to one worthy of offerings who has accomplished his vows, through this generation of the mind, and through this giving away of a gift, wherever I am born, may I be born there into a high family and attain qualities such as these! May I please teachers even more exalted than this one, and may I never displease them!'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who at that time, on that occasion, was the beggar was none other than this Bhadrika. Through the ripening of that action of offering a cake to the pratyekabuddha, he was born into the wealthy family of the Śākyas. Moreover, during the time of the Buddha Kāśyapa he went forth, and because he kept the conduct of the holy life there for ten thousand years, he has now directly realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, the ripening of entirely black actions is entirely black. The ripening of entirely white actions is entirely white. The ripening of mixed actions is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandoning entirely black actions and mixed actions, you should devote yourselves solely to entirely white actions. Monks, you should train in this way."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Rāṣṭrapāla. The Buddha, the Blessed One, honored, esteemed, revered, and worshipped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, palace attendants, merchants, ship captains, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas; the Buddha, the Blessed One, worshipped and renowned among gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was staying together with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas in the land called Sthūlakoṣṭhaka, in the Sthūlakoṣṭhaka forest.

At that time, in the land of Sthūlakoṣṭhaka, a king called Kauravya was ruling. During his reign the land was prosperous, flourishing, peaceful, with good harvests, and filled with many people and inhabitants. Disputes and quarrels were stilled; there were no disturbances, no uprisings, no robbers, no famines, and no diseases; and it was rich in śāli rice, sugarcane, cattle, and buffalo. Endowed with the Dharma, a Dharma king, he ruled in accordance with the Dharma.

Now the son of his younger brother, called Rāṣṭrapāla, was handsome, good to look upon, and beautiful, complete in all his major and minor limbs. The Blessed One saw that the time had come to discipline him. In the morning he put on his lower garment and his Dharma robe, took his alms bowl, and, going before the Saṅgha of monks and attended by the assembly of monks, went into Sthūlakoṣṭhaka for alms. Rāṣṭrapāla saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessed of a light surpassing a thousand suns, like a moving mountain of jewels, wholly excellent. The moment he saw him, his mind became joyful toward the Blessed One. Joy having arisen in him, he bowed at the Blessed One's feet and asked to go forth.

Then the Blessed One said to him, "Son, have your father and mother given you permission?" Rāṣṭrapāla replied, "Venerable One, they have not given permission." The Blessed One said, "Son, tathāgatas and the śrāvakas of tathāgatas do not let anyone go forth or receive full ordination without the permission of his father and mother."

Then Rāṣṭrapāla went to his father and mother. Having arrived, he spoke in praise of the Buddha: "I have seen the Blessed One, the perfectly complete Buddha Śākyamuni, who, having given up the flourishing kingdom of a wheel-turning king and sixty thousand queens, shaved his head and put on the patched Dharma robe, and is now dwelling right here in Sthūlakoṣṭhaka, going about for alms. It is fitting that you permit me to go forth after the Blessed One who has gone forth." But his father and mother did not give permission. Then he fasted for one day, two days, three days, up to six days.

Then Rāṣṭrapāla's father and mother went to where their son Rāṣṭrapāla was. Having arrived, they said this to their son Rāṣṭrapāla: "Son Rāṣṭrapāla, understand this! You have lived in comfort and you want a pleasant life. You have never known hardship, and the holy life is hard to practice. Dwelling in solitude is hard. Living alone is hard to delight in. Taking up residence in the wilderness, in forest thickets, and in remote dwellings is hard even to think of. Son Rāṣṭrapāla, stay right here and enjoy the pleasures of the senses. Give gifts too, and make merit too." But though they spoke thus, the householder's son Rāṣṭrapāla said nothing at all.

Then the parents of the householder's son Rāṣṭrapāla urged his relatives, saying, "O relatives, entreat our son Rāṣṭrapāla!" Then the relatives of the

householder's son Rāṣṭrapāla went to where the householder's son Rāṣṭrapāla was. Having arrived, they said this to the householder's son Rāṣṭrapāla: "Son Rāṣṭrapāla, understand this! You have lived in comfort and you want a pleasant life. You have never known hardship, and the holy life is hard to practice. Dwelling in solitude is hard. Living alone is hard to delight in. Taking up residence in the wilderness, in forest thickets, and in remote dwellings is hard even to think of. Son Rāṣṭrapāla, stay right here and enjoy the pleasures of the senses. Give gifts too, and make merit too." But though they spoke thus, the householder's son Rāṣṭrapāla said nothing at all.

Then the parents of the householder's son Rāṣṭrapāla urged Rāṣṭrapāla's friends, saying, "O young men, entreat our son Rāṣṭrapāla!" Then the friends of the householder's son Rāṣṭrapāla went to where Rāṣṭrapāla was. Having arrived, they said this to the householder's son Rāṣṭrapāla: "Dear Rāṣṭrapāla, understand this! You have lived in comfort and you want a pleasant life. You have never known hardship, and the holy life is hard to practice. Dwelling in solitude is hard. Living alone is hard to delight in. Taking up residence in the wilderness, in forest thickets, and in remote dwellings is hard even to think of. Dear Rāṣṭrapāla, stay right here and enjoy the pleasures of the senses. Give gifts too, and make merit too." But though they spoke thus, the householder's son Rāṣṭrapāla said nothing at all.

Then the friends of the householder's son Rāṣṭrapāla went to where Rāṣṭrapāla's father and mother were. Having arrived, they said this to the parents of the householder's son Rāṣṭrapāla: "Father and mother, please understand this! What good would it be if dear Rāṣṭrapāla were to die? Allow him to go forth with genuine faith from home into homelessness. If he comes to delight in the going forth, then, as he will be alive, you will see him. If he does not delight in it, there is no place for a son to go other than his father and mother." The parents said, "Young men, if, after our son Rāṣṭrapāla has gone forth, he will come to meet us, then we give our permission on that condition."

Then the friends of the householder's son Rāṣṭrapāla went to where the householder's son Rāṣṭrapāla was. Having arrived, they said this to Rāṣṭrapāla: "Dear Rāṣṭrapāla, your father and mother have given you permission to go forth, but they say they will grant it only if, after you have gone forth, you will come to meet them." Rāṣṭrapāla said, "Yes, I will meet them."

Then the householder's son Rāṣṭrapāla gradually regained the might and strength of his body and went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived,

he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the householder's son Rāṣṭrapāla said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable One, my father and mother have given me permission. If I may go forth in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya, receive full ordination, and attain the state of a monk, then I too wish to practice the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One." When he had made this request, the son of good family Rāṣṭrapāla went forth in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya, received full ordination, and attained the state of a monk.

Having gone forth in this way, through exertion, striving, and effort he understood that this very wheel of saṃsāra with its five spokes is moving and unstable, and he ascertained that all forms of conditioning factors are by nature subject to decay, to falling, to scattering, and to destruction. Abandoning all afflictions, he directly realized arhatship. As an arhat, free of attachment to the three realms, with a mind for which gold and a clod of earth were equal and to which space and the palm of the hand were alike, become cool like refined sandalwood, having broken the shell of the egg with knowledge, having obtained the knowledges, the superknowledges, and the analytical knowledges, turning away from gain, from attachment, and from honors in existence, he became one worthy of the worship, veneration, and respectful address of the gods, including Indra and Upendra.

Thereupon the Blessed One said to the monks, "Monks, foremost among my śrāvaka monks who dwell in the wilderness is this one: the monk Rāṣṭrapāla."

Then the monks, having become doubtful, asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what actions did the venerable Rāṣṭrapāla perform, that he was born into a wealthy family, that he was handsome, good to look upon, and beautiful, and that, having gone forth, he also directly realized arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, Rāṣṭrapāla himself, in other, former lives, performed and accumulated actions whose accumulations have come together, whose conditions have ripened, which are present like a rushing flood, and which inevitably come to pass. Since Rāṣṭrapāla himself performed and accumulated these actions, who else would experience them? Monks, actions that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen on the external earth element, nor do they ripen on the water element, the fire element, or the wind element. Rather, virtuous and nonvirtuous actions that have been performed and accumulated ripen solely on the appropriated

aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

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Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
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"Monks, long ago, in times past, an enemy army came against the king of Videha and his palace retinue. At a loss for what to do, he fled into the forest thickets. There, at midday, tormented by the heat of the sun's rays, he and his troops wandered this way and that and could not find the road.

"At times when buddhas do not appear in the world, pratyekabuddhas appear in the world, compassionate toward the miserable and the destitute, living in remote dwellings, the sole field of offering for the world. At that time a pratyekabuddha who was living by that wilderness road, moved by compassion, showed the king of Videha the road and also showed him a pool of water, and so he saved the precious lives of the king and his retinue. Then the king, faith having arisen in him, led him to his own city and served him for three months with every kind of requisite. After the pratyekabuddha had passed into nirvāṇa, the king built a stūpa for his relics and made this aspiration: 'Through this root of virtue, through this generation of the mind, and through this giving away of a gift, may I too attain such qualities as these! May I please teachers even more exalted than this one, and may I never displease them!'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who at that time, on that occasion, was the king was none other than this Rāṣṭrapāla.

"Monks, Rāṣṭrapāla also performed and accumulated other actions. In this very Fortunate Eon, when people lived for twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Kāśyapa, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One. He dwelt in dependence on the city of Vārāṇasī, at Ṛṣivadana in the Deer Park. At that time, in the city of Vārāṇasī, King Kṛkin was ruling. During his reign the land was prosperous, flourishing, peaceful, with good harvests, and filled with many people and inhabitants. Disputes and quarrels were stilled; there were no disturbances, no uprisings, no robbers, no famines, and no diseases; and it was rich in śāli rice, sugarcane, cattle, and buffalo. Endowed with the Dharma, a Dharma king, he ruled in accordance

with the Dharma.

"Then his youngest son went to Ṛṣivadana, and there he saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessed of a light surpassing a thousand suns, like a moving mountain of jewels, wholly excellent. The moment he saw him, his mind became joyful toward the Blessed One. Joy having arisen in him, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat before the Blessed One to listen to the Dharma. Then the Blessed One Kāśyapa taught him the Dharma. Faith arose in him, and he served the Blessed One Kāśyapa and his retinue, went for refuge, and took up the bases of training. After the Blessed One had passed into complete nirvāṇa, he also fastened a small parasol to his stūpa.

"Monks, what do you think? The one who was the prince at that time, on that occasion, is none other than this Rāṣṭrapāla. Rāṣṭrapāla also performed and accumulated other deeds. Monks, long ago, in times past, in the city of Vārāṇasī there lived a brahmin whose work was digging roots. Once, when he had gone to dig roots and was wandering about in the forest, he saw there a pratyekabuddha who was ill. Faith arose in him, and he attended to him; and when the pratyekabuddha had recovered from his illness, he offered him food as well and made this aspiration: 'May I too attain qualities such as these! May I please a teacher who is even more exalted than this one, and may I not displease him!'"

The Blessed One said: "Monks, what do you think? The one who was the root-digging brahmin at that time, on that occasion, is none other than this Rāṣṭrapāla. Through the karmic maturation of that deed he never once experienced suffering in saṃsāra, and now too he has been born into a wealthy royal family, handsome, good to look upon, and beautiful. By that very cause he has directly realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, wholly black deeds have a wholly black ripening; wholly white deeds have a wholly white ripening; and mixed deeds have a mixed ripening. Therefore, monks, abandon wholly black deeds and mixed deeds, and devote yourselves to wholly white deeds alone. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

Here ends the ninth group of the summary verses of the Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa.

The summary verse:

Subhūti and the Elder,
Hastaka, and the one Nourished with Care,
Saṃsāra and Guptika,
Virūpa and Gaṅgika,
Dīrghanakha and Truly Lovely:
these are taught in this group.

The story called Subhūti.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered and worshipped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, townspeople, guild masters, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras and mahoragas. Worshipped and acknowledged by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, alms food, bedding, seats, medicine for the sick and other requisites, was dwelling together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

Now, after the Blessed One had fully awakened to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, he appointed śrāvakas to benefit the people to be trained in the various regions. At that time, those who were meditators stayed on the terraces of Mount Meru, devoting themselves to meditative concentration.

Then one day Suparṇa, king of the birds, seized a young nāga from the depths of the great ocean, carried it up onto the terraces of Mount Meru, and began to devour it. As that young nāga was dying, it made its mind joyful toward the great śrāvakas, and then it died. Having died, it entered the womb of the chief wife of a brahmin named Bhūti in Śrāvastī. After eight or nine months had passed, a son was born to her: she gave birth to a boy who was handsome, good to look upon, and beautiful.

When the birth festival had been celebrated, they set about naming him, asking, "What name shall we give this boy?" The relatives said, "Since this boy's father is Bhūti, let this boy be named Subhūti."

The boy Subhūti was raised and nurtured, and when he had grown up, through the power and force of causes from the past he became impatient, wrathful, and given above all to malice. So his parents sent him away from the household, and he went forth among the sages. There too he devoted himself

to meditative concentration, and he lived in dependence on a forest.

In that forest there also dwelt a deity who had seen the truth. Feeling compassion for him, the deity thought, "Because this son of good family is given above all to wrath and malice, he will not attain any distinction. I shall bring him to see the Blessed One." So that deity spoke in praise of the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha in Subhūti's presence. A wish to see the Blessed One arose in Subhūti, and by the deity's magical power he was led into the Blessed One's presence.

Then he saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessed of a light surpassing a thousand suns, like a moving mountain of jewels, wholly excellent. The very moment he saw him, the spite he had harbored toward sentient beings vanished. Joy then arose in him, and he bowed at the Blessed One's feet and sat before the Blessed One to listen to the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, having understood his disposition, latent tendencies, constitution and nature, taught him the Dharma in such a way that he would come to realize the Four Noble Truths. When he had heard it, Subhūti, son of good family, shattered with the vajra of wisdom the twenty towering peaks of the mountain of the view of the perishable collection (satkāyadṛṣṭi), and directly realized the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truth, he went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One.

Through diligence, effort and exertion, and by cultivating loving-kindness, he tamed his mind. He understood that this very wheel of saṃsāra with its five spokes is moving and unstable, and he cut through to the certainty that all kinds of formations are of a nature to decay, to fall, to scatter and to be destroyed. Having abandoned all afflictions, he directly realized arhatship. As an arhat, he was free of attachment to the three realms. Gold and a clod of earth were equal to him; his mind was like space and like the palm of his hand; he had become cool, like rubbed sandalwood; with knowledge he had broken the shell of the egg; he had attained the knowledges, the superknowledges and the discriminating knowledges; he paid no heed to the gains, attachments and honors of existence; and he became an object of worship, veneration and respectful address for the gods together with Indra and Upendra.

Then the venerable Subhūti considered from where he had died and passed on, where he had been born, and through what deed he had been born, and he

saw that for five hundred lifetimes he had died as a nāga and been born again only as a nāga. Then this thought arose in him: "Because I brought about the conditions for aversion in this way, I was born only as a nāga for five hundred lifetimes, and for that very reason I underwent great suffering. Now I must act so that others do not come to feel aversion toward me, lest, possessed of it, after parting from the body they fall into the lower realms, the bad destinies, the ruinous states, and are born among the beings of the hells." So he took up and abided in the path of dwelling free of affliction.

Whenever he wished to stay for alms within the Saṅgha, or in a village, a district or a region, he would first of all survey the area where he would go about, thinking, "When they see me, surely no one, down even to an ant, will become hostile in mind on some account?" If so, he gave up that way of going about and changed to another, and so the minds of those beings became joyful. Although he was an arhat, he endured hardships such as these.

Then this thought arose in the venerable Subhūti: "Come now, I shall benefit many beings." By his magical power he emanated five hundred garuḍas. Seeing them, the nāgas were frightened and terrified, and in their misery they were all at a loss as to what to do. Then Subhūti protected them completely by the power of his magic. When their minds had become joyful, he gave them instruction in loving-kindness. Then again he emanated himself in the form of a great nāga and harried five hundred garuḍas; they too were frightened, and he gave them instruction in loving-kindness. In this way he tamed five hundred of the nāga race and five hundred of the garuḍa race.

On account of this, the Blessed One addressed the monks: "Monks, foremost among my śrāvaka monks who dwell free of affliction is this one: Subhūti, son of good family."

Then doubt arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts: "Venerable One, what deeds did the venerable Subhūti perform, that he has been declared foremost of those who dwell free of affliction?"

The Blessed One said: "Monks, in other former lives Subhūti himself performed and accumulated deeds whose accumulations are gathered and whose conditions have matured, that are present like a flood and will inevitably come. Since Subhūti himself performed and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water

element, the fire element or the wind element. Virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense sources.

"The deeds of embodied beings
are not lost even in a hundred eons;
when conditions gather and the time arrives,
they ripen into their fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in this very Fortunate Eon, when the lifespan of beings was twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One called Kāśyapa. He was staying near the city of Vārāṇasī, at Ṛṣivadana, in the Deer Park.

"There this one went forth. He gave gifts and great gifts, kept the discipline of pure conduct for ten thousand years, and made this aspiration: 'By this root of virtue, this generation of mind, and this giving away of things to be given, in the future, in the teaching of the one of whom the Blessed One Kāśyapa prophesied to the brahmin youth Uttara, "Brahmin youth, when the lifespan of beings is a hundred years, you will become the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened Buddha called Śākyamuni," may I go forth, and may I become foremost of those who dwell free of affliction.'

"If you ask through what deeds he was born as a nāga: not having abandoned the afflictions, with his faculties confused, and not having brought the paths of action to completion, he gave rise to a hostile mind toward monks in training and beyond training and uttered the words 'venomous snake,' and therefore he was born as a nāga. Because he gave gifts and great gifts and kept the discipline of pure conduct, he has now directly realized arhatship and has been declared foremost of those who dwell free of affliction.

"Thus, monks, wholly black deeds have a wholly black ripening.

"Wholly white deeds have a wholly white ripening, and mixed deeds have a mixed ripening. Therefore, monks, abandon wholly black deeds and mixed deeds, and devote yourselves to wholly white deeds alone. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, the twenty-first section.

The story called the Elder.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, esteemed, revered and worshipped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, townspeople, guild masters, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras and mahoragas. Worshipped and acknowledged by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, a recipient of robes, alms food, bedding, seats, medicine for the sick and other requisites, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove, at the Kalandaka feeding place.

At that time there lived in Rājagṛha a guild master who was rich, with much wealth and great resources, with vast and extensive holdings, possessed of wealth like Vaiśravaṇa's, rivaling the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He took a wife from a family equal to his own, and he played, enjoyed himself and made love with her. As he played, enjoyed himself and made love with her, his wife conceived a child; and before the child was born, he went on for a time playing, enjoying himself and making love with that same wife. As he played, enjoyed himself and made love with her, while that first child remained in the womb, in the course of time ten sons were born from the mother's belly one after another, yet that first child stayed on in the womb.

Then in time the householder's wife fell ill. Though she was treated with medicines of roots, stems, leaves, flowers and fruits, the illness did not subside. When she was struck by a mortal illness and was close to death, she said to her husband, "My lord, please know this: my first son is in here. When I have died, cut open my right side with a blade and take out the boy who has been there from the first." Having said this, she spoke these words:

"All that is gathered ends at last in loss;
all that is high ends at last in a fall;
all who meet end at last in parting;
all who live end at last in death."

And she died. When she had died, they adorned a bier with blue, yellow, red and white cloths, carried her to the charnel ground of the Cool Grove, and summoned Jīvaka, the king of physicians.

Throughout the city of Rājagṛha the word went round: "A certain woman had a child remaining in her womb for so many years. Ten other sons were born to her, yet the first child who stayed in the womb was never born. Today Jīvaka, king of physicians, is to cut open the belly of the dead woman with a blade and take out the first boy who has remained in the womb." When the word had gone round, many hundreds of thousands of living beings, and the six teachers beginning with Pūraṇa, gathered at the charnel ground of the Cool Grove to watch.

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda, "Ānanda, go and tell the monks this: 'The Blessed One wishes to go and walk in the charnel ground. Those of you who wish to see a marvel, come along.'"

Then, after a while, the Blessed One, attended by the great śrāvakas, the venerable Ājñāta Kauṇḍinya, Bāṣpa, Mahānāman, Aniruddha, Śāriputra, Maudgalyāyana, Kāśyapa, Ānanda, Revata and others, went to the charnel ground of the Cool Grove. And the crowd, seeing the Blessed One, made way for him.

Then the physician Jīvaka cut open the woman's right side. The boy came out by himself: his hair was white, his limbs were covered with wrinkles, every part of his body had grown old, his faculties were decrepit, he was emaciated and of little strength. The moment he came out, he looked at the crowd and spoke these words: "Listen! Do not speak harsh words to your superiors, or to those like superiors, or to your father and mother, or to your preceptors and teachers, lest you undergo an experience such as mine, who stayed sixty years in my mother's belly between the stomach and the intestines!" Having said this, he remained without saying anything more.

Then the Blessed One said to the monks, "Monks, since even a being in his final existence undergoes an experience such as this, be done with all birth in existence! Be done with all the requisites of birth in existence!"

Then the Blessed One said to the boy, "Boy, are you old?"

"Blessed One, I am old."

"Boy, are you old?"

"Sugata, I am old."

From that circumstance he was given the name the Elder.

Then, on that occasion, the Blessed One gave such a teaching of the Dharma that, on hearing it, many hundreds of beings became disenchanted and attained great distinction.

That Elder remained in the household life for ten years, and when he had reached the age of seventy he went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One. He undertook to spend the rains retreat on Vulture Peak Mountain together with twenty-five monks. There the elder of the Saṅgha laid down a rule: "No one who still remains an ordinary being shall take part in the pravāraṇā." Then in time, when three months had passed, twenty-four of the monks attained arhatship, while the Elder alone remained at the level of an ordinary being.

Then, during the pravāraṇā, the elder of the Saṅgha barred him again and again, eight times over, drove him out of the assembly and sent him away. So he took a blade, went into an inner room, and weeping and lamenting in many ways, he said:

"Though all the forests have burst into flame
and the mountains have already turned yellow,
still my sinful mind
has not been set free.

"Though the sound of the mountain streams has fallen still
and the rivers too are dwindling,
still my sinful mind
has not been set free.

"Though these birds born from eggs
have grown faint in their calls and cries,
still my sinful mind
has not been set free.

"Though the leaves of these forests are yellow
and the trees have shed their foliage,
still my sinful mind
has not been set free.

"Though the elders who give instruction
have already gone off in every direction,
still my sinful mind
has not been set free.

"While I remain an ordinary being,
how can I go before the Teacher?
What need is there to live without purpose?
I shall kill myself with the blade."

At that moment, there is nothing that the buddhas, the blessed ones, do not know, do not see, do not realize or do not understand. The buddhas, the blessed ones, possessed of great compassion, intent on benefiting the world, endowed with a single protection, solely heroic, without equal, never speaking in two ways, abiding in calm abiding and insight, illuminating the three knowledges, well trained in the three trainings, skilled in the three bases of discipline, having crossed the four floods, the soles of their feet planted firmly on the four bases of miraculous power, long familiar with the four means of gathering, fearless through the four fearlessnesses, roaring the great true lion's roar of the bull among men, having entirely abandoned the five factors, having wholly transcended the five destinies, endowed with the six factors, having completely perfected the six perfections, abiding in the six constant abidings, rich with the flowers of the seven limbs of awakening, teachers of the eightfold path, skilled in the nine successive meditative absorptions, possessed of the strength of the ten powers, their fame spreading through all the ten directions, surpassing even the lord of the thousand, by their very nature look upon the world with the buddha eye three times by day and three times by night, and their seeing wisdom engages, thinking: "Who is declining? Who is prospering? Who is in want? Who has fallen into hardship? Who is beset by harm? Who is beset by want, hardship and harm? Who is inclining toward the lower realms? Who is sliding toward the lower realms? Who has fallen into the lower realms? Whom shall I draw out of the lower realms and establish in the higher realms, in liberation, and in the fruits? Whom, sunk in the mire of desire, shall I pull out by the hand? Whom, lacking the seven noble riches, shall I establish in sovereign mastery of the seven noble riches? In whom shall I generate roots of virtue not yet generated? In whom shall I ripen roots of virtue already generated? Whom, already ripened, shall I liberate?"

Here it is said:

"The ocean, home of the sea monsters,
might let the hour of its tide pass by;
but for the children to be trained,
the Buddha never lets the hour pass."

Then, at that time, the Buddha, the Blessed One, took thought, went to him by his magical power, and taught him the Dharma suited to him. When he had heard it, the venerable Elder understood that this very wheel of saṃsāra with its five spokes is moving and unstable, and he cut through to the certainty that all kinds of formations are of a nature to decay, to fall, to scatter and to be destroyed. Having abandoned all afflictions, he directly realized arhatship. As an arhat, he was free of attachment to the three realms. Gold and a clod of earth were equal to him; his mind was like space and like the palm of his hand; he had become cool, like rubbed sandalwood; with knowledge he had broken the shell of the egg; he had attained the knowledges, the superknowledges and the discriminating knowledges; he paid no heed to the gains, attachments and honors of existence; and he became an object of worship, veneration and respectful address for the gods together with Indra and Upendra.

Having attained arhatship, the Elder thought, "Let me see whether there are any whom I too can train." He saw some five hundred merchants out on the ocean, caught and whirled about by the black wind of the rākṣasas, and he thought, "I shall protect these people who have met with suffering from that suffering. Perhaps I shall then be able to train them." So the Elder went there by his magical power and protected them from that danger. Faith arose in them, and they all went forth. He gave them instruction in mental attention, and through diligence, effort and exertion they all abandoned every affliction and directly realized arhatship.

But no one knew of their qualities, and the Group of Six began to mock them, muttering, "That old fool sits with five hundred men gathered around him and keeps them at his side; these too will be just like him and will never be tamed."

Then the venerable Ānanda, who was kind to his companions in the pure life and intent on benefiting others, wishing to speak with the venerable elder, went to where the venerable elder, the Elder, was. When he arrived, he exchanged with the venerable elder, the Elder, face to face, many kinds of pleasant and delightful conversation, and then sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the venerable Ānanda said this to the elder, the Elder: "If you would give me leave to ask and to have my questions answered, I would ask the venerable elder, the Elder, about certain points."

"Venerable Ānanda, ask, and when I have heard, I will explain it to you."

"Venerable elder, Elder, what dharmas should a monk who dwells in the wilderness, who dwells at the foot of a tree, who dwells in an empty house,

keep in mind without interruption?"

"Venerable Ānanda, a monk who dwells in the wilderness, who dwells at the foot of a tree, who dwells in an empty house, should keep two dharmas in mind without interruption: calm abiding and insight."

"Elder, when calm abiding has been practiced, cultivated and made much of, what benefit does one come to experience? When insight has been practiced, cultivated and made much of, what benefit does one come to experience?"

"Venerable Ānanda, when calm abiding has been practiced, cultivated and made much of, one is liberated in dependence on insight. When insight has been practiced, cultivated and made much of, one is liberated in dependence on calm abiding. And so, venerable Ānanda, the mind of a learned noble śrāvaka who has fully cultivated calm abiding and insight is liberated by way of the elements."

"Elder, what are the elements?"

"Venerable Ānanda, they are the element of abandonment, the element of freedom from attachment, and the element of cessation."

"Elder, what is it that, once abandoned, is called the element of abandonment? What is it that, once one is free of attachment to it, is called the element of freedom from attachment? What is it that, once it has ceased, is called the element of cessation?"

"Venerable Ānanda, the abandonment of all formations is called the element of abandonment. Freedom from attachment to all formations is called the element of freedom from attachment. The cessation of all formations is called the element of cessation."

Then the venerable Ānanda praised and rejoiced in what the elder, the Elder, had explained, and went to where the five hundred monks were. When he arrived, he said this to the five hundred monks: "Venerable ones, what dharmas should a monk who dwells in the wilderness, who dwells at the foot of a tree, who dwells in an empty house, keep in mind without interruption?"

"Venerable Ānanda, a monk who dwells in the wilderness, who dwells at the foot of a tree, who dwells in an empty house, should keep two dharmas in mind without interruption: calm abiding and insight."

"Venerable ones, when calm abiding has been practiced, cultivated and made much of, what benefit does one come to experience? When insight has been

practiced, cultivated and made much of, what benefit does one come to experience?"

"Venerable Ānanda, when calm abiding has been practiced, cultivated and made much of, one is liberated in dependence on insight. When insight has been practiced, cultivated and made much of, one is liberated in dependence on calm abiding. Venerable Ānanda, the mind of a learned noble śrāvaka who has fully cultivated calm abiding and insight is liberated by way of the elements."

"Venerable ones, what are the elements?"

"Venerable Ānanda, they are the element of abandonment, the element of freedom from attachment, and the element of cessation."

"Venerable ones, what is it that, once abandoned, is called the element of abandonment? What is it that, once one is free of attachment to it, is called the element of freedom from attachment? What is it that, once it has ceased, is called the element of cessation?"

"Venerable Ānanda, the abandonment of all formations is called the element of abandonment. Freedom from attachment to all formations is called the element of freedom from attachment. The cessation of all formations is called the element of cessation."

Then the venerable Ānanda praised and rejoiced in what the five hundred monks had explained, and went to where the Blessed One was. When he arrived, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the venerable Ānanda said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable One, what dharmas should a monk who dwells in the wilderness, who dwells at the foot of a tree, who dwells in an empty house, keep in mind without interruption?"

"Ānanda, a monk who dwells in the wilderness, who dwells at the foot of a tree, who dwells in an empty house, should keep two dharmas in mind without interruption: calm abiding and insight."

"Venerable One, when calm abiding has been practiced, cultivated and made much of, what benefit does one come to experience? When insight has been practiced, cultivated and made much of, what benefit does one come to experience?"

"Ānanda, when calm abiding has been practiced, cultivated and made much of, one is liberated in dependence on insight. When insight has been practiced,

cultivated and made much of, one is liberated in dependence on calm abiding. Ānanda, the mind of a learned noble śrāvaka who has fully cultivated calm abiding and insight is liberated by way of the elements."

"Venerable One, what are the elements?"

"Ānanda, they are the element of abandonment, the element of freedom from attachment, and the element of cessation."

"Venerable One, what is it that, once abandoned, is called the element of abandonment? What is it that, once one is free of attachment to it, is called the element of freedom from attachment? What is it that, once it has ceased, is called the element of cessation?"

"Ānanda, the abandonment of all formations is called the element of abandonment. Freedom from attachment to all formations is called the element of freedom from attachment. The cessation of all formations is called the element of cessation."

"Venerable One, it is marvelous how the Teacher and the śrāvakas, in the supreme words, agree and accord in exactly this way: meaning with meaning, word with word, and letter with letter."

"Why so? Venerable One, I went to where the senior monk, the Elder, was, and when I put this very meaning to the senior monk, the Elder, in these words and these letters, he answered me with this very meaning, in these words and these letters, exactly as the Blessed One has now declared it. I rejoiced in and praised what the senior monk, the Elder, had explained, and went to where the five hundred monks were. When I put this very meaning to the five hundred monks in these words and these letters, they too answered me with this very meaning, in these words and these letters, exactly as the Blessed One has now declared it. Venerable One, it is marvelous how the Teacher and the śrāvakas, in the supreme words, agree and accord in exactly this way: meaning with meaning, word with word, and letter with letter."

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, do you know who the elder monk is?"

He replied, "Venerable One, the elder monk is an arhat. His defilements are exhausted; he has done what had to be done and completed his task; he has laid down the burden and attained his own goal; he has completely exhausted the fetters that bind to existence; and through perfect knowledge his mind is utterly liberated. And those five hundred monks, every one of them, are likewise arhats. Their defilements are exhausted; they have done what had to

be done and completed their task; they have laid down the burden and attained their own goal; they have completely exhausted the fetters that bind to existence; and through perfect knowledge their minds are utterly liberated."

When the Blessed One and the venerable Ānanda had spoken of and proclaimed the elder monk and the five hundred monks in this way, doubts arose in the monks, and they asked the Blessed One, the Buddha, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what actions did the Elder perform, that he remained in his mother's womb for sixty years? Venerable One, what actions did he perform, that he became dull-witted, and yet went forth and realized arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, in other, former lives the Elder himself performed and accumulated actions whose accumulations have gathered and whose conditions have ripened, which are now present like a flood, and which will inevitably come to pass. Since it was the Elder himself who performed and accumulated these actions, who else would experience them? Monks, actions that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the outer earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element, or the wind element. Virtuous and nonvirtuous actions that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

The actions of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen as their very fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in this very Fortunate Eon, when beings lived for twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, the knower of the world, the unsurpassed guide who tames beings, the teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One called Kāśyapa. He was staying near the city of Vārāṇasī, at Ṛṣivadana, in the Deer Park.

"There, the son of a merchant went forth under a certain elder. That elder was an arhat who had abandoned attachment. Then, some time later, a festival took place in that land, and the young monk roused the elder, saying, 'Get up! Let us go to the village for alms.'

"The elder said, 'Son, you go on ahead for now, and busy yourself with something virtuous.'

"A second and a third time the young monk roused the elder, saying, 'Get up! Let us go to the village for alms,' and a second and a third time the elder said, 'Son, you go on ahead, and busy yourself with something virtuous.'

"Then that greedy young monk spoke harsh words: 'Then don't come out of the house for sixty years! I am going.'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who was the young monk at that time, on that occasion, is this elder monk. Through the ripening of that action, speaking harsh words with a mind of hatred toward an arhat, he remained in his mother's womb for sixty years.

"Moreover, because he was formerly stingy with the Dharma, he became deficient in wisdom, and his faculties ripened only with great difficulty. Because he trained there, recited the teachings, and became skilled in the aggregates, skilled in the elements, skilled in the sense sources, skilled in dependent origination, and skilled in what is possible and what is impossible, he has now gone forth in my teaching, abandoned all afflictions, and realized arhatship.

"Therefore, monks, you should strive to abandon faults of speech, so that faults such as the Elder's, from when he was an ordinary being, do not arise. And you should attain a collection of qualities like the one he gained by attaining arhatship. Monks, you should train in this way."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Hastaka.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, respected, revered, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, people of the palace retinue, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, who received robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time there lived in Śrāvastī a merchant who was rich, with much wealth and great means, with vast and extensive possessions, possessed of wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He took a wife from a family of equal standing, and he played with her, made love, and enjoyed

himself. As he played, made love, and enjoyed himself, his wife conceived, and after eight or nine months had passed she gave birth to a son, a boy who was handsome, good to look at, and beautiful, of fine complexion, golden in color, complete in all his limbs and smaller parts, and who by nature remembered his former lives.

Then he took hold of his own hands, kissed them, stroked them, and hugged them, and uttered these words: "Ah, at last, after a very long time, I have found my two hands! Ah, at last, after a very long time, I have found my two hands!"

Then, when the birth celebration had been held, they set about naming him, asking, "What name shall we give this boy?" His relatives said, "As soon as he was born, he took hold of his hands, kissed them, stroked them, and hugged them. Therefore let this boy be given the name Hastaka."

Then the boy Hastaka was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry him on their laps, two wet nurses to nurse him, two nurses to wash away his dirt, and two nurses to play with him. Those eight nurses raised and nourished him with milk, curd, butter, ghee, cream of butter, and every other kind of excellent provision, and he grew swiftly, like a lotus in a lake.

Then, at a time when a danger arose in that land, the crowds of people became frightened, and, at a loss what to do, they hid their possessions from one another. The boy Hastaka, however, hid his two hands, and said to the crowds of people, "Oh, do not harbor hostile thoughts toward those worthy of offerings! Do not speak harsh words! Oh, at last, after a very long time, I have found my two hands!"

Then, some time later, the boy Hastaka went to the Jeta Grove. There he saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessed of a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, wholly excellent, like a moving mountain of jewels. As soon as he saw him, his mind took joy in the Blessed One. Joy having arisen, he bowed at the feet of the Blessed One and sat before the Blessed One to listen to the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, understanding his inclinations, latent tendencies, constitution, and nature, taught him the Dharma in such a way that he would realize the four noble truths. Having heard it, Hastaka destroyed with the vajra of wisdom the twenty lofty peaks of the mountain of the view of the perishable

collection, and directly realized the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truths, he asked his father and mother for leave and went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One. Through effort, application, and striving, he understood that this very five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra is unsteady and unstable, and he resolved that all kinds of formations are by nature subject to decay, to falling, to dispersal, and to destruction. Having abandoned all afflictions, he directly realized arhatship.

Becoming an arhat, free of attachment to the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal; his mind was like space and like the palm of the hand; he became cool like refined sandalwood; with knowledge he had broken the shell of the egg; he had attained the knowledges, the higher perceptions, and the analytical knowledges; he no longer looked to the gains, attachments, and honors of existence; and he became one worshiped by the gods together with Indra and Upendra, an object of their offerings and respectful speech.

Even after he had attained arhatship, he taught the Dharma to the monks in the same way, saying, "Oh, do not harbor hostile thoughts toward those worthy of offerings! Do not speak harsh words! Ah, at last, after a very long time, I have found my two hands!"

Then doubts arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what actions did Hastaka perform and accumulate, that even though he has attained arhatship he still says, 'Ah, at last, after a very long time, I have found my two hands!'?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, this is the fruit of action seen directly. Do you wish to hear what he is thinking of when he speaks this way?"

"Venerable One, we wish to hear it."

"Monks, in other, former lives Hastaka himself performed and accumulated actions whose accumulations have gathered and whose conditions have ripened, which are now present like a flood, and which will inevitably come to pass. Since it was Hastaka himself who performed and accumulated these actions, who else would experience them? Monks, actions that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the outer earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element, or the wind element. Virtuous and nonvirtuous actions that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

The actions of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen as their very fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in this very Fortunate Eon, when beings lived for twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, the knower of the world, the unsurpassed guide who tames beings, the teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One called Kāśyapa. He was staying near the city of Vārāṇasī, at Ṛṣivadana, in the Deer Park.

"At one time there were two monks there who were friends. Of the two, one was an arhat and also very learned; the other was an ordinary being and of little learning. The learned arhat was known to all, possessed of great merit, a receiver of robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, and he received many invitations. Wherever he was invited, he took his friend the monk along as his attendant śramaṇa.

"Then one day, when the arhat had been invited and was about to set out, he looked for his attendant śramaṇa but could not find him. Since he was nowhere to be seen, the arhat took another monk with him. Then some frivolous young monks there said, 'Venerables, look! Today he did not take his attendant śramaṇa, but took someone else.'

"At that, the monk grew angry, and, with a mind of hatred toward the arhat, he spoke harsh words: 'If from now on I ever wash his alms bowl, may these two hands of mine cease to exist!'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who was the monk's friend at that time, on that occasion, is this Hastaka. Because he spoke harsh words with a mind of hatred toward an arhat, he was without hands for five hundred lifetimes. Later, heartfelt remorse arose in him, and he confessed his wrong as a wrong, acknowledging it, laying it bare, and clearing it away; because of this he has regained his hands. Because he trained there, recited the teachings, and became skilled in the aggregates, skilled in the elements, skilled in the sense sources, skilled in dependent origination, and skilled in what is possible and what is impossible, he has now realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, actions that are wholly black have a ripening that is wholly black; actions that are wholly white have a ripening that is wholly white; and mixed actions have a ripening that is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon

wholly black actions and mixed actions, and devote yourselves solely to wholly white actions. Monks, you should train in this way."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Nourished with Care.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, respected, revered, and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, people of the palace retinue, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas. Worshiped and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, who received robes, food, bedding, seats, and medicines and requisites for the sick, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time there lived in Śrāvastī a brahmin who was rich, with much wealth and great means, with vast and extensive possessions, possessed of wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He took a wife from a family of equal standing, and he played with her, made love, and enjoyed himself. As he played, made love, and enjoyed himself, his wife conceived, and after eight or nine months had passed she gave birth to a son, a boy of poor complexion, unpleasant to look at, and ill-favored. As soon as he was born, his mother's two breasts ran dry of milk.

Some time later the brahmin summoned another nurse for him, but through the ripening of the boy's actions her milk too dried up. Then, when no milk came even after every means of producing milk had been tried, he was nourished with great care, and so he was given the name Nourished with Care, Nourished with Care. He was known as one of little merit, and he was indeed of little merit: when he grew up, he could not find even a bellyful of food.

Then he saw monks, their lower robes neatly worn and their upper robes neatly draped, carrying alms bowls as black as bees, going into Śrāvastī for alms, and he saw them coming back out with their hands full and their bowls full. Seeing this, he wished to go forth in the teaching of the Blessed One, and he asked his father and mother for leave and went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One.

Even after going forth, he could not find even a bellyful of food, and he grew weary of it. Through that very weariness, and through effort, application, and

striving, he understood that this very five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra is unsteady and unstable, and he resolved that all kinds of formations are by nature subject to decay, to falling, to dispersal, and to destruction. Having abandoned all afflictions, he directly realized arhatship. Becoming an arhat, free of attachment to the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal; his mind was like space and like the palm of the hand; he became cool like refined sandalwood; with knowledge he had broken the shell of the egg; he had attained the knowledges, the higher perceptions, and the analytical knowledges; he no longer looked to the gains, attachments, and honors of existence; and he became one worshiped by the gods together with Indra and Upendra, an object of their offerings and respectful speech.

Some time later, he took up the task of sweeping the Blessed One's Perfumed Chamber. When he had swept it, he put on his lower robe and his Dharma robe, took his alms bowl, and went into Śrāvastī for alms. There he obtained plenty of good alms, and with them his faculties and great elements were satisfied. His faculties satisfied, he passed the night until dawn in the meditative concentrations, the liberations, and the absorptions.

Then the thought came to him: "Ah, this is a good method. I shall make a request of the Saṅgha of monks." So he made this request of the whole Saṅgha of monks: "Venerables, I am of little merit. Only when I have swept the Perfumed Chamber and then go for alms am I fed. Therefore, may the Saṅgha have compassion for me, and may no one else sweep the Perfumed Chamber."

The Saṅgha then made a rule that no one should sweep the Blessed One's Perfumed Chamber, and so, at his ease, he would sweep the Perfumed Chamber and afterward go into Śrāvastī for alms.

At that time the venerable Śāriputra, too, having undertaken to spend the rains retreat in the Jeta Grove together with a retinue of five hundred, arrived in Śrāvastī, and out of reverence for the Teacher he swept the Perfumed Chamber. When the venerable Nourished with Care noticed this, he said, "Elder, by sweeping the Perfumed Chamber you have struck me in the belly."

The elder said, "What is wrong?"

Nourished with Care said, "Elder, whenever I have not swept the Perfumed Chamber, I do not find any alms."

Then the elder Śāriputra said, "If that is so, do not be disheartened. Wherever I am invited, I will give you food there."

Then an invitation came for the elder Śāriputra together with his retinue of five hundred, and Nourished with Care set out with them as well. But when they came near the householder's door, through the ripening of Nourished with Care's actions a great quarrel broke out in that household. The venerable Nourished with Care thought, "This quarrel has broken out because I am of little merit." So he turned back, went to the monastery, and stayed there fasting.

The next day the venerable Śāriputra said, "Why did you not come?"

He replied, "Does the elder not know how a quarrel broke out there because I am of little merit?"

So that day the elder Śāriputra put him in front, and they went into the house. But even though he sat among the Saṅgha, and food was served to those on his right and his left, the man serving forgot him, and so, right there in the midst of the Saṅgha, he went without food for a second time.

Some time later the elder Ānanda heard of this. Having heard it, he said to Nourished with Care, "In that case, stay right here in the Jeta Grove, and I will bring your food to you."

The elder Ānanda possessed such memory that he had learned eighty thousand collections of Dharma from the Blessed One and twenty thousand from other monks. Yet through the obscuration of Nourished with Care's actions, even the elder Ānanda forgot, and there too he went without food for a third time.

Then, when four days had passed, the elder Ānanda made a special effort and gave him alms. But as Ānanda was coming back out, dogs snatched it away, and there too he went without food for a fourth time.

Then, when five days had passed, the elder Mahāmaudgalyāyana heard of it. He took alms for Nourished with Care and set out by his miraculous power, but through the ripening of Nourished with Care's actions, the king of birds, a garuḍa, struck the food with the tip of his wing and threw it into the ocean, and there too he went without food for a fifth time.

Then, when six days had passed, the elder Śāriputra heard of it and thought, "Ah, surely it must be I myself who fetches the alms for Nourished with Care." So the elder Śāriputra took alms for him, vanished from that very household, and came to the door of Nourished with Care's dwelling. But through the ripening of Nourished with Care's actions, that door became enclosed by rock.

Thinking, "I shall open the door by miraculous power," the elder Śāriputra set the alms bowl down on the ground, but through the ripening of Nourished with Care's actions it sank eighty thousand yojanas down, onto the golden ground below. The elder Śāriputra drew it up from there as well by miraculous power, and, thinking, "I shall put the food in his mouth," he put the food into his mouth; but through the ripening of his actions his mouth vanished, and the food fell outside.

Then the venerable Śāriputra, knowing that Nourished with Care had no share in it, grew weary, and there too the venerable one went without food for a sixth time.

Then, on the day when seven days had passed, the venerable Nourished with Care, in order to stir weariness in beings, to show that actions are not lost, and to make known the power of actions, filled his alms bowl with ashes, sat down before the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha, mixed the ashes with water and drank them, and passed completely into nirvāṇa in the realm of nirvāṇa without remainder of the aggregates. When the monks saw this, they grew weary, and they performed the funeral rites for his remains.

Then doubts arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what actions did Nourished with Care perform, that even though he attained arhatship he went without food for six days, and on the seventh day passed completely into nirvāṇa in the realm of nirvāṇa without remainder of the aggregates?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, in other, former lives Nourished with Care himself performed and accumulated actions whose accumulations have gathered and whose conditions have ripened, which are now present like a flood, and which will inevitably come to pass. Since it was Nourished with Care himself who performed and accumulated these actions, who else would experience them? Monks, actions that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the outer earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element, or the wind element. Virtuous and nonvirtuous actions that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

The actions of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen as their very fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in the city of Vārāṇasī, there lived the wife of a householder who was full of faith, virtuous, and good-hearted. Without interruption she gave gifts to śramaṇas, brahmins, the destitute, the wretched and needy, and beggars. Later her husband died, and after a time her son became master of the household. He was miserly and stingy, clinging to his possessions, one who would not give even a bali offering to the crows, and whenever he saw śramaṇas, brahmins, the destitute, the wretched and needy, or beggars, he felt hostility.

"His mother, as had been her custom before, went on giving gifts and abundant gifts to śramaṇas, brahmins, the destitute, the wretched and needy, and beggars. Then her son, overcome by miserliness, said, 'Mother, do not give gifts without my consent.'

"She said, 'My only son, in this house that is the custom of the household.'

"Then he set aside a separate portion of food for her, but even so she gave half of that food away and ate only half herself.

"Then he, his mind overcome by miserliness and clouded by anger, forbade her again and again, but whatever means he used to forbid her, he could not stop her. So he said to his mother, 'Mother, there is something to be done; please go into the inner room of the house.' Then she, being by nature honest, went into the inner room. He shut the door and cut off her food for a day, and she said, 'Son, I am hungry.'

"At that he spoke harsh words: 'Eat ashes!'

"Then, after a time, she met with misery, discomfort, and harm, and though she cried out piteously, he kept her fasting for six days and did not let her out, and she died. Yet he, clouded by miserliness, felt no remorse at being parted from his mother."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who was the householder's son at that time, on that occasion, is this Nourished with Care. Through the ripening of that action of harming his mother, he was born for one eon in the great hell of beings, Avīci. For that very reason, even though he has now realized arhatship, he went without food, and passed completely into nirvāṇa after eating ashes.

"Monks, Nourished with Care also performed and accumulated other actions. Monks, long ago, in times past, in the city of Vārāṇasī, there was a brahmin devoted to the gods, who was honored, respected, revered, worshiped, and

esteemed by all the brahmins, householders, and people living in Vārāṇasī.

"By the nature of things, when buddhas do not appear in the world, pratyekabuddhas appear in the world, compassionate toward the wretched and needy, living in remote dwellings, the sole worthy recipients of offerings in the world. At one time a pratyekabuddha went into Vārāṇasī for alms, and the brahmin saw him coming back out with his hands full and his bowl full. Miserliness arose in him, and he said, 'Let me see your alms bowl; bring it here.' Since the knowledge of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas does not operate unless they direct their minds to it, the venerable one showed it to him. Then the brahmin threw it to the ground and kicked it. The pratyekabuddha then went without food, yet no remorse arose in the brahmin.

"Monks, what do you think? The one who was the brahmin at that time, on that occasion, is this Nourished with Care. Moreover, he went forth during the time of the Blessed One Kāśyapa, and because he kept the life of pure conduct there, he has now realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, actions that are wholly black have a ripening that is wholly black; actions that are wholly white have a ripening that is wholly white; and mixed actions have a ripening that is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon wholly black actions and mixed actions, and devote yourselves solely to wholly white actions. Monks, you should train in this way."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story of Saṃsāra.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed and worshiped by kings, great ministers, wealthy men, people of the court, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshiped and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, who received robes, food, bedding, seats, medicine for the sick and other requisites, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time there lived in Śrāvastī a householder who was rich, of great wealth and great means, with vast and extensive holdings, who had the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa and rivaled the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He took a wife from a family equal to his own, and he played, enjoyed himself and made love with her. As

he played, enjoyed himself and made love, his wife became pregnant, and when eight or nine months had passed she gave birth. She bore a boy who was handsome, good to look upon and beautiful, complete in all his limbs and features. The moment he was born, he looked at the people of the household and spoke these words: "Alas, saṃsāra is suffering! Saṃsāra is the utmost suffering!" Having said this, he remained without saying anything more.

Then they held the birth feast for him, and as they were giving him a name, asking, "What name shall we give this boy?", his relatives said, "As soon as he was born, he cried out, 'Saṃsāra, saṃsāra!' Therefore let this boy be named Saṃsāra."

The boy Saṃsāra was then entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to hold him in their laps, two nurses to suckle him, two nurses to wash away his dirt, and two nurses to play with him. These eight nurses raised and nourished him with milk, curd, butter, ghee, the cream of butter, and every other kind of fine provision, so that he grew quickly, like a lotus in a lake.

As he gradually grew up, since he naturally remembered his former lives, he taught the Dharma to groups of people, saying, "O people, do not speak harsh words to your superiors, to those who are like superiors, to your father and mother, to preceptors and to teachers! Saṃsāra is suffering! Saṃsāra is the utmost suffering!"

Then some time later, while wandering about here and there, he came to the Jeta Grove. There he saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, and wholly excellent, like a moving mountain of jewels. As soon as he saw him, his mind became joyful toward the Blessed One. With joy arisen, he bowed at the feet of the Blessed One and sat before the Blessed One in order to hear the Dharma.

The Blessed One then taught him a Dharma discourse that brings weariness with saṃsāra. Having heard it, the boy Saṃsāra came to see the faults of saṃsāra and the benefits of nirvāṇa. He asked his father and mother for leave and went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One. Striving, exerting himself and making effort, he understood that this very five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra is moving and unstable, and he was decisively certain that all forms of conditioning factors are by nature subject to decay, falling, scattering and destruction. Abandoning all afflictions, he directly realized arhatship.

As an arhat, free from attachment to the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal; his mind was like space and the palm of his hand; he had become cool like refined sandalwood; with knowledge he had broken the eggshell of ignorance; he had attained the knowledges, the superknowledges and the analytical knowledges; he was indifferent to the gains, attachments and honors of existence; and he became one worthy of the worship, veneration and respectful address of the gods together with Indra and Upendra.

Even after he had become an arhat, he taught the Dharma to the monks, saying, "Venerable ones, do not speak harsh words to your superiors, to those who are like superiors, to your father and mother, to preceptors and to teachers! Saṃsāra is suffering! Saṃsāra is the utmost suffering!"

Then doubt arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what deeds did Saṃsāra do, that for five hundred lifetimes he came forth from his mother's womb as a corpse, dead, and that he went forth and directly realized arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, the deeds that Saṃsāra himself did and accumulated in other, earlier lives have gathered their causes and fulfilled their conditions; they are present like a swelling flood, and they will come without fail. Since Saṃsāra himself did and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds that have been done and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element or the wind element. Rather, virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds that have been done and accumulated ripen solely in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense sources.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time has come,
They ripen into their fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in this very Fortunate Eon, when beings lived for twenty thousand years, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the Perfectly Complete Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One, called Kāśyapa. He dwelt in the city of Vārāṇasī, at Ṛṣivadana, in the Deer Park.

"At that time, in the city of Vārāṇasī, the son of a merchant went forth under an elder. That elder was an arhat who had abandoned attachment. Then, some time later, a festival took place in that land. The young monk urged the elder, saying, 'Get up, let us go to the village for alms.' The elder said, 'Son, it is still early. Go for now and do something virtuous.' Two and three times the young monk urged the elder, saying, 'Get up, let us go to the village for alms,' and two and three times the elder said, 'Son, it is still early. Go and do something virtuous.' Then that young monk, greedy for food, spoke with harsh speech: 'For five hundred lifetimes may you never come out of the house alive! I am off.'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who was the young monk at that time, on that occasion, is this very one. Because he spoke harsh words with a mind of hatred toward an arhat, by the ripening of that deed he came forth from his mother's womb as a dead corpse for five hundred lifetimes. Now he has been born as a human being, and remembering that, he says, 'Saṃsāra is suffering! Saṃsāra is the utmost suffering!' Because remorse arose in him and he confessed his offense to the elder, and because he kept the life of pure conduct, he has now directly realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, actions that are wholly black have a ripening that is wholly black; actions that are wholly white have a ripening that is wholly white; and mixed actions have a ripening that is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon wholly black actions and mixed actions, and devote yourselves solely to wholly white actions. Monks, you should train in this way."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

From the Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa, the twenty-second and final section.

The story of Guptika.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed and worshiped by kings, great ministers, wealthy men, people of the court, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshiped and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, who received robes, food, bedding, seats, medicine for the sick and other requisites, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At the time when the Blessed One, invited by Lac Ear, brought to faith the many people to be tamed in the land of Baskets, the whole multitude of people living in the land of Baskets was inclined toward the Buddha, flowed toward the Dharma and flowed toward the Saṅgha.

At that time there lived in the land of Baskets a householder who was rich, of great wealth and great means, with vast and extensive holdings, who had the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa and rivaled the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He took a wife from a family equal to his own, and he played, enjoyed himself and made love with her. As he played, enjoyed himself and made love, his wife became pregnant, and when eight or nine months had passed she gave birth. She bore a boy, and as soon as he was born his whole body was found to be densely covered with boils. When those boils burst, his flesh turned into a festering mass; pus and blood oozed from his body, and an exceedingly foul stench came from it.

Then his father, by the force of his power as a lord, himself treated him with wealth, mantras, medicines and servants. Yet because the force of the power of karma prevailed, the disease did not subside, and his whole body remained like that. Since he was ashamed and kept himself hidden with clothing, he was given the name Guptika, "the Hidden One."

Then some time later, when the boy Guptika had grown up, his friends of the same age, who went back and forth between the city of Śrāvastī and the land of Baskets, said to his father, "Sir, if you take him to Śrāvastī, there are physicians, medicines and the like there, so he could surely be cured of that disease."

When his father heard these words, he gave him many jewels and servants and sent him to Śrāvastī. In due course he went with his friends of the same age to Śrāvastī. But although there were many physicians, riches, medicines and servants there, they could not cure that disease of his, which had arisen from his karma.

Then some time later he went to the Jeta Grove. There he saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, his body well adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, and wholly excellent, like a moving mountain of jewels. As soon as he saw him, his mind became joyful toward the Blessed One. With joy arisen, he bowed at the feet of the Blessed One and sat before the Blessed One in order to hear the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, understanding his disposition, his latent tendencies, his temperament and his nature, taught him the Dharma in such a way that he would realize the Four Noble Truths. Having heard it, he understood that the five aggregates of appropriation are a disease, a boil, a thorn, an evil, impermanent and suffering. Knowing that all conditioning factors are impermanent, he went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One. Striving, exerting himself and making effort, he understood that this very five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra is moving and unstable, and he was decisively certain that all forms of conditioning factors are by nature subject to decay, falling, scattering and destruction. Abandoning all afflictions, he directly realized arhatship.

As an arhat, free from attachment to the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal; his mind was like space and the palm of his hand; he had become cool like refined sandalwood; with knowledge he had broken the eggshell of ignorance; he had attained the knowledges, the superknowledges and the analytical knowledges; he was indifferent to the gains, attachments and honors of existence; and he became one worthy of the worship, veneration and respectful address of the gods together with Indra and Upendra.

His friends of the same age also became weary of the world, and through that very weariness they went forth. They went to where the venerable Guptika was, and having arrived, they spoke thus to the venerable Guptika: "Venerable Guptika, what in the world is subject to destruction, and what in the world is not subject to destruction?"

"Venerable ones, form is subject to destruction; nirvāṇa, its cessation, is not subject to destruction. Venerable ones, feeling, perception, conditioning factors and consciousness are subject to destruction; nirvāṇa, their cessation, is not subject to destruction.

"Venerable ones, what do you think? Is form permanent, or is it impermanent?"

"Venerable Guptika, it is impermanent."

"Venerable ones, is what is impermanent suffering, or is it not suffering?"

"Venerable Guptika, it is suffering."

"Venerable ones, would a learned noble śrāvaka grasp at what is impermanent, suffering and subject to change as a self, thinking, 'This is mine,

this is I, this is my self'?"

"Venerable Guptika, he would not."

"Venerable ones, what do you think? Are feeling, perception, conditioning factors and consciousness permanent, or are they impermanent?"

"Venerable Guptika, they are impermanent."

"Venerable ones, is what is impermanent suffering, or is it not suffering?"

"Venerable Guptika, it is suffering."

"Venerable ones, would a learned noble śrāvaka grasp at what is impermanent, suffering and subject to change as a self, thinking, 'This is mine, this is I, this is my self'?"

"Venerable Guptika, he would not."

"Therefore, venerable ones, whatever form there is, whether past, future or present, external or internal, coarse or subtle, inferior or excellent, far or near, all of it should be seen thus as it really is with perfect wisdom: 'This is not mine, this is not I, this is not my self.' Whatever feeling, perception and conditioning factors there are, and whatever consciousness there is, whether past, future or present, internal or external, coarse or subtle, inferior or excellent, far or near, all of it should be seen thus as it really is with perfect wisdom: 'This is not mine, this is not I, this is not my self.'

"Venerable ones, the learned śrāvaka who sees in this way becomes weary of form, and becomes weary of feeling, perception, conditioning factors and consciousness. Being weary, he becomes free from attachment. Being free from attachment, he becomes liberated. When liberated, the knowledge and vision of liberation arises in him alone: 'My birth is exhausted, the life of pure conduct has been lived, what had to be done has been done, I will know no existence other than this one.'"

When this Dharma discourse was spoken, the eye of Dharma regarding phenomena, free of dust and stainless, was purified in those friends of the same age.

Then doubt arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what deeds did Guptika do, that his body became so ugly, so diseased and so foul-smelling? And what deeds did he do, that his intelligence became sharp and clear, and that he went forth and directly realized arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, the deeds that Guptika himself did and accumulated in other, earlier lives have gathered their causes and fulfilled their conditions; they are present like a swelling flood, and they will come without fail. Since Guptika himself did and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds that have been done and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element or the wind element. Rather, virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds that have been done and accumulated ripen solely in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense sources.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time has come,
They ripen into their fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, there lived in the city of Vārāṇasī a merchant who was on bad terms with another merchant. That other merchant offered much wealth to the king and petitioned him: 'Your Majesty, this merchant has committed an offense. Please punish and chastise him.' The king consented and had him punished. The other merchant then summoned him to his own house and had him beaten with whips. When blood came from his body, he had a great quantity of powdered virulent poison sprinkled on it, so that the man's body became a festering mass of rotting flesh.

"When that merchant's friends heard what had been done to him, they joined together and cured him of that disease with special provisions. Then, through that very weariness, he left home and went forth, and without a teacher he cultivated the thirty-seven factors conducive to awakening and directly realized the awakening of a pratyekabuddha.

"Then this thought arose in him: 'That merchant has generated great demerit in his own mind stream. Before he is lost, I should certainly go to him and stir weariness in him.' He went before him, rose up into the sky above, and displayed miracles of various kinds. Ordinary people are quickly brought to faith by miraculous powers. Like a tree cut off at the root, the merchant fell and bowed at his feet, and joining his palms he entreated that blessed one: 'Great one worthy of offerings, please come down! I have wronged you, and I shall rise out of it by relying on you alone.' He begged the pratyekabuddha's forgiveness, served him food, offered him robes, and made this aspiration: 'May I not experience the ripening of the deed by which I wronged you in

anger! Through this honor that I have shown, may I attain qualities such as these! May I please a teacher even more exalted than this one, and may I never displease him!'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who was the merchant at that time, on that occasion, is this Guptika. Through the force of that deed he died under the whip for five hundred lifetimes, and for that very reason he has now obtained such a body. Furthermore, during the time of the Blessed One Kāśyapa he went forth together with his friends of the same age, and because they kept the life of pure conduct there, he has now directly realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, actions that are wholly black have a ripening that is wholly black; actions that are wholly white have a ripening that is wholly white; and mixed actions have a ripening that is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon wholly black actions and mixed actions, and devote yourselves solely to wholly white actions. Monks, you should train in this way."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story of Virūpa.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed and worshiped by kings, great ministers, wealthy men, people of the court, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas. Worshiped and known by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, who received robes, food, bedding, seats, medicine for the sick and other requisites, was staying together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of the householder Anāthapiṇḍada.

At that time there lived in the land called Bharga a householder who was rich, of great wealth and great means, with vast and extensive holdings, who had the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa and rivaled the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He took a wife from a family equal to his own, and he played, enjoyed himself and made love with her. As he played, enjoyed himself and made love, his wife became pregnant, and when eight or nine months had passed she gave birth. She bore a boy who had eighteen kinds of ugliness. His parents, out of love for their son, raised him. But when he had gradually grown up, his parents drove him out of the house because of his ugliness. Wherever he went, there too many people drove him away because he was so unpleasant to see. Even creatures born in

the animal realm treated him with contempt; what need is there to speak of humans? Driven out of the city, he stayed in a deserted pleasure grove. Sometimes, when he found fruits and roots, he ate them; at other times, when he found no fruits or roots, he lived on grass, flowers and leaves.

Then the Blessed One, seeing that the time had come to tame Virūpa, said to four great śrāvakas, "Monks, come, let us tame Virūpa." The Blessed One, attended by the great śrāvakas, then went to the deserted pleasure grove. When Virūpa saw the Blessed One, he was ashamed and fled this way and that. Then the Blessed One blessed him so that he could not flee anywhere at all. Then the Blessed One and the great śrāvakas entered the absorption of cessation. Rising from cessation, the Blessed One transformed himself into an ugly man, and having done so, he took a bowl filled with food and went over to Virūpa.

When Virūpa saw him, he was delighted and said, "Great friend, where have you come from? Come here! The two of us shall stay together." Then the Blessed One gave him food, and when his senses were satisfied, the Blessed One changed back into his own appearance.

When Virūpa saw the Buddha, the Blessed One, he said, "Now that you have become handsome, by the power of what deed has this happened?"

The Blessed One said, "I have a spell called Gladdening the Mind; this is its power."

Then Virūpa gave rise to a gladdened mind toward the Blessed One and the great śrāvakas who had entered the absorption of cessation. Because of that, his ugliness vanished and he became handsome. He went forth and directly realized arhatship.

Then doubt arose in the monks, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, who cuts through all doubts, "Venerable One, what deeds did Virūpa do, that he became so ill-colored, so unbearable to touch, and possessed of eighteen kinds of ugliness, and that he went forth and directly realized arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, the deeds that Virūpa himself did and accumulated in other, earlier lives have gathered their causes and fulfilled their conditions; they are present like a swelling flood, and they will come without fail. Since Virūpa himself did and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds that have been done and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element, nor do they ripen in the water

element, the fire element or the wind element. Rather, virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds that have been done and accumulated ripen solely in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense sources.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred eons.
When the conditions gather and the time has come,
They ripen into their fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the Perfectly Complete Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One, called Tiṣya. Later he dwelt at a certain royal palace.

"Then the Perfectly Complete Buddha Tiṣya considered, and saw that at that time there were two bodhisattvas who were close to awakening: the bodhisattva Śākyamuni and Maitreya. Of these, he saw that Maitreya's own mind stream had ripened but those he was to tame had not ripened, while Śākyamuni's own mind stream had not ripened but those he was to tame had ripened.

"Then, in order to ripen the mind stream of the bodhisattva Śākyamuni, the Perfectly Complete Buddha Tiṣya went up onto the Snow Mountain, entered a cave of jewels, sat down with his legs crossed, and entered the absorption of the fire element.

"At that time the bodhisattva Śākyamuni had gone up onto the Snow Mountain, king of mountains, in search of fruits and roots. As he wandered about here and there, he saw the Perfectly Complete Buddha Tiṣya, his body well adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, possessing a radiance surpassing a thousand suns, and wholly excellent, like a moving mountain of jewels. As soon as he saw him, he attained such one-pointedness of mind that for seven days and nights he stood on one foot and praised him with a single verse:

O bull among men, no other great ascetic like you is found in the god realms or on earth;
Nowhere at all in this world is there one, nor in the palace of Vaiśravaṇa;
Nor in the supreme abodes, the palaces of the gods, nor in the directions or the intermediate directions;

Though one roam the whole wide earth with its mountains and forests, where could one be found?

"Thus he praised him. Then the Perfectly Complete Buddha Tiṣya, seeing that the mind stream of the bodhisattva Śākyamuni had ripened, gave him his approval, saying:

Excellent, excellent, holy being!
Excellent brahmin, today,
By this power and perfected diligence
In praising well the Tathāgata,
Nine eons have been cut short.

"Thus he spoke. Then that Blessed One, attended by gods renowned as mighty, remained inside that cave. There was a god of lesser renown who lived in that cave, and he could not get into the cave. So he made his eyes hideous and menaced the Blessed One. Although he menaced him for a long time, he was unable to harm the Blessed One, and so he gained faith, thinking, 'This sage is a good one, one accomplished in his discipline.' Then he manifested his full body, bowed at the feet of the Blessed One, begged his forgiveness, and also served him food."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who was the god living in that cave at that time, on that occasion, is this Virūpa. Through the ripening of that deed he experienced endless suffering in saṃsāra, and now too, for that very reason, he has become ugly. Because he later gave rise to a gladdened mind, his ugliness vanished, he became handsome, went forth and directly realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, actions that are wholly black have a ripening that is wholly black; actions that are wholly white have a ripening that is wholly white; and mixed actions have a ripening that is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon wholly black actions and mixed actions, and devote yourselves solely to wholly white actions. Monks, you should train in this way."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Gaṅgika.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was honored, revered, esteemed and worshipped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, the townspeople, guild

leaders, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras and mahoragas. Worshipped and acknowledged by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, endowed with great merit and receiving robes, food, bedding, seats, medicine for the sick and medical supplies, was dwelling together with the community of śrāvakas in the city of Vārāṇasī, at Ṛṣivadana in the Deer Park.

At that time there lived in Vārāṇasī a householder who was rich, with much wealth and great possessions, with vast and extensive holdings, possessing wealth like that of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa. He took a wife from a family of equal standing, and he played, enjoyed himself and made love with her. But though he played, enjoyed himself and made love, no son was born and no daughter, so he rested his cheek on his hand and thought, "Although my house is endowed with much wealth, I have neither son nor daughter. Because there is no son, after I pass away everything I own will fall to the king." Thinking this, he sat absorbed in brooding.

Then śramaṇas, brahmins, soothsayers, friends, relatives and other kin urged him, "Pray to the gods!" So, wanting a son by that woman, he prayed to Śiva, Varuṇa, Kubera, Śakra, Brahmā and the others, and to other distinguished gods as well. That is, he prayed also to the gods of the parks, the gods of the forests, the gods of the crossroads, the gods of the three-way junctions, the gods who receive bali offerings, the gods born together with a person, the gods of like nature, and the gods who constantly follow behind. There is a saying in the world that sons and daughters are born because of prayer, but that is not so. If sons and daughters were born because of prayer, it would follow that each person would have a thousand sons, like a great wheel-turning king. In fact, sons and daughters are born from the coming together of three conditions. What are the three? The father and mother come together, aroused with desire; the mother is in season and fertile; and a gandharva is present. From the coming together of these three conditions, sons and daughters are born.

Then, while he was devoted to praying, a certain being died and passed from a certain class of beings and entered the womb of his wife. Some women who are wise by nature have five special qualities. What are the five? They know when a man is aroused and when he is not aroused; they know the time and the fertile period; they know when a child has been conceived; they know from whom the child has been conceived; and they know whether it is a boy or a girl. If it is a boy, it rests on the right side of the womb; if it is a girl, it rests on

the left side of the womb.

Then, overjoyed, she told her husband, "My lord, a child has been conceived in me. Since it rests on the right side of my womb, it will certainly be a boy. Please rejoice!" He too was overjoyed. Raising the upper part of his body and stretching out his right arm, he uttered words of joy: "I shall see the face of the son I have long wished for! May my son be well formed, and not ill formed! May he carry out my duties! May he support us in return for being supported! May he enjoy his inheritance! May my family line long endure! And after we have passed away and died, may he give gifts and make merit for our sake, whether much or little, and dedicate the reward, saying, 'Wherever these two are born and go, may this go to them!'"

Then, knowing that she had conceived, he kept her at ease on the upper floor of the mansion in order to care for the child. In the cold season she had the requisites for cold, and in the hot season the requisites for heat. She was given the foods prescribed by the physicians, foods not too bitter, not too sour, not too salty, not too sweet, not too pungent and not too astringent; she was nourished with foods free of the bitter, the sour, the salty, the sweet, the pungent and the astringent. Her body was adorned with necklaces and garlands, and like a divine maiden wandering in the Nandana grove, she moved from couch to couch and from seat to seat without ever descending to the ground below. And he saw to it that she heard no unpleasant sound whatsoever.

Then, when eight or nine months had passed, she gave birth. A boy was born, handsome, good to look at and beautiful, complete in all his major and minor limbs. When he was born, they held a birth celebration and named him Gaṅgika. Then the boy Gaṅgika was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry him in their laps, two nurses to suckle him, two nurses to wash away his dirt, and two nurses to play with him. Those eight nurses raised and nourished him with milk, curds, butter, ghee, the cream of butter and all other excellent kinds of provisions, so that he grew quickly, like a lotus in a lake.

He was also endowed with roots of virtue conducive to penetration. Finding no joy in living at home, he bowed at the feet of his father and mother and made this request: "Father and mother, please permit me to go forth in the teaching of the Blessed One." But because he was their only son, his parents would not allow it.

Then this thought occurred to Gaṅgika: "Gaining birth as a human being is hard to find. The appearance of a Tathāgata is also hard to find. And besides, having complete faculties is hard to find as well. Well then, what means is there for me to go forth in the teaching of the Blessed One?"

Then he thought: "Well then, I shall make an aspiration and bring about my own death, so that I may gain a human birth and go forth very quickly."

Having thought this, he drank poison, but he did not die. He leapt into fire, but he did not die. He leapt from a cliff, but he did not die. He leapt into the river Varaṇā, and there too he did not die. Then the thought occurred to him: "What other means is there for me to die?"

Then he thought: "Well then, King Ajātaśatru is fierce, violent, harsh and rash. I shall go to his palace and break into it at night." So he went to the city of Rājagṛha, and when night had come and darkness had fallen, he was breaking into the house. The guards seized him alive and brought him before King Ajātaśatru, saying, "Your Majesty, this man is a thief, a violator of the palace, an offender. At night he broke into the palace." Then the king sentenced him to death for committing a crime.

Then the executioners, wearing blue garments, with garlands of karavīra flowers about their necks and weapons in their hands, led him away. Proclaiming loudly on the highways, the streets, the crossroads, the junctions of three roads and the places of public announcement, they took him out through the southern gate of the city and led him to the charnel ground of the Cool Grove. As he was being led, he said to the executioners, "Hey! Before the king's order is reversed, lead me on quickly!"

Then the executioners reported this to the king. The king had him brought back and asked, "Man, why do you wish to give up your precious life?" Then he told the king the whole story in detail.

Then King Ajātaśatru, his hair standing on end like a kadamba flower, his eyes filled with tears and his face weeping, uttered words of joy: "Ah! Since he strives like this to give up his precious life in order to go forth, his mind stream is fully ripened. He has thoroughly understood the faults of saṃsāra. He has truly gained perfect faith."

Then the king sighed and said, "My son, I hold power over your life. Now go, and go forth in the teaching of the Blessed One." With these words the king released him.

He went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One. Through diligence, application and effort he understood that this very five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra is moving and unstable, and he ascertained that all kinds of formations are subject to decay, falling, scattering and destruction. Abandoning all afflictions, he directly realized arhatship. Having become an arhat, free from attachment to the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal. His mind was like space and like the palm of the hand. He had become cool, like sandalwood paste. With knowledge he had broken the shell of the egg. He had attained the knowledges, the superknowledges and the discriminating knowledges. He paid no heed to worldly gain, attachment or honors. He became worthy of veneration, of reverence and of respectful address by the gods, including Indra and Upendra.

Then the Blessed One said to the monks, "Monks, foremost among my śrāvaka monks who went forth through faith is this one: Gaṅgika, the son of the merchant of Vārāṇasī."

Then the monks felt doubt, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, the cutter of all doubts, "Venerable One, what deeds did Gaṅgika perform, through whose ripening fire could not harm his body, neither poison, nor weapons, nor water could bring about his death, and he also attained arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, in other, former lives Gaṅgika himself performed and accumulated deeds whose accumulations have been gathered, whose conditions have matured, which come on like a flood, and which will inevitably arrive. Since Gaṅgika himself performed and accumulated these deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element. They do not ripen in the water element, the fire element or the wind element. Virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds performed and accumulated ripen solely in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense sources.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred aeons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen as their fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, there lived in the city of Vārāṇasī a low-caste thief who stole goods from the charnel grounds. Once he robbed some travelers and obtained their goods, and afterward he was pursued by a band of ruffians. At that time, in one part of the charnel ground, a pratyekabuddha

was absorbed in the attainment of cessation. In front of him the low-caste charnel-ground thief threw down the goods and hid right there.

"Then the ruffians saw the pratyekabuddha. They struck him with stones, they cut at him with weapons and they burned him with fire. Yet because he was absorbed in the attainment of cessation, they could not move even the hem of his robe. Then, when the ruffians had grown weary and gone back, the pratyekabuddha slowly arose from his meditative absorption.

"Then the low-caste charnel-ground thief offered food to that pratyekabuddha and made this aspiration: 'May I too attain qualities such as these! Just as he cannot be harmed by others, so may I too, wherever I am born, be unharmed by others. May I please a teacher even more exalted than he is, and may I not displease him.'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who at that time, on that occasion, was the low-caste charnel-ground thief is none other than this Gaṅgika. Moreover, he went forth in the time of the Blessed One Kāśyapa, and because he there kept to the holy life, he has now directly realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, the ripening of entirely black deeds is entirely black. The ripening of entirely white deeds is entirely white. The ripening of mixed deeds is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon entirely black deeds and mixed deeds, and devote yourselves to entirely white deeds alone. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Dīrghanakha.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was respected, revered, honored and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, palace attendants, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras and mahoragas. Worshiped and renowned among gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, who received robes, alms food, bedding, seats, and medicines for the sick and other requisites, was dwelling together with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas at Rājagṛha, in the Bamboo Grove, at the Kalandaka feeding place.

At that time there lived in the village of Nālada a brahmin named Tiṣya, who had taken as his wife Śārī, the daughter of the brahmin Māṭhara. When

Śāriputra entered Śārī's womb, that woman, whenever she debated on the treatises with her brother Dīrghanakha, would bring her brother to defeat. Then this thought occurred to Dīrghanakha: "It seems that a being renowned for great merit has taken conception in her womb, and this is its power. Well then, I had better leave beforehand and settle in some other region." So Dīrghanakha went to the south and studied many treatises.

Then, in due course, Śāriputra was born. When he was sixteen years old he had mastered the grammar of Indra, and with the treatises he defeated every opponent in debate. Then, in due course, he went forth in the teaching of the Blessed One.

Some time later the wandering ascetic Dīrghanakha heard: "Your nephew defeated all those tīrthikas and has now professed himself a disciple of the śramaṇa Gautama." When he heard this, a strong sense of defeat arose in him, and the thought arose that to all the treatises there is no end.

Then, in due course, he arrived at Rājagṛha. At that time the Blessed One had risen from seclusion and was teaching the fourfold assembly the Dharma, rich in every flavor, like the unboiled honey of bees. Śāriputra too was standing before the Blessed One, holding a fan and fanning the Blessed One.

Then the wandering ascetic Dīrghanakha went to where the Blessed One was. When he arrived, the wandering ascetic Dīrghanakha saw the Blessed One seated, surrounded by his assembly like the shape of a crescent moon, teaching the Dharma, and Śāriputra standing there holding a fan and fanning the Blessed One. Seeing this, he said to the Blessed One, "Gautama, I accept nothing at all."

The Blessed One said, "Agnivaiśyāyana, this view that you hold, 'I accept nothing at all': do you not accept that either?"

"Gautama, this view that I hold, 'I accept nothing at all': that too I do not accept."

"In that case, Agnivaiśyāyana, if you know thus and see thus, this view will be abandoned, given up and discarded, and no other view will link on, be taken up or arise."

"Gautama, since I know thus and see thus, this view is abandoned, given up and discarded, and no other view will link on or arise."

"In that case, Agnivaiśyāyana, you will be in accord with many people and alike with them. Since many people also see thus and speak thus, you too are

just like them. Agnivaiśyāyana, those śramaṇas or brahmins, whoever they may be, who definitively abandon that view and do not take up another view are said to be fewer than the few in this world.

"Agnivaiśyāyana, there are these three standpoints of views. What are the three? Agnivaiśyāyana, here some see thus and speak thus: 'I accept nothing at all.' Again, here some see thus and speak thus: 'I accept everything.' Again, here some see thus and speak thus: 'I accept one thing and do not accept another.'

"Agnivaiśyāyana, of these, the view of those who see thus, 'I accept everything,' leads to attachment and not to freedom from attachment. It leads to aversion and not to freedom from aversion. It leads to delusion and not to freedom from delusion. It leads to bondage and not to release. It leads to affliction and not to purification.

It leads to increase and not to decrease; it leads to delight, to grasping and to intense clinging.

"Agnivaiśyāyana, of these, the view of those who see thus, 'I accept nothing at all,' leads to freedom from attachment and not to attachment. It leads to freedom from aversion and not to aversion. It leads to freedom from delusion and not to delusion. It leads to release and not to bondage. It leads to purification and not to affliction. It leads to decrease and not to increase; it leads to no delight, no grasping and no intense clinging.

"Agnivaiśyāyana, of these, as for the view of those who see thus, 'I accept one thing and do not accept another': first, what they accept leads to attachment and not to freedom from attachment. It leads to aversion and not to freedom from aversion. It leads to delusion and not to freedom from delusion. It leads to bondage and not to release. It leads to affliction and not to purification. It leads to increase and not to decrease; it leads to delight, to grasping and to intense clinging. What they do not accept leads to freedom from attachment and not to attachment. It leads to freedom from aversion and not to aversion. It leads to freedom from delusion and not to delusion. It leads to release and not to bondage. It leads to purification and not to affliction. It leads to decrease and not to increase; it leads to no delight, no grasping and no intense clinging.

"Here the learned noble śrāvaka trains in reflecting thus: 'If I were to see thus and speak thus, "I accept everything," then I would quarrel with both of these: with the one who sees thus and speaks thus, "I accept nothing at all," and with

the one who sees thus and speaks thus, "I accept one thing and do not accept another." If I quarrel, there will be dispute. If there is dispute, there will be harm.' Seeing rightly that this involves quarreling, involves dispute and involves harm, he abandons that view and does not take up another view. In this way that view is abandoned, given up and cleared away, and no other view links on, is taken up or arises.

"Here the learned noble śrāvaka trains in reflecting thus: 'If I were to see thus and speak thus, "I accept nothing at all," then I would quarrel with both of these: with the one who sees thus and speaks thus, "I accept everything," and with the one who sees thus and speaks thus, "I accept one thing and do not accept another." If I quarrel, there will be dispute. If there is dispute, there will be harm.' Seeing rightly that this involves quarreling, involves dispute and involves harm, he abandons that view and does not take up another view. In this way that view is abandoned, given up and cleared away, and no other view links on, is taken up or arises.

"Here the learned noble śrāvaka trains in reflecting thus: 'If I were to see thus and speak thus, "I accept one thing and do not accept another," then I would quarrel with both of these: with the one who sees thus and speaks thus, "I accept everything," and with the one who sees thus and speaks thus, "I accept nothing at all." If I quarrel, there will be dispute. If there is dispute, there will be harm.' Seeing rightly that this involves quarreling, involves dispute and involves harm, he abandons that view and does not take up another view. In this way that view is abandoned, given up and cleared away, and no other view links on, is taken up or arises.

"Agnivaiśyāyana, this body is material and gross, arisen from the four great elements as its cause. The noble śrāvaka should dwell contemplating it as ceaselessly arising and perishing. He should dwell contemplating freedom from attachment, contemplating cessation and contemplating relinquishment. When the noble śrāvaka dwells contemplating its ceaseless arising and perishing, then whatever desire for the body, affection for the body, cherishing of the body, dwelling upon the body, attachment to the body and intense clinging to the body he has, his mind does not remain overpowered by it.

"Agnivaiśyāyana, there are these three feelings. What are the three? Pleasant, painful, and neither painful nor pleasant. When the learned noble śrāvaka experiences a pleasant feeling, at that time the other two, the painful feeling and the feeling that is neither painful nor pleasant, cease for him. At that time

the noble śrāvaka experiences only the pleasant feeling, and that pleasant feeling too is impermanent and subject to cessation. When the noble śrāvaka experiences a painful feeling, at that time the other two, the pleasant feeling and the feeling that is neither painful nor pleasant, cease for him. At that time the noble śrāvaka experiences only the painful feeling, and that painful feeling too is impermanent and subject to cessation.

When the noble śrāvaka experiences a feeling that is neither painful nor pleasant, at that time the other two, the pleasant feeling and the painful feeling, cease for him. At that time the noble śrāvaka experiences only the feeling that is neither painful nor pleasant, and that feeling which is neither painful nor pleasant is also impermanent and subject to cessation.

"He thinks: 'What is the basis of these feelings? What gives rise to them? What is their origin? What brings them into being? The basis of these feelings is contact. What gives rise to them is contact. Their origin is contact. What brings them into being is contact. When this or that contact arises, this or that feeling arises; when this or that contact ceases, this or that feeling ceases, is stilled, becomes cool and comes to an end.' Having thought this, whenever he experiences any feeling, whether pleasant, painful, or neither painful nor pleasant, he understands, correctly and as it really is, the arising of those feelings, their passing away, their decline, their danger and the escape from them. Since he understands, correctly and as it really is, the arising of those feelings, their passing away, their decline, their danger and the escape from them, he dwells contemplating every feeling that arises as impermanent, contemplating it as perishing, contemplating its cessation and contemplating its relinquishment.

"When he experiences a feeling that lasts as long as the body, he understands, correctly and as it really is, 'I am experiencing a feeling that lasts as long as the body.' When he experiences a feeling that lasts as long as life, he understands, correctly and as it really is, 'I am experiencing a feeling that lasts as long as life. When life reaches its end and I am parted from the body, all my feelings without exception will cease right here; they will come to an end without remainder, be completely exhausted and be finished.'

"He thinks: 'At the time of parting from the body, even if I experience a pleasant feeling, that itself is the end of suffering. At the time of parting from the body, even if I experience a painful feeling, or a feeling that is neither painful nor pleasant, that itself is the end of suffering.'

"When he experiences a pleasant feeling, he experiences it unbound, and not bound. When he experiences a painful feeling, or a feeling that is neither painful nor pleasant, he experiences it unbound, and not bound. Unbound from what? I declare that he is unbound from attachment, aversion and delusion; unbound from birth, old age, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness and distress; unbound from suffering."

At that time the venerable Śāriputra had been fully ordained for half a month, and he was standing at the Blessed One's side, holding a fan and fanning the Blessed One. Then the venerable Śāriputra thought: "The Blessed One speaks only of the abandoning of these various dharmas. He speaks only of freedom from attachment to them, only of their cessation, only of their relinquishment. Well then, I too had better dwell contemplating the abandoning of these various dharmas. I had better dwell contemplating freedom from attachment, contemplating cessation and contemplating relinquishment."

Then the venerable Śāriputra, dwelling in contemplation of these various dharmas as impermanent, contemplating them as perishing, contemplating freedom from attachment, contemplating cessation and contemplating relinquishment, freed his mind from the defilements without grasping.

And in the wandering ascetic Dīrghanakha there arose, with regard to dharmas, the Dharma eye, free of dust and free of stain. Then the wandering ascetic Dīrghanakha, having seen the Dharma, heard the Dharma, understood the Dharma and plumbed the depths of the Dharma, crossed beyond hesitation and crossed beyond doubt. No longer depending on others and no longer led by others, he gained fearlessness in the teachings of the Teacher's doctrine. He rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, bowed with joined palms toward the Blessed One, and said to the Blessed One, "Venerable One, if I may go forth in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya, receive full ordination and attain the state of a monk, I wish to live the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One."

Then the wandering ascetic Dīrghanakha went forth in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya, received full ordination and attained the state of a monk. Having gone forth in this way, that venerable one dwelt alone and secluded, heedful, ardent and resolute. Dwelling alone and secluded, heedful, ardent and resolute, he realized in this very life, through his own higher knowledge, that unsurpassed culmination of the holy life for the sake of which sons of good family shave off their hair and beard, put on saffron robes, and with

perfect faith go forth from home into homelessness. Having accomplished it and experienced it, he knew fully: "My births are exhausted. I have lived the holy life. I have done what was to be done. I know no further existence beyond this one." That venerable one became an arhat, his mind perfectly liberated.

Then the Blessed One said to the monks, "Monks, foremost among my śrāvaka monks who have attained the discriminating knowledges is this one: the monk Sthūlakoṣṭhaka."

Then the monks felt doubt, and they asked the Buddha, the Blessed One, the cutter of all doubts, "Venerable One, what deeds did Sthūlakoṣṭhaka perform, so that he became a great expounder of the treatises, and after going forth directly realized arhatship?"

The Blessed One said, "In other, former lives Sthūlakoṣṭhaka himself performed and accumulated deeds whose accumulations have been gathered, whose conditions have matured, which come on like a flood, and which will inevitably arrive. Since Sthūlakoṣṭhaka himself performed and accumulated these deeds, who else would experience them? Monks, deeds performed and accumulated do not ripen in the external earth element. They do not ripen in the water element, the fire element or the wind element. Virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds performed and accumulated ripen solely in the appropriated aggregates, elements and sense sources.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred aeons.
When the conditions gather and the time arrives,
They ripen as their fruit.

"Monks, long ago, in times past, in the city of Vārāṇasī, five hundred ruffians led by a chieftain set out as thieves. After traveling for some time, they came to a khadira forest, and their leader said, 'You lotus-eyed ones, look and see whether there are any other people here. Then we will make an offering to the yakṣa and go on.'

"The ruffians searched all around, and seeing a pratyekabuddha sitting in that khadira forest, they seized him and led him before their chieftain. Then the chieftain of the ruffians commanded, 'Kill him!'

"Then, in order to benefit them, the pratyekabuddha rose into the sky like a king of geese spreading his wings, and displayed many kinds of miracles. Then the chieftain of the ruffians fell at his feet like a tree cut at the root, confessed

his wrongdoing, offered him food, and made this aspiration: 'May I too attain qualities such as these! May I please a teacher even more exalted than he is, and may I not displease him.'"

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? The one who at that time, on that occasion, was the chieftain of the ruffians is this great Sthūlakoṣṭhaka. Moreover, he went forth in the time of the Blessed One Kāśyapa, and there for ten thousand years he kept to the holy life. Because of that, he has now directly realized arhatship.

"Thus, monks, the ripening of entirely black deeds is entirely black. The ripening of entirely white deeds is entirely white. The ripening of mixed deeds is mixed. Therefore, monks, abandon entirely black deeds and mixed deeds, and devote yourselves to entirely white deeds alone. Monks, this is how you should train."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The story called Truly Lovely.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was respected, revered, honored and worshiped by kings, great ministers, the wealthy, palace attendants, merchants, caravan leaders, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras and mahoragas. Worshiped and renowned among gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras and mahoragas, the Buddha, the Blessed One, possessed of great merit, who received robes, alms food, bedding, seats, and medicines for the sick and other requisites, was dwelling together with his Saṅgha of śrāvakas near the city of Kuśinagarī, at the Upavartana of the Mallas, in the grove of the twin sāla trees.

Then, when the time had come for the Blessed One to pass into parinirvāṇa, he said to the venerable Ānanda, "Ānanda, tonight at midnight the Tathāgata will pass into parinirvāṇa in the realm of nirvāṇa without remainder of the aggregates. Prepare the Tathāgata's couch between the twin sāla trees, with its head toward the north."

"Venerable One, I will do so," he replied. The venerable Ānanda, just as the Blessed One had told him, prepared the couch between the twin sāla trees with its head toward the north. Then he went to where the Blessed One was, and when he arrived, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and stood to one side. Standing to one side, the venerable Ānanda said to the Blessed

One, "Venerable One, I have prepared the Tathāgata's couch between the twin sāla trees, with its head toward the north."

Then the Blessed One went to where the couch was, and when he arrived he lay down on his right side, placing one foot upon the other. Having placed one foot upon the other, endowed with the perception of light, with mindfulness and with vigilance, he held in his mind only the perception of nirvāṇa. And there, at midnight, the Blessed One passed into parinirvāṇa in the realm of nirvāṇa without remainder of the aggregates.

The very instant the Buddha, the Blessed One, had passed into parinirvāṇa, the great earth shook violently, meteors fell, the horizons blazed, and from the sky divine drums resounded. The instant the Buddha, the Blessed One, passed into parinirvāṇa, the twin sāla trees, finest of the trees of the forest, bowed down and scattered flowers over the Tathāgata as he lay in the lion's posture.

The very instant the Buddha, the Blessed One, had passed into parinirvāṇa, a certain monk spoke this verse:

These two finest trees of the sāla grove,
Graced with beauty,
Scatter flowers all around
Upon the Teacher who has passed beyond sorrow.

The very instant the Buddha, the Blessed One, had passed into parinirvāṇa, Śakra, lord of the gods, spoke this verse:

Alas, all formations are impermanent;
Their nature is to arise and to perish.
Having arisen, they cease;
Their stilling is bliss.

The very instant the Buddha, the Blessed One, had passed into parinirvāṇa, Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, spoke this verse:

In this world all sentient beings
Must surely cast off their bodies.
Even such a Teacher as this,
Who had no equal in this world,
The Tathāgata who attained the powers,
The One with Eyes, has passed into parinirvāṇa.

The very instant the Buddha, the Blessed One, had passed into parinirvāṇa, the venerable Aniruddha spoke these verses:

The Protector, whose mind was steadfast,
When the breath that moves out and in had ceased,
Resting in the unmoving and the peaceful,
The One with Eyes passed into parinirvāṇa.

When the Teacher, endowed with the supreme in every aspect,
Passed away,
Then a great terror arose,
Then the hair stood on end.

With a mind that did not falter
He accepted the feelings.
Like a lamp that has gone out,
His mind was fully liberated.

When seven days had passed since the Buddha, the Blessed One, had passed into parinirvāṇa, the venerable Ānanda, circumambulating the funeral pyre that had been raised for the Blessed One, spoke these verses:

The Guide's precious body, of great miraculous power,
He who has gone to the world of Brahmā,
Was burned by flames that sprang from his own body.
It had been wrapped in five hundred pairs of cloths.

With a full thousand garments and Dharma robes
The body of the Buddha had been wholly wrapped.
Yet there, of the cloths, the inner and the outer,
These two were not burned at all.

When a hundred years had passed since the Buddha, the Blessed One, had passed into parinirvāṇa, King Aśoka was reigning in the city called Pāṭaliputra. During his reign the land was prosperous, flourishing, and happy, with good harvests, full of many folk and people; quarrels and fighting were stilled, and there was no strife, no internal unrest, no robbers, no famine, and no disease; it was rich in sāli rice, sugar cane, cattle, and buffalo. He was righteous, a Dharma king who ruled in accordance with the Dharma.

Then, some time later, he sported, made merry, and took his pleasure together with his queen. As he sported, made merry, and took his pleasure, the queen later conceived, and when eight or nine months had passed a son was born. She gave birth to a boy who was handsome, good to look upon, and beautiful, whose eyes were like the eyes of the kuṇāla bird.

Then, after the birth feast had been held for him, they set about naming him, asking, "What name shall this boy be given?" The relatives said, "From the very moment he was born his eyes have been like the eyes of the kuṇāla bird, and so this boy shall be named Kuṇāla."

Then the boy Kuṇāla was entrusted to eight nurses: two nurses to carry him on the lap, two nurses to suckle him, two nurses to wash away his dirt, and two nurses to play with him. These eight nurses reared and nourished him with milk, curds, butter, ghee, and the cream of butter, and with every other kind of fine provision, and he grew up swiftly, like a lotus in a lake.

Then, adorned with every ornament, he was taken onto the king's lap. The king gazed at him again and again and took his fill of delight in his perfect looks, and he said, "In all the world there is no one equal in looks to my son."

Now at that time, in the land of Earth-Holder, there was a village called Great Flower Load. There a son was born to a certain householder, one who surpassed the complexion of humans though he had not attained the complexion of the gods. When he was born, there appeared a jeweled pool filled with fragrant divine water, and a great pleasure garden, perfect in flowers and fruits, which was able to move; wherever the boy went, there the pool and the pleasure garden would appear. The boy was given the name Sundara.

Then, some time later, when the boy had grown up, some merchants from the village of Great Flower Load went on some business to the land of Pāṭaliputra. Taking gifts with them, they went before King Aśoka. They bowed at the king's feet, offered their gifts, and sat down before him. Then King Aśoka showed them his son Kuṇāla and asked, "O merchants, in all your wanderings, have you ever before seen, anywhere at all, anyone of such distinguished looks as this?"

Then the merchants joined their palms, bowed low, and bowed at his feet, and having begged not to be held at fault, they said to the king, "Your Majesty, in our land there is a boy called Sundara, who surpasses the complexion of humans though he has not attained the complexion of the gods. When he was born, there appeared a jeweled pool filled with fragrant divine water, and a great pleasure garden, perfect in flowers and fruits, which is able to move; wherever the boy goes, there the pool and the pleasure garden appear."

When King Aśoka heard this, he was utterly amazed and wished to see him, and he sent a messenger with this message: "King Aśoka wishes to come to

see the boy Sundara, so do whatever needs to be done or prepared." At this most of the people were frightened, thinking, "If the king comes here with a great army, will that not bring great harm?"

So they made ready a fine mount for the boy and sent him to King Aśoka with a gift of a hundred thousand pearl necklaces. Traveling on by stages, he came to the city of Pāṭaliputra and, bearing the hundred thousand pearl necklaces, went before King Aśoka. Then King Aśoka saw the beauty of the boy Sundara's looks and the radiance of his complexion, and the divine pool and the pleasure garden, and the instant he saw them he was utterly amazed.

Then King Aśoka, wishing to show this wonder to the elder Upagupta, took the boy Sundara with him and went to the Kukkuṭārāma. At that Kukkuṭārāma there dwelt eighteen thousand arhats, headed by Upagupta, and twice that number of trainees and virtuous ordinary beings. The boy bowed at the elder's feet and sat down before him to listen to the Dharma, and the elder Upagupta taught him the Dharma.

That boy's mental continuum was fully ripened, and on hearing the Dharma he wished to go forth. He asked leave of King Aśoka and went forth in the presence of the elder Upagupta. Through application, practice, and effort, he understood that this very wheel of saṃsāra with its five spokes is moving and unstable, and he ascertained that all kinds of formations are by nature subject to decay, to falling, to scattering, and to destruction. Abandoning all afflictions, he directly realized arhatship.

Having become an arhat, free from attachment to the three realms, he regarded gold and a clod of earth as equal; his mind was the same toward space and the palm of his hand; he had become cool like sandalwood paste; with knowledge he had broken the shell of the egg; he had attained the knowledges, the superknowledges, and the analytical knowledges; he turned away from worldly gain, craving, and honors; and he became one worthy to be worshiped, honored, and respectfully addressed by the gods together with Indra and Upendra.

Then a doubt arose in King Aśoka, and he asked the elder Upagupta, "Venerable one, what deeds did Sundara perform, that he came to have such looks as these? What deeds did he perform, that there appeared a jeweled pool filled with fragrant divine water, and a great pleasure garden, perfect in flowers and fruits, that is able to move?"

The elder Upagupta said, "Great king, in other, former lives, Sundara himself performed and accumulated those deeds, whose collections have come together and whose conditions have matured, which arise like a flood and will inevitably come to pass. Since Sundara himself performed and accumulated those deeds, who else would experience them? Great king, deeds that have been performed and accumulated do not ripen in the outer earth element, nor do they ripen in the water element, the fire element, or the wind element. Virtuous and nonvirtuous deeds that have been performed and accumulated ripen only in the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources.

The deeds of embodied beings
Are not lost even in a hundred aeons.
When they have gathered and their time has come,
They ripen as their fruit.

"Great king, long ago, at the time when the Blessed One had passed into parinirvāṇa, the venerable Mahākāśyapa, with a retinue of five hundred, was wandering through the land of Magadha, wishing to compile the Dharma. At one point, a certain poor merchant saw that most of the community of monks were overwhelmed by grief at being parted from the Teacher, were weary from their journeying, and had their bodies covered with dust. Compassion arose in him, and he invited the five hundred monks headed by Mahākāśyapa to a bath performed with due ceremony. He offered warm water scented with various perfumes, washed the bodies of the monks, and washed their robes as well. He also satisfied them with fine food, and then he took refuge and received the bases of training, and he made this aspiration: 'May I go forth in this very teaching of the Blessed One Śākyamuni and directly realize arhatship.'

"What do you think, great king? The one who at that time, on that occasion, was the poor merchant is this monk Sundara. Because he gave the monks a bath performed with due ceremony, he now has such distinguished looks as these, and there appeared a jeweled pool filled with fragrant divine water, and a great pleasure garden, perfect in flowers and fruits, that is able to move. Because he took refuge and received the bases of training, he has directly realized arhatship in this very life.

"Thus, great king, wholly black deeds have a wholly black ripening, wholly white deeds have a wholly white ripening, and mixed deeds have a mixed ripening. Therefore, great king, abandon wholly black deeds and mixed deeds,

and devote yourself only to wholly white deeds. Great king, this is how you should train."

Then King Aśoka praised what the elder Upagupta had taught, rejoiced in it, rose from his seat, and departed.

Here ends the tenth summary verse of the Hundred Avadānas, and the Hundred Avadānas Beginning with Pūrṇa is complete.

This was translated and finalized by the Indian preceptor Jinamitra and the chief editor-translator, Bandé Devacandra.

Translator's Notes

• The summary verse names the stories of this first chapter. Some of its names are hard to split with certainty. □□□□□□□□□ may be "Pūrṇabhadra" or "the good Pūrṇa". □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read here as "Great Candra and Padma", but it could also mean "Candra and Mahāpadma". The lazy one and the caravan leaders are given in their meanings. The Sanskrit title is romanized as the Tibetan spells it. □□□□□□□ in the Buddha's words to the monks is read in its usual sense in this genre, "get ready".
• The cold hells are given in English, in the order this text lists them. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ does not read well as written. It is translated as "do not show a smile without reason", which the parallel stanza earlier in the same set of verses supports.
• The future buddha's name, written □□□□□□□□□, is probably Pūrṇabhadra. It is kept here as "the good Pūrṇa" so that it matches the summary verse.
• In the third of Ānanda's verses the Tibetan reads "rnams gyin da 'dzum mi ston," which makes little sense; given the parallel line in the preceding verse and the Sanskrit formula (nākāraṇaṃ ... smitam), it is taken as a scribal slip for a phrase meaning "without reason." The order of the cold hells follows this text (Aṭaṭa, Huhuva, Hahava). The buddha name rin chen ldan is rendered Ratnavat as the standard Sanskrit equivalent ("Possessor of Jewels"). The "king who turns the wheel by force" renders stobs kyi 'khor los sgyur ba (balacakravartin).
• The boy's name dga' byed ("one who causes delight") is explained by the text itself; its Sanskrit original cannot be identified with confidence (perhaps Nandaka or Nandana), so it is translated as "Delighter." The opening words "le lo can zhes bya ba ni" give the title of this story, "The Lazy One." "Nandana Grove" renders dga' ba'i tshal, the pleasure grove of the gods.
• The phrase "grum po bzhin du lnga re 'dug pa" is obscure; it is taken in its evident sense of sitting idle "like a cripple." "Pūraṇa" renders rdzogs byed, Pūraṇa Kāśyapa, foremost of the six tīrthika teachers. "Lord of the thousandfold world" renders brgya phrag bcu pa la dbang byed pa (Skt. daśaśatavaśavartin), an epithet of Brahmā.
• As in the earlier smile passage, "rnams gyin da 'dzum mi ston" in Ānanda's third verse is taken as a scribal slip for a phrase meaning "without reason," following the parallel line and the Sanskrit formula. The future buddha's name, stobs dang brtson 'grus dang mthu rtsal dang shin tu ldan pa, is translated into English because its Sanskrit form cannot be fixed with confidence (perhaps something like Balavīryaparākrama).
• "Restraining his own mind" renders "bdag gi sems la brgyad bkag nas," where brgyad ("eight") makes no sense; the evident sense is that he checked his own mind, perhaps reading rgyab bkag. "A quarter of a coin" renders zho'i bzhi cha gcig, a quarter of a small silver unit, stressing the trifling price.

• In Ānanda's second verse, the Tibetan reads gsum mchog ("supreme three"), which makes no sense; it is taken as a slip for gsung mchog ("supreme speech"), which fits the line. In the fourth verse the syllables gyin da are unclear; they are rendered "for no reason," in line with the parallel phrase in the preceding verse. The buddha name Spos mchog is rendered Gandhottama. The weaver's name Zla ba is rendered Candra ("Moon").
• The future buddha's name, Tshar tshar bla ma, could not be identified with a Sanskrit form with confidence; it is translated by meaning as "Supreme Fringe," echoing the strips of fringe (tshar tshar) the weaver offered.
• The name of the guild master's son, Che ba, could not be identified with a Sanskrit form with confidence, so it is translated by meaning as "Great." The syllables gyin da in the fourth verse of Ānanda's request are unclear and are rendered "for no reason," in line with the parallel phrase in the preceding verse.
• The herb named shi ri ka is given as "śirika," following the Tibetan spelling; it cannot be securely identified.
• The text here names the future buddha Śākyamuni; this is translated as it stands. The "sūtra like a youth" (gzhon nu lta bu'i mdo) is taken as the Daharasūtra, the discourse by which Prasenajit was won over to the Buddha.
• In the last verse, the syllables □□□□□□ in "the protectors, the perfect buddhas ... display a smile" do not make sense as written; following the context and the stock form of this verse, the line is taken to mean "not without reason," and is translated so. The rare term □□ is rendered as balacakravartin, a wheel-turning king who rules by force, as distinct from the universal monarch proper.
• □□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as the standard rendering of the buddha name Padmottara. In "those two learned that the Blessed One had come to their country," the two are the two kings of Pañcāla; it is the Blessed One's miraculous power that emanates the fourfold army.
• In the last verse, the syllables □□□□□□ do not make sense as written; following the context and the stock form of this verse, the line is taken to mean "not without reason." Pūraṇa (□□□□□□□□□□) is Pūraṇa Kāśyapa, one of the six non-Buddhist teachers.
• The Tibetan says "the fire died out," although only flowers, incense and water are named; the fire is evidently that of the burning incense.
• In the last verse, the syllables □□□□□□ do not make sense as written; following the context and the stock form of this verse, the line is taken to mean "not without reason." The future buddha's name □□□□□□□□ is given as Acala.
• The text reads □□□□□□, evidently a copyist's slip for □□□□□□ ("how"), which is translated. "Lotus Filament" renders □□□□□□□□□□□, the name of a battle formation; the exact Sanskrit term is not certain. The second account of Ajātaśatru's rout has □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("looked back") where the earlier ones have □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("turned his back"); it is rendered in the same sense.
• The river □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as the Ajiravatī, the river at Śrāvastī, whose name ("having courtyards") this Tibetan appears to render; the identification is probable but not certain. In Ānanda's third verse the syllables □□□□□□ are obscure; they are read, in line with the parallel verse and the Buddha's reply, as "without a reason." The Buddha's name □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("Giver of Fearlessness") is given as Abhayada. In the summary verse, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is divided into two titles, "Praise" and "the Boon-Giver," to yield the ten stories of the decade; this division is uncertain. The colophon line ends with the misspelling □□□□□□□□□ for □□□□□□□□.
• The buddha's name □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("Fortunate Chariot") is given as Bhagīratha, the name that □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ usually renders; the identification is probable rather than certain. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as "together with Viśvakarman," taking □□□□ as a slip;

□□□□□□□□□□□ is the standard rendering of Viśvakarman, the divine craftsman.
• □□□□□ is rendered as Śiva, whose epithet (Paśupati, "lord of cattle") it represents.
• "Five factors" (yan lag lnga) abandoned and "six qualities" (yan lag drug) possessed follow the stock Avadānaśataka epithet (pañcāṅgaviprahīṇa, ṣaḍaṅgasamanvāgata). The phrase rendered "whose accumulations had matured" (tshogs rnyed) renders the stock labdhasambhāra, more literally "having obtained the accumulations."
• The country called □□□□□□□□□ (and □□□□□□□□□□□) is rendered literally as "Reed Grove"; I could not identify its Sanskrit name with confidence. "Kalandaka Feeding Ground" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (Skt. Kalandakanivāpa).
• The brahmins' invocation of Śakra, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, is rendered literally ("husband of the Boneless Lady"). It evidently translates a Vedic epithet of Indra (perhaps one referring to Ahalyā, as in Ahalyājāra), but I cannot identify the underlying Sanskrit with confidence; □□□□□□□□ could also be simply "man."
• The buddha's name □□□□□□□□□□ is given as Indradamana, the form found in the Sanskrit Avadānaśataka. The rendering "latticework" for □□□□□□ is tentative; the architectural terms in the description of the monastery are not all certain.
• The text names the festival as the Five-Year Festival, but in the clause on its continuing in future times it reads "festival of the fifth day" (□□□□□□□); this may be a slip for □□□□□□□, but it is translated as written. The word □□□ in "the monks heard those very words" is unclear; it is taken as "here and there" (scattered), though it could also be read as "at dawn".
• The name of the past buddha, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, is translated by its meaning, Jewel Mountain, since its Sanskrit form could not be identified with confidence. The phrase rendered "twenty-one modulations" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) refers to the melodic modes or modulations (probably mūrchanā) of Indian music theory. The clause about the six great cities is terse; it is taken to mean that Supriya had outplayed the musicians there and declared those cities of no account.
• "Putting him off" renders □□□□□□, taken in its sense of delaying or deferring. "Elements of mind" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□) may refer to the elements of consciousness.
• The name of the future pratyekabuddhas, □□□□□□□, is translated by its meaning, Sweet Voice, since its Sanskrit form could not be identified with confidence. In Ānanda's verse, □□□□□□ is taken as "for no purpose", in line with the parallel "without cause or condition".
• The name of the past buddha, □□□□□□□□□, is translated by its meaning, Realizer, since its Sanskrit form could not be identified with confidence.
• The man's plea, "since I am worthy of the sublime gift" (bdag ni dam pa stsal ba'i 'os lags kyis), is terse and its exact sense is uncertain; it may mean that he is a fit recipient of the Buddha's excellent gift of protection. "Broken the shell of the egg" is the stock image of breaking through the eggshell of ignorance. The monks' remark that "everything is accomplished by the Blessed One's mere intention" is translated as it stands, though the Buddha's reply addresses the karmic background of the man's story. The name dbang po'i rgyal mtshan is rendered Indradhvaja.
• "Show the openness of his house" renders khyim yangs par bstan pa literally; the intended sense, probably the king's generous hospitality, is not entirely certain. The brahmin's words "I am worthy of receiving the sublime" (dam pa stsol ba'i 'os) are terse; they echo the same formula in the preceding story. Thags zangs ris is identified as the asura king Vemacitrin, and nor sbyin as Dhanada, an epithet of Kubera.
• The name of the past buddha, bde mdzad, is rendered Śaṅkara, its usual Sanskrit equivalent. "The finest sandalwood" renders tsan dan sa mchog, whose exact variety is uncertain.
• The goddess named bde sogs could not be identified with confidence; her name is translated by its meaning as "Gatherer of Bliss." The elephants sa srung gi bu and rab brtan are identified as Airāvaṇa and Supratiṣṭhita, and dga' byed kyi tshal as the Nandana Grove of the

Thirty-Three.

• The name of the future buddha, lha'i zas sbyin, could not be identified with confidence in Sanskrit and is translated by its meaning, "Giver of Divine Food."

• In the summary verse, several story titles are rendered by their meaning (the Ten-Headed, Soft Complexion, Cool Light, the Boatman, Rising Fragrance, Sweet Voice), since I cannot be fully certain of the Sanskrit forms; they likely correspond to the Avadānaśataka titles Daśaśiras, Sūkṣmatvac, Śītaprabha, Nāvika, Gandhamādana, and Valgusvara. The Ten-Headed and the others are the titles of the following stories in this section. The text reads □□□□□ at the start of the explanation of the three conditions; I have taken it as □□□□□, "rather," which the sense requires.

• The phrase rendered "a sprinkling of perfumed water" uses the word that elsewhere means empowerment; here, as an offering to a stūpa, it plainly means a ritual sprinkling or ablution. The final exhortation in the Tibetan addresses the monks with a singular "you"; it is rendered as in the parallel passages.

• The name of the future pratyekabuddha, literally "Supreme Lotus," is rendered Padmottara, its evident Sanskrit form.

• The future pratyekabuddha's name, literally "Supreme Wheel," is rendered Cakrottara, its evident Sanskrit form, on the pattern of Padmottara in the previous story.

• The phrase rendered "give birth ... crying out in distress" reads literally "was giving birth to a son and uttering bad sounds." "Three weeks, twenty-one days" renders the Tibetan's doubled expression of the period of the birth celebration.

• "Set his mind firmly on an aspiration" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, which in this genre stands for the Sanskrit idiom of making a resolve (praṇidhāna); the content of the aspiration follows later in the story.

• In Ānanda's second verse, □□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□, "by your own understanding," which the sense requires. In the fourth verse, the unclear □□□□□□ is rendered "without reason," as the context of the stock verse demands. "Bam po seven" marks the beginning of the seventh section (fascicle) of the collection.

• The "brahmin's son who was swollen with pride" is given descriptively, as the Tibetan gives it; it likely refers to the proud brahmin youth (Skt. perhaps Mānastabdha) whom the Buddha converted, but the identification is not certain. The "twenty peaks" are the twenty forms of the view of the perishable collection (satkāyadṛṣṭi), four for each of the five aggregates.

• The name of the future pratyekabuddha, □□□□□□□□□□, is translated by its meaning ("Crosser of Saṃsāra"), since the Sanskrit form could not be identified with confidence. In the verse "do not display a smile without reason," the written □□□□□□ makes no sense in context; it has been read as a scribal slip for an expression meaning "without cause" (matching the parallel line earlier in the same set of verses).

• The story title □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is translated by its meaning ("Wafting Fragrance"), as its Sanskrit form could not be identified with confidence.

• As in the previous episode, the written □□□□□□ in the verse line "Do not display a smile without reason" makes no sense as it stands and has been read as an expression meaning "without cause." The phrase □□□□□□□□□□ describing the nyagrodha tree is rendered as "as tall as it was broad"; the exact sense of □□□□ here is uncertain.

• As in the earlier episodes, the written □□□□□□ in the verse line "Do not display a smile without reason" has been read as an expression meaning "without cause."

• In Ānanda's verse, □□□□□□ (in "do not display a smile without purpose") makes no sense as written; it is taken as a slip for a phrase meaning "idly, without purpose," which the parallel verse requires. In the summary verse, □□□□□ ("Morsel") and □□□□□□ ("Peaceful") are translated by meaning, since their Sanskrit titles cannot be fixed with confidence; the other titles follow the standard Sanskrit forms. The "members of the association" (□□□□□□□□□□) are the

companions of a lay society or club whose offering was told in the preceding story.
• □□□□ (twice) makes no sense as written and is read as □□□□□, "to heal" / "remedy"; □□□□□ is read as □□□□□, "tears." The river □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is translated by meaning ("Turner-Back") since its Sanskrit name cannot be identified with confidence. In the description of nirvāṇa, □□□□□□□ is obscure; the phrase is rendered by its evident sense, "the ultimate end."
• The queen's name, □□□□□□□□, is rendered by its meaning, "Evil-Minded," as its Sanskrit original could not be identified with confidence. "Cleared away the thorns of the realm" renders the idiom for having subdued enemies and troublemakers.
• The clause about the king, literally "having become without entanglement in sensual passion," is taken to describe his prior character, contrasting with the anger that now overcomes him. The phrase □□□□□□□□, rendered "tried to calm him," is obscure. Dharmapāla's plea to his father (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) appears corrupt as transmitted; it is rendered by its evident sense, reading a greeting such as □□□□□□□□□□. □□□□□□□□ in the monk's reaction is uncertain and is rendered "eager."
• The palace name □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ could not be identified with a Sanskrit original and is translated by its meaning, "Great Sound of Peace." The description of the vulture (□□□) is obscure and is rendered by its apparent sense, "of fearsome, overbearing aspect."
• The verse's third line reads "freed from fears" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□); the familiar form of this saying has "freed from what is dear" there, but the line is translated as it stands. Guhyaka, "the hidden one," is an epithet of yakṣas used in addressing the yakṣa. Kauśika is a name of Śakra.
• "The sacred fire" renders □□, "fire," here meaning the household sacrificial fire as an object of veneration. Maitrakanyaka's name means "Maitra's girl," which the advice at the end of this passage explains.
• The passage opens with □□□□□, which in context must carry the sense "rather, in fact" (perhaps a slip for □□□□□); the meaning follows the stock Avadāna formula of the three conditions for conception. □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as the stock sahadharmika deities, "those who share his nature." In this passage □□□ is the ordinary word for heat and pungent taste, □□□□□□□□□ is the adjective "handsome," and □□□□ is "lotus," not the names listed for earlier pieces.
• The four places are identified from the Sanskrit Maitrakanyaka story: □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ = Ramaṇaka, □□□□□□□□□□□□ = Sadāmatta, □□□□□□□□ = Nandana, □□□□□□□□□□□□□ = Brahmottara. Among the five hired crew, □□□□□ is here a common noun for a ship's hand ("boatman") rather than a name, and □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is understood as the keeper of the birds released to find land; that identification is tentative.
• The training formula after "you should not harm them" is compressed in the Tibetan; it is read as a resolution the monks are to adopt, that the faults of Maitrakanyaka's time as an ordinary being not arise and that qualities like those he gained as a god be attained. The gems □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□ are rendered conventionally as emerald and sapphire; their exact identification is uncertain. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered literally as "people of the royal court" (the Sanskrit stock list has "townspeople").
• "Five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□, corresponding to the stock Sanskrit pañcagaṇḍaka, referring to the five destinies.
• In Ānanda's own statement the text reads □□□□ ("doer"), which makes no sense there; it is translated as □□□□ ("half"), the reading found in the Blessed One's reply. The rain of Mahendra (□□□□□□□) is the rain sent by the great Indra, lord of the gods.
• The prince's name, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, "Seeker of Well-Spoken Words," corresponds to Subhāṣitagaveṣin, the hero of the parallel story in the Sanskrit Avadānaśataka. The eight nurses and their duties follow the stock avadāna description. In the king's verse, □□□□□□ and □□□□ are ordinary words here ("most excellent," "lotuses"), not the names listed earlier.

• The opening "Anāthapiṇḍada" is the title of this story. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as a door-post or threshold pillar (perhaps Skt. indrakīla) set in the ground, an image of immovability. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as Viśākhā, the mother of Mṛgāra, and the pair □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□ as Ṛṣidatta and Purāṇa, Prasenajit's chamberlains known from the Sanskrit sources.
• "Twin sāla trees" renders □□□□□□□□□□; □□□□□□□ is taken as Upavartana, the Mallas' sāla grove near Kuśinagara, as in the Sanskrit parinirvāṇa narratives. The passage ends as the Blessed One begins to speak; his words follow in the next piece.
• The six teachers are identified with the standard Sanskrit forms of their names. In the verse, □□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□, "knowledge and conduct" (vidyā-caraṇa), since "feet touching" makes no sense in context. The "first to fourth ascetic" are the four stages of attainment, from stream-enterer to arhat. In the monks' closing words, □□□□□□□□□□□□ ("hook" or "grip" of saṃsāra) and □□□□□□□ ("security", apparently rendering Skt. yogakṣema) are unusual spellings and are translated by their evident sense.
• □□□□□□□, "official, chief," is read as □□□□□□□, "nephew," which fits Aśoka's following words about his relatives and the Buddha Kāśyapa; this reading is not certain. □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as the aśoka tree (usually □□□□□□□□□□□□). The monk's name □□□□□□□□□ is rendered Aśoka. In the herd leader's thought, □□□□□□□□□ "hold fast, keep together" is rendered by its evident sense.
• The phrase rendered "I simply lived at my ease" (bsod nyams su 'dug 'dug) is unusual; it seems to mean Aśoka grew complacent, relying on his kinship with the Buddha. The brahmin youth Bla ma is rendered by the Sanskrit name Uttara, the name under which Kāśyapa's prophecy to the future Śākyamuni is told. In the summary verse for the next group of ten (stories of hungry ghosts), the items "the lower stream" (chu smad) and "the cesspit" (phyis khung) are tentative literal renderings; I could not identify the corresponding story titles with confidence.
• The Tibetan tshal za, the man the guild leader instructs, is rendered "workman"; it seems to denote a servant or laborer, perhaps one working in the sugarcane plantation. The pratyekabuddha's reflection, "there is no help for it," renders a terse phrase (byas kyis med do) whose exact force is somewhat uncertain.
• The phrase rendered "He was unwell" (na dbu can) is unusual; it may mean he suffered from an illness of the head, but the general sense of being ill is clear from the physician's prescription that follows.
• The ghosts are first introduced with the feminine form □□□□□□□□□ ("female hungry ghost"), although they themselves say they were five hundred guild leaders and are referred to elsewhere simply as hungry ghosts; the translation uses the neutral "hungry ghosts." The "dedication of the offering" renders □□□□□□□□□□□ (Skt. dakṣiṇādeśanā), the recitation that dedicates the merit of a gift. "The gong" renders □□□□□ (gaṇḍī), the wooden sounding board struck to assemble the monks.
• Uttara renders □□□□□□, which names both the boy and the lunar mansion (nakṣatra) under which he was born, Uttarāṣāḍhā; the name is given from the mansion, and the story corresponds to the Uttara tale of the Sanskrit Avadānaśataka. The opening sentence begins mid-thought from the previous piece, completing the three questions the newly born gods ask themselves.
• In Uttara's reply to his mother, the text reads □□□□□□ ("like an illness"), which makes no sense in context; the translation follows the evident reading □□□□□ ("now"). In the account of the stolen cloth, the text reads □□□□□□□□□□□ ("he having departed"), which does not fit the action; the translation follows the evident reading □□□□□□□□□□ ("having cut it up"), since the monk then patches it onto a seat. "Deep weariness with saṃsāra" renders □□□□□□ (Skt.

saṃvega).
• "Nuns still in training and nuns beyond training" renders the technical pair slob pa and mi slob pa (Skt. śaikṣa and aśaikṣa), noble disciples still on the path and arhats. "Regular offerings" renders □□□□, the standing donations made to the community.
• "Struck the gong without pause" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, literally "struck the gong without an end," apparently the continuous signal sounded at a monk's death; the exact sense is uncertain. The closing scene places the visit in the Bamboo Grove at the Kalandaka Feeding Ground, although this story is set in the Jeta Grove at Śrāvastī; the translation follows the text as it stands, which repeats a stock passage.
• □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (literally "son of the reed-giver") is rendered Maudgalyāyana: in this collection the disciple who tours the realm of hungry ghosts is Maudgalyāyana, and this appears to be an older Tibetan rendering of his name, distinct from the more common □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□. "Sons" (□□) is the title of the new story (Sanskrit Putrāḥ). □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, □□□□□□□□□□, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ are the stock classes of personal deities (sahaja, sahadharmika, nityānubaddha) in this formula. In the phrase about the honey, □□□□□□□□□ is read as "unboiled", i.e. pure.
• □□□□□□□□, literally "cesspit," is the title and the boy's name; it is rendered as Jāmbāla ("filth, mire"), the name of the corresponding story in the Sanskrit Avadānaśataka, with the literal sense given once. The second wife (□□□□□□□□□□□) is the one who conceived; the first wife (□□□□□□□□□□), the barren one, is the one who gave the drug and became the hungry ghost woman. □□ is the Kūṭāgāra Hall on the bank of the Markaṭahrada (Monkey Pond).
• □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered "a man of unbroken accomplishment," Pūraṇa taking the boy's love of filth for the indifference of an accomplished ascetic. In "who far surpass even the lord who holds sway over a thousand" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, literally "one who has power over ten hundreds"), the referent is uncertain; it likely corresponds to Sanskrit daśaśatavaśavartin, perhaps the ruler of a thousandfold world system.
• □□□□□□□□□□□ ("Destroyer of Saṃsāra") is the standard Tibetan rendering of Krakucchanda, the buddha of this Fortunate Eon whose era is that of a forty-thousand-year lifespan. □□□□□□□□ is here the name of a royal capital, kept as Sundara. In the arhat's final thought, □□□□□□□□□□ is taken to mean the afflicted monk himself; the arhat keeps silent so as not to provoke him into further harmful speech.
• In the summary verse, the story titles are rendered from the Tibetan; □□□□□□□□□ ("Glorious One," a woman) is given as Śrīmatī, a likely but unconfirmed Sanskrit form; □□□□□ is "parrot" and □□□□ "buffalo." The heading "Here ends the fifth decade" renders "the fifth summary verse is complete," each summary verse marking a group of ten stories.
• "Gave up eating" renders □□□□□□, read in context as the snake's fasting before its death (compare the Sanskrit avadāna motif of renouncing food); the exact sense of the Tibetan expression is not certain. "Departed ancestors" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□, corresponding to Sanskrit pūrvapreta. Here □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ means being carried across the mountain of bones (accumulated over countless rebirths), not the ritual sense of □□□□□□□. "Conqueror of Foes" renders the epithet □□□□□□□.
• □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered "intense attachment"; context (the buried treasure) suggests attachment to wealth, and □□□ may be a slip for □□□ "wealth", but the text is translated as it stands. The boy's name □□□□ ("Moon") is given as Candra; the Sanskrit could also be Soma, so the identification is not certain. "Recite the dedication of the offering" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, the recitation dedicating the merit of a gift (dakṣiṇādeśanā) to the named person.
• The Buddha's reply to the monks appears to continue through the account of the father in the charnel ground; it is rendered as his continuing speech, though the Tibetan may also be read

as resumed narration. "Remains of the dead" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□, literally "the bones of the dead one," here the son's body.

• The festival name □□□□□□□□□□□, "Plucking of the Sāla," corresponds to the Indian spring festival of gathering sāla blossoms (compare Sanskrit śālabhañjikā). In the father's story, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as the king granting the father his life at the son's petition.

• "Many-storied palace" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□ (kūṭāgāra), here an upper-storied building in Ajātaśatru's palace at Rājagṛha, not the Kūṭāgāra Hall at Vaiśālī named elsewhere in the text. The "festival on the fifteenth day" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, the full-moon festival occasion. □□□□□□□□□□ is taken as the jīvaṃjīvaka bird.

• "The view of the perishable collection" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (satkāyadṛṣṭi), whose twenty peaks are the twenty forms of the view of self in relation to the five aggregates. "Departed ancestors" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□, the deceased forebears (pūrvapretas). "The story called The Garment" renders the section heading □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, which opens a new tale.

• "An eighth of a māṣaka" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□, an eighth of a zho, a small unit of weight and money; the point is the smallest possible gift. "The goddess who had formerly offered the cloth" renders the descriptive epithet □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, kept as a description rather than a personal name.

• "The lord of the thousand-fold world" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, literally "one who rules over the tenfold hundred," i.e. the lord of a thousand-world system, a Brahmā. The stock list of numbered qualities (single guard, five factors abandoned, six factors possessed, six constant abidings) is given as this text states it.

• "The view of the perishable collection" renders satkāyadṛṣṭi, the view of a real self in the aggregates; its "twenty peaks" are the twentyfold forms of that view. Spṛkkā is a fragrant plant used in unguents. "Toward me" in the Buddha's explanation follows the Tibetan, referring to the parrot's devotion to the present Buddha.

• "The Messenger" is the title of this new story. In the verse, the Tibetan reads □□□□□□□□□□ ("right bestowing"), which makes little sense here; it is translated as □□□□□□□□□□, "right effort", the evident reading. The bases of miraculous power (ṛddhipāda) and right effort are factors of awakening; the Buddha plays on the messenger's offer of a chariot, and the messenger in turn plays on "the feet of miraculous power."

• "Five great men" follows the Tibetan □□□□□□□□□. Parallel accounts of this kind of taming place masses of fire (□□) at the Buddha's sides, so □□ may be a slip for □□ ("five great fires"); the text is translated as written. "Stopped eating" renders □□□□□□, taken in context as fasting, which the following clause about the animal's fierce digestive fire explains.

• "A master of the three baskets" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (tripiṭaka), a monk learned in all three collections of scripture. In the new story, □□□□□□□□□ (Skt. upoṣadha, the fast-day observance) is the name of the god who appears in it; it is given in its Sanskrit form.

• The householder named □□□□□□□ (literally "Upper Waters") could not be identified with a Sanskrit name with confidence; his name is given in Tibetan phonetics as Chutö. The king's son □□□□□□□□□□ is rendered Sujāta, the usual Sanskrit equivalent. The name of the god Upoṣadha is evidently being linked to the eight-branched upoṣadha observance that the story goes on to tell.

• "Your Majesty" renders the royal honorific □□. The phrase □□□ is somewhat obscure. It is taken to mean that the nāga came out onto open ground and gave up his body to be fed upon, a motif familiar from other upoṣadha-keeping nāgas.

• In the verse, the Tibetan reads "joyful (□□□□□) to see in a thousand existences". The parallel verse in the preceding story has □□□□□, "hard to see", which the sense requires, so this is taken as a copyist's slip and translated as "hard to see".

• The summary verse lists the titles of the ten stories of this section. □□□□□□ could not be identified with confidence and is given in phonetics as Dugu. The other titles are translated by meaning, except Suvarṇābha ("Golden Light"), the hero of the first story.
• The householder's act with the fallen golden mirror is terse in the Tibetan (□□□□□

• Names in the list of would-be donors are identified as follows: □□□□□□□□□□□□ Mallikā, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ Ṛṣidatta, □□□□□□ Purāṇa, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ Viśākhā the mother of Mṛgāra. The kṣatriya maiden □□□□□□□□□□ could not be identified with confidence and is given by its meaning, "Rainy Season."
• The merchant's words "While I lay asleep, you kept watch for me" render the Tibetan literally; the sense is that she made merit on his behalf while he was heedless. "Regular meals in turn" renders a term for food offered to the Saṅgha on a regular rotation.
• The Tibetan name of Śuklā's father, □□□□□, is the usual rendering of the asterism Rohiṇī; the masculine form Rohiṇa is given as the likely Sanskrit, but it is not certain. In "a mind like space and like the palm of the hand," the formula means an arhat's mind is even and unobstructed.
• The girl's name □□□□, "moon," is kept as Candra for consistency with its earlier use in this text; as a woman's name the Sanskrit would properly be Candrā. The list of brahmanical learning follows the standard formula (nighaṇṭu, kaiṭabha, akṣaraprabheda, and itihāsa as the fifth).
• "The view of the perishing collection" is the view of a real self in the transitory aggregates (satkāyadṛṣṭi), whose twenty forms are pictured as mountain peaks. "Ultimate wisdom" refers to the knowledge that brings final liberation, arhatship.
• The brahmin youth □□□□ is given as Uttara, the usual Sanskrit name of the future Śākyamuni in the time of Kāśyapa. The festival is named after the nāga kings □□□□□ and □□□□□□□, given here as Giri and Valgu, following the Sanskrit Avadānaśataka's Girivalgusamāgama festival; the identification is likely but not certain.
• The phrase rendered "the consummation of utmost security" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) appears to correspond to the stock Sanskrit atyantaniṣṭha yogakṣema preceding nirvāṇa; the Tibetan wording is unusual and the rendering follows that parallel. "The five bases of discipline" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) likely corresponds to the five training precepts. The sage's teaching to the kinnarī is given in the past tense in the Tibetan and is translated as it stands.
• The king is called □□□□□□, while the palace is □□□□□□□□ (Sundara); both are taken as Sundara, the king evidently bearing the name of his capital. □□□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□□, "actors", an evident slip. The section heading "The story called Sundarī" marks the start of the next avadāna.
• "Kings of the land" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, literally "kings beneath the sun," i.e. the rulers of the surrounding regions. The princes address the nun with □□□, literally "aunt," a respectful term of address, rendered "Sister."
• The merchant's name □□□□□□ (later □□□□) is rendered Jaya, the usual Sanskrit for this Tibetan; the original may instead be Jina. The phrase rendered "whenever her garland of pearls was taken off, it appeared again" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is terse; the sense of □□□ is inferred from context. Anāthapiṇḍada's son is given the Sanskrit masculine form Supriya, consistent with the earlier name Supriyā listed for the same Tibetan.
• "Collect offerings" renders □□□□□□□□□□□, literally "collect faith," meaning to gather donations given in faith. "The quinquennial festival" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (Skt. pañcavārṣika). The "perfumed chamber" is the Buddha's dwelling (gandhakuṭī).
• "Withdrew into seclusion" renders nang du yang dag 'jog las gshegs pa; the particle las ("from") would literally suggest "came out of seclusion," but the sense, matching the Sanskrit Avadānaśataka (pratisaṃlayanāya praviśati), is that the Buddha gave a brief instruction and then withdrew, after which Kacaṅgalā explained it in detail. "Mahāmāyā" renders sgyu 'phrul chen mo, the Buddha's mother in his final life.
• The heroine's name, bde byed ma, and the prince's, bde byed, are given as Kṣemaṅkarā and Kṣemaṅkara on the standard equivalence bde byed = Kṣemaṃkara; the corresponding Sanskrit Avadānaśataka story calls her Kṣemā, so the exact Sanskrit form behind this Tibetan is not

certain. The king's reply, "this is not something I can undo" (ngas bcos su med), is understood as his saying that the betrothal he made, which brought him peace at her birth, cannot be revoked.

• "Those who hold sway over a thousand worlds" renders brgya phrag bcu pa la dbang byed pa ("those who have power over ten hundreds"), the stock epithet in which the buddhas are said to surpass such world-rulers.

• The girl's name □□□□ is a Sanskrit name written in Tibetan letters; it is given here as spelled, "Rastha"; its intended Sanskrit form is uncertain. The caravan leader's name □□□□ is rendered Gaṅga.

• "No wonder Gaṅga would not show her to us" renders the friends' remark ending in yus so, taken as acknowledging that his keeping her hidden was understandable.

• Rastha's name is kept as given earlier in this text. The names in the summary verse are identified from the parallel ninth decade of the Sanskrit Avadānaśataka; □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is translated literally as "the Apparitionally Born," since its exact Sanskrit title is uncertain. □□□□□□□□□□□□□ here is the monk Rāṣṭrapāla of the avadāna, not the Great King Dhṛtarāṣṭra, whose Tibetan name is spelled the same way. The boy born at sea is called Samudra, "ocean," as in the Sanskrit collection.

• The five kinds of hired crew are given in Tibetan terms whose exact nautical functions are not all certain; "bird-handlers" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□ literally, presumably the men who kept shore-sighting birds, but the identification is tentative. The epithet □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ qualifying nirvāṇa is obscure; it is rendered by its evident sense, corresponding to the stock Sanskrit phrase for nirvāṇa as the absolute culmination (atyantaniṣṭha). "Those who hold sway over a thousand" renders the stock epithet daśaśatavaśavartin, usually understood of Indra and similar lords.

• The merchants address the sage as bhagavat, rendered "Lord", as is usual when the title is given to a ṛṣi rather than to the Buddha. The divine flowers named in the last sentence are sumanas (jasmine) blossoms, which give the boy his name.

• The river □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ could not be identified with a known Sanskrit name and is given in phonetics as Khangden; its words mean roughly "possessing houses". In the verse, □□□□□□ is taken as an affectionate term for the young novice ("that little one"); the reading is not certain. "Gathered their conditions ... come upon him like a flood, inescapably" renders the stock Avadāna formula for the ripening of karma.

• "The Nandana Grove" renders □□□□□□□□□□, the pleasure grove of the gods of the Thirty-Three.

• The child's name, literally "Three Baskets" (Sanskrit Tripiṭaka, "the Three Collections"), is kept as Tripiṭa to match the earlier pieces. In "the dress of a renunciant," the first occurrence reads dag sbyong, evidently a slip for dge sbyong ("śramaṇa, renunciant"), which the later occurrences have. "Like a flood" renders dba' rgal, read as the stock simile of actions surging forth like a torrent.

• The line rendered "Surely I have not broken the promise I made before" is obscure in the Tibetan (gnyer dgum gor ma chag) and is translated by its evident sense. In "it would be good if the prince went forth, but it would not be good if he were to die here," the phrase de'u re is read in that sense. "Eloquent in knowledge and in liberation" renders rig pa dang grol bar smra ba, a stock epithet of a skilled Dharma speaker. Among the classes of beings, gdon sbyin is an evident slip for gnod sbyin, yakṣa.

• The river chu klung zlog byed, literally "the Averter," is taken as the Varaṇā, the river bounding Vārāṇasī whose name derives from a root meaning "to ward off." The phrase rendered "remained there, resting on his deeds" (las la rten cing 'dug) is terse; it may imply that he sat in contemplation of his karma rather than any act of self-harm, and the story continues with him alive.

• The king of trees yongs 'du sa brtol is the Pārijāta (also called Pārijātaka or Kovidāra), the celestial coral tree of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three; the stone slab "like a white woolen blanket" is the Pāṇḍukambala stone on which the Buddha spent this rains retreat teaching his mother.
• "Faith grounded in understanding" renders shes nas dad pa, the Tibetan for avetyaprasāda, the unwavering confidence of the noble disciple in the Buddha, Dharma and Saṅgha, together with the moral discipline dear to the noble ones (āryakānta śīla); these four are the factors of stream-entry.
• The city □□□□□□□ is taken as Sāṃkāśya, the traditional site of the Buddha's descent from the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, which fits this episode. The forest name □□□□□□□□ is a transliteration that I could not identify with confidence; it is given as spelled, "Apadjara."
• The monk's first aspiration, □□□□□□□□

• □□□□□□□□□□□□ / □□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as the pravāraṇā, the ceremony closing the rains retreat (usually □□□□□□□□ in Tibetan), as the following passage on exclusion from the assembly suggests. In the story title and the Buddha's question, □□□□□□ (Skt. sthavira) means both "old man" and "elder", which is the point of the naming.
• "The lord of the thousand" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("one who holds sway over ten hundred"), a stock comparison in this epithet series whose referent is not certain.
• In the Elder's first full answer the Tibetan begins one sentence with □□□□□ ("then"), where the parallel answers have none; it is read as continuing the Elder's reply ("And so").
• The text reads "mother's lta" in the Buddha's concluding statement; this is evidently a slip for lto, "womb," as in the monks' question, and is translated accordingly. The name rendered "the Elder" (rgan po) is kept as established earlier in the text; it is distinct from the title "senior monk" or "elder" (gnas brtan, sthavira) that precedes it.
• The phrase rendered "stroked them" (mthang la 'jor bar byed) is obscure; the sense of caressing the newly found hands is clear from context, but the exact gesture is uncertain. The opening line, "The story called Hastaka," is the title of the new avadāna.
• "Attendant śramaṇa" renders the Tibetan for one who follows behind a monk on his rounds (Skt. paścācchramaṇa). "Mixed actions" renders a term meaning actions both black and white.
• "Perfumed Chamber" renders the term for the Buddha's own dwelling (Skt. gandhakuṭī). The idiom rendered "struck me in the belly" means that Śāriputra's sweeping has deprived him of his food. The last clause, literally "the mouth became nonexistent and it was cast outside," is taken to mean that his mouth closed up and the food dropped away.
• "Eat ashes!" renders a curse whose verb as written ('gom, "tread") is odd; the sense is fixed by the later statement that he "passed into nirvāṇa after eating ashes." "Threw it to the ground" renders an unclear verb (pho nas), read as "dropping" or "knocking down." "A brahmin devoted to the gods" (lha la rten pa) could possibly be a personal name, but no Sanskrit form can be identified with confidence.
• The monks' question says Saṃsāra "came forth from his mother's womb as a corpse, dead" for five hundred lifetimes, which the narrative of this passage does not otherwise describe; it is translated as it stands, and the explanation presumably follows in the account of his past deeds. "Five-spoked wheel of saṃsāra" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□, the standard Avadāna image of the wheel with five sections (pañcagaṇḍaka), one for each destiny.
• The young monk's curse literally says he should not come out "of the house" alive; the story's fulfillment shows it was understood as the womb. Two names could not be identified with confidence and are translated literally: □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, "Lac Ear" (possibly Skt. Jatukarṇa), the one who invited the Buddha, and the land □□□□□□□□, "the land of Baskets." The line naming the twenty-second and final section is a section marker that the Tibetan places here, before the last stories.
• In the opening sentence the phrase □□□□□□□□□□ is obscure; it is taken in the sense "before he is lost," which fits the pratyekabuddha's compassionate intention. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered "a deserted pleasure grove"; □□□□□□ could also be the grove's proper name.
• The past buddha □□□□ is given as Tiṣya, the name under which this well-known episode appears in the Abhidharmakośabhāṣya; other sources call him Puṣya, and the Tibetan can render either. The verse of praise is in long lines of several metrical segments each and is rendered as four long lines.
• The particle □□□, used several times to open Gaṅgika's reflections, is an exclamation ("well then"), not "mother". The address □□□□□□□ in the king's words is rendered "my son"; it may allude to Gaṅgika being an only son. The passage on the executioners is translated as the Tibetan stands; in parallel avadāna accounts the blue garments and karavīra garland mark the condemned man.

• In the Dīrghanakha story, □□□□ in the debates between Śārī and her brother is the technical term for defeat in debate (nigraha), not the doctrinal "annihilation," and □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ likewise is a sense of defeat. The village □□□□□□□□□□□ ("having spikenard") is rendered Nālada, the spikenard (nalada) village known as Śāriputra's birthplace. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is Dīrghanakha's clan name, Agnivaiśyāyana. In the list of those who honored the Buddha, □□□□□□□□□ is the verb "revered," not the name Uttara.
• In the third reflection the Tibetan reads □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("one accepts everything") where the parallel clauses have □□□□□□; this is evidently a copyist's slip, and it is translated as "I accept everything." Here □□□□□□ in □□□□□□□□□□□□ is "affection for the body," not the name Maitreya.
• Two readings are taken as copyists' slips. In the first list of what the śrāvaka understands about feelings, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("escape"), as in the repeated list that follows. In Śāriputra's reflection, "speaks only of the experience (□□□□□□) of these dharmas" is read as "the abandoning (□□□□□□)," which the next sentence requires. The arhat whom the Buddha names at the end, after Dīrghanakha's ordination, is called Sthūlakoṣṭhaka (in other sources Mahākauṣṭhila).
• The Tibetan □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as the Upavartana of the Mallas, the traditional site of the parinirvāṇa near Kuśinagarī. The robbers' "offering to the yakṣa" appears, from the sequel, to be a human sacrifice for which they seek a victim, though the text does not say so explicitly.
• The place name Earth-Holder (sa 'dzin) and the village name Great Flower Load (me tog khur chen) are translated literally, as their Sanskrit forms could not be identified with confidence. The boy's name mdzes ldan, "the Beautiful One," is rendered Sundara, its most likely Sanskrit form. In Ānanda's verse, "bza' shing" is read as the cloths or garments wrapping the body, in line with the known tradition that the innermost and outermost wrappings of the Buddha's body did not burn. The phrase "a hundred thousand pearl necklaces" may instead mean a pearl necklace worth a hundred thousand, as is common in avadāna literature.
• The elder □□□□□□□□□□ is identified as Upagupta, the elder associated with King Aśoka at the Kukkuṭārāma; the usual Tibetan rendering is □□□□□□□□□, but this form is plainly the same figure. "The wheel of saṃsāra with its five spokes" refers to the five destinies of rebirth.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.